deficient harvests were experienced in 1907 and 1908, and in both years epidemics of cholera supervened, accounting in all for 15,500 deaths. In other respects, the decade was a period of development. The Barun-Daltongunj Railway was opened in 1902, thus bringing Palamau into direct communication with both Northern India and Bengal, and this gave a great stimulus to trade and commerce. There was also a boom in the lac market, which did not a little to bring money into the cultivators' pockets. The district abounds in *palas*, *kusum* and *bair* trees, which had for a long time past been regarded as of no particular economic value. The people now realized that they could, with little labour and cost, be turned into a source of profit. They were thus able to supplement their resources materially, and a number of lac factories were established in different parts of the district.

339. The excess of births over deaths in the ten years was 68,585, and the increment of population recorded at the census closely corresponds with this figure, being 67,667 or 10·9 per cent. The balance of migration is only slightly against the district, the outflow of population being less than the influx by 11,500. Compared with 1901, however, the movements of migrants have made a considerable difference, for emigrants have increased by 5,000, while immigrants are 13,000 fewer in number.

PALAMAU.	1911.		1901.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Actual population	341,615	345,654	306,203	313,397
Immigrants	13,968	11,942	19,899	18,939
Emigrants	18,968	18,512	14,689	17,521
Natural population	346,593	352,225	300,993	311,979

The increase has been general throughout the district, except in the Husainabad thana in the north, where there is a considerable decline. Part of this may be ascribed to the fact that at the last census the construction of the Barun-Daltonganj Railway through the thana caused a temporary increase of its population. Part may also be ascribed to mortality from cholera: plague also made its appearance more than once, but caused very little mortality. In all but one of the other thanas the increase is over 10 per cent., and in the south of the district away from the railway (in thanas Ranka, Mahuadand and Latehar) it varies from 19 to 31 per cent. All these are sparsely inhabited thanas, and the actual variation is not very great: in 1901, moreover, there appears to have been considerable temporary migration in consequence of scarcity.

MANBHUM.

340. Manbhum, which has long been the least difficult of access of all the Chota Nagpur districts, and whose coal-fields have attracted outside labour, has been developing very rapidly since 1881. In 1891 the addition of population amounted to 12·8 per cent., and this was followed by a further increase of 9·1 per cent. in 1901. The growth during the last decade would undoubtedly have been greater had it not been for acute scarcity in 1897 and the adverse balance of migration. Emigration to the tea districts was active throughout the decade and reached large proportions in 1896 and 1897; there was also a movement of the labouring classes to the Raniganj coal-field in Burdwan, but this was small compared with the movement of coolies to Assam, where half the emigrant population was enumerated in 1901. Altogether, there was a net loss of 30,000 persons by migration, and it was estimated that had it not been for this loss there would have been a natural increase of between 11 and 12 per cent.

MANBHUM.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
DISTRICT TOTAL	**1,547,576**	**+ 18·92**	**+9·05**
Sadar Subdivision ...	**1,163,454**	**+13·59**	**+ 5·39**
Jhalda	120,082	+ 16·57	+ 0·87
Purulia	287,133	+ 15·30	+ 11·81
Baghmandi	45,674	+ 12·55	+ 5·40
Chandil	109,803	+ 11·24	+ 6·51
Barabhum	143,999	+ 10·49	+ 4·88
Manbazar	99,902	+ 16·05	+ 10·42
Raghunathpur	132,618	+ 10·58	+ 2·65
Gaurangdi	58,636	+ 11·18	+ 0·19
Para	47,665	+ 12·01	— 2·13
Chas	117,940	+ 16·47	+ 0·77
Dhanbaid Subdivision ...	**384,122**	**+38·61**	**+25·15**
Gobindpur	45,075	+ 18·05	+ 4·37
Jheria	133,383	+ 75·50	+ 75·14
Topechanchi	99,832	+ 44·00	+ 30·24
Nirsha	69,420	+ 10·48	+ 7·09
Tundi	36,412	+ 18·31	+ 4·15

341. During the ten years ending in 1910 a great stimulus was given to the progress of the district by the development of the coal mines. During the first part of the decade the number of labourers in the mines was more than doubled, and in the second it rose again by two-thirds. High-water mark was reached in 1908, after which there was a falling off due to the state of the coal market. In spite of this, the industrial census shows that nearly 80,000 persons were employed in the collieries at the time of the census. There was also a "boom" in the lac trade, which was followed by a "slump" in 1908, but notwithstanding this the number of factories increased from 52 in 1900-1901 to 118 in 1909-10, when they gave employment to nearly 6,000 persons. The bulk of the people are agriculturists, who are compensated more or less for a failure of their harvests by the lac crop. Their harvests were good during the first half of the decade, but owing to deficient rainfall were very short in 1907-1908. The outturn was, however, excellent in the remaining years. The public health was, on the whole, good except for epidemics of cholera, which swept over the Jheria coal-field during several years. In 1908 there was a particularly virulent epidemic, which caused no less than 12,000 deaths; even this figure probably falls far short of the actuals, as the coal-field area in the Jheria and Topchanchi thanas was for some time reduced to a state of panic, and the returns were defective. The disease spread rapidly through the field, and panic-stricken coolies hurrying away from the infected collieries spread the disease into all parts of the district. The total death-rate during the decade was low, the average being only 26·5 per mille, and the net excess of births over deaths was 167,000.

342. The census shows that the number of inhabitants is now 246,212, or 18·9 per cent. more than in 1901. The increment is partly due to the natural growth of population and partly to migration being in favour of the district. A very remarkable change in the flow of migration inwards and outwards has taken place in the last ten years, owing mainly to the influx of outside labour to the collieries and to the fact that local labourers prefer the good wages offered there to the prospects of distant employment. The number of persons who have come into the district has risen by 80,000 and is now more than double what it was in 1901, while the number of emigrants has diminished by 21,000. The result of the tide of migration setting into the district instead of away from it, is that, whereas in 1901 emigrants outnumbered immigrants by nearly 74,000, the latter are now in excess by 27,000.

MANBHUM.	1911.		1901.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Actual population	788,537	759,039	653,336	648,028
Immigrants	82,606	60,170	37,391	24,728
Emigrants	50,465	65,027	64,915	71,057
Natural population ...	756,396	763,896	680,860	694,357

No less than two-fifths of the total increase is accounted for by the two thanas of Jheria and Topchanchi, which contain most of the collieries. Their expansion in the last 20 years, during which the bulk of them were opened, has been extraordinary, for Jheria has trebled its population, while Topchanchi has an increase of 88 per cent. Excluding these two thanas, Manbhum has had a proportional growth of a little under 13 per cent. since 1901. This advance has been general and fairly uniform, for no thana has an increase of less than 10 per cent. or of more than 18·3 per cent.

343. The census which has recently has been concluded shows that the population of Singhbhum is more than 50 per cent. what it was 30 years ago. The recorded growth would have been even greater but for emigration to the Feudatory States of Orissa and also to the tea districts of Assam and Jalpaiguri. In spite of this drain, there was an increase of 20 per cent. in 1891 and another advance of 12·5 per cent. in 1901.

SINGHBHUM.

SINGHBHUM.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
DISTRICT TOTAL	***694,394***	***+ 13·17***	***+ 12·48***
Chakradharpur	112,154	+ 9·34	+ 17·96
Ghatsila	255,731	+ 16·10	+ 18·26
Chaibasa	271,924	+ 8·59	+ 9·26
Monoharpur	54,585	+ 35·29	+ 15·69

The effects of scarcity in 1900 lingered for a little

time, the birth-rate being as low as 30 per mille in 1901, but it rose to 46 per mille in 1903. Until 1907 the condition of the people continued to be prosperous, but in that year there was a partial failure of the crops and some stress was felt in 1908, when cholera, that common concomitant of scarcity, broke out. In the decennium as a whole there was an excess of 87,000 births over deaths. The ten years under review were not only prosperous from an agricultural point of view, but also ushered in an era of industrial development. The Tata Iron and Steel Company opened large works at Sakchi in Dhalbhum, a railway being at the same time built from Kalimati to Gurumaisini in Mayurbhanj. Iron mines were also opened in Dhalbhum and in the Buda and Notu hills of the Kolhan by the Bengal Iron and Steel Company, a light railway being constructed for the carriage of ore from the hills to the main line at Manoharpur. "There is," reports the Deputy Commissioner (Mr. A. W. Cook), "a constant stream of cooly labour to the railways, mines and iron works, and among the coolies are included a large proportion of raiyats with small holdings. The off-season is spent at these centres, and at sowing and harvest time the workers return to their fields. The importance of this boon to the labourers and the poorer classes of raiyats cannot be over-estimated. They are provided with money to tide over the period from sowing to harvest, and, as a consequence, are no longer forced to have recourse to *mahajans* for their living expenses during this period."

344. The increase of population now recorded, viz., 80,815 or 13·2 per cent., must be attributed to the natural fecundity of a people with a large aboriginal element, the opening out of the district by the railway, and its more recent industrial development. The increase would have been greater but for the loss by migration. There has been, it is true, an influx of labourers and artisans to the iron works, mines and railways, and the concentration of labour in large centres has been accompanied by an increase in the number of traders who supply their wants. Owing mainly to this cause, the number of immigrants has increased by 13,000, but this increase is more than counterbalanced by the greater exodus from the district. The scarcity of 1907-08 drove many out of the district—the number of coolies recruited for Assam in this and the next year was greater than the aggregate for the preceding six years. Apart from this, the people, having realized how cheap and easy it is to travel by rail, and what good wages can be earned elsewhere, have learnt the habit of temporary migration. Emigrants are now more numerous by 42,000 than in 1901, and outnumber the immigrants by 56,000.

345. The increase is by no means uniformly distributed and varies very largely in different areas. The greatest fluctuation between the percentage of growth in 1901 and 1911 is noticeable in thanas Manoharpur and Chakradharpur. In the former the ratio has risen by almost 20 per cent., in the latter there is a deficit of about 9. This is due mainly to movements between the two thanas. It is reported that on the census day a large number of residents of the Chakradharpur thana were working at the works of the Bengal Iron and Steel Company, as well as in Manoharpur and its neighbourhood. In Ghatsila (Dhalbhum) the rate of growth has been slightly accelerated, while in the Chaibasa portion of the Kolhan it has slightly fallen off. The explanation is that a number of persons from the Kolhan left for employment in the iron works at Sakchi in Dhalbhum as well as at Gurumaisini in Mayurbhanj.

SINGHBHUM.	1911.		1901.	
	Males.	Females.	Males.	Females.
Actual population	341,207	353,187	302,425	311,154
Immigrants	21,027	28,831	18,536	18,044
Emigrants	50,432	55,202	31,293	32,527
Natural population	370,612	379,558	315,182	325,637

SONTHAL PARGANAS.

346. The census of the Sonthal Parganas both in 1872 and 1881 was admittedly incomplete—in 1881 an army of 4,500 men had to be sent into the district to prevent an outbreak, and the first reliable census was that of 1891. The census of 1901 showed an increase of only 3·2 per cent., but it was estimated that but for emigration there would have been an advance of at least 10 per cent.

The decade opened with bright prospects for the cultivators, for average or good crops were reaped during the first four years, but from 1905 to 1907 the harvests were deficient. The ensuing distress culminated in 1908, when the people, whose staying powers had been severely tried by three bad years, were on the verge of famine in the Dumka and Godda subdivisions. Some relief was obtained by the high prices obtained from lac, but the aboriginals squandered their profits in drink: on this account, the scarcity in 1908 actually coincided with an abnormal increase in the consumption of country spirit. A more substantial mitigation of the distress was furnished by the readiness of the able-bodied Santals to leave their homes in search of labour and wages. Owing to the exodus of the males, and also to the lowered vitality of those left behind, the birth-rate fell from 44 per mille in 1904 to 34 per mille in 1908, and sunk to 31 per mille next year; but after this, good crops and the fall of prices brought about a rapid recovery. In spite of these adverse conditions, there was, according to the returns, an excess of 190,669 of births over deaths during the whole decade.

SONTHAL PARGANAS.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
DISTRICT TOTAL ...	**1,882,973**	**+ 4·05**	**+ 3·19**
Dumka Subdivision ...	**416,004**	**- 0·21**	**+ 3·1**
Dumka	377,713	- 2·25	+ 6·5
Dumka Damin	38,291	+ 25·67	- 26·77
Godda Subdivision ...	**387,160**	**- 0·81**	**+ 1·39**
Godda	122,657	- 11·06	+ 12·32
Pareya	61,668	+ 3·90	- 2·27
Mahagama	93,015	- 0·87	+ 6·22
Godda Damin	109,820	+ 10·67	- 12·27
Deoghar Subdivision ...	**306,477**	**+ 3·05**	**+ 4·68**
Deoghar	103,981	+ 0·29	+ 2·88
Sarwan	41,275		
Madhupur	83,025	+ 8·37	+ 4·21
Sarath	78,196	+ 2·95	+ 8·79
Jamtara Subdivision ...	**205,646**	**+ 8·35**	**+ 9·25**
Pakaur Subdivision ...	**257,635**	**+ 7·95**	**+ 3·6**
Pakaur	84,891	+ 14·92	+ 8·24
Pakuria P. S.	38,254	+ 4·96	+ 2·13
Maheshpur I. O. P.	65,931		
Pakaur Damin	68,559	+ 4·63	+ 1·1
Rajmahal Subdivision	**310,051**	**+ 12·05**	**+ 0·11**
Rajmahal	67,165	+ 18·95	- 6·66
Barharwa	40,084	+ 6·92	
Sahibganj	28,516	+ 44·89	- 2·49
Rajmahal Damin	174,286	+ 3·88	+ 4·83

347. The census shows that the total addition of population is only 73,236 or 4 per cent. To repeat the remarks made in the last census report regarding the ratio of increase recorded in 1901:—"This is a surprisingly small rate of development in a healthy district with a prolific population. The statistics of migration supply the necessary explanation." In that year the number of persons born in the Sonthal Parganas but enumerated elsewhere was 226,008: it has now reached the astonishing figure of 321,283, an increase of 95,000 in 10 years. There are, moreover, 5,000 less immigrants in the district than in 1901, and the emigrants outnumber the immigrants by 215,000. There is, in fact, an army of emigrants pouring forth from the district year by year, and spreading over the Barind in Malda and Dinajpur, the rice-fields in other Bengal districts, and the coal-mines in Manbhum and Burdwan.

SONTHAL PARGANAS.	1911.		1901	
	Males.	Females.	Males.	Females.
Actual population ...	933,425	949,548	896,373	913,364
Immigrants ...	48,366	58,331	53,191	58,334
Emigrants	162,101	159,182	115,894	110,114
Natural popul tio ...	1,047,160	1,050,399	959,076	965,144

348. The Dumka and Godda subdivisions, which suffered most from the succession of bad years (1905-1908), show a slight decrease, the result of emigration. The decline in both is confined to the thanas outside the Damin (except the hilly area of Poreya), while there has been a substantial addition to the inhabitants of the Damin. The Deoghar subdivision was also affected by scarcity, but to a smaller degree, and has grown slightly: thanas Deoghar (with Sarwan) and Madhupur, which suffered most, are practically stationary, but Madhupur thana is more populous by 8·4 per cent. The Jamtara and Pakaur subdivisions, which were still less affected by poor harvests and high prices, have a normal growth (8·35 and 7·95 per cent. respectively), in which all parts share. The Rajmahal subdivision is the most progressive part of the district: the greater part of its increase (12 per cent.) is due to natural growth, but part is due to the fact that there was a large labour force, mainly of up-country coolies, employed in the Lower Ganges Bridge quarries in 1911, and that Sahibganj, the increase in which appears *primâ*

facie abnormal, was partially deserted in 1901 on account of an epidemic of plague.

349. The increase in the Damin since 1901 amounts to 11·9 per cent., whereas in the remainder of the district it is only 2·8 per cent. A certain amount of growth in the Damin may be expected, for the population consists of prolific aboriginals, mainly Santals, who have been benefited by special agrarian legislation. "To that legislation is due the unhampered extension of cultivation, the controlled enhancement of rent, and the general protection of weak and ignorant cultivators, who would otherwise have become the prey of their wilier and stronger neighbours, and have sunk into the position of hewers of wood and drawers of water for the more advanced races round them."* On the other hand, a large percentage of increase is not to be expected in the Damin, which loses heavily by emigration and which consists mainly of hills, where cultivation is neither so advanced nor so widespread as in the plains. The cultivated area has, it is true, increased by 36 per cent. in 30 years, but the increase in the zamindari estates amounts to 84 per cent. When the figures for different tracts are examined, there are the most remarkable variations, as shown in the marginal table. In the Pakaur and Rajmahal subdivisions the increase in the Damin is less than in the country outside it, as is only natural, for the latter tract (except for part of Maheshpur and Pakauria thanas) consists of fertile alluvial soil. The population of the Pakaur and Rajmahal thanas was, moreover, temporarily swollen by the presence of imported coolies and masons working in the Lower Ganges Bridge quarries near Tudkipur (Rajmahal) and Pakaur, while the addition in the Sahibganj thana, as already explained, is due to its being partially evacuated in 1901. In the Dumka and Godda subdivisions, however, the results are exactly the reverse. In the former subdivision, the Damin lost 26·77 per cent. between 1891 and 1901, and now has a gain of 25·67 per cent., though the rest of the subdivision has a decrease. In Godda, the Damin lost 12·27 per cent. at the last census and now has advanced by 10·67 per cent., whereas there is a decrease of 4·77 per cent. outside the Damin. In both subdivisions, emigration from the Damin is active, and *a priori* large increases in this area are not to be expected. The explanation appears to be that there was some confusion about the boundaries of the Damin in 1901 and that part of its population was included in the country outside it. It is safer therefore to compare the present results with those of 1891, according to which the Dumka and Godda Damin have a decrease of 8·6 and 3 per cent. respectively (the result chiefly of emigration), while the country outside the Damin has an increase of 4·1 and 2 per cent., respectively.

Subdivision.	Variation per cent. since 1901.	
	Damin.	Extra Damin.
Dumka	+25·67	- 2·25
Godda	+10·67	- 4·77
Pakaur	+ 4·63	+ 9·2
Rajmahal	+ 6·88	+ 19·5

350. In Angul the census of 1901 showed an increase of 12·85 per cent., but while the Angul subdivision added 23 per cent. to its population, the Khondmals lost 3 per cent. There had been some distress in the Angul subdivision in 1897 owing to the partial failure of the crops. After this, the people had a series of bad years, which exhausted their resources and culminated in general scarcity in 1900-01. This was most felt in the Khondmals, specially by those who depended for their sustenance on jungle produce, such as yams and edible bulbs. There were again short harvests in 1902-03, but next year, with bumper crops, all signs of distress disappeared. The prosperity of the people continued till 1908, when there was again scarcity. The failure of the rains, in the latter part of 1907 caused great damage to the winter rice, and the *rabi* crops also suffered. There was a fair mango

Angul.

Angul.	Population, 1911.	Percentage of variation.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
District total	**199,451**	+ 3·93	+ 12·85
Sadar Subdivision	**125,233**	- 1·93	+ 23·13
Khondmals Subdivision ...	**74,218**	+ 15·58	- 3·22

* H. McPherson, *Sonthal Parganas Settlement Report.*

crop in the Angul subdivision, but it failed in the Khondmals, while the *mahua* crop was a failure in both areas. The failure of these two crops seriously affected the poorer classes and aboriginal races, who live on them for about three months in the year. For three successive years, these and other crops had suffered more or less, but it was not until 1908 that the accumulative effect of all these partial failures, coupled with the prevailing high prices, began to show itself and to necessitate relief measures. About three-fourths of the district was affected; the distressed classes were mainly Pans and labourers, the numbers requiring relief being augmented by the families of Pans who had absconded. The distress was never very acute, and it was not necessary to declare famine. In the Angul subdivision, however, considerable mortality was caused by cholera, which was introduced from Dhenkanal; the deaths due to it in this year represented no less than 10 per mille of the population of the subdivision.

351. The census of 1911 shows that, while there is a total addition of 7,540 or 3·9 per cent., the results of the preceding census in the two subdivisions are reversed. The Angul subdivision, which had a large growth between 1891 and 1901, has lost ground, while the Khondmals, which declined slightly in that decade, has advanced rapidly. Probably part of the increase in the Khondmals must be ascribed to an improvement in the methods of enumeration, and part to the natural fecundity of the Khonds. There have been no widespread epidemics, and even 1908, when there was scarcity, was a healthy year, the drought causing a diminution of malaria. Moreover, though the hill and jungle areas in which the Khonds live were most affected by the drought, the Khonds, being accustomed to live on jungle produce, experienced less distress than the poorer cultivators and labourers in the plains of Angul. In the latter subdivision, the loss is partly due to the mortality caused by cholera and partly to loss from emigration, the Pans having migrated to Assam and elsewhere in considerable numbers. In the district, as a whole, the emigrants now outnumber the immigrants, whereas the reverse was the case in 1901. Inquiries made in 1908 showed that 1,276 persons emigrated to the tea gardens, and, according to the census returns, the total number of emigrants to places outside the district is or more than treble the number returned in 1901.

ANGUL.	1911.		1901.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Actual population ...	98,372	101,079	95,985	95,976
Immigrants ...	7,873	10,775	9,363	12,169
Emigrants	9,253	11,864	2,294	4,184
Natural population ...	99,752	102,168	88,866	87,991

SAMBALPUR.

352. In Sambalpur, as in other districts of the Chota Nagpur Plateau, the first reliable census was that of 1891, which disclosed a growth of 11·7 per cent. The development of the district received a severe check in the next decade owing to the famine of 1900 and the mortality caused by epidemics of fever, cholera and small-pox during the famine—the death-rate for this year rose to the appalling figure of 108 per mille. The result was that the census of 1901 showed an addition to the population of only 3·3 per cent. The Sambalpur subdivision suffered little, and the east and north of the Bargarh subdivision were not seriously affected; but distress was very acute in the south-west of the latter and especially in Borasambar.

SAMBALPUR.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION. 1901—1911.
DISTRICT TOTAL	***744,193***	***+ 16·46***
Sadar Subdivision ...	***302,039***	***+ 10·03***
Mundher	15,660	+ 28·07
Dhama	30,125	+ 9·62
Sambalpur	50,569	+ 9·40
Sasan	28,892	+ 14·62
Katarbaga	34,506	+ 6·21
Laikera	41,122	+ 3·48
Jharsugra	41,838	+ 12·03
Rampella	31,344	+ 13·18
Mura	27,983	+ 7·83
Bargarh Subdivision ...	***442,154***	***+ 21·27***
Ambabhona	26,220	+ 12·54
Attabira	48,878	+ 12·73
Bheran	46,785	+ 12·81
Bargarh	39,550	+ 19·27
Bhasli	51,509	+ 16·07
Sohella	39,586	+ 17·50
Bijepur	35,619	+ 23·79
Melchhamunda	33,369	+ 20·42
Gaisilat	21,193	+ 27·45
Padampur	23,222	+ 27·48
Jagdalpur	31,510	+ 27·48
Paikmal	25,077	+ 42·48
	19,636	+ 70·21

The birth-rate of 1901, which was only 30 per mille, was abnormally low in consequence of lowered vitality and reduced fecundity, while, owing to the previous clearance made by famine and disease among the old and weakly, the death-rate reached the minimum ever recorded

(19·56 per mille). The recovery from the effects of the famine was, however, rapid, for next year the birth-rate rose abruptly to 46·65 per mille and throughout the succeeding years it continued at a very high level. The death-rate on the other hand was uniformly low except in 1908, and the combined effect of a high birth-rate and a low death-rate was an excess of births amounting to 104,000 in the decade. The people, moreover, had a succession of good agricultural seasons, except in 1901-03 and 1907-1908, when crops were short in consequence of capricious and unevenly distributed rainfall. On the whole, the decade was one of steady and peaceful progress. "In every direction," writes the Deputy Commissioner, "there are evidences of increasing prosperity. New villages have been settled, and new lands are being brought under cultivation. Agriculture has improved as well as extended. Facilities for irrigation have increased. The value of land has gone up appreciably. The railway has developed the trade of the country, and agricultural produce has commanded better prices than ever it did before. Indebtedness has not increased. The standard of living has not appreciably risen, but ideas of comfort have begun to take hold of the people. Coarse Ganda cloths are being given up in favour of those of finer texture; more people now use shirts and shoes; gold and silver ornaments are coming into greater use. Tiled houses are now quite common, and even pucca houses are not so rare as they used to be. Bicycles too are very much more largely used every year."

353. The census shows the effect of these influences, and testifies to the completeness of the recovery from the famine, for there has been an addition of 105,201 or 16·5 per cent. The increase is partially due to improved enumeration in some tracts, but, even so, the figure is remarkable, when it is considered that the balance of migration is adverse to the district, emigrants outnumbering immigrants by 130,000. Figures are not available showing the number of immigrants that were enumerated in 1901 in the present district, but those for the district as then constituted (which extended over 1,136 square miles more than it now does) will serve for purposes of comparison. They show that there are now nearly 19,000 less immigrants, but 66,000 more emigrants. Part of the decrease of the former may be due to the reduction of area. The large rise in the number of the latter is striking evidence of the extent to which the people of Sambalpur have moved out of the district.

SAMBALPUR.	1911.		1901.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Actual population ...	365,552	378,641	313,882	325,110
Immigrants[a]	19,700	23,701	29,073	33,087
Emigrants[a]	88,108	85,419	48,509	56,333
Natural population ...	433,960	440,359	333,318	348,556

354. All parts of the districts are progressive, but while the Sambalpur subdivision, which was more or less immune from the famine of 1900, has an increase of 10 per cent., the Bargarh subdivision, which was seriously affected by it, has grown more than twice as rapidly. In this latter subdivision there has been an extraordinary development in Borasambar (where distress was most acute), for the four thanas constituting it, *viz.*, Melchhamunda, Gaisilat, Padampur and Paikmal, have percentages of increase varying from 27 to 70 per cent. In this area the revival of agricultural prosperity has resulted in an expansion of the area under cultivation, which has attracted new settlers. In the first two thanas, the rate of progress has been uniform (27·5 per cent.), while in Jagdalpur (42·5 per cent.) the waste and jungle are being fast cleared away and new villages established. The very remarkable increase in Paikmal (70 per cent.) is partly due to the same causes and partly to incomplete enumeration in 1901, when very few literate men were available to work as enumerators. In the Sambalpur subdivision, the most progressive thana is Mundher, which records a growth of 28 per cent., also largely the result of waste and jungle being brought under the plough. Elsewhere the increase is fairly evenly distributed, the least advance being noticeable in Katarbaga and Laikera. Both these thanas are situated close to the border of the Bamra State, and

[a] The 1901 figures of immigrants and emigrants for the district as now constituted not being available, those for the district as then constituted have been given.

during the dry season many of their inhabitants leave their homes to work in the Bamra forests.

ORISSA FEUDATORY STATES.

355. Between 1891 and 1901 the Orissa Feudatory States added 9·5 per cent. to their population, every State recording an increase except Baud in the south and Sonpur and Patna in the east. Baud sustained a slight loss owing to epidemics of disease and scarcity in 1900, which stimulated emigration. In Sonpur and Patna there was a heavy loss of 13 and 16 per cent. respectively, which was directly due to famine in the year preceding the census, in consequence of which a number of people left their homes. The census now concluded shows a general advance except in Dhenkanal and Ranpur, the aggregate addition to the population being 623,168 or 19·64 per cent. This large increase is partly due to more accurate enumeration, but is mainly the result of natural growth among hardy and prolific races. The crops have, on the whole, been good and there has been, writes the Political Agent, "a large expansion of cultivation due to the great improvements in communications, light rents and the large profits to be made by agriculturists, who are now, owing to the advent of the Bengal Nagpur Railway through Gangpur and Bamra and the East Coast section of the same railway, enabled to obtain a highly profitable market for their produce." Immigrants are attracted by the areas awaiting development and the easy terms on which land can be acquired, and outnumber the emigrants by 224,000: details are given in the marginal statement.

ORISSA STATES.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
TOTAL	**3,796,563**	**+ 19·64**	**+ 9·48**
Athgarh	46,813	+ 6·92	+ 19·62
Talcher	66,201	+ 9·55	+ 14·73
Mayurbhanj	729,218	+ 19·47	+ 14·68
Nilgiri	68,714	+ 3·39	+ 18·26
Keonjhar	364,702	+ 27·63	+ 15·18
Pal Lahara	25,680	+ 14·89	+ 13·46
Dhenkanal	270,175	- 1·27	+ 14·85
Athmallik	53,766	+ 31·93	+ 28·94
Hindol	49,840	+ 5·64	+ 24·25
Narsinghpur	39,964	+ 0·89	+ 17·08
Baramba	41,429	+ 8·28	+ 17·63
Tigiria	23,240	+ 2·72	+ 10·11
Khondpara	73,821	+ 6·30	+ 9·74
Nayagarh	151,293	+ 7·47	+ 19·44
Ranpur	45,956	- 0·26	+ 14·86
Daspalla	57,053	+ 9·74	+ 14·01
Baud	113,441	+ 28·55	- 1·45
Bamra	138,016	+ 11·94	+ 18·22
Rairakhol	31,729	+ 18·00	+ 32·29
Sonpur	215,701	+ 27·03	- 12·99
Patna	408,716	+ 47·15	- 16·39
Kalahandi	418,957	+ 19·52	+ 7·43
Gangpur	303,829	+ 27·18.	+ 24·79
Bonai	58,309	+ 52·33	+ 19·17

ORISSA STATES.	Male.	Female.
Actual population	1,882,588	1,913,975
Immigrants	142,510	157,230
Emigrants	26,374	48,923
Natural population	1,766,452	1,805,668

NORTH-EASTERN STATES.

356. In discussing the variations which have occurred, it will be convenient to divide the 24 States into 4 groups according to locality. The first group consists of the north-eastern States of Mayurbhanj, Keonjhar and Nilgiri. Mayurbhanj has progressed rapidly since 1901. Its economic resources have been developed, it has been opened up by roads and railways, and its trade has expanded greatly. A narrow-gauge railway has been built connecting the capital Baripada with the Bengal-Nagpur Railway line, and another line has been constructed from the works of the Tata and Iron Steel Company at Sakchi (in Singhbhum) to the mines at Gurumaisini. There was some scarcity in 1908, and relief operations had to be instituted, but otherwise the decade was one of agricultural prosperity, new areas being reclaimed and the cultivation in the older settled tracts improving steadily. The increase in the whole State amounts to 19·47 per cent. and all parts have contributed to it. The ratio of increase is least in the Bamanghati subdivision (7·66 per cent.) where there was scarcity in 1908 accompanied by epidemics of cholera and small-pox: it is greatest in Panchpir (35·5 per cent.), a jungly backward tract which has attracted immigrants and in which the census of 1901 was not quite complete. In Keonjhar the percentage of increase is 27·6 per cent., but Nilgiri has grown very slightly, viz., by 3·4 per cent. This latter State suffered from severe

epidemics of cholera in 1907 and 1908, while there was a partial failure of the crops both in 1905-1906 and 1907-1908.

NORTH-WESTERN STATES.

357. The second group consists of the Gangpur and Bonai States to the north-west, both of which have an increase, amounting to 27·18 per cent. in Gangpur, and to 52·3 per cent. in Bonai. The former State has benefited greatly from the railway which passes through it, and it has had excellent crops except in 1908. The inducements offered to immigrants by the large cultivable area lying waste and the small rents charged for holdings have, moreover, led to an influx of settlers from Chota Nagpur. The extraordinary increase in Bonai must be ascribed partially to incomplete enumeration in 1901, and partly to the opening up of the State, the railway being only 12 miles beyond its border. The land is being rapidly reclaimed, and as the State is very sparsely inhabited, there is ample room for expansion.

WESTERN STATES.

358. The western block comprises Bamra, Rairakhol, Sonpur, Patna and Kalahandi, all of which were transferred from the Central Provinces in 1905. In Bamra, Rairakhol and Kalahandi, the proportional growth varies from 12 to 19·5 per cent. The increase in Bamra would have been greater, had it not been that at this census a number of people were away working in manganese mines in Gangpur, and that in 1901 the number of persons enumerated in the State was enhanced by 2,000 or more owing to the presence of a large marriage party hailing from Pal Lahara and elsewhere. The rate of growth has been far more rapid in Sonpur (27 per cent.) and Patna (47 per cent.), where it marks a recovery from the famine of 1900, during which there was heavy mortality, while many of the inhabitants died or migrated to Sambalpur. The emigrants returned with the revival of agricultural prosperity, which continued almost unabated through the decade. Sonpur has been opened up by roads connecting it with Sambalpur and Rairakhol, while Patna has benefited by immigration, especially in the south-east and west, where large areas are available for reclamation.

CENTRAL AND SOUTH-EASTERN STATES.

359. The central States consist of Baud, Athmallik, Talcher and Pal Lahara, in which the ratio of increase varies from 9·5 per cent. to 31·9 per cent. The latter percentage returned for Athmallik, a sparsely populated State which gains by immigration. The ratio of increase for Baud (28·55) is very little less, but this State was partially depleted in 1901 as a result of severe scarcity. The remaining States consist of a block to the south-east on or near the borders of Cuttack and Puri, viz., Athgarh, Dhenkanal, Hindol, Narsinghpur, Baramba, Tigiria, Khondpara, Nayagarh, Ranpur and Daspalla, all of small size except Dhenkanal and Nayagarh. Dhenkanal has lost ground slightly, owing to scarcity in 1908 and mortality from cholera and other diseases. The number of recorded deaths in that year was treble the annual average for the remainder of the decade. Emigration was stimulated by the distress, and the result is seen in the figures for the sexes, the females having a slight increase in their numbers while males have decreased. The same phenomenon is observable in Ranpur, where the population is stationary. Narsinghpur has only advanced slightly, while the slow progress made by Tigiria is accounted for by the fact that it is more densely populated than any of the other States. In the other States of this group, the increase of population is fairly uniform, varying only from 5·6 to 9·7 per cent.

CHOTA NAGPUR STATES.

CHOTA NAGPUR STATES.	Population, 1911.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION.	
		1901—1911.	1891—1901.
TOTAL	**148,646**	**+ 5·36**	**+ 9·10**
Saraikela	109,794	+ 5·03	+ 11·40
Kharsawan	38,852	+ 6·33	+ 3·02

360. The Chota Nagpur States consist of the two small States of Kharsawan and Saraikela, both of which lie to the north of the Singhbhum district. The increase of population registered in these two States is natural and calls for no special remarks.

SIKKIM.

361. The State of Sikkim recorded an increase of 28,556 or 93·8 per cent. in 1901. This phenomenal increase was partly due to the greater accuracy of the census, the enumeration of 1891 being admittedly incomplete, and partly to immigration, for settlers from Nepal flocked in to cultivate the areas awaiting reclamation. No less than 22,720 persons, or 38·5 per cent. of the total population, were returned as born in Nepal, and the greater majority of them were new-comers, who had crossed the border since 1891. The census recently concluded has brought to light a further addition of 28,906, or 49 per cent. An analysis of the returns of birthplace shows that the immigrant population has increased by 5,000, while the number of persons born in Sikkim who were enumerated outside the State is greater by 1,255: the large increase cannot therefore be ascribed to any greatly enhanced influx into the State. At the same time, the fact that the number of immigrants is greater than in 1901 shows that the influx of settlers has continued and that the number of new-comers more than makes up for loss by death among the earlier immigrants. Part of the increase is due to natural growth among hardy and prolific races, such as the Nepalese, and part to the greater completeness of the census, which was for the first time carried out by an organized census staff: in 1901 only persons who had houses in Sikkim were enumerated, and not non-residents such as graziers and Nepalese in search of work.

Sikkim.	1911.		1901.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
Actual population ...	45,059	42,861	30,795	28,219
Immigrants	16,476	13,359	13,337	11,667
Emigrants	1,675	1,768	1,046	1,142
Natural population ...	30,258	31,270	18,504	16,695

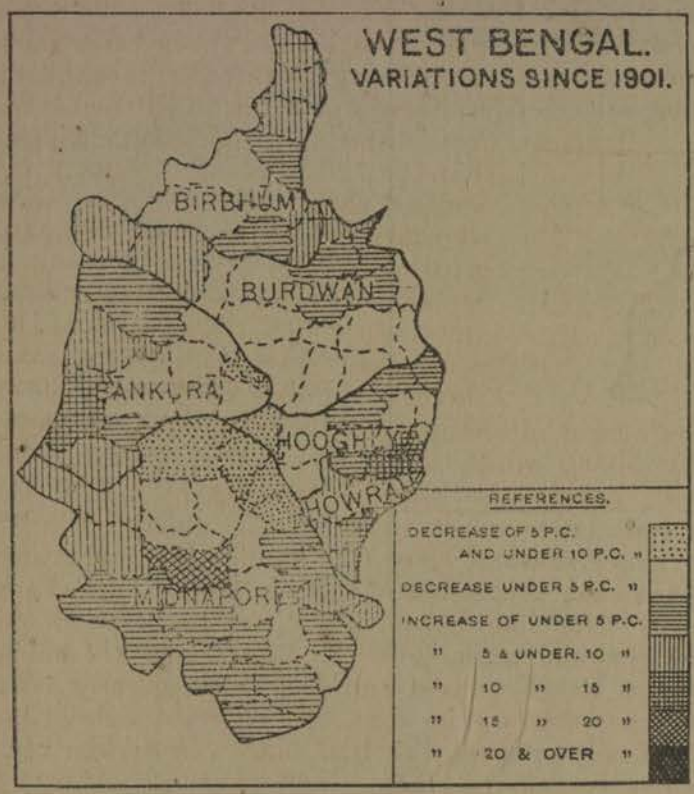
362. Altogether 25,610 persons, or 2,890 more than in 1901, were returned as born in Nepal, but instead of forming 38·5 per cent. of the total population, they now represent 29 per cent. The number of those born in Sikkim has risen from 34,010 to 58,085, or by 71 per cent., owing partly to their including the children of immigrants from Nepal who have settled in Sikkim: the native-born now form two-thirds of the population instead of half as in 1901. The number of Lepchas has risen from 7,982 to 9,031, and of Bhotias from 8,184 to 12,414, of whom 10,250 are Sikkim Bhotias. These indigenous races account for nearly a quarter of the population, and practically all the remainder are Nepalese, among whom the Khambus (Jimdars) are the most numerous, having 15,872 representatives.

SUMMARY.

263. West Bengal, *i. e.*, the Burdwan Division, had advanced but slightly since 1901, its net increase representing only 2·8 per cent. The most progressive district is Howrah, where there is an addition of 10·9 per cent., mainly the result of immigration stimulated by industrial activity in the city of Howrah and its neighbourhood. In the district, as a whole, immigrants represent one-fifth of the total population, and in the city of Howrah more than two-thirds of the inhabitants are immigrants from outside districts. This city accounts for a fourth of the total increase, and has grown more rapidly than the rest of the districts. Outside its limits the increase is due partly to natural growth and partly to immigration. In all the other districts the rate of increase is below 4 per cent. This figure is nearly reached by Hooghly, which, like Howrah, receives a large number of immigrants, their proportion to the total population being 17 per cent. The Serampore subdivision, which adjoins the Howrah and, like it, is an industrial centre, has grown at very nearly the

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same rate as that district, but the Sadar subdivision is now more populous by only 1·16 per cent., and the Arambagh subdivision has sustained a loss. Both these latter subdivisions are unhealthy and decadent : the population of the former is very little more than in 1891, while that of the latter is less by nearly 8,000. Hooghly is closely followed by Birbhum with an increase of 3·7 per cent., due not to emigration, but to natural growth. Here the accession of population is unevenly distributed between the north and south of the district, for the Rampur Hat subdivision to the north has an increase of 6·7 per cent. spread over all its thanas, while the Sadar subdivision has advanced very slightly. Bankura has lost heavily by emigration, the number of persons born in the district but enumerated outside it being 20 per cent. more than in 1901 and equal to 15 per cent. of the district population. Moreover, while the Sadar subdivision records a gain of 4·9 per cent., the Vishnupur subdivision has lost 3·1 per cent. The latter is a malarious and unhealthy tract in the deltaic rice plain, and its population has decreased at every census except that of 1901. Midnapore has an increase of only 1·2 per cent., the general growth of population being affected by the loss sustained in the Ghatal subdivision in the north-east. The latter, which suffered greatly from epidemic disease and also lost by emigration, has decreased by 7·3 per cent., but the other subdivisions have ratios of increase varying from 1·75 to 3·1 per cent. The population of the Burdwan district, which has suffered from epidemic and endemic diseases, is stationary. The Asansol subdivision in the north-west has added 4·7 per cent. to its population, mainly owing to the influx of labourers to the coal-fields, and the Katwa subdivision in the north-east has a growth of 3·3 per cent. The remainder of the district, which lies along three great rivers, Ajay, Damodar and Bhagirathi, has lost population, only two (Sahebganj and Manteswar) out of 11 thanas having any addition to the number of their inhabitants.



364. Briefly, the two purely alluvial districts (Hooghly and Howrah) owe their increase mainly to the influx of population attracted by the prospects of employment in industrial and manufacturing concerns and by their proximity to Calcutta. The alluvial tracts elsewhere, which are remote from Calcutta, and which have no large industries and manufactures, have suffered from persistent unhealthiness and are more or less decadent or stationary, *e.g.*, the Vishnupur subdivision of Bankura, the Ghatal subdivision of Midnapore, the Hooghly district with the exception of the Serampore subdivision, and the Sadar and Kalna subdivisions of Burdwan. In the lateritic area, however, there has been a small advance, *e.g.*, in the Birbhum district, the Sadar subdivision of Bankura and the Asansol subdivision of Burdwan.

365. Central Bengal owes its increase of 4½ per cent. entirely to the accession of population in the 24-Parganas, Calcutta, and Murshidabad. There is an actual loss of population in the remainder of the division, where there are no large industries to attract labour from outside. Both Jessore and Nadia, two

CENTRAL BENGAL.

unhealthy districts lying entirely in the deltaic rice plain, have declined, while Murshidabad, which is not entirely alluvial, has a small increase, due to the lateritic area to the west of the Bhagirathi. The 24-Parganas is now more populous than it was in 1901 by 17 per cent. It has gained very greatly by immigration, the immigrant population being nearly one-fourth of the total population. All parts of the district have added to their numbers, but nowhere has there been greater progress than in the suburban municipalities and the Barrackpore subdivision, where the growing demand for labour has resulted in an increase of 45 and 42 per cent., respectively. In rural areas great progress has been made in the northern thanas, through which the Barasat-Basirhat Railway runs, and in the country to the south, where the development is due to the reclamation of the Sundarbans. In the city of Calcutta the percentage of increase has fallen from 24 per cent. to 5·7 per cent., owing partly to the tendency of immigrants to settle in the suburbs rather than in the city itself. This movement has been stimulated by the clearance of insanitary overcrowded *bastis* in Calcutta, the improved suburban traffic service and the development of large industries in its neighbourhood. The reduction in the rate of increase is also partly due to the census of 1901 having been more complete than its predecessor, as a result of which an unnaturally large increase was registered. Murshidabad has added 2·9 per cent. to its population, but while the Jangipur and Kandi subdivisions have grown fairly rapidly, the growth in the Lalbagh subdivision is slight and the Sadar subdivision has lost ground. Nadia and Jessore have sustained a loss, both being unhealthy areas with an unenviable reputation and no manufactures to attract immigrants. The history of both is, as already stated, a dismal record of disease and decline.

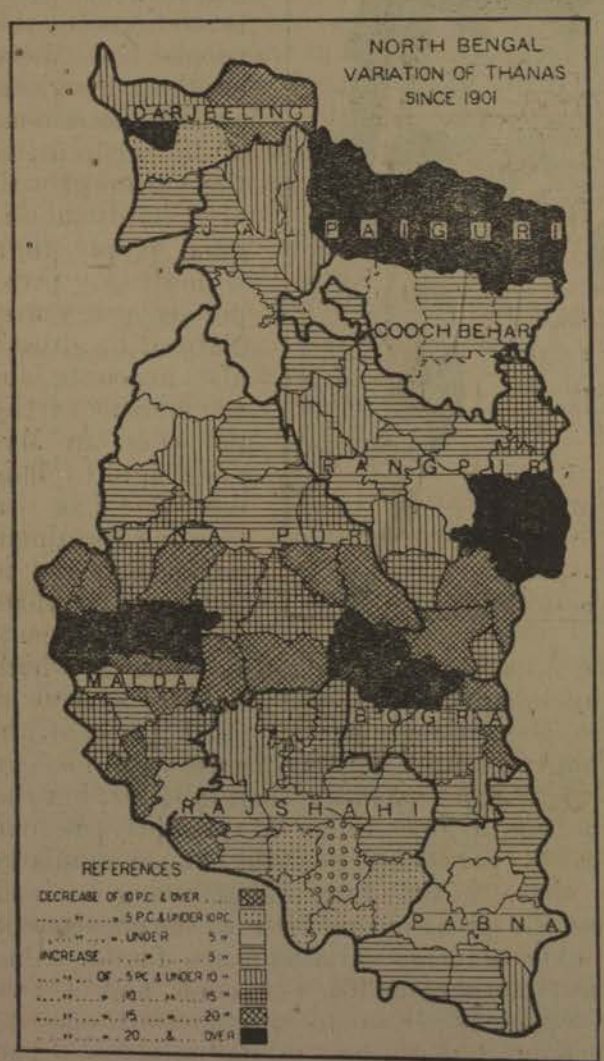


366. In North Bengal the most rapid growth of population has taken place in Bogra, which has been growing steadily since 1872 and now records an increase of 15·2 per cent. The increase is due mainly to natural growth among a population largely composed of Muhammadans. It is closely followed by Jalpaiguri, which has gained 14·8 per cent. nearly entirely from the influx of immigrants. In this district there is a small natural growth in the east, a fairly large increase in the centre, where it is the result partly of natural causes and partly of immigration, and a remarkable increase in the Alipur subdivision, where immigrants are fast taking up the available waste land. The tract known as the Western Duars has nearly trebled its population since 1901, but in Mainaguri and Damdim to the west, where nearly all the waste land has now been taken up, the ratio of increase has fallen. The two latter thanas have apparently nearly reached the limit of their expansion, and consequently new settlers are pouring into the more distant and less developed lands of the Alipur subdivision. The population of the latter will probably

North Bengal.

have a diminished rate of growth henceforward, as the area of cultivable land outside the reserved forest is now comparatively small. Malda has developed almost as rapidly as Jalpaiguri, but its development is due to natural growth. The past decade in this district has been one of peaceful progress stimulated by the opening of the Katihar-Godagari Railway. All parts of the district share in the increase except Nawabganj, where land has been diluviated and the cultivators have moved to other places. Rangpur, which in 1901 had an increase for the first time in its history, has a further addition of 10·7 per cent. The health of the people has improved since the earthquake of 1897, and the extension of railway communications has stimulated immigration. All parts of the district are progressive, but the greatest advance has been made in the Kurigram and Gaibandha subdivisions, where many new settlers have come to the *char* lands from Sirajganj and Mymensingh.

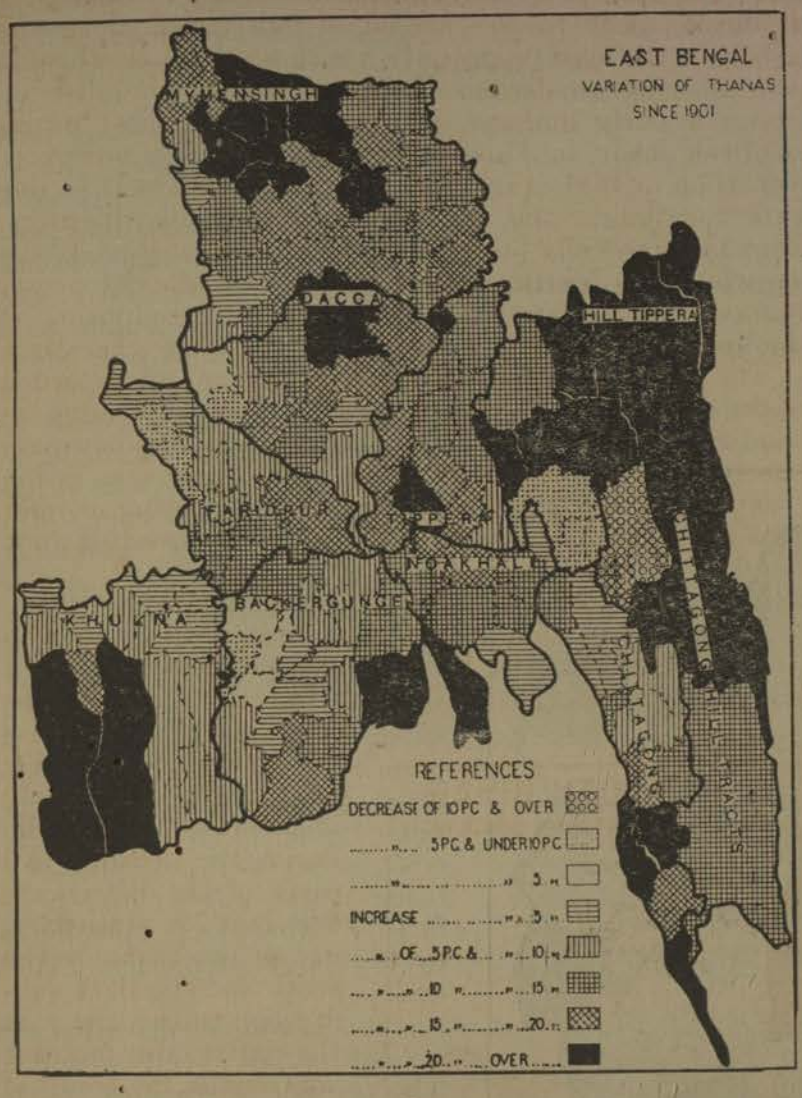
367. The increase of 7·7 per cent. in Dinajpur is the combined result of natural growth and of immigration, the volume of which has swollen very much since 1901. Immigrants now number 197,000 or over 11 per cent. of the total population. The increase has been most rapid in the Balurghat subdivision to the south, while the Thakurgaon subdivision to the north is practically stationary. The rate of progress in Darjeeling has fallen from 11·55 per cent. to 6·65 per cent., the explanation being that any considerable further expansion is precluded by the large proportion of land under forest or tea, and that the area in which cultivation can extend is fast being reduced. The growth is greatest in the Darjeeling subdivision, where immigrants have come into Jorbungalow and Kalimpong. The Siliguri subdivision has a slight increase, but the Kurseong subdivision has lost population. Cooch Behar has had an increase of population (4·6 per cent.) for the first time since 1881. This increase is due partly to natural development and partly to immigration, which has been stimulated by railway communications; four lines of railway intersect the State. Rajshahi, which had an addition of only 1·6 per cent. in 1901, has a further small increase of 1·4 per cent. The greatest advance has been made in the *ganja*-growing thanas in the Naogaon subdivision (14 and 13 per cent.) and in the Barind, where the percentage of increase varies from 4½ to 17 per cent. The Naogaon subdivision has developed rapidly, and the Sadar subdivision very slightly, but the Nator subdivision, an ill-drained malarious area, is steadily declining. Pabna is now practically stationary owing to persistent unhealthiness and the loss it has sustained by emigration. The Sirajganj subdivision has lost ground, and there is only a slight increase in the Sadar subdivision.



368. East Bengal as a whole has added 12 per cent. to its population, and all parts of it, whether densely or sparsely inhabited, are progressive. The greatest progress

EAST BENGAL.

has been made by the State of Hill Tippera, where the large increase of 32½ per cent. is recorded. The area available for cultivation in this State has led to an influx of colonists; over three-fifths of the net gain is due to the increase in the number of immigrants. The Chittagong Hill Tracts, a remote tract with few attractions for the people of more civilized districts, owes its increment of 23 per cent. to the natural growth of a hardy aboriginal people in a series of prosperous years. Natural growth also accounts for the increase of 15½ per cent. in Mymensingh. This district has a teeming Musalman population, and is now more populous by 92 per cent. than in 1872. Least progress has been made in the Tangail subdivision, which suffers from malaria, and has lost by emigration as well as from a virulent epidemic of cholera in 1905. The proportional growth (14·7 per cent.) in Tippera is also accounted for by natural causes, for the district has lost by migration. All parts of the district are more populous than in 1901, but the ratio of increase is greatest in the south and diminishes slightly as one proceeds northwards. The gain of 14 per cent. in Noakhali is similarly independent of migration; all parts share in the increase, but owing to land being swept away and reformed by the great rivers, and to the consequent movements of the people, some extraordinary variations are found. One thana has a gain of only 4 per cent., another of 36½ per cent., and of two thanas which supported over 1,000 persons per square mile in 1901, one has added 20 per cent. and another only 2 per cent. to its numbers. The district of Dacca, with an increment of 12 per cent., has 62 per cent. more inhabitants than in 1872. The balance of migration has been against it, but all parts have gained ground, except on the western boundary where diluviation has caused the inhabitants to move across the Padma to alluvial accretions in Faridpur and Pabna. The Manikganj subdivision consequently has only a small increase. Munshiganj, in spite of its dense population, has again an increase of over 9 per cent., while the Sadar and Narayanganj subdivisions have grown even more rapidly than in the preceding decade.

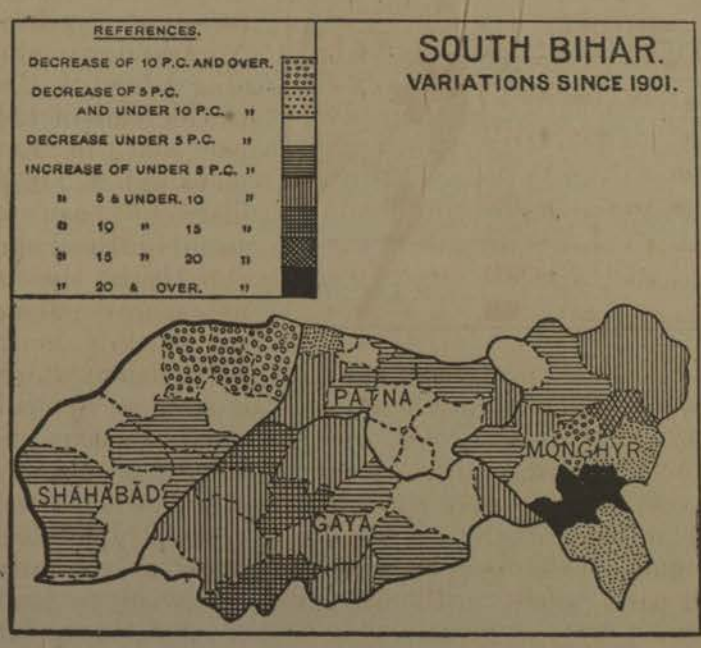


369. Chittagong, in which the rate of increase was reduced to 4·9 per cent. in 1901 on account of the disastrous cyclone of 1897, has now fully recovered. The most progressive thanas are those which suffered most in that year, but the whole of the south, where cultivation is expanding, has large gains, and considerable progress has been made in the north where trade has been stimulated by the railway. There is again an increase of 9 per

cent. in Khulna, the percentage varying from ·01 in the north-east to 26 per cent. in the south-west. The most progressive thanas are those to the south-west, which owe their development to the spread of cultivation along the fringe of the Sundarbans : the least progressive are those to the north-west and north-east, which are more malarious than the rest of the district. Elsewhere there has been a fairly uniform development. The most extraordinary progress has been made in Paikgachha thana, which is now more populous by 80 per cent. than in 1881 : the development of this tract is due to the driving back of the jungle and the settlement of new cultivators. Faridpur has continued to make steady progress. The gain is greatest in the Madaripur subdivision, which is a healthy locality with fertile alluvial accretions to which immigrants are attracted. The Goalundo subdivision is stationary owing to the loss sustained by one thana, but elsewhere there is a fair rate of increase. The growth of population in Backergunge was retarded during the last half of the decade, for it suffered from a failure of crops in 1905 and from floods and a cyclone in 1909. The ratio of increase is, however, very nearly the same as in 1901. There has been a rapid expansion in the Dakshin Shahbazpur subdivision, where new colonists are pouring in, and also in the Sundarbans area in Patuakhali, where cultivation is spreading ; but the Pirojpur subdivision has remained stationary.

South Bihar.

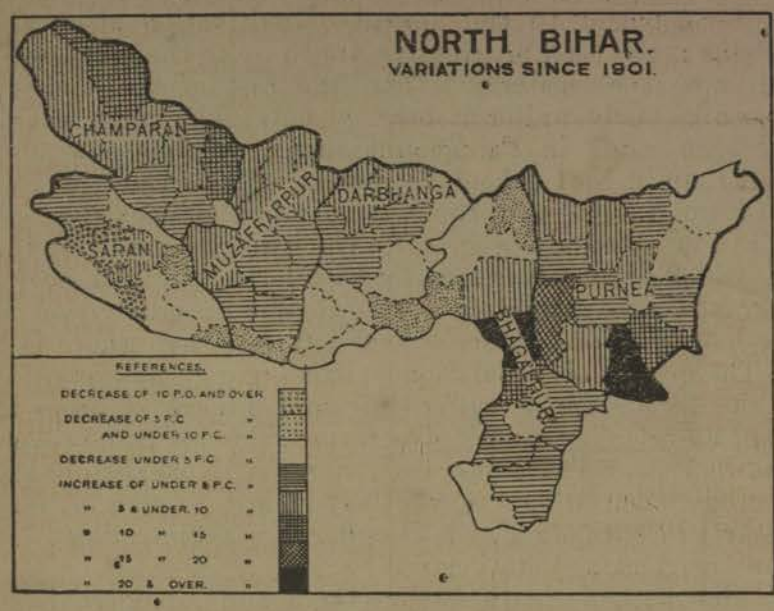
370. Two of the districts of South Bihar (Gaya and Monghyr) have added to their population since 1901, and two (Shahabad and Patna) have sustained a loss. In Patna there is a slight decrease (nearly 1 per cent.), for which the mortality due to disease is mainly responsible; the plague death-rate alone was 8·7 per mille during the decade. All parts of the district are decadent or stationary, except one thana to the south and the Barh subdivision on the east ; in the latter the increase was mainly the result of an influx of labourers who came to cut crops. Gaya, which declined by 3·7 per cent. in 1901, has recovered its position, the ratio of increase being 4·8 per cent. Its advance is principally attributable to the fact that in 1901 the population was reduced by a virulent epidemic of plague, which caused many deaths and still more desertions. There has since been a general development throughout the district, only two thanas having a decrease. Shahabad, on the other hand, which lost 4·7 per cent. of its population between 1891 and 1901, has another falling off of 4·9 per cent. In the north there is a general loss of population, and the south is practically stationary. It has suffered both from plague and endemic fever ; not only has a series of bad agricultural years stimulated emigration, but the immigrant population is steadily diminishing. Monghyr has advanced by 3·1 per cent., the result of natural growth : were it not for the large number of persons who left the district during the cold weather for work elsewhere, the percentage of increase would have been far greater.



North Bihar.

371. All the districts of North Bihar have added to their population, except Saran which has declined by 5 per cent. This district has suffered severely from persistent

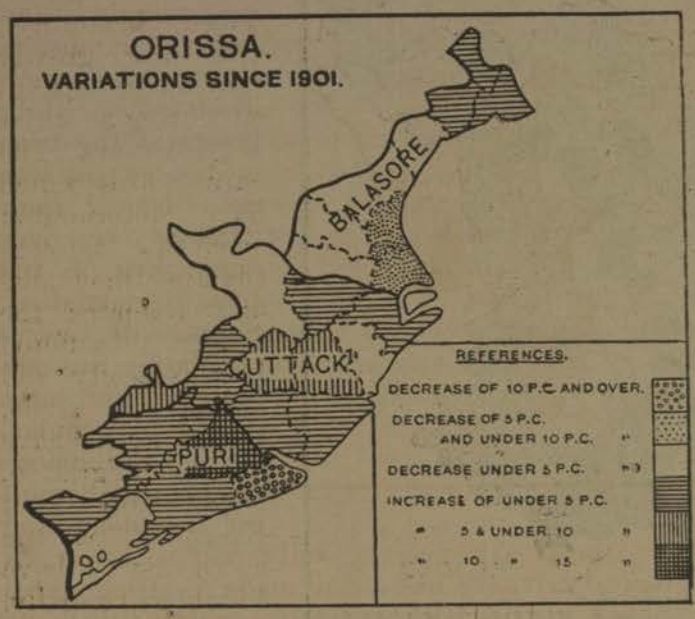
fever as well as from the ravages of plague, which has carried off 166,000 or 7 per cent. of the population. Emigration has, moreover, become increasingly popular; the number of those who were absent from their homes at the time of the census was no less than 292,000 or over one-eighth of the total population. Signs of over-population are apparent. The most densely populated subdivisions (Sadar and Siwan) are decadent, and the Gopalganj subdivision, where the pressure on the soil is not so heavy, is practically stationary. The greatest advance has been made in Champaran (6·6 per cent.) and Purnea (6 per cent.), both sparsely populated districts which attract immigrants by reason of the fertile areas awaiting development and the low rents at which land can be obtained. The remainder of the districts of North Bihar lose more or less heavily by the exodus of the district born. All parts of Purnea have an increment, except the Kishanganj subdivision in the north-east, which is the most unhealthy but also the most populous part of the district, though, compared with other parts of North Bihar, the density is low. Champaran has now made good the loss caused by the famine of 1897: all parts are progressive, except one thana in the south-east (Madhubani) which is the most densely populated of all the thanas and has lost by emigration.



372. The rate of increase in Muzaffarpur is only half what it is in Champaran, but conditions in this district were not favourable to any large expansion. It suffered from severe floods in 1906, from crop failures in 1907 and 1908, and from another inundation in 1910. The volume of emigration has also been swollen by the increasing number of labourers seeking employment outside the district: at the time of the census 195,000 persons, or 7 per cent. of the total population, were away from their homes. The most progressive tract is the Sitamarhi subdivision, a fertile rice-growing area, which gains by immigration: the Sadar subdivision loses by the movements of its inhabitants and has only a small increase, while the Hajipur thana has a decline, the combined result of plague mortality and emigration. The proportional growth in Bhagalpur (2·4 per cent.) is a little less than in Muzaffarpur. Here the Banka subdivision is stationary, while the Supaul subdivision has sustained a loss owing to scarcity in 1908-09 and heavy mortality from cholera and fever. The Sadar subdivision in the centre of the district has a small increase, while the Madhupura subdivision has advanced by 9 per cent. owing to the expansion of cultivation in areas formerly swept by the Kosi. In the Darbhanga district the percentage of increase has fallen at each census since 1881, and is now under 1 per cent. The Madhubani subdivision, which is the least populous part of the district, has a small increase; the Sadar subdivision is practically stationary, and Samastipur, where the pressure on the soil is greatest, is decadent. The district suffered from two famines in the decade, but these famines do not appear to be responsible for any loss of population. The leading factor appears to be congestion of the population and consequent quickening of emigration. The number of emigrants is 58 per cent. greater than in 1901, and is little less than that returned for Muzaffarpur.

373. In 1901 Orissa recorded an advance of 7 per cent., but the percentage of increase is now reduced to 1 per cent. owing to floods, scarcity, increased emigration and epidemics of disease. The most progressive district is Cuttack, where however the rate of growth is only 2½ per cent. The Sadar and Kendrapara subdivisions have both developed, but there is a decline in the Jajpur subdivision, which suffered from scarcity and lost heavily by the emigration of able-bodied labourers. Owing to the facilities afforded by the railway, the exodus of the district-born in search of more remunerative employment is becoming an annual occurrence and the number of emigrants has risen rapidly: they now account for 173,000, or 8 per cent. of the district population. In Puri the course of the seasons was unpropitious, and the natural growth of population was checked by disease. In 1908 famine was declared in two localities, and elsewhere distress prevailed. The actual increase of population was a little over ½ per cent., but it would have been greater had it not been that the number of pilgrims was considerably smaller than in 1901. The effect of short crops and hard times is seen even more clearly in the Balasore district, where cholera synchronized with scarcity and the pressure of high prices stimulated emigration. There is progress in the north, but the centre of the district is stationary, and there is a loss of population throughout the south. The explanation of these variations lies in the fact that emigration is most active in the centre and south, where also the people suffered most from floods and drought, the consequent destruction of their crops, and a virulent epidemic of cholera. The north of the district had not the same calamitous seasons to face, and instead of sending out emigrants, attracted new settlers.

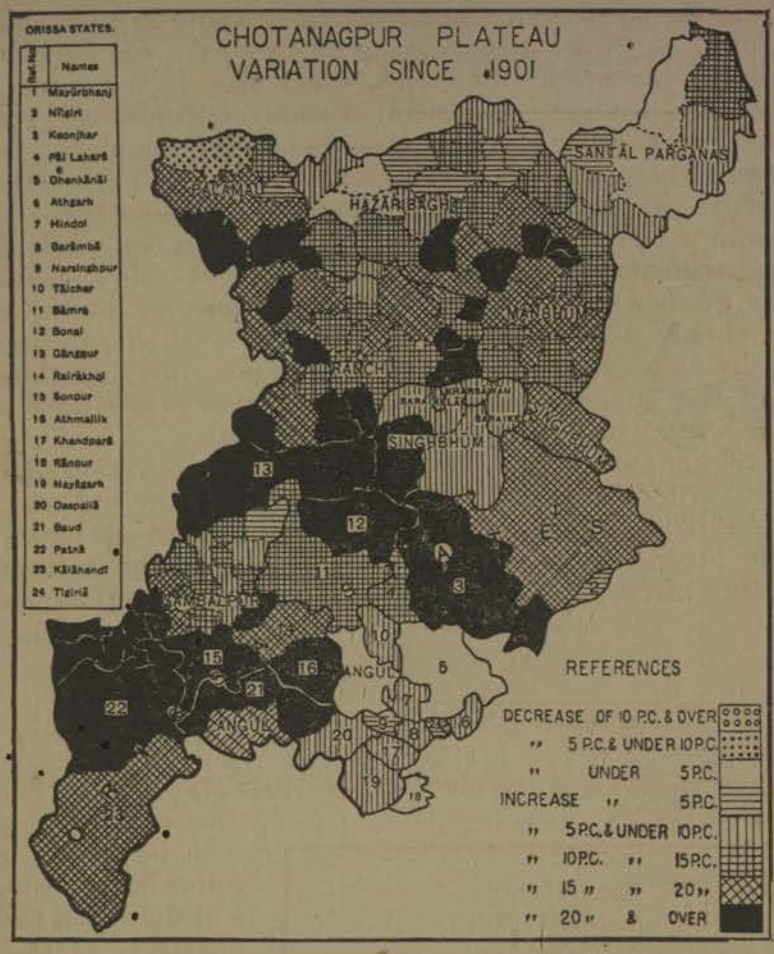
ORISSA.



374. No part of Bihar and Orissa has developed so rapidly as the Chota Nagpur Plateau, which is now more populous by 14 per cent. than it was in 1901. This large increase is partly due to more complete enumeration in tracts, difficult of access, where literate enumerators are comparatively scarce, and partly to natural growth among prolific aboriginal races. They lead simple healthy lives, and are not fettered by caste restrictions, or troubled by prudential considerations regarding their ability to support offspring without inconvenience to themselves. The land, though infertile and unable to support any great population, is still very thinly peopled. There is ample room for a larger population, and the inhabitants are in any case not entirely dependent on their crops, for they subsist largely on jungle products. The greatest increase has been recorded in the Orissa States, where the population exceeds that returned in 1901 by 20 per cent. Part of the increase must be ascribed to the greater accuracy of the present census, but apart from that there has been a remarkable development owing to various causes, such as the natural fecundity of the people, recovery from famine, the influx of cultivators attracted by the low rents charged for cultivable waste or imperfectly cultivated land, and the opening up of the country by the railway. At the previous census only three States recorded a decrease, viz., Baud, Sonpur and Patna, where it was directly due to famine in 1900 and consequent emigration. All three States have now increments, viz., 27 per cent. in Sonpur, 28 per cent.

CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.

in Baud and 47 per cent. in Patna, figures which serve to show the extent to which they lost from the famine of 1900 (by deaths, desertions and reduced fecundity), and how greatly they have expanded during a series of good years. The only States which have deteriorated since the last census are Dhenkanal and Rahpur; the former suffered from scarcity and disease in 1908, while both have lost by emigration. Mayurbhanj and Keonjhar on the north-east have advanced rapidly, and the same is the case with Gangpur and Bonai on the north-west: the phenomenal increase (52 per cent.) returned for Bonai is due partly to improved enumeration and partly to immigration and the development of its resources. The central States and also the western States near Sambalpur have made rapid progress. The least advance has been made by the south-eastern States in the neighbourhood of Cuttack and Balasore.



375. The district of Manbhum is now more populous by 19 per cent. than it was in 1901, this large addition to its population being mainly due to the expansion of the collieries. Two-fifths of the total increase has taken place in thanas Jheria and Topchanchi, which contain most of the coal mines: in the rest of the district the ratio of increase averages 13 per cent., and is very evenly distributed. The progress made by Ranchi (17 per cent.) is all the more noticeable, because it has lost heavily by the exodus of its inhabitants to centres where employment is better paid than it is locally: the number of emigrants is now 305,309 or 22 per cent. of the total population. All parts of the district have gained ground, but the greatest advance has been made by the Gumla subdivision (in the south): the gain here is the result of a movement from the north and centre of the district to undeveloped tracts where land is available on easy terms. The percentage of increase (16½ per cent.) in Sambalpur is nearly as great as in Ranchi. In 1901 this district was suffering from the effects of the famine of 1900, but it quickly recovered, and the present increase is the consequence of revived prosperity, expansion of cultivation and, in some areas, improved enumeration. Singhbhum owes its increase to the natural fecundity of its people during a series of good years, and to the development of the district by the railway and industrial enterprise; but for the number (105,634 or 15 per cent. of the total population) of the district-born that were temporarily or permanently resident outside its boundaries at the time of the census, its growth would have been greater. In Palamau the decade witnessed a recovery from the effects of famine, and the steady progress made by the district resulted in an increase of 11 per cent. There has been a decline in the north, which is more apparent than

real, and a rapid expansion in the thinly peopled tracts to the south. Hazaribagh has a natural increase, to which all parts of the district contribute except two thanas to the west, which suffered from scarcity in 1908 and have declined slightly.

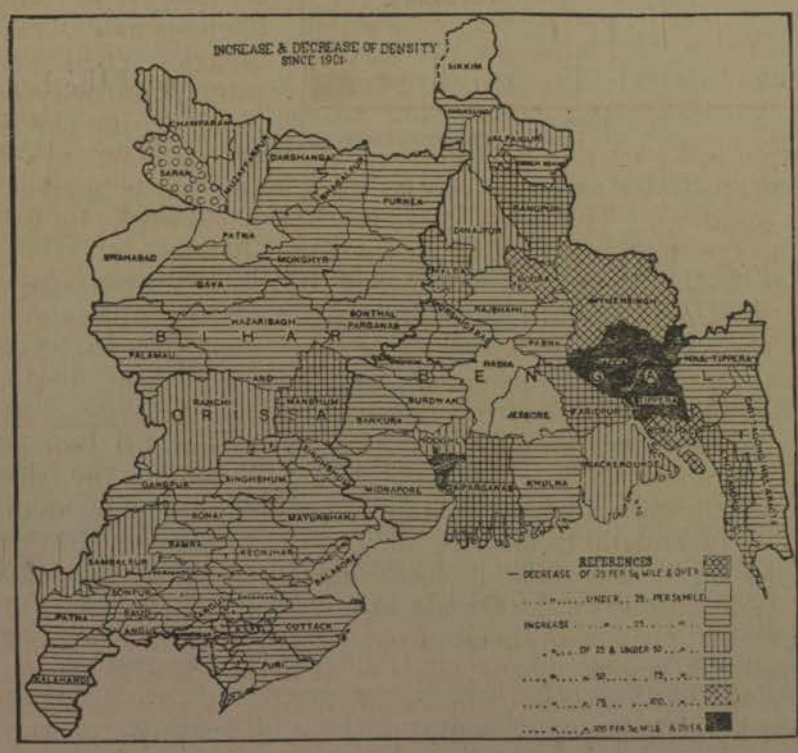
376. The population of the Sonthal Parganas, which grew by 3 per cent. between 1891 and 1901, has a slightly accelerated rate of growth (4 per cent.). Its inhabitants are pouring out, in ever increasing numbers, in search of employment elsewhere, and this drain, temporary though it mostly is, affects the census results very materially. The number of persons born in the Sonthal Parganas who were enumerated outside it was over one-sixth of the total population : had their number been the same as in 1901, there would have been an increase of 9·3 per cent. Angul, which was affected by scarcity in 1908, has a gain of only 4 per cent. ; while there is a slight decline in the Angul subdivision, the Khondmals have developed rapidly, thus reversing the results of the last census. The Chota Nagpur States have a natural increase of 5 per cent., which calls for no remarks.

SIKKIM.

377. The State of Sikkim, which grew by 94 per cent. between 1891 and 1901, now records another addition of 49 per cent. The explanation of this large increase is partly the incompleteness of the previous census, partly continued immigration from Nepal, and partly the natural fecundity of the people, of whom three-fourths are Nepalese.

VARIATION OF POPULATION IN RELATION TO DENSITY.

378. Statistics of the variation in the population of districts since 1872 in relation to density will be found in Subsidiary Table I at the end of this chapter, while statistics showing the variation since 1891 (both actual and proportional) of thanas classified according to density are given in Subsidiary Table IV. In Bengal it is noticeable that during the last 20 years the addition of population in the most populous areas has been greater than in the most sparsely populated. In the last decade the gain in areas with a density of 1,050 or more has been nearly equal to that of thanas where there are under 150 persons per square mile, while in the previous decade it was 405,000 more. This is due partly to the influx of population into the cities of West and Central Bengal, and partly to natural growth in the fertile rice-growing areas of East Bengal. Here, for instance, Dacca, which in 1901 had 952 persons to the square mile, registers a gain of 12 per cent., and Tippera, which had 848, of nearly 15 per cent. To East Bengal the remarks recorded by Mr. Beverley in the Bengal Census Report of 1872 are specially applicable : "In a country like Bengal, where a large proportion of the land yields two crops a year, where the diet of the people consists almost entirely of rice, where there are no preventive checks to the increase of the



population, and where the only positive check is disease, we must expect to find a population far in excess of what we are accustomed to meet with in the West. An Indian population, indeed, would seem to be limited only by the extent of cultivable land in each district."

In Bihar and Orissa the greatest expansion of population has taken place in the most sparsely inhabited areas, *i.e.*, thanas with under 150 persons per square mile : these thanas all lie in the Chota Nagpur Plateau and have grown by 20 per cent. since 1901. The increase is due to the natural growth of the prolific and hardy races of the plateau, and to the spread of cultivation in parts where the land lay waste for want of cultivators. At the other end of the scale, *i.e.*, in thanas containing 1,050 persons or more per square mile, there was a loss in 1901 and again in 1911. Both North and South Bihar have shared in this loss, but since 1901 it has been far greater in North Bihar. In several localities in this latter tract it appears that the limit which the land can support has been reached, and that the people are transferring themselves to places where the pressure on the soil is not so heavy.

379. The stage of congestion appears to have reached in parts of three districts, viz., Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga and Saran, where the dependence of the people on their harvests is not relieved by the presence of any large industries. The cultivation and manufacture of indigo formerly furnished employment to many thousands, but this industry is only a shadow of what it was. The area under indigo cultivation in these three districts was 156,400 acres in 1901, but had fallen to 51,200 acres in 1910-11, and it may be estimated that 50,000 persons had to find employment in other directions. The monopoly of agriculture and the increase of population have reduced the cultivators' holdings to a small size. In Darbhanga and Saran the settlement has shown that the average size of the cultivators' holding is only a little over 3½ acres which is, however, well above the area (2½ acres) of a subsistence holding, *i.e.*, a holding from the produce of which an agricultural family can manage to subsist in *normal* years. The estates of the landlords are, moreover, generally exiguous, owing to the extreme length to which subdivision of proprietary interests has been pushed. These three districts are the home of petty proprietors often in little better circumstances than the cultivators, who have in many cases been forced from their lands to make room for them. In Muzaffarpur there are, on the average, 5½ estates to a village, each proprietor holding 12 acres, of which only 9 acres are cultivated. In Saran the average area held by a proprietor is 14 acres, but shares are so small that a fraction equal to a 59-millionth part of an estate is recognised. In Darbhanga the estates are far larger, nearly half the district being included in the property of the Maharaja of Darbhanga or other large landlords, but the average is as low as 8 acres in the Samastipur subdivision, where the proprietor is little more than an ordinary cultivator. The petty proprietor has hitherto been able to meet the wants of his growing family and the further subdivision of property it entails by raising his tenants' rents or by ousting them from their lands and bringing them under his own cultivation ; but the record-of-rights which has now been prepared is rendering this process more difficult.

Fortunately the pressure on the soil is relieved by emigration. In addition to those who have permanently left the district and made homes elsewhere, large numbers migrate annually during the cold weather to work in the mills or on the roads, railways and fields elsewhere. Their remittances contribute to the support of their households while they are away, and on their return in the hot weather the family's resources are augmented by their savings. In the famine year of 1896-97 over 15 lakhs were paid by money-order in Muzaffarpur, and a very large proportion represented remittances sent by emigrants to their homes. The amount thus remitted has been more than doubled, the total value of money-orders paid in the district during 1901 amounting to 34 lakhs of rupees. The amount remitted by money-order in Saran is still greater, aggregating nearly 51½ lakhs in the latter year : altogether 17 lakhs, or one-third of the total. were paid in the first quarter of the year, when temporary emigration is most active. the average amount per money-order being Rs. 15.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—VARIATION IN RELATION TO DENSITY SINCE 1872.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	PERCENTAGE OF VARIATION. INCREASE (+) OR DECREASE (−).				NET VARIATION, 1872—1911.	MEAN DENSITY PER SQUARE MILE.				
	1901—1911.	1891—1901.	1881—1891.	1872—1881.		1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1872.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	+ 6·7	+ 4·9	+ 7·5	+ 11·9	+ 34·7	433	405	386	359	321
Bengal	+ 8·0	+ 7·7	+ 7·5	+ 6·7	+33·5	551	510	473	440	412
WEST BENGAL	+ 2·8	+ 7·2	+ 4·0	− 2·8	+ 11·3	607	591	551	530	545
Burdwan	+ 0·4	+ 10·1	− 0·2	− 6·2	+ 3·5	572	570	517	518	542
Birbhum	+ 3·7	+ 13·0	+ 0·8	− 7·0	+ 9·9	534	515	456	452	486
Bankura	+ 2·0	+ 4·4	+ 2·7	+ 7·6	+ 17·6	434	426	408	397	370
Midnapore	+ 1·2	+ 6·0	+ 4·6	− 1·1	+ 10·9	544	538	507	485	490
Hooghly	+ 3·9	+ 1·4	+ 6·1	− 12·9	− 2·6	918	883	870	821	942
Howrah	+ 10·9	+ 11·4	+ 13·1	+ 6·2	+ 48·4	1,850	1,668	1,497	1,324	1,247
CENTRAL BENGAL	+ 4·5	+ 5·2	+ 3·2	+ 11·8	+ 26·8	634	607	577	559	500
24-Parganas	+ 17·1	+ 9·9	+ 11·9	+ 6·9	+ 53·9	502	429	390	349	326
Calcutta	+ 5·7	+ 24·3	+ 11·4	− 3·3	+ 41·6	28,002	26,494	21,322	19,135	19,782
Nadia	− 2·4	+ 1·5	− 1·2	+ 10·6	+ 8·4	580	594	586	593	535
Murshidabad	+ 2·9	+ 6·6	+ 2·0	+ 1·04	+ 13·0	640	622	584	572	567
Jessore	− 3·0	− 4·0	− 2·6	+ 33·6	+ 21·1	601	620	646	663	496
NORTH BENGAL	+ 8·0	+ 5·7	+ 4·1	+ 5·3	+ 25·1	522	484	458	440	418
Rajshahi	+ 1·4	+ 1·6	− 0·8	+ 1·9	+ 4·1	566	558	549	553	543
Dinajpur	+ 7·7	+ 5·7	+ 2·8	+ 0·9	+18·0	428	397	376	366	362
Jalpaiguri	+ 14·8	+ 15·7	+ 17·8	+ 39·0	+116·6	309	269	233	198	143
Darjeeling	+ 6·6	+ 11·6	+ 43·5	+ 68·8	+179·5	228	214	192	134	82
Rangpur	+ 10·7	+ 4·3	− 1·5	− 2·6	+10·8	686	619	594	603	619
Bogra	+ 15·2	+ 11·8	+ 11·3	+ 7·0	+53·4	724	628	562	505	472
Pabna	+ 0·5	+ 4·3	+ 3·9	+ 8·3	+17·9	772	768	736	709	655
Malda	+ 13·9	+ 8·5	+ 14·5	+ 5·0	+48·5	529	464	423	374	356
Cooch Behar	+ 4·6	− 2·1	− 3·9	+ 13·2	+11·3	454	434	443	461	407
EAST BENGAL	+ 12·1	+ 10·5	+ 14·1	+ 11·0	+ 56·8	516	460	417	365	329
Khulna	+ 9·1	+ 6·4	+ 9·0	+ 3·2	+30·6	287	263	247	227	220
Dacca	+ 11·9	+ 10·6	+ 14·6	+ 14·4	+62·2	1,066	952	861	752	657
Mymensingh	+ 15·5	+ 12·7	+ 13·6	+ 29·9	+ 94·2	724	627	556	489	377
Faridpur	+ 8·7	+ 6·2	+ 9·9	+ 8·5	+ 37·7	824	758	714	649	598
Backergunge	+ 6·0	+ 6·4	+ 13·3	+ 0·7	+ 28·7	523	494	464	409	407
Tippera	+ 14·7	+ 18·8	+ 17·7	+ 7·9	+ 73·1	972	848	713	606	562
Noakhali	+ 14·0	+ 13·1	+ 23·0	− 2·3	+ 54·9	792	694	614	499	511
Chittagong	+ 11·5	+ 4·9	+ 13·9	+ 0·4	+ 33·8	605	543	518	454	452
Chittagong Hill Tracts	+ 23·3	+ 16·3	+ 5·6	+ 46·0	+121·0	30	24	21	20	14
Hill Tippera	+ 32·5	+ 26·1	+ 43·7	+171·2	+551·2	56	42	34	23	9
Bihar and Orissa ...	+ 5·1	+ 1·8	+ 7·5	+18·4	+ 36·2	344	327	321	299	252
NORTH BIHAR	+ 1·9	+ 0·1	+ 5·9	+ 14·0	+ 23·2	646	634	633	598	524
Saran	− 4·9	− 2·3	+ 7·4	+ 10·5	+ 10·3	853	896	919	855	774
Champaran	+ 6·6	− 3·7	+ 8·0	+ 19·3	+ 32·5	540	507	527	488	408
Muzaffarpur	+ 3·2	+ 1·5	+ 5·0	+ 15·0	+ 26·6	937	905	894	831	740
Darbhanga	+ 0·6	+ 3·9	+ 6·5	+ 23·1	+ 37·1	875	870	837	786	638
Bhagalpur	+ 2·4	+ 2·8	+ 3·3	+ 7·8	+ 17·2	506	494	481	466	432
Purnea	+ 6·0	− 3·6	+ 5·2	+ 7·8	+ 15·9	398	376	390	370	343
SOUTH BIHAR	+ 0·7	− 3·6	+ 2·7	+ 10·9	+ 10·5	515	512	531	517	466
Patna	− 0·9	− 8·4	+ 1·0	+ 12·6	+ 3·2	773	785	857	849	754
Gaya	+ 4·8	− 3·7	+ 0·6	+ 9·1	+ 10·9	483	437	454	451	413
Shahabad	− 4·9	− 4·8	+ 5·6	+ 14·0	+ 9·1	427	449	471	445	391
Monghyr	+ 3·1	+ 1·6	+ 3·4	+ 8·5	+ 17·5	544	527	519	502	463
ORISSA	+ 0·9	+ 7·1	+ 6·8	+ 17·7	+ 35·8	509	504	471	441	374
Cuttack	+ 2·4	+ 6·5	+ 7·9	+ 16·2	+ 36·7	577	564	530	491	422
Balasore	− 1·7	+ 7·7	+ 5·2	+ 22·7	+ 36·7	506	515	474	434	370
Puri	+ 0·6	+ 7·6	+ 6·3	+ 15·4	+ 32·9	410	407	378	356	308
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU...	+14·01	+ 6·4	+14·3	+ 34·1	+86·1	186	163	153	134	100
Hazaribagh	+ 9·4	+ 1·2	+ 5·4	+ 43·1	+ 66·9	184	164	166	137	110
Ranchi	+ 16·8	+ 5·2	+ 6·7	+ 30·1	+ 70·6	195	167	159	149	114
Palamau	+ 10·9	+ 3·8	+ 8·3	+ 30·0	+ 62·2	140	126	121	112	86
Manbhum	+ 18·9	+ 9·1	+ 13·8	+ 29·0	+ 88·6	373	314	288	255	198
Singhbhum	+ 13·2	+ 12·5	+ 20·2	+ 42·6	+118·2	178	158	140	117	82
Santhal Parganas	+ 4·0	+ 3·2	+ 11·9	+ 24·5	+ 49·5	345	331	321	247	230
Angul	+ 3·9	+ 12·8	+ 5·7	+105·2	+154·5	119	114	101	96	47
Sambalpur	+ 16·5	+ 3·3	+ 11·7	+ 25·8	+ 68·9	193	167	162	145	115
Orissa Feudatory States ...	+ 19·6	+ 9·5	+ 23·9	+ 41·1	+132·7	135	113	103	82	58
Chota Nagpur States	+ 5·4	+ 9·1	+ 19·5	+ 16·8	+ 60·5	247	234	215	180	154
Sikkim	+49·0	+93·8	...	...	...	31	21	11	...	...
CITIES—										
Calcutta	+ 5·7	+ 24·3	+ 11·4	− 3·3	+ 41·6	28,002	26,494	21,322	19,135	19,782
Howrah	+ 13·6	+ 35·2	+ 28·4	+ 8·0	+112·9	20,945	18,475	13,670	10,646	9,856
Cossipur-Chitpur	+ 18·2	+ 29·7	+ 19·5	+ 3·6	+ 89·9	14,824	12,538	9,669	8,090	7,806
Manicktollah	+ 66·0	+ 15·0	− 41·3	− 10·9	− 0·4	15,721	9,470	8,234	14,072	15,787
Garden Reach	+ 60·6	+ 1·0	+124·2	+ 34·5	+389·3	13,322	8,297	8,213	3,664	2,723
Dacca	+ 31·0	+ 10·0	+ 4·1	+ 14·2	+ 58·2	15,917	13,157	11,963	11,491	10,058
Patna	+ 1·0	− 18·4	− 3·2	+ 7·4	− 14·3	15,124	14,976	18,355	18,962	17,656
Gaya	− 30·0	− 11·3	+ 5·2	+ 14·3	− 25·3	6,240	8,911	10,048	9,552	8,355
Bhagalpur	− 1·9	+ 9·6	+ 1·3	+ 4·4	+ 13·7	8,261	8,418	7,678	7,582	7,264

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—VARIATION IN NATURAL POPULATION.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	POPULATION IN 1911.				POPULATION IN 1901.				VARIATION PER CENT. (1901-1911) IN NATURAL POPULATION. INCREASE (+) DECREASE (−)
	Actual population.	Immigrants.	Emigrants.	Natural population.	Actual population.	Immigrants.	Emigrants.	Natural population.	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**84,740,935**	...	...	**84,820,761**	**79,439,033**	...	...	**79,320,977**	+ 6·9
Bengal*	**46,305,642**	**1,970,778**	*583,610	**44,918,474**	**42,881,776**	...	...	**41,740,887**	+ 7·6
WEST BENGAL	**8,467,314**	**441,566**	**413,585**	**8,439,333**	**8,240,076**	**345,077**	**331,170**	**8,226,169**	+ 2·6
Burdwan	1,538,371	179,590	126,530	1,485,311	1,532,716	158,347	94,414	1,468,783	+ 1·1
Birbhum	935,473	64,079	50,202	921,596	902,280	60,606	47,361	889,035	+ 3·7
Bankura	1,138,670	46,182	175,384	1,267,872	1,116,411	29,584	146,518	1,233,395	+ 2·8
Midnapore	2,821,201	75,625	171,772	2,917,348	2,789,114	49,861	134,245	2,873,498	+ 1·5
Hooghly	1,090,097	186,309	149,508	1,053,296	1,049,041	139,714	122,841	1,032,168	+ 2·0
Howrah	943,502	189,984	40,392	793,910	850,514	144,620	23,396	729,290	+ 8·9
CENTRAL BENGAL	**8,078,555**	**1,006,226**	**300,025**	**7,372,354**	**7,730,775**	**761,046**	**230,245**	**7,199,974**	+ 2·4
24-Parganas	*2,434,104	401,623	139,245	2,171,726	2,079,359	225,367	118,960	1,971,952	+ 10·1
Calcutta	896,067	639,348	88,148	344,867	847,796	557,139	36,320	326,977	+ 5·5
Nadia	1,617,846	75,153	135,279	1,679,972	1,658,281	59,010	123,737	1,723,008	- 2·5
Murshidabad	1,372,274	75,571	107,283	1,403,986	1,333,184	71,096	78,696	1,340,784	+ 4·7
Jessore	1,758,264	59,773	73,312	1,771,803	1,813,155	47,036	71,134	1,837,253	- 3·6
NORTH BENGAL	**10,731,254**	**925,820**	**131,876**	**9,937,310**	**9,940,594**	...	...	**9,335,170**	+ 6·5
Rajshahi	1,480,587	95,067	38,726	1,424,246	1,460,584	79,179	23,612	1,405,017	+ 1·4
Dinajpur	1,687,863	197,043	23,480	1,514,300	1,366,845	132,003	17,193	1,452,035	+ 4·3
Jalpaiguri	902,660	265,268	20,999	658,391	786,326	188,223	17,426	615,529	+ 7·0
Darjeeling	265,550	117,158	10,416	158,808	249,117	124,391	5,694	130,420	+ 21·8
Rangpur	2,385,330	178,490	61,585	2,268,375	2,154,115	109,416	54,162	2,098,861	+ 8·1
Bogra	983,567	63,148	25,576	945,995	853,304	37,897	15,756	831,383	+ 13·8
Pabna	1,428,586	64,900	102,667	1,466,353	1,421,395	49,040	64,305	1,436,660	+ 2·1
Malda	1,004,159	118,871	41,508	926,796	881,734	97,887	26,764	810,611	+ 14·3
Cooch Behar	592,952	55,142	36,236	574,046	566,974	44,843	32,343	554,674	+ 3·5
EAST BENGAL	**19,028,519**	**309,591**	**379,130**	**19,098,058**	**16,970,331**	**251,261**	**260,504**	**16,979,574**	+ 12·5
Khulna	1,366,766	54,730	39,847	1,351,883	1,253,043	65,717	25,883	1,213,209	+ 11·4
Dacca	2,960,402	114,621	177,903	3,023,684	2,644,435	85,299	128,487	2,687,623	+ 12·5
Mymensingh	4,526,422	161,395	156,993	4,522,020	3,918,102	115,010	80,365	3,883,457	+ 16·4
Faridpur	2,121,914	96,333	81,469	2,107,050	1 951,943	73,483	75,810	1,954,270	+ 7·8
Backergunge	2,428,911	61,412	45,069	2,412,568	2,291,752	59,985	39,012	2,270,779	+ 6·2
Tippera	2,430,138	60,360	95,757	2,465,535	2,117,991	56,752	53,529	2,116,768	+ 16·5
Noakhali	1,302,090	22,844	48,548	1,327,834	1,141,728	19,343	33,585	1,155,968	+ 14·9
Chittagong	1,508,433	18,701	99,627	1,589,359	1,353,250	11,339	106,037	1.447,948	+ 9·8
Chittagong Hill Tracts	153,830	6,298	1,271	148,803	124,762	6,864	1,871	119,769	+ 24·2
Hill Tippera	229,613	81,663	1,373	149,322	173,325	43,894	152	129,583	+ 15·2
Bihar and Orissa†	**38,435,293**	**449,712**	†1,916,706	**39,902,287**	**36,557,257**	...	...	**37,580,090**	+ 6·2
NORTH BIHAR	**14,102,314**	**310,517**	**582,513**	**14,374,310**	**13,834,300**	...	...	**13,985,053**	+ 2·8
Saran	2,289,778	46,934	284,201	2,527,045	2,408,814	56,424	244,934	2,597,324	− 2·7
Champaran	1,908,385	95,518	47,832	1,860,699	1,790,463	106,781	36,077	1,719,759	+ 8·2
Muzaffarpur	2,845,514	73,286	194,814	2,967,042	2,756,130	87,702	153,537	2,821,965	+ 5·1
Darbhanga	2,929,682	86,748	176,066	3,019,000	2,912,611	90,580	111,512	2,933,543	+ 2·9
Bhagalpur	2,139,318	135,907	167,897	2,171,308	2 088,953	107,538	124,305	2,105,720	+ 3·1
Purnea	1,989,637	198,869	38,448	1,829,216	1,877,329	108,005	37,418	1,806,742	+ 1·2
SOUTH BIHAR	**7,767,682**	**158,371**	**645,604**	**8,254,915**	**7,716,175**	**160,809**	**521,890**	**8,077,256**	+ 2·2
Patna	1,609,631	92,106	173,915	1,691,440	1,624.742	82,440	142,316	1,684,618	+ 0·4
Gaya	2,159,498	61.394	204,564	2,302,668	2,059.933	46,114	175,469	2,187,288	+ 5·3
Shahabad	1,865,660	60.607	176,296	1,981,349	1,962,696	83,913	159,713	2,038,496	− 2·8
Monghyr	2,132,893	93,139	239,704	2,279,458	2,068,804	86,069	184,119	2,166,854	+ 5·2
ORISSA	**4,188,109**	**59,955**	**231,502**	**4,359,656**	**4,151,239**	**69,585**	**151,654**	**4,233,308**	+ 3·
Cuttack	2,109,139	33,254	172,674	2,248,559	2,060,313	32,944	116,759	2,144,128	+ 4·9
Balasore	1,035,568	32,429	72,476	1,095,615	1,073.642	29,467	51.763	1.095.938	- 0·2
Puri	1,023,402	43,440	35,520	1,015,482	1,017,284	53.033	28,991	993,242	+ 2·2
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.	**12,377,188**	**435,105**	**955,612**	**12,897,695**	**10,855,543**	...	...	**11,284,473**	+ 14·3
Hazaribagh	1,288,609	41,631	144,541	1,391,519	1,177,961	41,883	150,356	1,286,434	+ 8·2
Ranchi	1,387,516	33,643	305,309	1,659,182	1,187,925	32,058	275,251	1.431,120	+ 15·9
Palamau	687,267	25,930	37,481	698,818	619,600	38,838	32,210	612,972	+ 14·0
Manbhum	1,547,576	142,776	115,492	1,520,292	1,301,364	62.119	135,972	1,375,217	+ 10·5
Singhbhum	694.394	49,858	105,634	750.170	613,579	36,580	63,320	640,819	+ 17·1
Sonthal Parganas	1,882,973	106.697	321,283	2,097,559	1,809,737	111.525	226,008	1,924.220	+ 9·0
Angul	199.451	18,648	21,117	201.920	191,911	21.532	6.478	176,857	+ 14·2
Sambalpur‡	744,193	43,401	173.527	874,319	638.992	47,871	80,894	672,015	+ 30·1
Orissa Feudatory States‡	3,796,563	299,740	75.297	3,572.120	3,173,395	231,953	93,606	3,035,048	+ 17·7
Chota Nagpur States‡	148,646	18,738	1,888	131,796	141,079	14,737	3,429	129,771	+ 1·6
Sikkim	**87,920**	**29,835**	**3,443**	**61,528**	**59,014**	**25,004**	**2,188**	**36,198**	+ 70·0

* Column 4 includes 41,395 persons enumerated in other provinces and 30,024 persons enumerated outside India, who were returned as born in Bengal, but whose district of birth is not known.

† Column 4 includes 15,711 persons enumerated outside India, who were returned as born in Bihar and Orissa, but whose district of birth is not known.

‡ Owing to changes of area in Sambalpur, the Orissa Feudatory and Chota Nagpur States, figures for immigrants and emigrants are not available and proportional figure have had to be taken.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Comparison with Vital Statistics.

District and Natural Division.	In 1901—1910 total number of—		Number per cent. of population of 1901 of—		Excess (+) or deficiency (−) of births over deaths.		Increase (+) or decrease (−) of population of 1911 compared with 1901.	
	Births.	Deaths.	Births.	Deaths.	Actual number.	Proportional figures.	Natural population.	Actual population.
1	2	3	4	5	6 (a)	6 (b)	7	8
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**29,351,442**	**25,373,322**	**39·10**	**33·80**	**+3,978,120**	**+ 5·30**	**+ 4,867,479**	**+4,552,293**
Bengal	**15,797,344**	**13,728,296**	**37·60**	**32·67**	**+2,069,048**	**+ 4·93**	**+ 3,098,714**	**+3,312,532**
WEST BENGAL	**2,758,647**	**2,665,820**	**33·48**	**32·35**	**+ 92,827**	**+ 1·13**	**+ 213,164**	**+ 227,238**
Burdwan	494,407	514,589	32·26	33·57	− 20,182	− 1·31	+ 16,528	+ 5,655
Birbhum	322,151	303,462	35·70	33·65	+ 18,689	+ 2·05	+ 32,561	+ 38,193
Bankura	400,596	342,418	35·88	30·67	+ 58,178	+ 5·21	+ 34,477	+ 22,259
Midnapore	931,270	876,308	33·39	31·42	+ 54,962	+ 1·97	+ 43,850	+ 32,087
Hooghly	330,346	366,064	31·49	34·90	− 35,718	− 3·41	+ 21,128	+ 41,056
Howrah	279,877	262,979	32·91	30·92	+ 16,898	+ 1·99	+ 64,620	+ 92,988
CENTRAL BENGAL	**2,615,322**	**2,652,421**	**33·83**	**34·31**	**− 37,099**	**− 0·48**	**+ 172,380**	**+ 347,780**
24-Parganas	666,623	567,054	32·07	27·28	+ 99,569	+ 4·79	+ 199,774	+ 355,745
Calcutta	150,199	295,733	17·72	34·88	− 145,534	− 17·16	+ 17,890	+ 48,271
Nadia	651,655	645,766	39·30	38·94	+ 5,889	+ 0·36	− 43,036	− 40,435
Murshidabad	556,762	483,654	41·76	36·28	+ 73,108	+ 5·48	+ 63,302	+ [illegible]
Jessore	590,083	660,214	32·34	36·41	− 70,131	− 3·87	− 65,450	− 54,891
CENTRAL BENGAL (EXCLUDING CALCUTTA).	**2,465,123**	**2,356,688**	**35·81**	**34·24**	**+ 108,435**	**+ 1·57**	**+ 145,280**	**+ 299,509**
NORTH BENGAL	**3,789,336**	**3,396,633**	**40·43**	**36·24**	**+ 392,703**	**+ 4·19**	**+ 582,748**	**+ 764,682**
Rajshahi	613,340	582,074	41·99	39·85	+ 31,266	+ 2·14	+ 19,229	+ 20,003
Dinajpur	684,391	638,765	43·68	40·77	+ 45,626	+ 2·91	+ 62,265	+ 121,018
Jalpaiguri	292,880	248,224	37·25	36·66	+ 4,646	+ 0·59	+ 42,862	+ 116,334
Darjeeling	85,434	93,959	34·29	39·52	− 10,525	− 4·23	+ 38,388	+ 16,433
Rangpur	868,335	784,522	40·31	34·17	+ 133,512	+ 6·20	+ 169,514	+ 231,215
Bogra	356,405	255,473	41·76	29·93	+ 100,932	+ 11·73	+ 114,632	+ 130,063
Pabna	476,677	447,915	33·54	34·33	− 11,238	− 0·79	+ 29,693	+ 7,191
Malda	411,874	313,390	46·71	35·54	+ 98,484	+ 11·17	+ 116,185	+ 122,425
Cooch Behar	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
EAST BENGAL	**6,634,039**	**5,013,422**	**39·79**	**30·07**	**+1,620,617**	**+ 9·92**	**+ 2,069,711**	**+1,972,832**
Khulna	301,500	408,420	40·02	32·59	+ 93,080	+ 7·43	+ 138,674	+ 113,723
Dacca	1,066,226	806,988	40·32	30·52	+ 259,238	+ 9·80	+ 336,061	+ 315,967
Mymensingh	1,476,951	1,006,842	37·70	25·70	+ 470,109	+ 12·00	+ 638,863	+ 608,320
Faridpur	780,741	679,181	40·00	34·80	+ 101,560	+ 5·20	+ 152,780	+ 169,971
Backergunge	923,940	791,158	40·40	34·61	+ 132,788	+ 5·79	+ 141,789	+ 137,159
Tippera	810,665	533,089	38·28	25·17	+ 277,576	+ 13·11	+ 348,767	+ 312,147
Noakhali	527,328	361,574	46·19	31·67	+ 165,754	+ 14·52	+ 171,866	+ 160,362
Chittagong	544,688	424,176	40·25	31·34	+ 120,512	+ 8·91	+ 141,411	+ 135,183
Chittagong Hill Tracts	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Hill Tippera	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Bihar and Orissa	**13,554,098**	**11,645,026**	**41·01**	**35·23**	**+1,909,072**	**+ 5·78**	**+ 1,758,037**	**+1,239,761**
NORTH BIHAR	**5,592,915**	**4,892,069**	**40·43**	**35·36**	**+ 700,846**	**+ 5·07**	**+ 389,257**	**+ 268,014**
Saran	966,578	975,477	40·13	40·50	− 8,899	− 0·37	− 70,379	− 119,036
Champaran	767,180	584,839	42·85	32·66	+ 182,341	+ 10·19	+ 140,940	+ 117,922
Muzaffarpur	1,173,654	973,101	42·58	35·31	+ 200,553	+ 7·27	+ 145,077	+ 89,584
Darbhanga	1,162,745	972,763	39·92	33·40	+ 189,942	+ 6·52	+ 85,457	+ 17,071
Bhagalpur	805,535	702,902	38·56	33·65	+ 102,633	+ 4·91	+ 65,588	+ 50,365
Purnea	717,223	682,987	38·20	36·38	+ 34,236	+ 1·82	+ 22,474	+ 112,306
SOUTH BIHAR	**3 292,705**	**3,177,530**	**42·67**	**41·18**	**+ 115,175**	**+ 1·49**	**+ 177,659**	**+ 51,507**
Patna	660,080	771,712	40·63	47·50	− 111,632	− 6·87	+ 6,822	− 15,111
Gaya	925,927	856,042	44·95	41·56	+ 69,885	+ 3·39	+ 115,340	+ 99,365
Shahabad	807,325	787,580	41·13	40·13	+ 19,745	+ 1·00	− 57,147	− 97,036
Monghyr	899,373	762,196	43·47	36·84	+ 137,177	+ 6·63	+ 112,604	+ 64,089
ORISSA	**1,624,448**	**1,515,872**	**39·13**	**36·52**	**+ 108,576**	**+ 2·61**	**+ 126,348**	**+ 36,870**
Cuttack	846,327	749,717	41·08	36·39	+ 96,610	+ 4·69	+ 104,431	+ 48,826
Balasore	406,776	404,719	37·89	37·70	+ 2,057	+ 0·19	− 823	− 18,074
Puri	371,345	361,436	36·50	35·53	+ 9,909	+ 0·97	+ 22,240	+ 6,118
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	**3,044,030**	**2,059,555**	**41·42**	**28·02**	**+ 984,475**	**+ 13·40**	**+ 1,049,062**	**+ 883,370**
Hazaribagh	549,164	378,943	46·62	32·17	+ 170,221	+ 14·45	+ 105,085	+ 110,648
Ranchi	529,194	332,740	44·55	28·01	+ 196,454	+ 16·54	+ 228,062	+ 199,391
Palamau	296,909	228,324	47·92	36·85	+ 68,585	+ 11·07	+ 85,846	+ 67,667
Manbhum	511,945	345,112	39·34	26·52	+ 166,833	+ 12·82	+ 145,075	+ 246,212
Singhbhum	237,226	139,941	37·08	22·81	+ 97,285	+ 14·22	+ 109,351	+ 80,815
Santhal Parganas	678,927	488,358	37·52	26·98	+ 190,569	+ 10·54	+ 173,339	+ 73,236
Angul	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Sambalpur	250,665	146,237	39·23	22·89	+ 104,428	+ 16·34	+ 202,304	+ 105,201
Orissa Feudatory States	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Chota Nagpur States	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...

* In the calculation for each Province and natural division those areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III-A.—Ratios of Births, Deaths and Increase.

Year.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.			Bihar and Orissa.		
	Ratio per 1,000 of population of 1901.			Ratio per 1,000 of population of 1901.			Ratio per 1,000 of population of 1901.		
	Births.	Deaths.	Excess of births over deaths.	Births.	Deaths.	Excess of births over deaths.	Births.	Deaths.	Excess of births over deaths.
1901	39·3	31·5	+ 7·8	37·7	30·3	+ 7·4	41·3	33·1	+ 8·2
1902	40·9	33·8	+ 7·1	39·1	35·1	+ 4·0	43·1	32·1	+ 11·0
1903	39·7	33·7	+ 6·0	36·7	32·2	+ 4·5	43·5	35·6	+ 7·9
1904	43·4	32·9	+ 10·5	40·9	33·2	+ 7·7	46·6	32·5	+ 14·1
1905	40·0	38·1	+ 1·9	37·8	36·5	+ 1·3	42·9	40·2	+ 2·7
1906	38·1	35·3	+ 2·9	35·4	33·3	+ 2·1	41·5	37·7	+ 3·8
1907	38·1	35·7	+ 2·4	35·9	33·6	+ 2·3	41·0	38·5	+ 2·5
1908	38·4	36·1	+ 2·3	37·9	31·8	+ 6·1	39·1	41·7	- 2·6
1909	39·5	32·1	+ 7·4	39·3	31·2	+ 8·1	39·7	33·2	+ 6·5
1910	39·8	33·6	+ 6·2	37·7	31·4	+ 6·3	42·5	36·6	+ 5·9
Average per annum for 10 years	39·7	34·3	+ 5·4	37·9	32·9	+ 5·0	42·1	36·1	+ 6·0
Average for 1906-1908 ...	38·6	36·3	+ 2·4	36·8	35·8	+ 3·0	41·1	39·5	+ 1·6
Average for the remaining 6 years...	40·4	32·9	+ 7·5	38·5	32·2	+ 6·3	42·8	33·9	+ 8·9

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Variation by Thanas classified according to density.

(a) Actual Variation.

Natural Division.	Decade.	Variation in thanas with a population per square mile at commencement of decade of—							
		Under 150	150—300.	300—450.	450—600.	600—750.	750—900.	900—1,050.	1,050 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	**1891 to 1901**	**+ 374,998**	**+ 532,342**	**+ 521,214**	**+ 599,360**	**+ 494,933**	**+ 544,012**	**+ 155,842**	**+ 449,766**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 964,881**	**+ 508,224**	**+ 827,292**	**+ 246,343**	**+ 343,718**	**+ 280,792**	**+ 292,643**	**+ 235,110**
Bengal	**1891 to 1911**	**+ 86,636**	**+ 251,218**	**+ 414,128**	**+ 620,486**	**+ 532,460**	**+ 463,964**	**+ 179,470**	**+ 491,743**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 323,713**	**+ 184,005**	**+ 543,455**	**+ 260,379**	**+ 260,814**	**+ 215,916**	**+ 152,469**	**+ 317,589**
West Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	...	+ 24,075	+ 119,795	+ 146,777	+ 137,718	+ 9,915	+ 11,730	+ 100,877
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 10,304	+ 32,874	+ 27,347	+ 8,170	+ 25,908	- 1,448	+ 101,453
Central Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	...	+ 23,671	+ 39,815	+ 18,620	- 13,526	+ 44,435	+ 40,134	+ 229,362
	1901 to 1911	+ 138,054	+ 33,022	+ 19,656	- 37,852	+ 19,962	+ 42,280	- 20,717	+ 72,275
North Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	+ 61,786	+ 137,752	+ 96,915	+ 78,775	+ 117,874	+ 20,857	- 128	+ 21,140
	1901 to 1911	+ 91,357	+ 40,120	+ 287,992	+ 110,644	+ 125,246	+ 56,700	- 2,822	- 5,360
East Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	+ 24,850	+ 65,720	+ 157,603	+ 376,311	+ 290,394	+ 388,757	+ 127,734	+ 140,364
	1901 to 1911	+ 94,302	+ 100,559	+ 202,933	+ 160,240	+ 107,416	+ 91,033	+ 177,456	+ 149,221
Bihar and Orissa	**1891 to 1901**	**+ 288,362**	**+ 281,124**	**+ 107,086**	**- 21,126**	**- 37,527**	**+ 80,048**	**- 23,628**	**- 41,977**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 641,168**	**+ 324,219**	**+ 283,837**	**- 14,036**	**+ 82,904**	**+ 64,876**	**+ 140,174**	**- 82,279**
North Bihar ...	1891 to 1901	...	- 5,033	- 28,055	- 3,431	- 5,365	+ 62,668	+ 25,076	- 31,578
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 72,005	+ 89,670	+ 55,803	+ 47,632	+ 1,576	+ 64,233	- 59,725
South Bihar ...	1891 to 1901	...	- 4,597	- 34,664	- 60,857	- 82,112	- 18,430	- 60,827	- 30,436
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 48,659	+ 20,359	- 78,612	+ 32,128	- 1,539	+ 64,756	- 22,066
Orissa	1891 to 1901	...	+ 37,334	+ 94,211	+ 34,740	+ 38,837	+ 35,610	+ 12,123	+ 20,54
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 10,820	- 30,585	- 3,009	- 7,057	+ 64,839	+ 11,185	- 9,323
Chota Nagpur Plateau	1891 to 1901	+ 288,362	+ 252,920	+ 75,594	+ 8,422	+ 11,113	...	...	- 503
	1901 to 1911	+ 641,168	+ 192,735	+ 204,393	+ 11,782	+ 10,201	...	...	+ 8,835

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Variation by Thanas classified according to density—*concluded.*

(*b*) Proportional Variation.

Natural Division.	Decade.	Variation in thanas with a population per square mile at commencement of decade of—							
		Under 150.	150—300.	300—450.	450—600.	600—750.	750—900.	900—1,050.	1,050 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	*1891 to 1901*	+ *11·1*	+ *6·2*	+ *5·0*	+ *4·3*	+ *3·7*	+ *4·6*	+ *1·9*	+ *8·8*
	1901 to 1911	+ *20·6*	+ *6·2*	+ *7·5*	+ *2·0*	+ *2·3*	+ *2·7*	+ *2·5*	+ *4·7*
Bengal	*1891 to 1901*	+ *36·0*	+ *13·1*	+ *8·0*	+ *6·6*	+ *5·9*	+ *7·4*	+ *5·4*	+ *11·6*
	1901 to 1911	+ *22·0*	+ *13·0*	+ *10·4*	+ *3·3*	+ *2·4*	+ *3·6*	+ *2·6*	+ *7·9*
West Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	...	+ 6·3	+ 6·9	+ 7·7	+ 8·9	+ 2·0	+ 1·9	+ 10·1
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 4·3	+ 2·5	+ 1·2	+ 0·5	+ 2·6	- 0·3	+ 8·3
Central Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	...	+ 41·9	+ 13·7	+ 0·9	- 0·8	+ 3·9	+ 7·0	+ 15·5
	1901 to 1911	+ 14·3	+ 11·9	+ 7·4	- 2·0	+ 1·0	+ 5·5	- 2·9	+ 11·2
North Bengal ...	1891 to 1901	+ 62·4	+ 15·3	+ 4·8	+ 3·4	+ 4·2	+ 2·2	- 0·3	+ 8·3
	1901 to 1911	+ 56·8	+ 9·1	+ 11·6	+ 4·8	+ 4·4	+ 4·7	- 1·4	- 2·1
East Bengal... ...	1891 to 1901	+ 17·5	+ 11·5	+ 13·8	+ 11·8	+ 10·3	+ 10·4	+ 6·1	+ 9·1
	1901 to 1911	+ 27·7	+ 20·7	+ 17·5	+ 11·4	+ 2·6	+ 3·1	+ 3·9	+ 8·0
Bihar and Orissa	*1891 to 1901*	+ *9·2*	+ *4·2*	+ *2·0*	- *0·5*	- *0·9*	+ *1·4*	- *0·5*	- *4·9*
	1901 to 1911	+ *20·0*	+ *4·3*	+ *5·0*	- *0·3*	+ *2·0*	+ *1·4*	+ *2·5*	- *7·9*
North Bihar ...	1891 to 1901	...	- 0·9	- 1·8	- 0·2	- 0·3	+ 1·8	+ 0·7	- 5·9
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 10·9	+ 6·1	- 3·3	+ 2·4	+ 0·1	+ 1·5	- 7·3
South Bihar... ...	1891 to 1901	...	- 0·5	- 3·0	- 3·4	- 5·3	- 1·5	- 7·2	- 11·0
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 5·3	+ 1·8	- 3·8	+ 1·7	- 0·2	+ 11·0	- 14·3
Orissa	1891 to 1901	...	+ 7·1	+ 8·4	+ 6·3	+ 6·1	+ 4·9	+ 4·5	+ 71·3
	1901 to 1911	...	+ 2·5	- 2·3	- 0·5	- 3·6	+ 6·7	+ 2·0	- 18·9
Chota Nagpur Plateau	1891 to 1901	+ 9·2	+ 5·5	+ 5·4	+ 3·8	+ 7·1	...	...	- 2·6
	1901 to 1911	+ 20·0	+ 4·1	+ 11·4	+ 5·1	+ 6·1	...	...	+ 44·9

CHAPTER III.

BIRTHPLACE.

INTRODUCTORY.

380. THIS Chapter deals with the subject of migration and is based on the statistics of birthplace contained in Imperial Table XI. Supplementary statistics will be found in the following Subsidiary Tables at the end of the chapter :—

Subsidiary Table I—Shows the number of immigrants in each district.

Subsidiary Table II—Shows the number of emigrants from each district.

Subsidiary Table III—Gives proportional figures of migration to and from each district.

Subsidiary Table IV—Shows the volume of migration between the natural divisions compared with 1901.

Subsidiary Table V—Shows the volume of migration between Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, and other parts of India.

Subsidiary Table VI—Shows migration to and from border districts.

TYPES OF MIGRATION.

381. Before proceeding to discuss the statistics, it may be explained that five different types of migration may be distinguished, viz.—

(1) *Casual migration*, or the minor movements between adjacent villages. These affect the returns only when the villages in question happen to lie in different districts, being separated by some natural or artificial boundary. There is generally an excess of females in such cases owing to the fact that it is the common practice for Hindus to take a wife from another village, and that young married women often go to their parents' home for their first confinement.

(2) *Temporary migration*, due to journeys on business, visits to fairs and places of pilgrimage, and the temporary demand for labour created by the construction of new roads and railways. As an example of the manner in which this kind of migration affects the returns, it will suffice to mention the presence of a large body of pilgrims in Puri at the time when the census was held, and the collection of thousands of labourers for the construction of the Lower Ganges bridge works in the districts of Nadia and Pabna.

(3) *Periodic migration*, such as the annual migration which takes place in Bihar and Orissa. In this Province many thousands of labourers leave their homes during the cold weather in order to find employment elsewhere and rejoin their families after a few months when they have saved enough to satisfy their needs, if not their wishes. The movement may be from one part of a district to another, in which case there is no record of it in the returns. In other cases, however, the movement is from one district to another and the returns are materially affected. The number of persons who move from place to place in this way is often very large, *e.g.*, 15,000 temporary labourers were engaged in cutting *rabi* crops in one thana of the Patna district when the census was taken.

(4) *Semi-permanent migration*—The people of one place reside and earn their living in another, but retain their connection with their own homes, where they leave their families and to which they return in their old age, and at more or less regular intervals in the meantime. This kind of migration is evidenced by the excess of males in the emigrant population, and is becoming more common as commerce and industry extend and the avenues open to labour or clerical employment grow wider.

(5) *Permanent migration*, *i.e.*, where overcrowding drives people away, or the superior attractions of some other locality induce people to settle there.

In this case the sexes are more or less equally represented, the new colonists bringing their wives and families with them. It is most common in sparsely populated tracts, such as the Sundarbans, the Orissa States and the Brahmaputra *chars*, where there is plenty of cultivable land available at low rentals.

CONDITIONS AT THE TIME OF THE CENSUS.

382. It must be clearly understood that the census merely shows the number of persons present in each locality on one day in the year. This fact is of especial importance in considering the statistics of migration, for the census is held at a time when the poorer classes, who furnish the bulk of migrants, have no special inducements to keep them at homes. By the beginning of March, when the census takes place, nearly all the crops are off the ground in Bihar and Chota Nagpur, and there is little or no work in the fields. The landless labourers and poorer cultivators begin to leave their homes in the cold weather, after the rice has been harvested, to find employment either on the land in districts where the harvest comes later, or on the roads and railways, in mines, mills, factories, docks, etc. The greatest exodus takes place in November and December, when there is a large demand for labour in reaping the winter rice crop of Bengal. Many return after December or January when that crop has been reaped, but others stay on in different kinds of employment. As a rule, there are few left after May, for they go back before the breaking of the rains to cultivate their own fields. If, therefore, the census was held in January, the number of those enumerated outside their own district would be greater, and if it was held in June it would be far smaller.

GENERAL RESULTS.

383. The movements of the people in the two Provinces dealt with in this Report present a sharp contrast, for Bengal gains largely by immigration, whereas emigration causes a heavy, though temporary, drain on Bihar and Orissa. In Bengal the immigrants from other parts of India number 1,839,000, but it sends out only 553,000 emigrants. In Bihar and Orissa, on the other hand, there is a comparatively small influx from other Provinces, but the exodus of the native-born has attained very large dimensions. It receives an accession of only 410,000 from other parts of India, while it sends out 1,901,000 of its inhabitants. The contrast between conditions in the two Provinces is further illustrated by the marginal statement, from which it will be seen that in Bengal immigrants are nearly four times as numerous as emigrants, while Bihar and Orissa has only 1 immigrant to every four emigrants.

	NO. PER MILLE OF POPULATION.	
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
IMMIGRANTS	***43***	***12***
Immigrants from contiguous districts	8	7
Ditto from other places ...	35	5
EMIGRANTS	***13***	***49***
Emigrants to contiguous districts ...	7	18
Ditto to other places ...	6	31

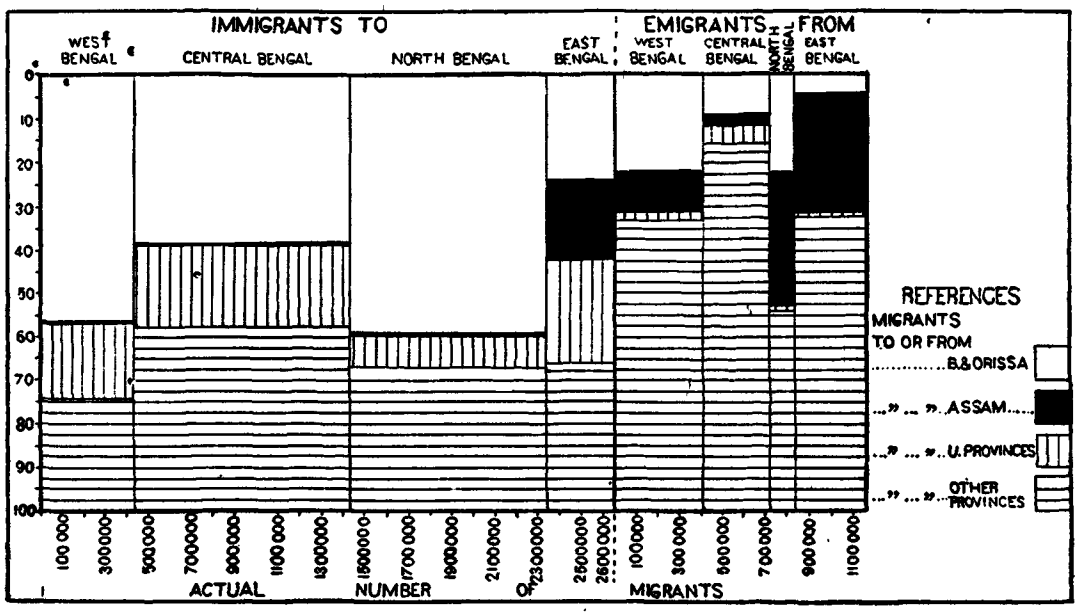
384. The Bihari, swarthy aboriginal of Chota Nagpur and, to a minor extent, the Oriya are adventurous and strike far afield, but the Bengali favours neither distant provinces nor distant districts either within or outside Bengal. If we exclude those who were enumerated in contiguous districts of other Provinces, the aggregate of emigrants from Bengal is reduced to 270,000. Even within the ring-fence of his own Province, the Bengali does not care to go far away from his native village, though, wherever he goes, he enjoys much the same climate and finds himself among men of the same race and language. Those who were either temporarily or permanently resident at the time of the census in non-contiguous districts represented only 6 per mille of the population. On the other hand, in Bihar and Orissa, with its medley of races and languages and its great diversity of climate, the proportion of emigrants to contiguous districts is only about half of that returned for distant places.

MOVEMENTS BETWEEN THE TWO PROVINCES.

385. Bengal gains no less than 1,087,000 persons by the balance of migration between it and Bihar and Orissa. The number of Bengali emigrants present in the latter Province at the time of the census was only

165,000, of whom 133,000 were enumerated in the adjoining districts of Purnea, the Sonthal Parganas, Manbhum, Singhbhum and Balasore. The immigrants to Bengal from Bihar and Orissa were nearly 8 times as many, amounting to 1,252,000, or one-thirtieth of the total population, among whom there were 8 males to every female. An account will be given later in this chapter of the movements to and from each natural division, but may be anticipated by the marginal statement. West Bengal receives one-fifth, Central Bengal one-third, North Bengal over two-fifths, and East Bengal only 6 per cent. of the emigrants. Of those enumerated in West Bengal, nearly half come from the Chota Nagpur Plateau. 59,000 being born in the Sonthal Parganas. Central Bengal draws mainly on Bihar, and especially South Bihar, while the great majority of the emigrants to North Bengal come from North Bihar and the Chota Nagpur Plateau, the former contributing one-third and the latter three-fifths of the total number.

BORN IN	ENUMERATED IN				
	Bengal.	West Bengal.	Central Bengal.	North Bengal.	East Bengal.
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**1,252,371**	**250,294**	**386,666**	**541,395**	**74,016**
North Bihar	353,746	34,686	94,408	183,042	41,610
South Bihar	298,468	66,383	174,806	33,446	23,833
Orissa	123,750	37,318	77,206	5,149	4,077
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	476,407	111,907	40,246	319,758	4,496



386. The difference between the two Provinces is due partly to racial characteristics, partly to climate, and partly to economic and industrial conditions. The Bengali has a very different character from that of the Bihari, and in particular of the Bhojpuri people, who have been described by Sir G. Grierson as "an alert and active nationality, with few scruples and considerable abilities. Dearly loving a fight for fighting's sake, they have spread all over Aryan India, each man ready to carve his fortune out of any opportunity which may present itself to him. As fond as an Irishman is of a stick, the long-boned, stalwart Bhojpuri, with his staff in hand, is a familiar object striding over fields far from his home. Thousands of them have emigrated to British Colonies and have returned rich men; every year still larger numbers wander over Northern Bengal and seek employment, either honestly, as *palki*-bearers, or otherwise as dacoits. Every Bengal zamindar keeps a *posse* of these men, euphemistically termed *darwans*, to keep his tenants in order. Calcutta, where they are employed, and feared, by the less heroic natives of Bengal, is full of them." The second great cause of difference is the higher standard of prosperity attained by the Bengali. It is on this account that he can employ foreign labour instead of working himself. It is a commonplace that now-a-days the sons of middle class cultivators despise the manual work

which their fathers did as a matter of course, but this attitude would be impossible unless they had sufficient means to maintain it.

387. Some allowance must also be made for the weakening effects of climate. The harvesting of the great winter rice crop of Bengal takes place at the height of the fever season, and in some districts the ravages of fever are so widespread that it is difficult to procure enough local labourers.* The combined effect of easy circumstances, the ravages of fever and, to some extent also, religious orthodoxy is that immigrants are largely recruited for two classes of labour, viz., work involving hard physical labour and tasks that are regarded as degrading. The big-boned Bihari and the small but wiry aboriginal are consequently being employed more and more as earth-workers, *palki*-bearers, scavengers and leather workers. Besides this, the up-countrymen is preferred for posts in which some power of control and physical strength are necessary, such as that of *darwan*, *chaprasi*, railway servant, etc.

388. Lastly, the industrial development of Bengal has naturally created a great demand for labour, which is not fully supplied from local sources. It is unnecessary to dwell on this aspect of the question at any length, as reference has already been made to the vast strides made in Bengal during the last decade, and to the backward condition of Bihar and Orissa. Suffice it to say, that the special industrial census shows that in Bengal industrial concerns employing 20 hands or more have a total labour force of over 606,000, whereas in Bihar and Orissa the number is only 180,000. Coal-mining is, in fact, the only industry of great importance in the latter Province; if it be excluded, the number employed in industrial concerns is only 94,000. Indigo is now only a shadow of what it was and furnishes employment to less than one-ninth of the number working on the tea gardens in Bengal, while there is no such industry as that of jute, which in Bengal requires 200,000 men to man the mills. The labour force of these large organized industries is being drawn more and more from the United Provinces, from Bihar and Orissa, and even from Madras, and the native-born Bengalis are yielding place to immigrants.

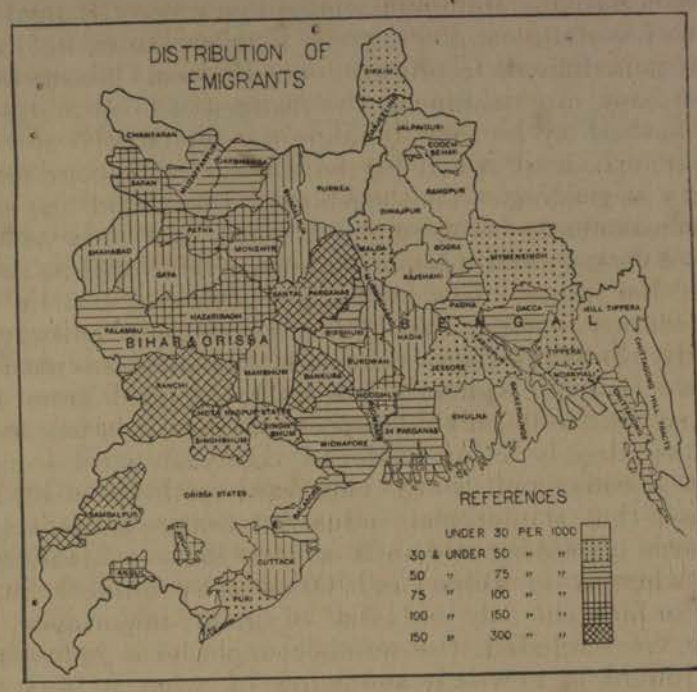
389. The extent of the movements of the people in each natural division will be sufficiently realized from the marginal statement. These figures show that the preceding remarks regarding the contrast between the two Provinces apply to every division. In all the divisions of Bengal the gain from distant places is greater than from contiguous districts, but the reverse is the case in Bihar and Orissa. In Bengal again the emigrants to contiguous districts outnumber those who move to distant places in every division but East Bengal, where the numbers are equal. The exceptional position of this latter division is due to Dacca, the quick-witted inhabitants of which supply fresh recruits, year after year, to the ranks of the professional classes in distant parts of the

NATURAL DIVISIONS AND DISTRICTS.

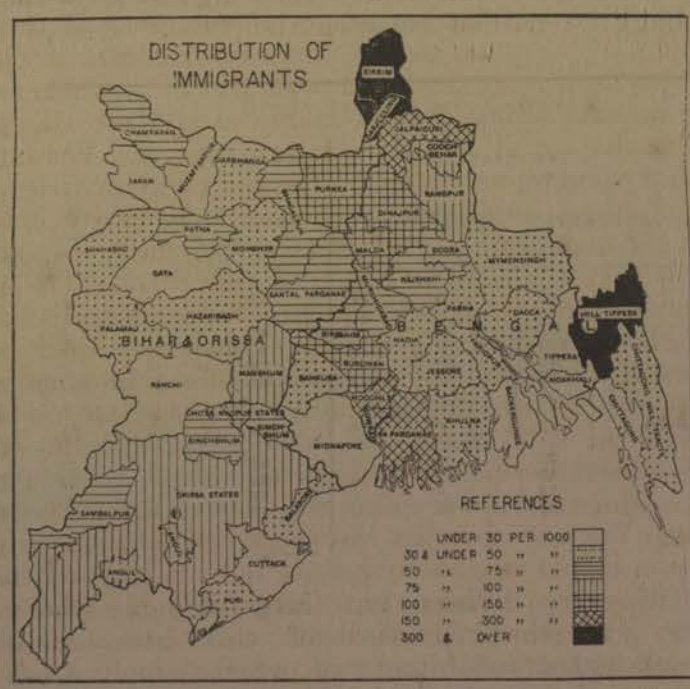
NATURAL DIVISION.	NUMBER PER 100,000 OF ACTUAL POPULATION.					
	IMMIGRANTS FROM—			EMIGRANTS TO—		
	Total.	Contiguous districts.	Other places.	Total.	Contiguous districts.	Other places.
BENGAL	**43**	**8**	**35**	**13**	**7**	**6**
West Bengal	52	21	31	49	37	12
Central ,, ...	125	39	86	37	25	12
North ,, ...	86	34	52	12	10	2
East ,, ...	16	7	9	20	10	10
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**12**	**7**	**5**	**49**	**18**	**31**
North Bihar	22	16	6	41	19	22
South ,, ...	20	17	3	83	24	59
Orissa	14	8	6	56	19	37
Chota Nagpur Plateau	35	28	7	77	24	53

* *Cf.* Hooghly District Gazetteer, page 170.—"There is a general complaint of the insufficiency of the supply of labour. During the winter months, the labour question often becomes acute, and instances have been known of crops rotting on the fields and looms stopping for want of workers. The difficulties caused by the deficiency of labour are further aggravated by epidemics of malarial fever that break out from November to February, reducing the number of workers and diminishing the working capacity of those who survive." Also *see* Jessore District Gazetteer, page 84.—"It is said that owing to the unhealthiness of the district there has been a decline in the number of skilled labourers for some years past, and that the supply of agricultural labourers is unequal to the demand, especially during the fever season, so much so that land sometimes remains uncultivated for want of men to till it."

country. In Bihar and Orissa, on the other hand, every division contributes more emigrants to remote areas than to adjoining districts.



390. In Bengal there are only ten districts of which the emigrant exceeds the immigrant population, viz., Bankura and Midnapore in West Bengal, Nadia, Jessore and Murshidabad in Central Bengal, Pabna in North Bengal, and Dacca, Tippera, Noakhali and Chittagong in East Bengal. The excess in these districts is greatest in the comparatively healthy district of Bankura (129,000) and least in the notoriously unhealthy district of Jessore (13,500).



Bankura is also easily first from a relative point of view, for its emigrants constitute 15 per cent. of its total population : in no other district does the proportion reach 7 per cent., and it falls to 4 per cent. in Jessore. Of the districts which benefit by immigration the greatest gainers are the 24-Parganas and Jalpaiguri, where the immigrants outnumber the emigrants by 262,000 and 245,000, respectively : the case of Calcutta, where the excess is over half a million, is exceptional. Proportionately, however, the foreign-born population

is greatest in Darjeeling, where it represents 44½ per cent. of the total population, and it is least in Chittagong, where it is 1 per cent. only.

391. In Bihar and Orissa there are only four districts where immigrants outnumber emigrants, viz., Manbhum, where the excess is due to the influx of labourers to the coal mines, Puri, where it is accounted for by pilgrimage to the shrine of Jagannath, and Champaran and Purnea, two sparsely populated districts which still depend on new comers from other districts for the development of their arable waste. There is also a preponderance of immigrants in the Chota Nagpur and Orissa States, the excess over emigrants (224,000) being especially great in the Orissa States, where extensive areas of cheap cultivable land are attracting colonists from adjoining areas. The actual number of immigrants in the Orissa States (300,000) is far above that returned for any district, only four having over 100,000, viz., Purnea (199,000), Manbhum (143,000), Bhagalpur (136,000) and the Sonthal Parganas (107,000). The Chota Nagpur States, however, have relatively the largest foreign-born population, viz., 13 per cent., and then Purnea with 10 per cent.; the third place is shared by Angul and Manbhum, each of which have a ratio of 9 per cent.

No district sends out so many emigrants as the Sonthal Parganas, the number born in it but enumerated elsewhere being 321,000. It is closely followed by Ranchi (305,000), after which comes Saran (284,000). Two more districts have an aggregate of over 200,000 emigrants, viz., Monghyr (240,000) and Gaya (208,000), and ten of 100,000 to 200,000. The proportion of emigrants to the total population is over 20 per cent. in Sambalpur (23) and Ranchi (22), over 15 per cent. in the Sonthal Parganas (16) and Singhbhum (15), and over 10 per cent. in Saran, Patna and Angul. It falls below 5 per cent. only in Puri (3·5), Champaran (2·5), the Orissa States (2), Purnea (1·9), and the Chota Nagpur States (1·3). No district is less dependent on others than Cuttack, where the foreign-born population represents under 2 per cent.

392. Before proceeding to discuss the movements of the people to and from other parts of India, reference may be made to three great streams of migration inside the two provinces. The first which may be mentioned is that from the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where the number of those enumerated outside the district or State of birth aggregates 955,000, or 8 per cent. of the total population. The main trend is in two directions, viz., into the Orissa Feudatory States and into Bengal and Assam. There is an increasing influx of new settlers into the Feudatory States, to which Ranchi and Singhbhum to the north and Sambalpur to the south-east have contributed altogether 145,000. The sexes are very evenly divided, and it is clear that the emigrants are cultivators, who have been attracted by the wide stretches of arable land to be got at cheap rates. The great majority of the emigrants, however, go to distant places, altogether 874,000 being enumerated in other provinces. Nearly all of these find their way to Bengal or Assam. Assam contains over a quarter of a million emigrants from the Plateau, and Bengal no less than 476,000. Of these latter 246,000 hail from the Sonthal Parganas, while 99,000 persons born in Ranchi are engaged in clearing land or cultivating tea in Jalpaiguri.

INTERNAL MOVEMENTS.

CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.

393. The readiness of the people of the Chota Nagpur Plateau to migrate is explained by three factors, viz., that the aboriginal inhabitants are multiplying rapidly, they pursue an uneconomic system of cultivation, and they have thriftless habits. The operation of these three factors is well explained in the report on the settlement of Ranchi by Mr. J. Reid, I.C.S., whose account of conditions in Ranchi are equally applicable to other parts of the Chota Nagpur Plateau. "It is sometimes said that the aborigines have no strong ties to bind them to their homes, and that this explains the apparent ease with which they emigrate. This view seems to me to be incorrect. Both Mundas and Oraons possess a very deep attachment for their homes and fields in this district; especially, as is often the case, if they are the pioneers, or descendants of the pioneers, who cleared the lands which they cultivate. The pride with which a Munda or Oraon tells one that he is a descendant of the original founders of the village (a *bhuinhar* or *khuntkattidar*) is unmistakeable. The

aborigines, in fact, cling with remarkable tenacity to their homes and fields. It is not uncommon to find that a Munda or an Oraon will persist in cultivating the ancestral fields long after he has been ejected from them by the Courts, and I have known numerous cases in which individual aboriginals underwent imprisonment five or six times for persisting in their attempts to get back the ancestral lands. Large numbers of those who emigrate to Assam and the Duars return, if they are able to save a little money, and buy back the farms which they had lost or some land in the vicinity. This, in fact, is often the object with which they emigrate.

"Only the severest economic pressure will drive the aboriginal from his native wilds. The causes are not far to seek. The soil of the district is, on the whole, extremely poor and infertile. The methods of cultivation practised are primitive and antiquated. The needs of the Munda and Oraon are few; but he is not industrious, and is generally heedless of the morrow. He spends whatever little savings he may have in the local liquor shop, and whenever a period of stress occurs, he has no margin to fall back upon. It is true that new areas are being constantly cleared and opened up, and that the available food-supply is being constantly increased. The increase in cultivation does not, however, keep pace with the increase in the population. The primitive aboriginal does not care to cultivate more than is necessary for his own immediate needs; nor does he make provision for bad seasons by increasing the area under cultivation and thereby making up the deficiency in outturn, even if lands are available."

BIHAR

394. The main features of emigration from Bihar are similar to those of Chota Nagpur. Its volume is very great, there being one and a quarter million enumerated outside the districts in which they were born. The majority move to distant places; less than half a million were present in adjoining districts, whether in Bihar and Orissa or outside it. Emigration is most active in South Bihar, the emigrants from which constitute 8 per cent. of the population, a ratio double that of North Bihar. The periodic exodus of the people is growing rapidly, the number of persons absent from their districts at the time of the census being 279,000 more than in 1901. One great body makes its way to Calcutta and the metropolitan districts of Howrah, Hooghly and the 24-Parganas, where employment is found in the mills and factories. Districts which hitherto had but a small share in this movement are now contributing to it largely. For example, the number in those industrial centres hailing from the three adjoining districts of Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga and Monghyr has risen in the last ten years from 47,000 to 84,000. The other direction in which the current of migration sets is eastwards, and its volume is swelling with the facilities of intercommunication afforded by through lines of railway. Purnea, with its extensive areas of cheap cultivable land, is the first to benefit by the outflow. Even in the last ten years the number of emigrants to this district from the four districts to the west (Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Bhagalpur and Monghyr) has nearly been doubled, rising from 68,000 to 130,000: over two-thirds of these come from the neighbouring districts of Monghyr and Bhagalpur, and the proportion of the sexes shows that the majority are permanent settlers.

395. With this exception the exodus is mainly periodic, just as it is in Chota Nagpur. It owes its origin to different causes, however, for it cannot be said that the people of Bihar are multiplying rapidly, are careless in their husbandry or thriftless in their habits. On the contrary, the population has been stationary during the last 20 years, the cultivators are alert and industrious, and the large amounts remitted to their homes by emigrants absolve them of the suspicion of thriftlessness. There is, however, a host of landless labourers—the number of those returned at this census as dependent on agricultural labour is 4,680,000, or over one-fifth of the total population. Besides this, the holdings of a considerable proportion of the cultivators are so small that they are insufficient to support them, and they have necessarily to eke out their livelihood by labour: the settlement shows a million of landless labourers and petty cultivators in Saran and Darbhanga alone. There are no large local industries to engage the energies of this large population of workers, and agriculture requires comparatively few hands

during the greater part of the cold weather. They are thus free to emigrate, and know that good wages can be acquired during a temporary absence from their homes. Access to the labour centres is cheap and easy, there are no hardships to be undergone, and last and greatest of all, there is the knowledge that a few months of work will not only help to support their families at the slack time of the year, but also provide a reserve against hard times, and save them from reducing the standard of comfort or further subdividing their holdings. Briefly, as stated by the Collector of Saran—"The people having once acquired the habit of migrating for wages, and having found that it is easy to save money in this way, now emigrate annually as a matter of habit to supplement their incomes."

EAST BENGAL.

396. The third great movement of population is taking place in East Bengal, where there is a rush for land along the Brahmaputra to the north-east and in Hill Tippera to the south-east. The movement in the former area is determined by the abundance of *char* lands on the upper reaches of the Brahmaputra in the districts of Rangpur and Goalpara (in Assam). These cheap and fertile lands are attracting a growing number of cultivators from the lower reaches in the densely populated districts of Bogra, Pabna, Mymensingh and Dacca, where the riparian lands suffer from diluvion. Those who have lost their land by the ravages of the river, or whose holdings are reduced by subdivision to a size which means reduction in their standard of comfort, are shifting northwards to Rangpur and Goalpara, where there is abundance of land to be had on easy terms, and where the pressure on the soil does not lead to the same competition for it. Prior to 1901 the movement did not go further than Rangpur and had attained no great dimensions. Since 1901, the influx into that district has increased enormously, and the emigrants have overflowed across the provincial frontier into Goalpara. The number of immigrants from the four southern districts to Rangpur and Goalpara has risen from 35,000 to 123,000, the increase in Goalpara alone being 51,000.

In the south-east the current of migration is flowing into Hill Tippera, a sparsely peopled State which depends for development on immigrants, for the aboriginal population live chiefly by the nomadic practice of *huming* and wood-cutting. It is now being filled up by Musalmans from the adjoining district of Tippera on the east and from Sylhet on the west. The aggregate of immigrants from these two districts is 61,000, or over one-fourth of the State population, of which Tippera contributes seven-twelfths and Sylhet five-twelfths. The new-comers from the latter district promise to furnish a greater proportion of permanent colonists, for the sexes are fairly equally divided, whereas there are two males to every female among the immigrants from Tippera.

MIGRATION TO AND FROM FOREIGN COUNTRIES.

NEPAL.

397. The number of persons born in Nepal, who were resident outside its limits at the time of the census, is 168,291, of whom 106,727 are found in Bengal, 35,954 in Bihar and Orissa and 25,610 in Sikkim. The emigrants from Nepal to Bihar and Orissa diminish in number as one proceeds from west to east, practically all being found in Champaran (13,929), Muzaffarpur (7,408), Darbhanga (8,542), Bhagalpur (3,050) and Purnea (2,709). There are two females to every one among them, a proportion which shows that the migration is casual and due to matrimonial arrangements. The Nepalese have few inducements to settle among an alien people in the closely cultivated and populous districts of North Bihar, but are colonizing the hilly tracts of Sikkim and Darjeeling, where they find a climate like that of their own country and men of their own race and language. In Sikkim the immigrants from Nepal account for over one-fourth of the population; in Darjeeling they number 70,000, or three-tenths of the population. They are attracted to the latter district not only by the prospects of agriculture, but also by the demand for labour on the tea gardens; about one-third of the total number are actual workers in tea gardens. The proportion is even higher in Jalpaiguri, where over a half of the aggregate number (34,000) are tea garden employés.

Between 1891 and 1901 the number of Nepalese immigrants decreased slightly, but since 1901 it has risen by 7,000. This increase is due almost

entirely to the greater influx into Sikkim and Jalpaiguri: in the latter district the immigrant population is nearly twice as numerous as it was ten years ago. Immigration into the border districts of Bihar and Orissa has waned, and there has been a further decline in Darjeeling, where the original settlers are dying off: though immigration still continues, the number of new comers is not great enough to fill their places. Its continuance is due to the pressure of the population on the soil in Eastern Nepal and the impoverishment of the soil there. "There is apparently in that country no forest reserved by Government. The land is in consequence over-cultivated, cattle are scarce, and the soil is insufficiently manured. In some parts fuel is very difficult to procure, and dung being burnt as fuel lessens still further the supply of manure available for the fields."*

BHUTAN AND TIBET.

398. There is but little immigration from Bhutan, a country with undeveloped resources which, so far from having any surplus population, calls for colonists. There has been no appreciable increase in the number of immigrants from that country who still number under 2,000. As no census has been conducted in Bhutan, statistics of migration from British districts and States are not available, but it is believed that it attracts a steadily growing number of colonists from the west. It is known that a certain number of Lepchas and others from Darjeeling have moved across the frontier. "Abundant forests, untrammelled by restrictions, enable them to follow their wasteful, though ancient, system of *jhuming*. Any such as the grip of the money-lender presses beyond endurance can emigrate to Bhutan, which is the El Dorado of the Eastern Himalayas, now that the milder form of Government lately introduced by the Bhutanese Chiefs has induced thousands of Nepali cultivators to clear the vast and fertile jungles of that country."† Immigration from Tibet is even smaller in volume, the aggregate of immigrants being only a little over 1,500, nearly all of whom were enumerated in Darjeeling. Small as the number is, it is considerably larger than in 1901, partly in consequence of the freer intercourse with Tibet which followed the Tibet Mission and partly because the Dalai Lama was staying in Darjeeling at the time of the census.

AFGHANISTAN AND CHINA.

399. The number of emigrants from Afghanistan, who are mostly itinerant hawkers, has fallen from 4,363 to 3,367, of whom 2,710 are found in Bengal and 657 in Bihar and Orissa. Nearly one-third of the total number were enumerated in Calcutta and the adjoining districts of Howrah and the 24-Parganas. There has been an increase of 668 immigrants from China, which has brought up the aggregate to 3,107. Practically the whole of the increase has occurred in Calcutta, where all but 88 of the Chinese residents were born in China. Small settlements are also found in the 24-Parganas (211), Jalpaiguri (214) and Darjeeling (162). Few bring their wives with them, and the males outnumber the females by 8 to 1.

THE COLONIES.

400. The statistics compiled under the Colonial Emigration Act show that during the decade 11,667 persons were recruited for the colonies, of whom more than half came from Bihar, 3,473 being residents of Shahabad and 1,109 of Patna. Emigration to the colonies is not apparently growing in favour, there being a decrease of 5,000 compared with the previous decade. As is well known, a considerable number of the emigrants return home with their savings after a period of labour in the colonies: the proportion of returned emigrants to outgoing emigrants during the decade was approximately one to two. Statistics of emigration to different colonies will be found in Subsidiary Table II at the end of this chapter; the marginal table shows the Colonies in which more than 1,000 from either province were enumerated.

Colony.	Number.
Bengal.	
Mauritius ...	19,691
Straits Settlements ...	3,300
Federated Malay States ...	3,059
Fiji ...	2,641
Ceylon ...	1,561‡
Bihar and Orissa.	
Natal ...	15,026

* C. A. Bell, Kalimpong Settlement Report, page 8.

† C. A. Bell, Kalimpong Settlement Report, page 17.

‡ Includes 1,099 persons on vessels which put in at Colombo shortly after the census.

401. The marginal statement shows the number of persons born in the chief European countries and in Africa, America and Australasia. Nearly half of those who had their birth in Europe are temporary or permanent residents of Calcutta, 7,630 being enumerated there. No district contains more than 1,000, except the 24-Parganas (1,725), Darjeeling (1,570) and Patna (1,038). Their presence in the first district is due to industrial enterprise, in Darjeeling to the tea gardens and European schools as well as to its containing a military station, and in Patna to there being a European regiment in cantonments at Dinapore. Since 1901 the number of persons born in Europe and enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa has increased by 3,032, to which Calcutta contributes 929 in spite of a large reduction in the number of European sailors and firemen enumerated in vessels lying in the port. The greatest gain has been from England, the number born there rising by 3,148, while the increase of Scotchmen hailing from Scotland is, surprising to relate, only 465. A heavy decrease of 733 is recorded for those born in Ireland, which is, however, merely due to the fact that an Irish regiment was stationed in Calcutta in 1901, and that there was no such regiment in either Bengal or Bihar and Orissa at this census.

EUROPEAN AND OTHER COUNTRIES.

BORN IN—	ENUMERATED IN—	
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
Europe	13,503	2,801
United Kingdom ...	12,179	2,572
England and Wales ...	8,969	2,059
Scotland	2,393	314
Ireland	814	199
Germany	305	148
France	175	26
Africa	232	30
America	312	66
Australasia ...	306	40

402. Between 1891 and 1901 the number of emigrants to Assam from Bengal, Bihar and Orissa increased by 86,000. There has since been a further rise of 89,000, bringing the aggregate up to 593,000, or 42 per cent. more than in 1891. Of these, 194,000 persons were born in Bengal, which is a heavy loser by the interchange of population, for it receives only 67,000 immigrants from Assam. There are, as already explained, two inter-provincial movements in progress. Musalman cultivators are steadily moving from Dacca, Mymensingh and Pabna in quest of land along the fertile *char* lands in Goalpara, which also receives immigrants from the adjoining Bengal district of Rangpur. The number of the emigrants from these four districts is now 70,000, or 50,000 more than in 1901. The other movement is from Sylhet into the State of Hill Tippera; during the last decade the influx of these new settlers has developed considerably, and they now aggregate 26,000 or 10,000 more than in 1901. There is also an ebb and flow between Sylhet and the adjoining districts of Tippera and Mymensingh, from which Sylhet is the gainer by 12,000.

MIGRATION TO AND FROM OTHER PARTS OF INDIA.

ASSAM.

The exodus from Bengal is small in comparison with that from Bihar and Orissa, from which no less than 399,000 persons have gone to Assam. All parts of Bihar and Orissa contribute to this number, but the emigrants from the Chota Nagpur Plateau (281,000) far outnumber those from the remainder of the province. The emigrants are nearly all tea-garden coolies, for whom Chota Nagpur is the favourite recruiting ground. The drain has been greatest on Ranchi, which has sent out 92,000 emigrants. Hazaribagh has contributed 56,000, Manbhum 55,000 and Singhbhum 22,000. Outside the Chota Nagpur Plateau emigration to Assam is most active in Cuttack (27,000) and Saran (19,000).

403. Burma gains heavily from Bengal, the number of emigrants enumerated in it being 135,756, while Bengal receives only 2,600 from Burma. This is, however, not a real gain, for the emigration is merely periodic, labourers flocking southwards from Chittagong and other districts to cut the rice crops in Arakan and returning to their homes when the harvest is over. Altogether 64,000 persons born in Chittagong were present in Burma at the time of the census, and only 4,000 of them were females. Large as this number is, it is

BURMA.

15,000 less than in 1901, when emigration was stimulated by the scarcity and suffering caused by a cyclone and subsequent hard times. The Burma census returns furnish no information regarding the birth districts of other emigrants from Bengal.

404. Nearly half of the emigrants from Chittagong were found in the Akyab district, where, however, their number is 14,000 less than in 1901. The decrease is attributed by Mr. Morgan Webb, Superintendent of Census Operations in Burma, partly to the fact that the census was held later than in 1901, and partly to immigration being checked by the systematic assessment of the immigrants to a capitation-tax. "The later date on which the census was taken in 1911 (the 10th March, against the 1st March 1901) must have had a considerable effect in reducing the numbers recorded. The first half of March is the period when the immigrants are returning to their homes in large numbers after the completion of harvest operations. A postponement of the record by ten days in the busiest portion of the emigration season would cause a marked reduction in the number of immigrants to be entered. But this could not account for the whole of the large decrease." The principal cause of the greater portion of the decrease is in his opinion the stringent assessment of a capitation tax on agricultural labourers who find employment in Akyab. He concludes—"The migration is seasonal, and consequently the later date of the census of 1911, at a time when the immigrants were returning to their homes, resulted in a small record; it is fluctuating, so that marked changes in numbers were to be anticipated; it has been subjected in the past few years to a heavy taxation from which it had hitherto been largely exempt; its decline was foretold four years before the census was taken; and, finally, so far as the records of actual migration are available, they suggest that emigration is proceeding more rapidly than immigration. Apart entirely from a genuine decrease, it is probable that immigrants, fearing assessment to the tax, avoided being entered in the enumeration records."[*]

405. The number of emigrants to Burma from Bihar and Orissa is 8,392, of whom 5,389 were born in Shahabad. Their presence in Burma is due to their having been recruited for the development of two estates, which were granted to private capitalists in order to stimulate migration to sparsely populated areas. One of these is an estate of 27,506 acres at Kyauktaga in the Pegu district which was leased to Mr. Mylne of the Bihia Estate in Shahabad; the other is a grant of 15,000 acres at Zeyawaddy in the Toungoo district made in 1894 to Rai Bahadur Jai Prakash Lal, C.I.E. On the Kyauktaga grant most of the settlers are agriculturists from the United Provinces, but on the Zeyawaddy grant the majority are from Bihar, Shahabad district supplying 3,494 of the total (5,065). "In both grants the immigrants live in self-contained Hindu villages, influencing but little, and influenced but little by, the Burmese life surrounding them. They have maintained their caste system and rules with greater success than the majority of Hindu immigrants into Burma, who are necessarily brought more closely into contact with the disintegrating influence of Burmese life and opinion."

406. The movements between the Central Provinces and Bihar and Orissa mainly affect contiguous districts and States. Altogether 129,000 persons who were born in the latter province were present in the Central Provinces at the time of the census, of whom nearly 100,000 were emigrants from Sambalpur, while 13,000 were inhabitants of Ranchi and Palamau, who had moved across the frontier into the adjoining Tributary States. The balance of migration is heavily against Bihar and Orissa, for the immigrants from the Central Provinces number only 53,000, of whom 19,000 were enumerated in Sambalpur and 25,000 in the Orissa Feudatory States. Sambalpur, therefore, loses 81,000 by the exchange, while the Orissa States have a gain of 22,000: the even distribution of the sexes among the immigrants to the latter shows that they are permanent settlers. The migration between Bengal and the Central

CENTRAL PROVINCES.

[*] Burma Census Report, 1911, pp. 80-1.
[o] *id.*, p. 76.

Provinces calls for no special remarks. Bengal receives 21,000 persons, and its emigrants number only 6,000. The excess of immigrants is due simply to the demand for labour in a rich country with large manufactures.

MADRAS.

407. The volume of migration to and from Madras is comparatively small, and does not extend far beyond adjoining districts and States. It is decidedly in favour of Bihar and Orissa rather than of Madras, for the latter sends 35,508 persons to Bihar and Orissa and receives only 1,428 persons in exchange. Six-sevenths of the immigrants were enumerated in the Orissa States, Puri and Angul, which lie along the border line, and all but 10,000 of them were emigrants from Ganjam. The Orissa States gain most, there being an influx of 19,000 persons, attracted by the prospects of cultivation in a sparsely peopled territory, while less than 1,000 persons left for Madras. Bengal has a net gain of nearly 8,000 from Madras, the immigrants being generally temporary absentees from their homes. They number altogether 14,343, of whom 8,000 were enumerated in the 24-Parganas and Calcutta: in Titagarh alone there were over 3,000 mill-hands from Ganjam and Vizagapatam.

UNITED PROVINCES.

408. The interchange of population in Bihar and Orissa and the United Provinces is more even, there being a balance of only 19,000 in favour of the former province. The immigrants from the United Provinces number altogether 124,000, of whom nearly two-thirds were enumerated in districts contiguous to the districts in which they were born, viz., in Shahabad (28,035), Saran (24,503), Palamau (1,592) and Champaran (26,561). The current of immigration sets more strongly into North Bihar, which contains altogether 69,000 immigrants, while South Bihar has only 38,000. Only 17,000 immigrants are found outside Bihar. The aggregate of persons born in Bihar and Orissa, but enumerated in the United Provinces, is 105,000, of whom 94,000 hail from the four border districts already mentioned. There is but little emigration except from Bihar, the aggregate number of those born in other districts (excluding the border district of Palamau) being barely 1,000. The greatest gainer by the movements of the people across the boundary is Champaran, in which the immigrants exceeds the emigrants by 19,000. The heaviest loser is Saran, from which 53,000 persons have moved to the United Provinces, while only 24,500 have come from that province. Shahabad is scarcely affected by the movements of the people across the frontier line, immigration and emigration nearly counterbalancing one another. During the last decade the emigrants from this district have decreased by nearly 12,000, while the immigrants from the United Provinces are less numerous by 14,000. There has also been a notable change in the movements of the people to and from Saran. The number of those who have found a temporary or permanent home in Ballia has fallen by 5,000, but on the other hand there has been an increase of nearly 20,000 among those who have transferred themselves to Gorakhpur: the emigrants from Saran to this latter district now outnumber the immigrants by 24,000.

409. There is not much to attract an immigrant from the United Provinces in the cultivating districts of Bihar, where conditions are much the same as in his own home, and there is not the incentive of better wages awaiting the temporary labourer. The greater number of those in quest of lucrative employment therefore make their way to Bengal, where 406,000 of them were enumerated at this census; among these there were two males to every female. More than half of the total number were found in Calcutta and the industrial districts of Hooghly, Howrah and the 24-Parganas—the cities of Howrah, Calcutta and the Suburbs alone contain 155,000, or 16,000 more than are found in the whole of North and East Bengal. Bengal makes a very poor return to the United Provinces, sending only 26,000 of its inhabitants there, so that its net gain is 380,000. The Bengali emigrants belong to two main classes, viz., persons in clerical and other employment, and pilgrims to the sacred shrines. It is on this account that females, who generally predominate in pilgrimages, outnumber the males.

Immigrants enumerated in—	Number.
West Bengal	79,634
Central ,, ...	186,829
North ,, ...	63,034
East ,, ...	76,199
Total ...	405,696

410. Statistics of migration to and from each district will be found in Subsidiary Tables I, II and III at the end of this chapter. It is therefore not proposed to go into any detail in the account of migration between different parts of the two provinces, but to sketch briefly its main features.

MIGRATION WITHIN BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.

411. West Bengal, from the point of view of migration, comprises two very different tracts. In Burdwan, Hooghly and Howrah there are large organized industries which call for labour, and in each of them the immigrant population is large. The remaining districts are agricultural, and contain stretches of sterile soil, inhabited to a great extent by races of aboriginal descent. These supply much of the labour required by the richer cultivators of the alluvial flats, and by the mill and factories lining the banks of the Hooghly. Both in Midnapore and Bankura the emigrant population outnumbers the immigrant, but in Birbhum, which adjoins the Sonthal Parganas and receives part of its overflow, immigrants are in excess.

WEST BENGAL.

412. Burdwan owes its large immigrant population of 180,000 persons to its collieries, iron foundries and other manufactures. It draws mainly on the adjoining districts, and in particular on Bankura (45,000), the Sonthal Parganas (27,000) and Manbhum (12,000). The influx from the Sonthal Parganas is double as great as in 1901, but the number hailing from Manbhum has fallen greatly owing to the rapid development of the Jheria coal-field, which wants all the labour it can get. Altogether 82,000, or about one-half of the immigrants, come from Bihar and Orissa and non-contiguous parts of other provinces, and only 11,000 from non-contiguous districts of Bengal. Half the emigrants go to contiguous districts, their movement being of the usual casual character, which is determined mainly by marriage relations ; of the remainder one-third are found in Calcutta. Birbhum gains mainly from the adjoining districts, notably the Sonthal Parganas, the balance in its favour being nearly 17,000 : were it not for this, the emigrants would outnumber the immigrants.

413. The emigrants from Bankura are 3½ times as numerous as those from Birbhum, and constitute 15 per cent. of the total population. No district in Bengal sends out such a large number in proportion to its population, and only three districts in Bihar and Orissa (Ranchi, Sambalpur and the Sonthal Parganas). The exodus is however mainly periodic, and most of it is directed to the alluvial districts of West Bengal, for which the people have a distinctive name, viz., *namal*, *i.e.*, the lowlands. No less than 70,000, or two-fifths of the total number, are found in the adjoining districts of Burdwan and Manbhum, from which Bankura receives only 30,000 immigrants : the latter are mostly casual visitors, females being in excess by 16,000. Bankura is also a heavy loser to Hooghly to the extent of 48,000 persons. Emigration from Midnapore is growing in volume owing to the railway extensions, and the increase in the number of male emigrants since 1901 is the same as in Bankura, viz., 20,000. The current sets mainly into Hooghly, the 24-Parganas and Calcutta, which account for three-fifths of the total number. There is also a small overflow into Mayurbhanj, which gains 9,000 cultivators at the expense of Midnapore. The immigrants from outside Bengal outnumber those born in the province, there being 28,000 from Bihar and Orissa, 7,000 from the Central Provinces, 6,000 from the United Provinces and 3,000 from Madras.

414. Migration to and from Hooghly is very materially affected by its proximity to Calcutta, which draws largely on the district, and its own need of labour for agriculture as well as for industries. Its position is consequently somewhat unique, for next to Bankura and Midnapore it sends out a larger proportion of emigrants, and next to Howrah it receives a larger proportion of new-comers, than any other district in Bengal. It loses no less than 83,000 persons to Calcutta, Howrah and 24-Parganas, in which half its emigrants are found. It gains mainly from Bankura and from Bihar and Orissa. Bihar sends it 29,000, Orissa 8,000 and Chota Nagpur 13,000. The foreign-born population in Howrah now amounts to 190,000, or 4,000 more than in Hooghly. Like that district, it depends on outside sources for the labour required by its mills and factories, and it is noticeable that Bengal supplies it with less immigrants than outside provinces. No less than

109,000 persons come from outside Bengal, and the majority are Hindustanis, 39,000 coming from Bihar and 47,000 from the United Provinces: Orissa alone accounts for 14,000.

CENTRAL BENGAL.

415. The difference between conditions in Calcutta and 24-Parganas, with their important commercial and industrial interests, and those prevailing in the agricultural districts of Western Bengal is strikingly exemplified in the census returns. In Calcutta and the 24-Parganas immigrants largely outnumber emigrants, while the reverse is the case in Murshidabad, Jessore and Nadia. Extraordinary as it may appear, the outflow from the latter three districts to the industrial centres is comparatively small, in spite of their proximity: only one-tenth of those enumerated outside the districts in which they were born have found their way to Calcutta and the 24-Parganas.

416. Calcutta itself may be regarded as an epitome of India, for it draws on all parts of it for its heterogeneous population. The aggregate of persons born in Calcutta and resident there is barely three-tenths of the population; if we also exclude those born in the 24-Parganas, the number contributed by the whole of Bengal (194,000) constitutes only about one-fifth. The province of Bihar and Orissa sends 10,000 more than this latter number, mostly labourers and artisans from South Bihar (109,000), North Bihar (46,000) and Orissa (41,000). Even the division last named accounts for more than all the districts of Eastern Bengal. Altogether 90,000 come from the United Provinces, or double the number from Eastern Bengal and Assam, and 21,000 from Rajputana. As many of its inhabitants come from the Punjab (9,000) as from the Chittagong Division, and double as many from Europe (7,630) as from the Rajshahi Division. Of individual districts, next to the 24-Parganas, Calcutta receives most immigrants from Hooghly (48,000), Gaya (41,000), Patna (29,000) and Cuttack (27,000). A further account of the constitution of its immigrant population will be found in the last paragraph of this chapter.

417. The foreign-born population in the 24-Parganas has increased by no less than 176,000 during the last ten years, and now amounts to 402,000 or 16½ per cent. of the total population. As in the case of Calcutta, it is recruited from far afield, 84,000 coming from the United Provinces, 57,000 from South Bihar, 34,000 from Orissa and 14,000 from the Chota Nagpur Plateau. Eastern Bengal and Assam can claim only 9,000, while Madras accounts for 5,000 and the Central Provinces for 2,000. The great majority are engaged in industrial and manufacturing concerns, but the reclamation of the Sundarbans in the south attracts a number of cultivators and labourers not only from Midnapore but also from Chota Nagpur.

418. The movements of the people in the remaining districts of Central Bengal call for only a brief notice, as conditions are much the same as in 1901 and the figures show very little change. There is, however, one new feature, viz., that the opening of the railway from Katihar to Godagari has led to a small but noticeable northward movement from Murshidabad. The number of persons from that district enumerated in Malda has risen from 12,000 to 27,000, and the movement has not stopped there but has extended to Purnea. In 1901 the latter district contained under 1,000 persons born in Murshidabad, but the number is now 5,000.

NORTH BENGAL.

419. In all parts of North Bengal the last decade has witnessed a substantial increase in the number of immigrants, the increment ranging from 10,000 in Cooch Behar to 77,000 in Jalpaiguri, which is closely followed by Rangpur (69,000). Emigration has also developed with the extension of railway communications. The rise in the number of emigrants is shared in by all districts except Rangpur, where there is a slight falling off, but except in Bogra and Pabna it is not great. The most prominent features of migration in this part of the province are (1) the excess of immigrants over emigrants, the only exception being Pabna, where the emigrants outnumber the foreign-born population by 38,000, and (2) that immigrants from distant places are more numerous than those from contiguous localities in all but three districts, viz., Rajshahi, Pabna and Malda. Pabna is the only district from which there is any considerable emigration to non-contiguous districts, but the

distance covered by the emigrants is not great, for they merely move northwards to the Brahmaputra *chars* in Rangpur and Goalpara. Pabna has sent 24,000 emigrants to the former and 15,000 to the latter; and as the sexes are fairly well balanced, they seem to have left Pabna to set up new homes in those two northern districts. The districts which have the largest gains from distant places are Darjeeling, where 44½ per cent. of the population are foreign-born, and Jalpaiguri, where the ratio is 29 per cent.

420. The chief factors which cause the influx from distant places are briefly as follows. There are extensive cultivable wastes in the Barind, an elevated tract which comprises a considerable area on the confines of Dinajpur, Malda, Rajshahi and Bogra. These wastes are being steadily reclaimed, but the local labour supply is not sufficient, and is also not so expert in pioneer work as the Santals and other aboriginals from outside districts. The rich alluvial *chars* of the Brahmaputra in Rangpur and Goalpara attract Musalman cultivators from the more congested tracts along the lower reaches of the same river, where, moreover, the land is more subject to dilluvion. The districts affected by this movement are Pabna, in a major, and Bogra, in a minor, degree. Lastly, the tea industry in Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri is carried on almost wholly by foreign labour, and elsewhere the development of the jute and tobacco trade is increasing the demand for labour, which is not fully met from local sources.

421. There is a steady annual influx of labourers from Bihar and United Provinces, who find employment in different kinds of labour, *e.g.*, as domestic servants, police-constables, jail warders, railway servants field-labourers, leather-workers, *palki*-bearers, scavengers, etc. No less than 183,000 come from North Bihar and 63,000 from the United Provinces. The largest drafts of labourers, however, are obtained from the Chota Nagpur Plateau, and in particular the Sonthal Parganas and Ranchi. The former has sent over 160,000 of its people to the four districts containing the Barind, viz., Dinajpur (74,000), Malda (48,000), Rajshahi (14,000) and Bogra (4,000), and to the tea-garden districts of Jalpaiguri (20,000) and Darjeeling (4,000). Ranchi has sent 99,000 persons to Jalpaiguri and 7,000 to Darjeeling, where they find employment on the tea-gardens. Among these immigrants the sexes are fairly balanced, and the migration may therefore be regarded as semi-permanent. Many of the tea-garden coolies, it is true, leave the the tea-gardens yearly for their homes, but the majority settle down and go home for an occasional visit only. The population of Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri is also largely recruited from Nepal, those born in Nepal numbering 70,000 in the former and 34,000 in the latter. Jalpaiguri has further received 27,000 immigrants from Cooch Behar, giving in return only 9,000 emigrants: as the immigrants have an excess of males and the emigrants an excess of females, it may fairly be inferred that the gain of Jalpaiguri consists largely of temporary labourers.

EAST BENGAL.

422. In Hill Tippera and five of the nine districts included in East Bengal, viz., Khulna, Mymensingh, Faridpur, Backergunge and the Chittagong Hill Tracts, the foreign-born population exceeds the emigrant population, but except in Hill Tippera the excess is not large, varying only from 5,000 to 16,000: in Hill Tippera, where one-third of the population is foreign-born, the excess amounts to 80,000. In the division, as a whole, the immigrants from contiguous districts (86,000) are nine times as numerous as those from other parts of the province (9,000), but their aggregate is only about a third that returned for immigrants from Assam, Bihar and Orissa and the United Provinces (243,000). In Mymensingh and Chittagong only do the immigrants from distant places exceed those from contiguous places. Proportionately, the immigrants from neighbouring districts are most numerous in Khulna, which receives 34,000 persons from Backergunge and Jessore but gives them only 16,000. The causes of immigration are much the same as in North Bengal, viz., the insufficiency of the local labour force for handling the jute trade, and the comparative wealth and high standard of comfort of the people, which enables them to employ imported labour.

423. There are two main currents of immigration. The first is the great influx of labourers from Bihar and Orissa and the United Provinces, from which Dacca, Mymensingh and Faridpur have received 35,000, 75,000 and 12,000

immigrants respectively. These immigrants are chiefly Hindus, the number of Musalmans who come for employment, chiefly as coachmen, cart-drivers and railway servants, being very small. The Mundas, Oraons and Santals, who figure so largely among the immigrants into North Bengal, are rare in East Bengal, and the majority of the foreign-born are functional castes, such as Chamar, Muchi, Kurmi, Kahar, Nuniya, Kandu, Mallah and sweeper castes. There has been a considerable increase in the number of immigrants from Bihar and Orissa and the United Provinces, which is shared by almost all the districts, but is specially marked in Dacca and Mymensingh. In the former, immigration was stimulated to some extent by the city of Dacca being made the capital of Eastern Bengal and Assam, and by the amount of building work in progress while it held that position.

424. The second movement is the influx of cultivators into Hill Tippera from Tippera and Sylhet, the former having sent 35,000 persons and the latter nearly 26,000 persons to that State. Tippera has sent 5 females, and Sylhet 10 females, to every 12 males, from which it appears that the immigrants from the former include a much smaller proportion of permanent settlers than those from Sylhet. The number of persons enumerated in this State but born in Tippera has increased nearly three-fold since 1901, while the immigrants from Sylhet have grown by 10,000.

425. There are only four districts in which the outflow exceeds the influx, viz., Dacca, Tippera, Noakhali and Chittagong. Emigration is least active in the Chittagong Hill Tracts and Hill Tippera, where the aboriginal inhabitants have no incentive to leave their homes. The main currents of emigration, excluding the usual movements to adjacent places, are (1) from Dacca and Mymensingh to Rangpur and Goalpara and (2) from Chittagong to Burma. Dacca and Mymensingh have sent 19,599 males and 14,317 females to Rangpur, and 22,954 and 17,142 females to Goalpara, while Chittagong has sent 60,261 males and only 3,707 females to Burma. The sex proportions show that, while the emigrants to Rangpur and Goalpara include a large proportion of permanent settlers, there are very few among those enumerated in Burma. Nor is this to be wondered at, for the emigrants to Rangpur and Goalpara are cultivators who leave their homes in the riparian tracts along the Jamuna to settle in the fertile alluvial land on the upper reaches of the Brahmaputra, whereas the emigrants to Burma are merely labourers attracted by the high wages paid for harvesting crops in Burma. In Dacca, which has the highest density in East Bengal, the excess of emigration over immigration may be attributed partly to the increasing pressure on the soil and partly to its educated inhabitants not finding sufficient remunerative employment near their homes. No less than 63,000 find employment in distant parts of Bengal as clerks, lawyers, doctors, traders, boatmen, shop-keepers, etc. Altogether, 18,000, or nearly half the total number from the whole of East Bengal, were enumerated in Calcutta and its suburbs.

426. Emigration causes a heavy drain on all the districts of North Bihar, except Champaran and Purnea to the extreme north-west and east, respectively. These are two sparsely peopled districts, with large areas awaiting reclamation or further development, which attract immigrants from the neighbouring districts in search of land on easy terms. In addition to receiving 14,000 persons from Nepal, Champaran benefits largely by immigration from the surrounding districts of Muzaffarpur, Saran and Gorakhpur: the net gain is 14,000 from Muzaffarpur, 19,000 from Saran, 17,000 from Gorakhpur and 2,000 from other districts of the United Provinces. In Purnea the foreign-born population is proportionately twice as large as in Champaran, representing 10 per cent. of the total population. The immigrants come mainly from the east, and in particular from Bhagalpur, from which it receives 72,000, Darbhanga (25,000) and Monghyr (23,000). It also receives part of the overflow from the Sonthal Parganas and gains slightly from Malda, but loses by migration to the three Bengal districts of Darjeeling, Jalpaiguri and Dinajpur. In all the other districts of North Bihar immigration is growing in volume. Nowhere, however, is it so great as in Saran, the immigrants from which number no less than 284,000 or one-eighth of the population. In the

NORTH BIHAR.

remaining three districts the number varies from 168,000 in Bhagalpur and 176,000 in Darbhanga to 195,000 in Muzaffarpur, the percentages to the total population being 8, 6 and 7 respectively. More than two-fifths of the emigrants from Bhagalpur find their way to Purnea, and a large proportion of the remainder spread into North Bengal. This latter tract is also the favourite resort of sturdy labourers from the other districts, and contains more than half the emigrants from North Bihar who were enumerated in Bengal. An increasing number, however, are following the example of the Saran emigrants (who, as remarked in the last report, are more catholic in their choice of a temporary home), and find employment in the metropolitan districts. The most noticeable feature of the history of the last ten years is the extent to which temporary migration is increasing in favour, the rise in the number of emigrants varying from 44,000 in Bhagalpur to 65,000 in Darbhanga.

BORN IN—	ENUMERATED IN—				Total.
	Hooghly.	Howrah.	24-Parganas.	Calcutta.	
Saran	8,751	7,629	26,026	14,719	57,125
Muzaffarpur ...	3,512	3,765	9,344	17,359	33,980
Darbhanga ...	1,746	1,962	7,853	9,014	15,575
Total ...	**14,009**	**13,356**	**38,223**	**41,092**	**106,680**

427. Emigration to Calcutta and the metropolitan districts is even more popular in South Bihar, three-tenths of the absentees from Patna, Gaya and Shahabad being enumerated there. The stream of migration from Monghyr is setting steadily in the same direction, but though the number has been doubled since 1901, it is still only one-seventh of the total number of emigrants. The people of South Bihar also show greater readiness to make their homes in Assam than those of North Bihar. Altogether 36,000 emigrants from the latter division were enumerated in Assam, of whom 19,000 were born in Saran, but as there was only one female to every five males, the great majority were obviously only temporary absentees. The number of those who have gone from South Bihar to Assam is however 46,000, and there are two women to every three men, from which it is clear that a large proportion settle down in the country. Of this number, 15,000 were born in Shahabad, 13,000 in Monghyr, 13,000 in Gaya and 5,000 in Patna. Assam and the metropolitan districts thus account for a quarter of a million of the emigrants, and the remainder are found mainly in contiguous districts. The interchange of population with the United Provinces is practically even, but is of small account, except in the border district of Shahabad; the other three districts send only 6,000 to that province and receive 10,000. Gaya loses to Chota Nagpur on the south and in particular to the adjoining districts of Hazaribagh and Palamau, while Monghyr, which has relations mainly with North Bihar, gains slightly from Darbhanga on the west, but loses heavily to Bhagalpur, Purnea and the Sonthal Parganas on the east, its aggregate loss amounting to 58,000.

SOUTH BIHAR.

BORN IN—	ENUMERATED IN—				Total.
	Hooghly.	Howrah.	24-Parganas.	Calcutta.	
Patna	5,038	7,067	13,651	29,017	54,773
Gaya	3,862	5,036	12,387	41,221	62,506
Shahabad ...	3,102	8,935	21,012	20,865	53,914
Monghyr ...	2,191	3,785	10,139	18,283	34,398
Total ...	**14,193**	**24,823**	**57,189**	**109,386**	**205,591**

428. In Cuttack and Balasore there is a large excess of emigrants over immigrants, but in Puri the foreign-born population predominates slightly. The actual excess in the last district, however, amounts only to 7,920, and special inquiries show that the total of pilgrims in the district at the time of the census was 7,139, so that the district is really unaffected by the movements of the people. The pressure of hard times in Cuttack and Balasore has led to a large number of labourers and small cultivators leaving their homes for a time in order to obtain employment elsewhere, and so supplement the resources of their families. The number of emigrants from Cuttack is 173,000 and represents 8 per cent. of the population. In Balasore the actual number, though largely increased since 1901, has not reached the same figure, but proportionately is very little less. viz., 7 per cent. The people mainly go to distant

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places, more than half of the emigrants from Cuttack being found in Calcutta and its vicinity or in Assam, and over half of those from Balasore in the former locality. One-third of the emigrants from Cuttack were enumerated in Calcutta, Hooghly, Howrah and the 24-Parganas, their number having risen during the last ten years from 40,000 to 64,000. These, however, are merely temporary absentees, who return home after a period of labour in the mills and factories, or in domestic service or as gardeners or day-labourers. Those who go to the tea-gardens in Assam, however, take women with them, and settle down either as tea-garden coolies or as cultivators when their contracts have expired. No less than 27,000 of the people of Cuttack were enumerated in Assam. The inhabitants of Balasore have not shown the same readiness, or have not been considered so suitable, for recruitment for Assam, in which there were only 2,000 of them at the time of the census. They are flocking more and more to Calcutta and the metropolitan districts—the number employed there has more than doubled during the decennium, and now amounts to nearly 39,000. There is also an interchange of population with Midnapore, the balance of which is slightly against Balasore. Altogether 23,000 cultivators and others have left the district for the Orissa Feudatory States, more especially to Mayurbhanj, but only 9,000 have moved into Balasore from the Orissa States, so that the district sustains a loss of 14,000 on this account.

CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.

429. The volume of emigration from the districts of the Chota Nagpur Plateau is one of the most remarkable features of the census, the proportion of emigrants to the district population being under 10 per cent. only in Manbhum (7½) and Palamau (5½), while it varies from 10 to 17 per cent. in Angul (10·6), Hazaribagh (11), Singhbhum (15) and the Sonthal Parganas (17). The maximum is reached in Ranchi and Sambalpur, where it is 22 and 23 per cent. respectively. Emigration is proceeding along four main lines, viz. (1) to Assam, (2) to North Bengal, (3) to the Orissa Feudatory States and (4) to the Central Provinces, of which an account will be given later in the section dealing with the different districts. From the marginal statement it will be seen that in some districts the tide of emigration to Assam is ebbing, but that the exodus from Singhbhum and the Sonthal Parganas has increased in volume. The small increase in the case of Palamau is probably more apparent than real, owing to the fact that in 1901 many of the emigrants returned their district of birth as Lohardaga, the old name for Ranchi, of which it was a subdivision till 1891, and so were grouped with those born in Ranchi.

DISTRICT.	1911.	1901.
Ranchi	91,000	92,000
Hazaribagh	56,000	69,000
Manbhum	55,000	70,000
Sonthal Parganas ...	35,000	31,000
Singhbhum	22,000	13,000
Palamau	5,000	7,000

MANBHUM.

430. Large as is the number of emigrants from Manbhum, it is exceeded by the number who have been attracted from other districts by the good wages obtainable in the coal-fields. In 1901 emigrants outnumbered immigrants by 74,000, but the immigrants are now in excess by over 27,000. During the last 10 years the emigrants have decreased by 21,000, the total now returned being 115,500. The immigrants, on the other hand, have had an addition of 81,000, or over 100 per cent., bringing up their total to nearly 143,000. Of these, 57,000 come from Bengal, nearly 26,000 being born in the adjoining district of Bankura, the immigrants from which have doubled their numbers since 1901. There are 30,000 immigrants from Bihar, and nearly all the remainder come from Chota Nagpur, chiefly from the adjoining district of Hazaribagh. The checking of emigration, which is due to the local demand for labour, is responsible for the falling off of emigration to Assam by 15,000 and for the decrease of 19,000 in the number of natives of Manbhum who were enumerated in Burdwan. Ten years ago the Raniganj coal-field drew a large number of labourers from Manbhum, but now that the Jheria field has been developed, there is no need for the coal-cutters to move far from their homes.

ORISSA FEUDATORY STATES.

431. In the Orissa Feudatory States the immigrants outnumber those enumerated outside the States in which they were born by no less than 224,000, and the absence of

any great disparity between the sexes show that the great majority of the new-comers have left their homes for good. There has been a great gain at the expense of all adjoining British districts, the balance in favour of the Orissa States being as shown in the margin. The largest gain is registered by Gangpur on the north-west, in which there are 39,000 immigrants from Ranchi and nearly 12,000 from Sambalpur. Patna and Bamra also gain at the expense of Sambalpur, which has sent 21,000 persons to the former and 11,000 to the latter. On the south-east Mayurbhanj gains both from Singhbhum and Balasore, 26,000 emigrants from the former and 12,000 from the latter being enumerated in it. The adjoining State of Keonjhar receives 15,000 persons from Singhbhum, nearly 4,000 from Cuttack and 2,000 from Balasore. The number of emigrants from the Orissa States aggregates only 75,000, of whom 61,000 were enumerated in the adjoining British districts shown in the marginal statement above. There is but little emigration to distant places, but 6,000 persons were enumerated in Assam, of whom 4,435 were natives of Kalahandi and 993 of Gangpur.

District.	Net gain.
Ranchi	43,121
Singhbhum	34,635
Sambalpur	39,797
Angul	7,922
Cuttack	19,520
Puri...	5,186
Balasore	13,708
Ganjam	12,067
Vizagapatam	5,327

SONTHAL PARGANAS.

432. "The Santals," wrote Mr. Gait in 1901, "are spreading east and north, and the full effect of the movement is not exhausted in the districts that adjoin the Sonthal Parganas, but makes itself felt even further away, in those parts of Dinajpur, Rajshahi and Bogra which share with Malda the elevated tract of *quasi*-laterite known as the Barind. These wanderings of the Santals have hitherto been confined to a laterite soil, and they are said to be averse to the payment of rent. In what direction they will spread when they have finished their work of reclamation in the Barind it is impossible yet to conjecture. The future alone can show whether they will then accept the inevitable and settle down as permanent rent-paying cultivators, or move further afield, overcoming their dislike to alluvial soil, or retrace their steps and rove once more in the infertile uplands of the Chota Nagpur Plateau." The outward movement has been still further accelerated during the last ten years, but it is noticeable that the Santals are now spreading southwards, as well as to the north and east, and that they are beginning to make their homes in purely alluvial tracts. In Purnea, for example, there has been an increase of nearly 15,000, while 2,000 are now found in Hooghly and over 5,000 in Rangpur. The districts of the Barind contain 140,000, and the tea-garden districts of Jalpaiguri and Darjeeling 23,000. Over 42,000 have found their way to other northern districts, while more than 72,000 are found to the south-east in four districts of the Burdwan Division. The marginal statement shows the actual number enumerated in the districts included in each of these groups and the increase since 1901. There is but little emigration to the east, the districts of Manbhum, Hazaribagh and Monghyr containing only 8,000 persons born in the Sonthal Parganas.

District.	Number.	Increase since 1901.
Dinajpur	74,381	25,791
Malda	48,402	5,827
Rajshahi	13,667	7,186
Bogra	3,545	1,645
Total ...	***139,995***	***40,448***
Jalpaiguri	19,609	9,077
Darjeeling	3,641	680
Total ...	***23,250***	***9,757***
Purnea	20,453	14,820
Rangpur	5,371	1,528
Bhagalpur	16,699	6,960
Total ...	***42,523***	***23,308***
Burdwan	27,378	13,553
Birbhum	28,282	2,230
Murshidabad ...	14,933	3,362
Hooghly	2,000	1,251
Total ...	***72,593***	***20,396***

OTHER DISTRICTS OF THE CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.

433. The movements of the people in Sambalpur are unique in character, so far as the province of Bihar and Orissa is concerned, for there is a large outflow to the Central Provinces. Out of the 174,000 emigrants, nearly 100,000 are found in the Central Provinces, 18,000 being enumerated in Raipur. In return, however, Sambalpur receives only 19,000 from the Central Provinces, the balance against it being thus 81,000. There is also a heavy drain owing to the movements of cultivators and labourers to the Orissa

States, which receive 56,000, but return only 16,000 to Sambalpur. Of the emigrants from Ranchi, 199,000 are found in the tea gardens of Assam and Jalpaiguri ; the number in the latter district has risen by 19,000 since 1901. Of the remaining emigrants, 39,000 have, as already stated, crossed the border to the sparsely populated State of Gangpur, while 5,000 were enumerated in the Central Provinces States. The volume of migration to and from Palamau is small. It loses to the Central Provinces States, especially Jashpur, and also to Mirzapur in the United Provinces, the aggregate loss being 7,000. It gains exactly the same number, however, from Gaya. The interchange of population is even smaller in the case of Angul, which loses to the Orissa States, and more especially to Athmallik : all but 2,000 of its emigrants were enumerated in the Feudatory States. The last of the districts to be mentioned is Singhbhum, in which emigration has been stimulated by the opening of the railway. There has been an increase of 42,000 immigrants, 9,000 of which is accounted for by the rise in the number of coolies enumerated in Assam. That province contains one-fifth of the emigrants, while nearly two-fifths have made their way into the adjoining States of Mayurbhanj and Keonjhar.

CONSTITUTION OF THE IMMIGRANT POPULATION OF CALCUTTA.

434. Special statistics which were compiled for the most numerous castes among the immigrants to Calcutta throw an interesting light on the character of its foreign-born population. Their aggregate number is 290,000, and of the 24 districts from which they are drawn, nine are in Bengal, nine in Bihar and Orissa, four in United Provinces and two in Rajputana. The area covered is large, and the figures may be taken as typical of the immigrant population. There are only two females to every five males : two-thirds of the latter are actual workers, but only one-fourth of the females are actually engaged in any occupation. Prostitutes alone account for one-fourth of the female workers, and their number is equal to one-seventh of the female immigrants of adult age. Altogether 15 per cent. of both sexes are under 15 years of age. Half the women and two-thirds of the men are adults, *i.e.*, aged 15 to 40 : at this age period there are three males to every female. Trade engages the energies of 19 per cent. of the male workers, while 14 per cent. are employed in domestic service, 13 per cent. are day-labourers and 7 per cent. are clerks. Domestic service accounts for the largest proportion of female workers, viz., 42 per cent., and then come prostitutes with 25 per cent. Brahmans represent nearly one-fifth of the total number of immigrants, and the Kayasths are the next largest caste, representing about one-seventh. The aggregate of the three trading castes of Agarwala, Mahesri and Subarnabanik is equal to only 5 per cent., and is exceeded by that returned for four of the lower castes, viz., Chamar, Chasi Kaibartta, Goala and Kahar. The returns for the Brahmans show to what an extent the absence of home surroundings loosens the ties of orthodoxy and tradition, for of the male workers one-fifth are traders and one-seventh are clerks—there are nearly as many Brahman clerks as there are Kayasths. Four per cent. of the priestly class are day-labourers or coolies, and only 9 per cent. returned priesthood as their occupation or means of livelihood.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—IMMIGRATION (ACTUAL FIGURES).

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION WHERE ENUMERATED.	BORN IN (000's OMITTED).																	
	District (or Natural Division).			Contiguous districts in Province.			Other parts of Province.			Contiguous parts of other Province, etc.			Non-contiguous parts of other Province, etc.			Outside India.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
BENGAL	***44,335***	***22,425***	***21,910***	...	...	...	...	...	...	***381***	***195***	***186***	***1,458***	***1,104***	***354***	***131***	***79***	***52***
WEST BENGAL	***8,026***	***3,989***	***4,037***	***73***	***33***	***40***	***11***	***7***	***4***	***110***	***54***	***56***	***246***	***178***	***68***	***3***	***2***	***1***
Burdwan	1,359	678	681	86	37	49	11	6	5	39	20	19	43	29	14	·6	·5	·1
Birbhum	871	435	436	26	10	16	3	2	1	28	12	16	7	5	2	·11	·1	·01
Bankura	1,092	549	543	31	7	24	1·2	·6	·6	12	4	8	2·7	1·9	·8	·07	·06	·01
Midnapore	2,746	1,370	1,376	23	10	13	4	2	2	17	7	10	31	21	10	·3	·2	·1
Hooghly	904	448	456	109	50	59	8	4	4	...	...	...	69	55	16	·33	·26	·07
Howrah	753	373	380	70	39	31	10	7	3	...	...	...	109	79	30	1	·8	·2
CENTRAL BENGAL ...	***7,072***	***3,580***	***3,492***	***293***	***170***	***123***	***59***	***44***	***15***	***17***	***9***	***8***	***621***	***490***	***131***	***16***	***13***	***3***
24-Parganas	2,032	1,030	1,002	138	78	60	19	12	7	...	...	...	242	183	59	2·4	2	·4
Calcutta	257	137	120	104	58	46	179	125	54	...	...	...	344	278	66	13	10	3
Nadia	1,545	775	770	49	20	29	6	3	3	...	...	...	17	14	3	·2	·1	·1
Murshidabad	1,296	639	657	41	17	24	5	3	2	15	8	7	14	11	3	·16	·14	·02
Jessore	1,698	871	827	50	23	27	4	2	2	...	...	...	6	5	1	·075	·07	·005
NORTH BENGAL ...	***9,805***	***4,985***	***4,820***	***160***	***95***	***65***	***21***	***15***	***6***	***202***	***106***	***96***	***431***	***309***	***122***	***112***	***64***	***48***
Rajshahi	1,385	698	687	50	27	23	10	7	3	...	...	...	35	23	12	·14	·13	·01
Dinajpur	1,490	770	720	35	19	16	18	12	6	7	3	4	136	85	51	·2	·18	·02
Jalpaiguri	637	337	300	33	18	15	25	15	10	3	2	1	168	96	72	36	22	14
Darjeeling	148	75	73	3	2	1	3	2	1	10	5	5	27	18	9	74	40	34
Rangpur	2,207	1,129	1,078	49	26	23	40	24	16	1	·5	·5	88	75	13	·5	·4	·1
Bogra	921	465	456	28	13	15	7	5	2	...	...	...	27	19	8	·2	·1	·1
Pabna	1,364	679	685	34	19	15	5	4	1	...	...	...	25	21	4	·16	·12	·04
Malda	885	434	451	35	17	18	4	3	1	55	28	27	24	16	8	·05	·04	·01
Cooch Behar	538	280	258	24	11	13	7	5	2	2	1	1	21	19	2	·58	·54	·04
EAST BENGAL	***18,719***	***9,458***	***9,261***	***86***	***44***	***42***	***9***	***5***	***4***	***52***	***27***	***25***	***160***	***127***	***33***	***1·7***	***1·3***	***·4***
Khulna	1,312	679	633	47	25	22	3	2	1	...	...	...	4	3	1	·1	·1	·003
Dacca	2,846	1,403	1,443	64	33	31	10	8	2	...	...	...	39	33	6	·6	·5	·1
Mymensingh	4,365	2,228	2,137	64	39	25	7	6	1	12	6	6	77	60	17	·2	·16	·04
Faridpur	2,025	1,018	1,007	79	43	36	5	3	2	...	...	...	12	10	2	·11	·09	·02
Backergunge	2,388	1,198	1,170	39	28	11	16	14	2	...	...	...	5	4	1	·1	·08	·02
Tippera	2,389	1,204	1,185	40	25	15	3	2	1	8	4	4	10	8	2	·09	·07	·02
Noakhali	1,279	633	646	12	6	6	10	6	4	...	...	...	·7	·6	·1	·028	·026	·002
Chittagong	1,489	710	779	5	3	2	6	4	2	·8	·4	·4	7	5	2	·3	·2	·1
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	148	78	70	4	3	1	1	·6	·4	·5	·3	·2	·3	·2	·1	·05	·03	·02
Hill Tippera	148	71	77	45	31	14	2	1	1	26	14	12	7	4	3	·12	·09	·03

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—IMMIGRATION (ACTUAL FIGURES).

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION WHERE ENUMERATED.	BORN IN (,000's OMITTED).																	
	District (or Natural Division).			Contiguous districts in Province.			Other parts of Province.			Contiguous parts of other Province, etc.			Non-contiguous parts of other Province, etc.			Outside India.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**37,986**	**18,585**	**19,401**	...	...	...	...	...	...	**257**	**118**	**139**	**152**	**97**	**55**	**40**	**15**	**25**
NORTH BIHAR	**13,792**	**6,713**	**7,079**	**162**	**72**	**90**	**7**	**4**	**3**	**68**	**29**	**39**	**37**	**23**	**14**	**36**	**12**	**24**
Saran	**2,243**	*1,052*	*1,191*	**20**	*4*	**16**	1·3	·6	·7	**23**	6	17	3	2	1	·16	·1	·06
Champaran	**1,813**	900	913	**51**	**21**	**30**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**24**	**12**	**12**	**4**	**3**	**1**	**14**	**5**	**9**
Muzaffarpur	**2,772**	1,336	1,436	**59**	**18**	**41**	**2**	**1**	**1**	...	...	...	**4**	**3**	**1**	**8**	**2**	**6**
Darbhanga	**2,843**	1,386	1,457	**68**	**18**	**50**	**6**	**4**	**2**	...	...	...	**4**	**2**	**2**	**8**	**2**	**6**
Bhagalpur	**2,003**	992	1,011	**100**	**42**	**58**	**20**	**14**	**6**	...	...	...	**13**	**8**	**5**	**3**	**1**	**2**
Purnea	**1,791**	899	892	**92**	**49**	**43**	**74**	**50**	**24**	**13**	**6**	**7**	**16**	**10**	**6**	**3**	**2**	**1**
SOUTH BIHAR	**7,609**	**3,753**	**3,856**	**104**	**41**	**63**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**30**	**10**	**20**	**21**	**13**	**8**	**1·7**	**1·4**	**·3**
Patna	**1,517**	771	746	**81**	**31**	**50**	·9	·5	·4	...	...	...	**9**	**6**	**3**	**1·1**	**1**	**·1**
Gaya	**2,098**	1,039	1,059	**55**	**18**	**37**	**2**	**1·4**	**·6**	...	...	...	**5**	**3**	**2**	**·12**	**·09**	**·03**
Shahabad	**1,605**	886	919	**28**	**7**	**21**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**26**	**7**	**19**	**4**	**3**	**1**	**·1**	**·06**	**·04**
Monghyr	**2,040**	1,007	1,038	**79**	**37**	**52**	**6**	**4**	**2**	...	...	...	**7**	**5**	**2**	**·3**	**·2**	**·1**
ORISSA	**4,128**	**1,988**	**2,140**	**26**	**7**	**19**	**2**	**1·4**	**·6**	**7**	**3**	**4**	**25**	**13**	**12**	**·2**	**·1**	**·1**
Cuttack	**2,076**	991	1,085	**26**	**6**	**20**	·7	·5	·2	...	...	...	**7**	**4**	**3**	**·07**	**·04**	**·03**
Balasore	**1,023**	492	531	**21**	**7**	**14**	·7	·5	·2	**8**	**3**	**5**	**2·4**	**1·7**	**·7**	**·06**	**·04**	**·02**
Puri	**980**	489	491	**27**	**9**	**18**	**1·2**	·8	·4	**5**	**2**	**3**	**10**	**6**	**4**	**·07**	**·04**	**·03**
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU.	**11,942**	**5,901**	**6,041**	**190**	**89**	**101**	**21**	**14**	**7**	**153**	**77**	**76**	**70**	**48**	**22**	**1·1**	**·7**	**·4**
Hazaribagh	**1,247**	608	639	**34**	**16**	**18**	**3**	**2**	**1**	...	...	...	**4**	**3**	**1**	**·12**	**·08**	**·03**
Ranchi	**1,354**	660	694	**19**	**8**	**11**	**9**	**6**	**3**	**·9**	**·5**	**·4**	**4**	**2**	**2**	**·2**	**·1**	**·1**
Palamau	**661**	328	333	**21**	**11**	**10**	·7	·4	·3	**3**	**2**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**·05**	**·04**	**·01**
Manbhum	**1,405**	706	699	**45**	**19**	**26**	**36**	**20**	**16**	**23**	**9**	**14**	**38**	**34**	**4**	**·2**	**·1**	**·1**
Singhbhum	**644**	320	324	**26**	**9**	**17**	**9**	**5**	**4**	**6**	**2**	**4**	**9**	**5**	**4**	**·2**	**·1**	**·1**
Southal Parganas ...	**1,776**	885	891	**50**	**30**	**20**	**14**	**9**	**5**	**29**	**11**	**18**	**13**	**8**	**5**	**·13**	**·8**	**·5**
Angul	**181**	90	91	**11**	**4**	**7**	**1·8**	**1·5**	**·3**	**5**	**2**	**3**	·2	·1	·1	**·004**	**·004**	...
Sambalpur	**701**	346	355	**16**	**6**	**10**	**3**	**2**	**1**	**14**	**6**	**8**	**10**	**5**	**5**	**·05**	**·04**	**·01**
Orissa Feudatory States ...	**3,497**	1,740	1,757	**229**	**106**	**123**	**10**	**5**	**5**	**47**	**23**	**24**	**13**	**8**	**5**	**·13**	**·1**	**·03**
Chota Nagpur States ...	**130**	64	66	**18**	**8**	**10**	·6	·4	·2	...	...	...	·3	·2	·1	...	...	...
SIKKIM	**58**	**29**	**29**	...	...	...	...	...	...	**3**	**2**	**1**	**·8**	**·7**	**·1**	**26**	**14**	**12**

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—EMIGRATION (ACTUAL FIGURES).

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION OF BIRTH.	ENUMERATED IN (000'S OMITTED).																	
	DISTRICT OR NATURAL DIVISION.			CONTIGUOUS DISTRICTS IN PROVINCE.			OTHER PARTS OF PROVINCE.			CONTIGUOUS PARTS OF OTHER PROVINCE, ETC.			NON-CONTIGUOUS PARTS OF OTHER PROVINCE, ETC.			OUTSIDE INDIA.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
BENGAL	***44 335***	***22,425***	***21,910***	...	...	...	...	...	...	***314***	***186***	***128***	***239***	***169***	***70***	***31***	***23***	***8***
WEST BENGAL	***8,026***	***4,989***	***4,037***	***232***	***141***	***91***	***12***	***7***	***5***	***83***	***43***	***40***	***88***	***54***	***34***	·01	·01	...
Burdwan	1,359	678	681	62	20	42	35	21	14	7	3	4	22	14	8	·003	·003	...
Birbhum	871	435	436	26	11	15	7	4	3	12	4	8	5	3	2	...	...	...
Bankura	1,092	549	543	104	50	54	15	9	6	26	18	8	30	19	11	...	...	...
Midnapore	2,746	1,370	1,376	89	49	40	37	23	14	29	12	17	16	8	8	...	...	...
Hooghly	904	448	456	84	43	41	51	35	16	...	...	...	14	10	4	·002	·001	...
Howrah	753	373	380	30	17	13	2	1	1	...	...	...	8	5	3	·005	·005	...
CENTRAL BENGAL ...	***7,072***	***3,580***	***3,492***	***194***	***95***	***99***	***35***	***22***	***13***	***9***	***4***	***5***	***60***	***36***	***24***	·5	·5	·003
24-Parganas	2,032	1,030	1,002	122	62	60	5	3	2	...	...	...	12	7	5	·004	·004	...
Calcutta	257	137	120	48	25	23	10	5	5	...	...	...	30	18	12	·5	·4	·002
Nadia	1,545	775	770	93	47	46	36	23	13	...	...	...	6	4	2	...	...	...
Murshidabad	1,296	639	657	74	34	40	16	10	6	8	3	5	9	5	4	...	...	...
Jessore	1,698	871	827	51	23	28	18	13	5	...	...	...	4	3	1	...	...	...
NORTH BENGAL	***9,805***	***4,985***	***4,820***	***46***	***25***	***21***	***7***	***5***	***2***	***60***	***31***	***29***	***17***	***12***	***5***	...	...	...
Rajshahi	1,385	698	687	33	16	17	3	2	1	...	...	...	3	2	1	...	...	...
Dinajpore	1,490	770	720	16	7	9	2	1	1	3	1	2	3	2	1	...	...	...
Jalpaiguri	637	337	300	17	7	10	·4	·3	·1	2	1	1	1·2	·8	·4	...	...	...
Darjeeling	148	75	73	3	1	2	1	·6	·4	3	2	1	3	2	1	...	...	...
Rangpur	2,207	1,129	1,078	42	21	21	2	1	1	16	9	7	1·8	1·3	·5	...	...	...
Bogra	921	465	456	22	11	11	·8	·5	·3	...	...	...	2	1	1	...	...	...
Pabna	1,364	679	685	52	29	23	32	19	13	...	...	...	18	11	7	...	...	...
Malda	885	434	451	21	11	10	2	1	1	16	8	8	2	1	1	...	...	...
Cooch Behar	538	280	258	32	17	15	·6	·3	·3	1·5	·8	·7	2	1	1	...	...	...
EAST BENGAL	***18,719***	***9,458***	***9,261***	***112***	***62***	***50***	***68***	***53***	***15***	***79****	***56****	***23****	***120***	***93***	***27***	·5	·5	...
Khulna	1,312	679	633	33	15	18	5	3	2	...	...	...	1·3	1	·3	...	...	...
Dacca	2,846	1,403	1,443	57	25	32	63	49	14	...	...	...	27	20	7	·1	·1	...
Mymensingh	4,365	2,228	2,137	86	44	42	10	8	2	21	11	10	40	23	17	·002	·002	...
Faridpur	2,025	1,018	1,007	56	34	22	21	16	5	...	...	...	5	3	2	·01	·01	...
Backergunge	2,368	1,198	1,170	29	17	12	12	9	3	...	...	...	3	2	1	·003	·003	...
Tippera	2,369	1,204	1,165	73	45	28	5	4	1	13	6	7	5	4	1	·01	·01	...
Noakhali	1,279	632	646	37	25	12	8	7	1	...	...	...	3·3	3·1	·2	2	2	...
Chittagong	1,459	710	779	13	9	4	9	8	1	31	28	3	47	46	1	·1	·1	...
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	148	78	70	·4	·2	·2	·02	·01	·01	·8[c]	·4[c]	·4[c]	·001	·001	...	...	...	...
Hill Tippera	148	71	77	1	·5	·5	·012	·007	·005	·2	·1	·1	·18	·12	·06	...	...	...

* The figures for contiguous districts of Burma are not available. The figures for Bengal in columns 14-16 include 41,395 emigrants (30,824 males and 10,571 females) who did not state the district in which they were born. These in columns 17-19 include 30,024 persons (21,820 males and 8,204 females) enumerated outside India (as noted below) who were returned as born in Bengal, but whose district of birth was not returned. All of these are, therefore, left out of account in the figures for individual districts.

	Total.	Male.	Female.
1. Anglo-Egyptian Soudan	1	1	...
2. Basutoland	4	4	...
3. Cape of Good Hope	6	6	...
4. Ceylon	562	407	155
5. Federated Malay States	3,059	2,784	275
6. Fiji	2,641	1,801	840
7. Hongkong	22	21	1
8. Johore	212	208	4
9. Malta	3	3	...
10. Mauritius	19,691	13,255	6,436
11. Natal	442	287	155
12. Northern Rhodesia	4	4	...
13. Southern ,, ...	24	23	1
14. Scotland	20	20	...
15. Seychelles	11	7	4
16. Straits Settlements	3,300	2,971	329
17. Transvaal	14	12	2
18. Uganda	8	6	2

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—EMIGRATION (ACTUAL FIGURES).

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISIONS OF BIRTH.	ENUMERATED IN (000's OMITTED)—																	
	DISTRICT OR NATURAL DIVISION.			CONTIGUOUS DISTRICTS IN PROVINCE.			OTHER PARTS OF PROVIN E.			CONTIGUOUS PARTS OF OTHER PROVINCE, ETC.			NON-CONTIGUOUS PARTS OF OTHER PROVINCE, ETC.			OUTSIDE INDIA.		
	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.	Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
BIHAR AND ORISSA ...	*37,986*	*18,585*	*19,401*	...	...	...	...	...	...	*709*	*375*	*334*	*1,191*	*845*	*346*	*16*	*11*	*5*
NORTH BIHAR	*13,792*	*6,713*	*7,079*	*116*	*47*	*69*	*12*	*9*	*3*	*152*	*89*	*63*	*302*	*261*	*41*	*·02*	*·02*	...
Saran	2,243	1,052	1,191	44	24	20	18	14	4	50	15	35	171	150	21	·02	·02	...
Champaran	1,813	900	913	17	5	12	3	2	1	7	3	4	20	19	1	...	...	...
Muzaffarpur	2,772	1,336	1,436	88	23	65	22	16	6	...	...	...	85	74	11	·002	·002	...
Darbhanga	2,843	1,386	1,457	92	33	59	32	28	3	...	...	...	52	47	5	·001	·001	...
Bhagalpore	2,003	992	1,011	126	57	69	2	1	1	...	...	...	39	26	13	·001	·001	...
Purnea	1,791	899	892	8	4	4	1·7	1·1	·6	25	13	12	4	3	1	...	...	...
SOUTH BIHAR	*7,609*	*3,753*	*3,856*	*156*	*70*	*86*	*77*	*41*	*36*	*28*	*5*	*23*	*384*	*276*	*108*	*·02*	*·02*	...
Patna	1,517	771	746	63	20	43	17	10	7	...	...	...	94	65	29	·01	·01	...
Gaya	2,098	1,039	1,059	75	29	46	31	15	16	...	...	...	99	73	26	·007	·007	...
Shahabad	1,805	886	919	24	10	14	25	16	9	26	4	22	100	70	30	·003	·003	...
Monghyr	2,040	1,007	1,033	113	42	71	32	18	14	...	...	...	94	70	24	...	...	...
ORISSA	*4,128*	*1,986*	*2,140*	*64*	*27*	*37*	*8*	*6*	*2*	*14*	*8*	*6*	*145*	*121*	*24*	*·01*	*·01*	...
Cuttack	2,076	991	1,085	59	26	33	6	4	2	...	...	...	107	88	19	·01	·01	...
Balasore	1,023	492	531	28	9	19	2	1	1	9	3	6	33	30	3	...	...	...
Puri	980	489	491	24	7	17	1	·8	·2	·04	·03	·01	10	8	2	·001	·001	...
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	*11,942*	*5,901*	*6,041*	*81*	*29*	*52*	*·2*	*·1*	*·1*	*213*	*105*	*108*	*661*	*355*	*306*	...	...	...
Hazaribagh	1,247	608	639	53	22	31	3	2	1	...	...	...	88	53	35	...	...	...
Ranchi	1,354	660	694	69	33	36	1·2	·6	·6	5	3	2	230	123	107	...	...	...
Palamau	661	328	333	13	5	8	4	2	2	10	6	4	10	5	5	...	...	...
Manbhum	1,405	706	699	25	7	18	·3	2	1	23	9	14	63	32	31	...	...	...
Singhbhum	644	320	324	69	32	37	·3	·2	·1	6	3	3	30	15	15	...	...	...
Santhal Parganas	1,776	885	891	46	20	26	·3	·2	·1	119	60	59	156	82	74	...	...	...
Angul	181	90	91	19	8	11	·6	·4	·2	...	...	...	1·1	·7	·4	...	...	...
Sambalpur	701	346	355	56	37	39	2·5	1·9	·6	31	15	16	84	44	40	...	...	...
Orissa Feudatory States ...	3,497	1,740	1,757	61	19	42	·04	·02	·03	·7	·3	4	7	4	3	...	...	...
Chota Nagpur States ...	130	64	66	·3	·1	·2	·005	·003	·002	...	...	...	1·5	·6	·9	...	...	...
SIKKIM	*58*	*29*	*29*	...	...	...	...	...	...	*3*	*1*	*2*	*·4*	*·2*	*·2*	...	...	...

The figures in columns 17 to 19 against Bihar and Orissa include 15,711 persons (10,365 males and 5,346 females) enumerated outside India (as noted below) whose district of birth is not known and who are, therefore, left out of account in the figures for individual districts :—

	Total.	Male.	Female.		Total.	Male.	Female.
1. Cape of Good Hope	190	179	11	4. Scotland	5	5	...
2. Natal	15,026	9,749	5,277	5. Transvaal	487	430	57
3. Orange Free State	3	2	1				

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—Proportional Migration to and from each District.

District and Natural Division.	Number per mille of actual population of—						Number of females to 100 males.			
	Immigrants.			Emigrants.			Immigrants.		Emigrants.	
	Total.	From contiguous districts.	From other places.	Total.	To contiguous districts.	To other places.	From contiguous districts.	From other places.	To contiguous districts.	To other places.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
BENGAL	**43**	**8**	**35**	**13**	**7**	**6**	**95**	**34**	**69**	**40**
WEST BENGAL	**52**	**21**	**31**	**49**	**37**	**12**	**110**	**39**	**72**	**62**
Burdwan	117	81	36	82	45	37	118	57	294	63
Birbhum	69	58	11	54	41	13	143	48	156	80
Bankura	41	37	4	154	114	40	296	57	93	59
Midnapore	27	14	13	61	42	19	131	49	93	73
Hooghly	171	100	71	137	77	60	116	34	97	43
Howrah	201	74	127	43	33	10	80	39	76	62
CENTRAL BENGAL	**125**	**39**	**86**	**37**	**25**	**12**	**74**	**27**	**105**	**64**
24-Parganas	165	57	108	57	50	7	78	33	96	73
Calcutta	714	116	598	98	53	45	78	30	90	77
Nadia	45	30	15	84	58	26	144	37	97	57
Murshidabad	55	41	14	78	60	18	127	37	121	70
Jessore	34	28	6	42	29	13	122	37	122	34
NORTH BENGAL	**86**	**34**	**52**	**12**	**10**	**2**	**80**	**45**	**89**	**46**
Rajshahi	64	34	30	26	22	4	88	48	101	59
Dinajpur	117	25	92	14	11	3	91	59	134	55
Jalpaiguri	294	41	253	23	21	2	87	71	125	55
Darjeeling	441	49	392	39	25	14	83	74	91	57
Rangpur	75	21	54	26	24	2	92	29	94	55
Bogra	64	29	35	26	23	3	107	44	103	67
Pabna	45	24	21	72	37	35	77	21	80	69
Malda	118	90	28	41	37	4	100	45	99	58
Cooch Behar	93	45	48	61	57	4	117	19	90	85
EAST BENGAL	**16**	**7**	**9**	**20**	**10**	**10**	**94**	**28**	**62**	**29**
Khulna	40	34	6	29	24	5	95	13	116	40
Dacca	39	22	17	60	29	31	94	22	57	32
Mymensingh	36	17	19	35	24	11	69	29	94	62
Faridpur	45	37	8	38	26	12	84	25	66	35
Backergunge	25	16	9	19	12	7	40	17	71	37
Tippera	25	20	5	39	35	4	69	23	70	20
Noakhali	18	10	8	37	28	9	111	51	48	6
Chittagong	12	4	8	66	60	6	56	45	19	4
Chittagong Hill Tracts	41	31	10	8	8	...	18	55	87	87
Hill Tippera	356	314	42	6	5	1	60	69	103	53
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**12**	**7**	**5**	**49**	**18**	**31**	**118**	**72**	**89**	**41**
NORTH BIHAR	**22**	**16**	**6**	**41**	**19**	**22**	**127**	**103**	**97**	**16**
Saran	21	19	2	124	41	83	336	75	139	16
Champaran	50	39	11	25	13	12	127	130	200	11
Muzaffarpur	26	21	5	68	31	37	222	148	276	18
Darbhanga	30	23	7	60	31	29	277	106	181	20
Bhagalpur	64	47	17	78	59	19	136	52	119	53
Purnea	100	53	47	19	16	3	90	50	100	39
SOUTH BIHAR	**20**	**17**	**3**	**83**	**24**	**59**	**164**	**57**	**146**	**45**
Patna	57	50	7	108	39	69	160	55	212	48
Gaya	28	25	3	95	35	60	208	56	159	47
Shahabad	33	29	4	95	28	67	275	57	255	47
Monghyr	44	37	7	112	53	59	192	53	170	44
ORISSA	**14**	**8**	**6**	**56**	**19**	**37**	**254**	**86**	**126**	**12**
Cuttack	16	12	4	82	28	54	319	81	126	23
Balasore	31	28	3	69	36	33	193	42	195	14
Puri	42	32	10	35	24	11	194	63	241	22
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	**35**	**28**	**7**	**77**	**24**	**53**	**107**	**47**	**120**	**86**
Hazaribagh	32	27	5	112	41	71	115	34	138	66
Ranchi	24	15	9	220	53	167	130	60	105	86
Palamau	38	34	4	55	35	20	89	57	110	79
Manbhum	92	44	48	75	32	43	141	37	189	98
Singhbhum	72	46	26	152	108	44	178	88	114	98
Santhal Parganas	57	42	15	171	87	84	154	59	106	90
Angul	84	84	10	106	97	9	167	24	138	60
Sambalpur	58	40	18	233	117	116	151	74	108	87
Orissa States	79	73	6	20	18	2	113	80	210	67
Chota Nagpur States	126	120	6	13	2	11	114	59	112	133
SIKKIM	**339**	**34**	**305**	**39**	**34**	**5**	**92**	**80**	**109**	**86**

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV—MIGRATION BETWEEN NATURAL DIVISIONS (ACTUAL FIGURES) COMPARED WITH 1901.

BENGAL.

NATURAL DIVISIONS IN WHICH BORN.		NUMBER ENUMERATED (000'S OMITTED) IN NATURAL DIVISIONS.				
		West Bengal.	Central Bengal.	North Bengal.	East Bengal.	TOTAL.
1		2	3	4	5	6
TOTAL	1911	442	1,006	926	310	2,683
	1901	*154*	*487*	*318*	*194*	*1,153*
West Bengal	1911	[8,026]	233	6	5	244
	1901	*[7,895]*	*191*	*7*	*5*	*204*
Central Bengal	1911	75	[7,072]	96	59	230
	1901	*60*	*[6,979]*	*74*	*62*	*195*
North Bengal	1911	2	20	[9,805]	32	54
	1901	*1*	*21*	*[9,991]*	*26*	*47*
East Bengal	1911	7	94	79	[18,719]	179
	1901	*5*	*75*	*43*	*[18,707]*	*123*
Outside the Province	1911	358	659	745	214	1,976
	1901	*88*	*200*	*194*	*101*	*584*

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

NATURAL DIVISIONS IN WHICH BORN.		NUMBER ENUMERATED (000'S OMITTED) IN NATURAL DIVISIONS.				
		North Bihar.	South Bihar.	Orissa.	Chota Nagpur Plateau.	TOTAL.
1		2	3	4	5	6
TOTAL	1911	311	158	60	435	964
	1901	*262*	*154*	*51*	*284*	*751*
North Bihar	1911	[13,792]	89	·303	39	128
	1901	*[13,553]*	*75*	*·526*	*30*	*106*
South Bihar	1911	131	[7,609]	·775	101	233
	1901	*112*	*[7,556]*	*·490*	*88*	*200*
Orissa	1911	·152	·141	[4,128]	71	72
	1901	*·96*	*·127*	*[4,062]*	*62*	*62*
Chota Nagpur Plateau.	1911	38	17	26	[11,942]	81
	1901	*16*	*16*	*20*	*[9,493]*	*52*
Outside Province	1911	142	52	3	224	450
	1901	*134*	*63*	*30*	*104*	*331*

The figures within brackets show the number born in and enumerated in each natural division.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Migration between the Province and other parts of India.

Total.

Province or State.	Immigrants to—					Emigrants from—					Excess (+) or deficiency (−) of immigrants over emigrants.			
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	
	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Ajmer-Merwara	653	143	796	464	+ 332	289	112	401	395	+ 6	+ 364	+ 31	+ 395	+ 69
Andamans and Nicobars	80	13	93	158	− 65	1,279	886	2,165	2,457	− 292	− 1,199	− 873	− 2,072	− 2,299
Assam	67,089	3,142	70,231	48,296	+ 21,935	193,575	398,864	592,439	503,876	+ 89,366	− 126,486	− 395,722	− 522,208	− 455,580
Ditto State	221	20	241	...	+ 241	300	503	803			− 79	− 483	− 562	
Baluchistan	97	19	116	...	+ 116	123	62	185	...	+ 185	− 26	− 43	− 69	...
Ditto (Agency Tracts)	19	...	19	...	+ 19	2	1	3	...	+ 3	+ 17	− 1	+ 16	...
Baroda States	124	108	232	134	+ 98	332	150	482	916	− 434	− 208	− 42	− 250	− 782
Bengal	...	165,333	...	...	...	...	1,233,943	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Ditto States	...	51	...	...	...	...	18,428	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Bihar and Orissa	1,248,401	...	..	...	...	153,400	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Ditto States	3,970	...	...	...	...	11,984	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Bombay (including Aden)	5,949	2,302	8,151	5,399	+ 2,752	6,377	876	7,253	5,402	+ 2,728	− 428	+ 1,326	+ 898	+ 1,993
Ditto States	2,578	1,229	3,807	1,296	+ 2,511	497	380	877			+ 2,081	+ 849	+ 2,930	
Burma	2,600	173	2,773	1,664	+ 1,109	135,756	8,392	144,148	156,998	− 12,850	− 33,156	− 8,219	− 141,375	− 155,334
Central India Agency	3,161	3,610	6,771	23,116	− 16,345	1,004	1,115	2,119	6,196	− 4,077	+ 2,157	+ 2,495	+ 4,652	+ 16,920
Central Provinces and Berar	19,378	38,455	57,833	46,734	+ 11,099	3,542	98,674	102,216	44,650	+ 39,746	+ 15,836	− 60,219	− 44,383	+ 17,620
Ditto States	1,599	14,181	15,780	15,536	+ 244	2,256	29,924	32,180			− 657	− 15,743	− 16,400	
Coorg	3	5	8	5	+ 3	6	3	9	18	− 9	− 3	+ 2	− 1	− 13
Hyderabad	244	204	448	662	− 214	717	17	734	290	+ 444	− 473	+ 187	− 286	+ 373
Kashmir	293	83	376	325	+ 51	131	79	210	198	+ 12	+ 162	+ 4	+ 166	+ 127
Madras (including Laccadives)	14,240	35,489	49,729	26,695	+ 23,034	6,537	1,401	7,938	9,824		+ 7,703	+ 34,088	+ 41,791	
Ditto States	103	19	122	954	− 832	156	27	183	...	− 1,703	− 53	− 8	− 61	+ 17,825
Cochin	*48*	*3*	*51*	...	*+ 51*	*22*	*25*	*47*	...		+ 26	*+ 22*	*+ 4*	
Travancore	*54*	*16*	*70*	...	*+ 70*	*194*	*2*	*196*	...		− 70	*+ 14*	*− 56*	
Mysore	428	204	632	621	+ 11	413	59	472	415	+ 57	+ 15	+ 145	+ 160	+ 206
North-West Frontier Province	1,034	351	1,385	...	+ 1,385	272	22	294	...	+ 294	+ 762	+ 329	+ 1,091	...
Ditto (Agencies and Tribal areas)	...	...	...	...	...	13	2	14	...	+ 14	− 13	− 2	− 14	...
Punjab	17,564	4,883	22,447	16,437	+ 6,010	3,780	1,191	4,971	7,074	− 1,610	+ 13,874	+ 3,692	+ 17,476	+ 10,368
Ditto States	1,012	415	1,427	1,005	+ 422	239	254	493			+ 773	+ 161	+ 934	
Rajputana Agency	36,659	15,188	51,847	40,572	+ 11,275	737	398	1,135	884	+ 251	+ 35,922	+ 14,790	+ 50,712	+ 39,688
Sikkim	2,354	12	2,366	2,188*	+ 1,178	3,052	189	3,241	...	+ 3,241	− 302	− 177	+ 125	+ 2,188
United Provinces of Agra and Oudh	404,198	122,804	528,002	495,803	+ 32,199	25,659	105,061	130,720	128,991	+ 1,909	+ 378,539	+ 18,743	+ 397,282	+ 367,949
Ditto States	1,498	439	1,937	1,137	+ 800	160	20	180			+ 1,338	+ 419	+ 1,757	
Total British Territory	***1,781,286***	***374,012***	***741,564***	***641,655***	***+ 99,909***	***530,595***	***1,849,487***	***992,739***	***868,584***	***+ 167,281***	***+ 1,250,691***	***− 1,475,475***	***+ 251,175***	***− 139,383***
Total Native States	***55,263***	***35,763***	***87,005***	***87,546***	***− 541***	***21,992***	***51,546***	***43,126***			***+ 33,271***	***+ 15,379***	***+ 43,879***	
French Settlements	1,606	80	1,686	1,012	+ 674	...†	...†	...	10,999	− 10,999	+ 1,606	+ 80	+ 1,686	− 9,987
Portuguese Settlements	755	9	764	690	+ 74	...†	...†	...	...	...	+ 755	+ 9	+ 764	+ 690
India (unspecified)	106	44	150	...	+ 150	...	...	...	...	...	+ 106	+ 44	+ 150	...

The figures for 1901 refer to Bengal as constituted in that year.
* Excludes 34,010 persons born and enumerated in Sikkim.
† Figures for French and Portuguese settlements are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—MIGRATION BETWEEN THE PROVINCE AND OTHER PARTS OF INDIA.

British Territory.

PROVINCE OR STATE.	IMMIGRANTS TO—					EMIGRANTS FROM—					EXCESS (+) OR DEFICIENCY (-) OF IMMIGRANTS OVER EMIGRANTS.			
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	
	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Ajmer-Merwara	650	141	791	442	+ 349	289	112	401	...	...	+ 361	+ 29	+ 390	...
Andamans and Nicobars	80	13	93	158	- 65	1,221	872	2,093	...	...	- 1,141	- 859	- 2,000	...
Assam	36,290	3,135	39,425	28,989	+ 10,436	191,612	392,698	584,310	...	...	- 155,322	- 389,563	- 544,885	...
Ditto State	135	20	155	...	+ 155	300	503	803	...	...	- 165	- 483	- 648	...
Baluchistan	97	15	112	...	+ 112	123	62	185	...	...	- 26	- 47	- 73	...
Ditto (agency Tracts) ...	19	...	19	...	+ 19	2	1	3	...	...	+ 17	- 1	+ 16	...
Baroda States	124	99	223	109	+ 114	332	150	482	...	...	- 208	- 51	- 259	...
Bengal	...	153,351	...	...	...	...	1,229,981	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Ditto States	...	49	...	...	...	...	18,420	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Bihar and Orissa	1,229,981	...	...	...	...	153,351	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Ditto States	3,962	...	...	...	...	11,982	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
Bombay (including Aden)	5,923	1,883	7,806	5,246	+ 2,560	6,347	757	7,104	...	...	- 424	+ 1,126	+ 702	...
Ditto States	2,475	849	3,324	1,288	+ 2,036	495	368	863	...	...	+ 1,980	+ 481	+ 2,461	...
Burma	2,596	155	2,751	1,646	+ 1,105	134,985	8,392	143,377	...	...	- 132,389	- 8,237	- 140,626	...
Central India Agency	3,161	3,076	6,237	8,388	- 2,151	1,004	1,047	2,051	...	...	+ 2,157	+ 2,029	+ 4,186	...
Central Provinces and Berar ...	18,016	19,743	37,759	24,736	+ 13,023	3,540	93,785	97,325	...	...	+ 14,476	- 74,042	- 59,566	...
Ditto States	1,599	7,883	9,482	2,195	+ 7,287	2,252	29,291	31,543	...	...	- 653	- 21,408	- 22,061	...
Coorg	3	5	8	5	+ 3	6	2	8	...	...	- 3	+ 3	...	...
Hyderabad	244	193	437	643	- 206	717	17	734	...	...	- 473	+ 176	- 297	...
Kashmir	293	81	374	322	+ 52	131	79	210	...	...	+ 162	+ 2	+ 164	...
Madras (including Laccadives) ...	13,170	16,795	29,965	20,271	+ 9,694	6,537	426	6,963	...	...	+ 6,633	+ 16,369	+ 23,002	...
Ditto States	103	19	122	265	- 143	156	27	183	...	...	- 53	- 8	- 61	...
Cochin	*48*	*3*	*51*	...	+ *51*	*22*	*25*	*47*	...	...	+ *26*	- *22*	+ *4*	...
Travancore	*54*	*16*	*70*	...	+ *70*	*124*	*2*	*126*	...	...	- *70*	+ *14*	- *56*	...
Mysore	427	190	617	614	+ 3	412	59	471	...	...	+ 15	+ 131	+ 146	...
North-West Frontier Province ...	1,011	321	1,332	...	+ 1,332	272	22	294	...	...	+ 739	+ 299	+ 1,038	...
Ditto (agencies and tribal areas)	...	...	...	...	...	12	2	14	...	...	- 12	- 2	- 14	...
Punjab	17,482	4,086	21,568	16,170	+ 5,398	3,752	1,147	4,899	...	...	+ 13,730	+ 2,939	+ 16,669	...
Ditto States	1,012	370	1,382	1,001	+ 381	235	254	489	...	...	+ 777	+ 116	+ 893	...
Rajputana Agency	35,744	13,652	49,396	37,925	+ 11,471	736	398	1,134	...	...	+ 35,008	+ 13,254	+ 48,262	...
Sikkim	3,354	12	3,366	2,187	+ 1,179	3,052	189	3,241	...	...	+ 302	- 177	+ 125	...
United Provinces of Agra and Oudh	399,578	122,104	521,682	482,727	+ 38,955	25,578	104,993	130,571	...	...	+ 374,000	+ 17,111	+ 391,111	...
Ditto States	1,480	437	1,917	1,020	+ 897	160	20	180	...	...	+ 1,320	+ 417	+ 1,737	...
Total British Territory	***1,724,877***	***321,747***	***663,292***	***580,390***	***+ 82,902***	***527,613***	***1,633,249***	***977,530***	...	...	***+ 1,197,264***	***- 1,511,502***	***- 314,238***	...
Total Native States ...	***54,132***	***26,930***	***77,051***	***55,957***	***+ 21,094***	***21,978***	***50,825***	***42,401***	...	...	***+ 32,154***	***- 23,895***	***+ 34,650***	...
French Settlements	1 606	79	1,685	1,012	+ 673	...	...	...	...	...	+ 1,606	+ 9	+ 1,685	...
Portuguese Settlements	732	9	741	671	+ 70	...	...	...	...	...	+ 732	+ 9	+ 741	...
India (unspecified)	106	44	150	...	+ 150	...	...	...	...	...	+ 106	+ 44	+ 150	...

The figures for 1901 refer to Bengal as constituted in that year.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Migration between the Province and other parts of India. **Native States.**

Province or State.	Immigrants to—					Emigrants from—					Excess (+) or deficiency (−) of immigrants over emigrants.			
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.			Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	
	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.	Variation.	1911.	1911.	1911.	1901.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Ajmer-Merwara	3	2	5	22	− 17	...	...	...	...	...	+ 3	+ 2	+ 5	
Andamans and Nicobars	...	...	...	...	...	58	14	72	...	...	− 58	− 14	− 72	
Assam	30,799	7	30,806	19,307	+ 11,499	1,963	6,166	8,129	...	...	+ 28,836	− 6,159	+ 22,677	
Ditto State	86	...	86	...	+ 86	...	...	...	...	...	+ 86	...	+ 86	
Baluchistan	...	4	4	...	+ 4	...	...	...	...	...	...	+ 4	+ 4	
Ditto (agency Tracts)	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Baroda States	...	9	9	25	− 16	...	...	...	...	...	...	+ 9	+ 9	
Bengal	...	11,982	...	...	...	...	3,962	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Ditto States	...	2	...	...	...	...	8	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Bihar and Orissa	18,420	...	...	...	...	49	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Ditto States	8	...	...	...	...	2	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Bombay (including Aden)	26	319	345	153	+ 192	30	119	149	...	...	− 4	+ 200	+ 196	
Ditto States	103	380	483	8	+ 475	2	12	14	...	...	+ 101	+ 368	+ 469	
Burma	4	18	22	18	+ 4	771	...	771	...	...	− 767	+ 18	− 749	
Central India Agency	...	534	534	14,728	− 14,194	...	68	68	...	...	...	+ 466	+ 466	
Central Provinces and Berar	1,362	18,712	20,074	21,998	− 1,924	2	4,889	4,891	...	...	+ 1,360	+ 13,823	+ 15,183	
Ditto States	...	6,298	6,298	13,341	− 7,043	4	633	637	...	...	− 4	+ 5,665	+ 5,661	
Coorg	...	...	...	...	...	...	1	1	...	...	...	− 1	− 1	
Hyderabad	...	11	11	19	− 8	...	...	...	...	...	...	+ 11	+ 11	
Kashmir	...	2	2	3	− 1	...	...	...	...	...	...	+ 2	+ 2	
Madras (including Laccadives)	1,070	18,694	19,764	6,424	+ 13,340	...	975	975	...	...	+ 1,070	+ 17,719	+ 18,789	
Ditto States	...	...	...	689	− 689	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Cochin	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Travancore	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Mysore	1	14	15	7	+ 8	1	...	1	...	...	...	+ 14	+ 14	
North-West Frontier Province	23	30	53	...	+ 53	...	...	...	...	...	+ 23	+ 30	+ 53	
Ditto (agencies and tribal areas)	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
Punjab	82	797	879	267	+ 612	28	44	72	...	...	+ 54	+ 753	+ 807	
Ditto States	...	45	45	4	+ 41	4	...	4	...	...	− 4	+ 45	+ 41	
Rajputana Agency	915	1,536	2,451	2,647	− 196	1	...	1	...	...	+ 914	+ 1,536	+ 2,450	
Sikkim	...	...	...	1	− 1	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	
United Provinces of Agra and Oudh	4,620	1,700	6,320	13,076	− 6,756	81	68	149	...	...	+ 4,539	+ 1,632	+ 6,171	
Ditto States	18	2	20	117	− 97	...	...	...	...	...	+ 18	+ 2	+ 20	
Total British Territory	***56,409***	***52,265***	***78,272***	***61,265***	***+ 17,007***	***2,982***	***16,238***	***15,209***	...	...	+ ***53,427***	+ ***36,027***	+ ***63,063***	
Total Native States	***1,131***	***8,833***	***9,954***	***31,589***	***− 21,635***	***14***	***721***	***725***	...	...	+ ***1,117***	+ ***8,112***	+ ***9,229***	
French Settlements	...	1	1	...	+ 1	...	...	...	...	...	...	+ 1	+ 1	
Portuguese Settlements	23	...	23	19	+ 4	...	...	...	...	...	+ 23	...	+ 23	
India (unspecified)	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	

The figures for 1901 refer to Bengal as constituted in that year.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Migration to and from Border Districts, Bengal.

Enumerated in—	Born in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.			Born in—	Enumerated in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.		
		Total.	Male.	Female.			Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
MIDNAPORE	***Bihar and Orissa***	***26,408***	***14,610***	***11,798***	MIDNAPORE	***Bihar and Orissa***	***20,194***	***8,255***	***11,939***
	Contiguous Districts	15,862	6,385	9,477		Contiguous Districts	19,206	7,612	11,594
	Balasore	9,379	3,623	5,756		Balasore	8,163	2,814	5,349
	Manbhum	811	408	403		Manbhum	3,439	2,077	1,362
	Singhbhum	5,672	2,354	3,318		Singhbhum	7,604	2,721	4,883
	Other Districts	10,546	8,225	2,321		Other Districts	988	643	345
	Bihar and Orissa States	***1,589***	***804***	***785***		***Bihar and Orissa States***	***10,126***	***5,065***	***5,061***
	Mayurbhanj	1,058	749	309		Mayurbhanj	9,938	4,973	4,965
	Other States	531	55	476		Other States	188	92	96
BANKURA	***Bihar and Orissa***	***13,018***	***4,960***	***8,058***	BANKURA	***Bihar and Orissa***	***28,802***	***19,379***	***9,423***
	Manbhum	11,149	3,687	7,462		Manbhum	25,533	17,566	7,967
	Other Districts	1,869	1,273	596		Other Districts	3,269	1,813	1,456
BURDWAN	***Bihar and Orissa***	***67,867***	***39,317***	***28,550***	BURDWAN	***Bihar and Orissa***	***10,511***	***4,867***	***5,644***
	Contiguous Districts	38,932	20,410	18,522		Contiguous Districts	7,185	2,888	4,297
	Santhal Parganas	27,378	15,276	12,102		Santhal Parganas	3,539	1,421	2,118
	Manbhum	11,554	5,134	6,420		Manbhum	3,646	1,467	2,179
	Other Districts	28,935	18,907	10,028		Other Districts	3,326	1,979	1,347
BIRBHUM	***Bihar and Orissa***	***32,977***	***16,030***	***16,947***	BIRBHUM	***Bihar and Orissa***	***14,114***	***5,532***	***8,582***
	Santhal Parganas	28,282	12,607	15,675		Santhal Parganas	11,696	4,074	7,622
	Other Districts	4,695	3,423	1,272		Other Districts	2,418	1,458	960
MURSHIDABAD	***Bihar and Orissa***	***23,811***	***13,978***	***9,833***	MURSHIDABAD	***Bihar and Orissa***	***13,791***	***6,245***	***7,546***
	Santhal Parganas	14,933	7,278	7,655		Santhal Parganas	7,636	2,928	4,708
	Other Districts	8,878	6,700	2,178		Other Districts	6,155	3,317	2,838
MALDA	***Bihar and Orissa***	***71,613***	***39,190***	***32,423***	MALDA	***Bihar and Orissa***	***17,432***	***8,063***	***9,369***
	Contiguous Districts	55,317	28,163	27,154		Contiguous Districts	16,121	7,459	8,662
	Santhal Parganas	48,402	24,973	23,429		Santhal Parganas	6,824	3,144	3,680
	Purnea	6,915	3,190	3,725		Purnea	9,297	4,315	4,982
	Other Districts	16,296	11,027	5,269		Other Districts	1,311	604	707
DINAJPUR	***Bihar and Orissa***	***132,568***	***81,175***	***51,393***	DINAJPUR	***Bihar and Orissa***	***4,337***	***2,200***	***2,137***
	Purnea	7,243	3,566	3,677		Purnea	2,976	1,104	1,872
	Other Districts	125,325	77,609	47,716		Other Districts	1,361	1,096	265
JALPAIGURI	***Bihar and Orissa***	***162,452***	***91,856***	***70,596***	JALPAIGURI	***Bihar and Orissa***	***1,753***	***943***	***810***
	Purnea	3,282	1,779	1,503		Purnea	685	245	440
	Other Districts	159,170	90,077	69,093		Other Districts	1,068	698	370
	Assam	***889***	***672***	***217***		***Assam***	***1,869***	***1,025***	***844***
	Goalpara	320	189	131		Goalpara	1,818	994	824
	Other Districts	569	483	86		Other Districts	51	31	20

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Migration to and from Border Districts, Bengal—*continued.*

Enumerated in—	Born in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.			Born in—	Enumerated in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.		
		Total.	Male.	Female.			Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
DARJEELING	***Bihar and Orissa***	***28,339***	***17,700***	***10,639***	DARJEELING	***Bihar and Orissa***	***743***	***530***	***213***
	Purnea	7,305	4,076	3,229		Purnea	185	96	89
	Other Districts	21,034	13,624	7,410		Other Districts	558	434	124
	Sikkim	***2,974***	***1,423***	***1,551***		***Sikkim***	***2,993***	***1,555***	***1,438***
COOCH BEHAR	***Assam***	***3,293***	***1,927***	***1,366***	COOCH BEHAR	***Assam***	***1,677***	***912***	***765***
	Goalpara	2,615	1,761	1,854		Goalpara	1,526	798	728
	Other Districts	678	666	12		Other Districts	151	114	37
RANGPUR	***Assam***	***1,780***	***1,144***	***636***	RANGPUR	***Assam***	***16,691***	***9,429***	***7,262***
	Contiguous Districts	1,067	500	567		Contiguous Districts	15,882	8,727	7,155
	Goalpara	1,036	486	550		Goalpara	15,304	8,388	6,916
	Garo Hills	31	14	17		Garo Hills	578	339	239
	Other Districts	713	644	69		Other Districts	809	702	107
MYMENSINGH	***Assam***	***13,065***	***6,483***	***6,582***	MYMENSINGH	***Assam***	***58,358***	***32,410***	***25,948***
	Contiguous Districts	12,826	6,342	6,484		Contiguous Districts	21,465	11,453	10,012
	Garo Hills	797	480	317		Garo Hills	4,249	2,213	2,036
	Sylhet	12,029	5,862	6,167		Sylhet	17,216	9,240	7,976
	Other Districts	239	141	98		Other Districts	36,893	20,957	15,936
TIPPERA	***Assam***	***8,372***	***3,460***	***4,912***	TIPPERA	***Assam***	***16,281***	***8,326***	***7,955***
	Sylhet	8,187	3,371	4,816		Sylhet	15,153	7,589	7,564
	Other Districts	185	89	96		Other Districts	1,128	737	391
HILL TIPPERA	***Assam***	***27,506***	***14,860***	***12,646***	HILL TIPPERA	***Assam***	***286***	***117***	***169***
	Contiguous Districts	26,309	14,190	12,119		Contiguous Districts	271	106	165
	Sylhet	25,549	13,813	11,736		Sylhet	265	101	164
	Lushai Hills	760	377	383		Lushai Hills	6	5	1
	Other Districts	1,197	670	527		Other Districts	15	11	4
CHITTAGONG HILL TRACTS	***Assam***	***617***	***329***	***288***	CHITTAGONG HILL TRACTS	***Assam***	***804***	***425***	***379***
	Lushai Hills	452	305	247		Lushai Hills	803	424	379
	Other Districts	165	124	41		Other Districts	1	1	...
	Burma	***28***	***16***	***12***		***Burma***	...	...	...
	Northern Arakan	...	...	...		Northern Arakan	...	...	...
	Other Districts	28	16	12		Other Districts	...	...	...
CHITTAGONG	***Burma***	***1,026***	***508***	***518***	CHITTAGONG	***Burma***	***63,968***	***60,261***	***3,707***
	Akyab	845	409	436		Akyab	30,521	27,715	2,806
	Other Districts	181	99	82		Other Districts	33,447	32,546	901

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Migration to and from Border Districts, Bihar and Orissa.

Enumerated in—	Born in the districts of the contiguous province of—	Population.			Born in—	Enumerated in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.		
		Total.	Male.	Female.			Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5		7	8	9	10
PURNEA	***Bengal***	***20,819***	***10,175***	***10,644***	PURNEA	***Bengal***	***27,381***	***14,418***	***12,963***
	Contiguous Districts	13,143	5,760	7,383		Contiguous Districts	24,745	13,611	12,134
	Darjeeling	185	96	89		Darjeeling	7,305	4,076	3,229
	Jalpaiguri	685	245	440		Jalpaiguri	3,282	1,779	1,503
	Dinajpur	2,976	1,104	1,872		Dinajpur	7,243	3,566	3,677
	Malda	9,297	4,315	4,982		Malda	6,915	3,190	3,725
	Other Districts	7,676	4,415	3,261		Other Districts	2,636	1,807	729
SONTHAL PARGANAS	***Bengal***	***34,006***	***14,280***	***19,726***	SONTHAL PARGANAS	***Bengal***	***245,903***	***128,118***	***117,785***
	Contiguous Districts	29,695	11,567	18,128		Contiguous Districts	118,995	60,134	58,861
	Malda	6,824	3,144	3,680		Malda	48,402	24,973	23,429
	Murshidabad	7,636	2,928	4,708		Murshidabad	14,933	7,278	7,655
	Birbhum	11,696	4,074	7,622		Birbhum	28,282	13,607	15,675
	Burdwan	3,539	1,421	2,118		Burdwan	27,378	15,276	12,102
	Other Districts	4,311	2,713	1,598		Other Districts	126,908	67,984	58,924
MANBHUM	***Bengal***	***57,373***	***40,609***	***16,764***	MANBHUM	***Bengal***	***31,602***	***13,795***	***17,807***
	Contiguous Districts	32,618	21,110	11,508		Contiguous Districts	23,514	9,229	14,285
	Burdwan	3,646	1,467	2,179		Burdwan	11,554	5,134	6,420
	Bankura	25,533	17,566	7,967		Bankura	11,149	3,687	7,462
	Midnapur	3,439	2,077	1,362		Midnapur	811	408	403
	Other Districts	24,755	19,499	5,256		Other Districts	8,088	4,566	3,522
SINGHBHUM	***Bengal***	***11,326***	***4,763***	***6,563***	SINGHBHUM	***Bengal***	***13,505***	***6,328***	***7,177***
	Midnapur	7,604	2,731	4,883		Midnapur	5,672	2,354	3,318
	Other Districts	3,722	2,042	1,680		Other Districts	7,833	3,974	3,859
BALASORE	***Bengal***	***9,044***	***3,419***	***5,625***	BALASORE	***Bengal***	***39,793***	***31,754***	***8,039***
	Midnapore	8,163	2,814	5,349		Midnapore	9,379	3,623	5,756
	Other Districts	881	605	276		Other Districts	30,414	28,131	2,283
PURI	***Madras***	***6,322***	***2,835***	***3,487***	PURI	***Madras***	***675***	***277***	***398***
	Ganjam	5,558	2,417	3,141		Ganjam	42	31	11
	Other Districts	764	418	346		Other Districts	633	246	387
ANGUL	***Madras***	***5,289***	***2,427***	***2,862***	ANGUL	***Madras***	...	...	...
	Ganjam	5,285	2,425	2,860		Ganjam	...	...	...
	Other Districts	4	2	2		Other Districts	...	...	...
SAMBALPUR	***Central Provinces and Berar.***	***13,687***	***6,604***	***7,083***	SAMBALPUR	***Central Provinces and Berar.***	***86,388***	***45,767***	***40,621***
	Raipur	8,580	4,358	4,222		Raipur	18,330	9,330	9,000
	Other Districts	5,107	2,246	2,761		Other Districts	68,058	36,437	31,621
	Central Provinces States	***5,066***	***1,707***	***3,359***		***Central Provinces States***	***13,045***	***5,512***	***7,533***
	Raigarh	1,617	572	1,045					
	Other States	3,449	1,135	2,314					

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Migration to and from Border Districts, Bihar and Orissa—*concluded.*

Enumerated in—	Born in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.			Born in—	Enumerated in the districts of the contiguous Province of—	Population.		
		Total.	Male.	Female.			Total.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
RANCHI	***Central Provinces States***	***923***	***511***	***412***	RANCHI	***Central Provinces States***	***5,218***	***2,688***	***2,530***
	Jaspur	844	472	372					
	Other States	79	39	40					
PALAMAU	***Central Provinces States***	***1,825***	***1,002***	***823***	PALAMAU	***Central Provinces States***	***7,254***	***4,186***	***3,068***
	Surguja	1,797	983	814					
	Other States	28	19	9					
	United Provinces	***1,577***	***877***	***700***		***United Provinces***	***3,112***	***1,542***	***1,570***
	Mirzapur	996	475	521		Mirzapur	2,848	1,459	1,389
	Other Districts	581	402	179		Other Districts	264	83	181
SHAHABAD	***United Provinces***	***28,035***	***8,450***	***19,585***	SHAHABAD	***United Provinces***	***30,267***	***6,393***	***23,874***
	Contiguous Districts	25,754	6,974	18,780		Contiguous Districts	26,645	4,519	22,126
	Mirzapur	2,510	895	1,615		Mirzapur	4,839	1,291	3,548
	Benares	3,551	1,228	2,323		BCnares	8,143	1,633	6,510
	Ghazipur	10,169	2,731	7,438		Ghazipur	8,509	760	7,749
	Ballia	9,524	2,120	7,404		Ballia	5,154	845	4,309
	Other Districts	2,281	1,476	805		Other Districts	3,622	1,874	1,748
SARAN	***United Provinces***	***24,503***	***7,016***	***17,487***	SARAN	***United Provinces***	***53,099***	***17,080***	***36,019***
	Contiguous Districts	22,511	5,753	16,758		Contiguous Districts	49,818	14,938	34,880
	Ballia	3,466	1,186	2,280		Ballia	6,286	657	5,629
	Gorakhpur	19,045	4,567	14,478		Gorakhpur	43,532	14,281	29,251
	Other Districts	1,992	1,263	729		Other Districts	3,281	2,142	1,139
CHAMPARAN	***United Provinces***	***26,559***	***13,877***	***12,682***	CHAMPARAN	***United Provinces***	***7,102***	***3,059***	***4,043***
	Gorakhpur	23,911	12,116	11,795		Gorakhpur	6,854	2,937	3,917
	Other Districts	2,648	1,761	887		Other Districts	248	122	126
ORISSA FEUDATORY STATES	***Bengal***	***11,814***	***6,141***	***5,673***	ORISSA FEUDATORY STATES	***Bengal***	***3,680***	***2,093***	***1,587***
	Midnapore	10,094	5,047	5,047		Midnapore	1,586	801	785
	Other Districts	1,720	1,094	626		Other Districts	2,092	1,290	802
	Madras	***18,687***	***9,380***	***9,307***		***Madras***	***975***	***562***	***413***
	Contiguous Districts	17,461	8,695	8,766		Contiguous Districts	47	36	11
	Ganjam	12,087	5,868	6,219		Ganjam	...	...	...
	Vizagapatam	5,374	2,827	2,547		Viz gapatam	47	36	11
	Other Districts	1,226	685	541		Other Districts	928	526	402
	Central Provinces and Berar.	***18,674***	***9,287***	***9,387***		***Central Provinces and Berar.***	***2,762***	***1,260***	***1,502***
	Raipur	13,688	6,697	6,991		Raipur	2,762	1,260	1,502
	Other Districts	4,986	2,590	2,396		Other Districts	...	...	...
	Central Provinces States	***6,298***	***3,114***	***3,184***		***Central Provinces States***	...	...	...
	Contiguous States	5,562	2,747	2,815					
	Raigarh	3,536	1,755	1,781					
	Jashpur	2,026	992	1,034					
	Other States	736	367	369					

CHAPTER IV.

RELIGION.

PART I.—STATISTICAL.

INTRODUCTORY.

435. Statistics for all religions are contained in Imperial Table VI, while Tables XVII and XVIII give figures for the denominations, races and ages of Christians. The following subsidiary tables, in which the statistics are illustrated by means of proportional figures, will be found at the end of this chapter.

Subsidiary Table I—Showing the general distribution of the population by religion.

Subsidiary Table II—Showing the strength of the main religions in each district and natural division at each of the last four censuses.

Subsidiary Table III—Showing the numbers and variations of Christians in each district and natural division.

Subsidiary Table IV—Showing the distribution of Christians by race and sect.

Subsidiary Table V—Showing the Christian races distributed by sect and the Christian sects distributed by race.

Subsidiary Table VI—Showing the distribution of the urban and rural population by religion in each natural division.

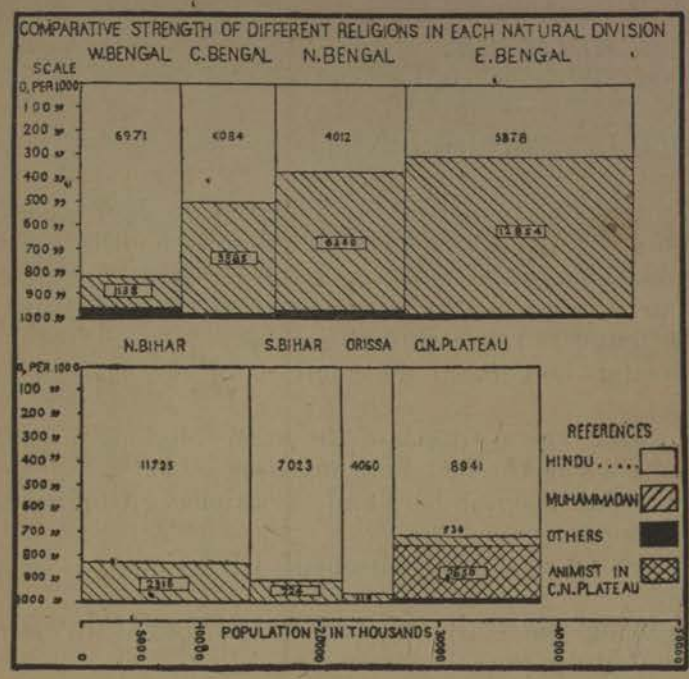
436. The general distribution of the people by religion at this and the last census is shown in the margin together with the variations which have occurred since 1901. In Bengal the Musalmans predominate, representing 52·3 per cent. of the population, and outnumbering Hindus (45·2 per cent.) by over 3¼ millions. These two religions account between them for all but 2·4 per cent. of the population, the other religions being but poorly represented. Animists, Buddhists and Christians, taken together, number only a little over 1,100,000, and the aggregate for all other religions is under 16,000. The distribution of religions in Bihar and Orissa is very different. Hindus form an overwhelming majority, representing 82·6 per cent. of the total population, and then come, *longo intervallo*, the Musalmans with 9·6 per cent. and Animists with 7 per cent. Christians account for over a quarter of million, or more than double the number found in Bengal, but no other religion has even 5,000 adherents.

RELIGION.	BENGAL.			BIHAR AND ORISSA.		
	Number.		Variation per cent., 1901—1911.	Number.		Variation per cent., 1901—1911.
	1911.	1901.		1911.	1901.	
Hindus	20,945,379	20,150,541	+ 3·9	31,749,018	30,559,029	+ 3·9
Musalmans	24,237,228	21,947,960	+ 10·4	3,683,438	3,540,351	+ 4·0
Animists	730,780	442,594	+ 65·1	2,720,268	2,281,414	+ 19·2
Buddhists	246,866	216,506	+ 14·0	1,927	843	+ 128·6
Christians	129,746	106,596	+ 21·7	268,265	172,498	+ 55·5
Jains	6,782	5,232	+ 29·6	4,629	2,656	+ 74·3
Brahmos	2,938	2,898	+ 2·0	585	318	+ 84·0
Sikhs	3,221	258	+ 760·9	2,228	81	+2650·6
Jews	1,993	1,914	+ 4·1	25	32	— 32·4
Confucians	1,058	178	+ 494·4	...	...	...
Parsis	611	356	+ 71·6	35	33	+ 6·1
Aryas	20	...	...	4,085	...	...
Others	...	48	...	770	2	+38,400

INSTRUCTIONS REGARDING THE ENTRY OF RELIGION.

437. The instructions regarding the entry of religion in the schedules were that the religion which each person returned was to be entered, and that when a person belonged to an aboriginal tribe and had no recognized religion (*i.e.*, was not a Hindu, Musalman, Christian, Buddhist, Sikh, Jain, Parsi, etc.), the name of the tribe was to be entered. All persons whose tribal name was entered in the schedules were taken to be Animists. It was specifically laid down that the answer which each man gave about his religion was to be accepted, but it is recognized that these orders were not always carried out. As Mr. Gait said in 1901, it is fashionable to call oneself a Hindu, and many semi-aboriginals lay claim to be Hindus, though Hindus scout their pretensions. In some parts Hindu enumerators refused to entertain claims which they considered preposterous, and would not enter the aspirants as Hindus. The practical difficulties which arise over this question may be realized from the report of Mr. M. G. Hallett, I.C.S., late Subdivisional Officer of Gumla in Ranchi. "One of the chief difficulties which arose in connection with the filling up of the census schedules in this part of

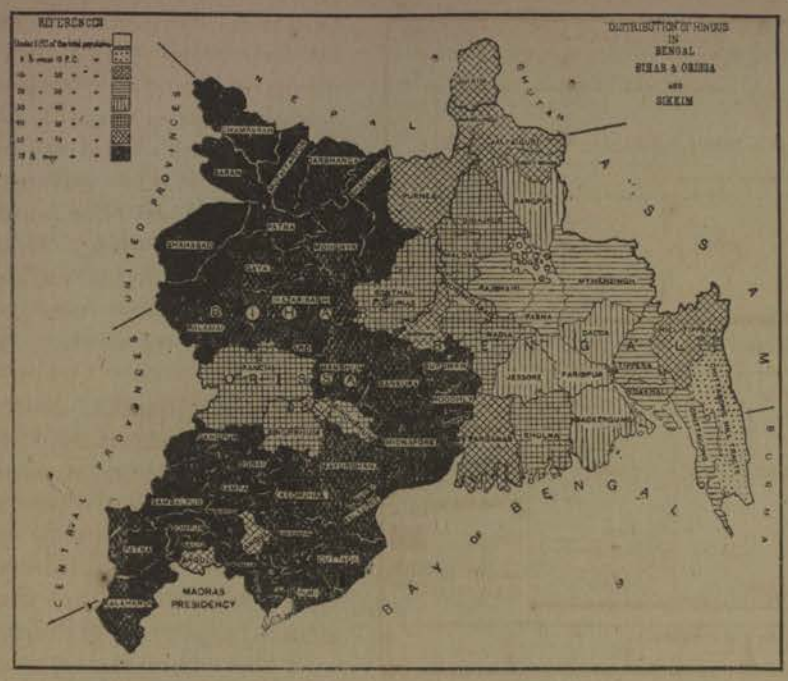
Chota Nagpur was in regard to the entry in the column of religion. Much doubt was felt, and many questions were asked both by supervisors and enumerators as to whether certain castes should be classified as Hindus or Animists. The general rule issued on this point was to the effect that every person who called himself a Hindu was to be entered as such. In the case of Oraons, Kharias, Mundas, Asurs and other purely aboriginal tribes, there was no difficulty. I only came across two instances in which an Oraon claimed to be a Hindu : one was a Sub-Inspector of Police, and the other was a man who had risen above other members of his tribe and become the proprietor of two or three villages." Such persons were naturally recorded as Hindus, but in the case of other Oraons, apart of course from the converts to Christianity, the entry was Animist. The difficulty arose in dealing with castes which are, as it were, on the border line. I allude in particular to such castes as Chik, Ghasi, Turi, Lohar, Gond, Dom and others. If you ask a person of these castes the straight question 'What is your religion,' he will probably reply that he is a Hindu, or again if you ask him 'Are you a Hindu,' he will probably reply in the affirmative. If, however, you prosecute your inquiries further, and try to find out whether he observes any of the tenets of Hinduism, you will soon discover that his first answer was given merely as the result of ignorance, and that his superstitious and religious customs are much more closely allied to the Animistic religion of the Oraon and Munda than to the religion of the Hindu. The entry in column 3 depended therefore to a large extent on the individual supervisor or enumerator. He interpreted the general order on the subject according to his own religion. The Hindus, such as they are, of these parts look down upon the border-line castes, and are not willing to admit that they are Hindus. Hence the enumerator who was a Brahman or Kayasth or Rajput would record these persons as Animists. On the other hand, when the enumerator was an educated Christian, Oraon or Munda, he would record them as Hindus, accepting their bare statement. It was thus practically impossible to secure uniformity in this entry. Nor would a uniform entry be correct. In the more out-of-the-way parts of the district these castes are undoubtedly more Animistic in their religion than in the more civilized parts, and again individuals in these castes who have risen at all in the social scale have undoubtedly more claim to be regarded as Hindus."



438. In Bengal the Hindu element steadily diminishes as one proceeds eastwards. The most distinctively Hindu districts are found in West Bengal (the Burdwan Division), where Hindus represent 82 per cent. of the total population. In Central Bengal the proportion falls to 51 per cent., while in North Bengal it is only 37 per cent., the minimum of 31 per cent. being reached in East Bengal. West Bengal contributes one-third of the total Hindu population of the province, and East Bengal a little over a quarter, while Central and North Bengal each account for under a fifth. Proportionately, the greatest number of Hindus is found in Midnapore (88 per cent.), and the smallest in the Chittagong Hill Tracts (9 per cent.). Altogether, there are only ten districts in which Hindus outnumber Musalmans, viz., the six districts of West Bengal, the 24-Parganas in Central Bengal, Darjeeling and Jalpaiguri in North Bengal, and the Chittagong Hill Tracts : in the district last named, however, the Hindus are largely outnumbered by both Animists and Buddhists. The

DISTRIBUTION OF HINDUS.

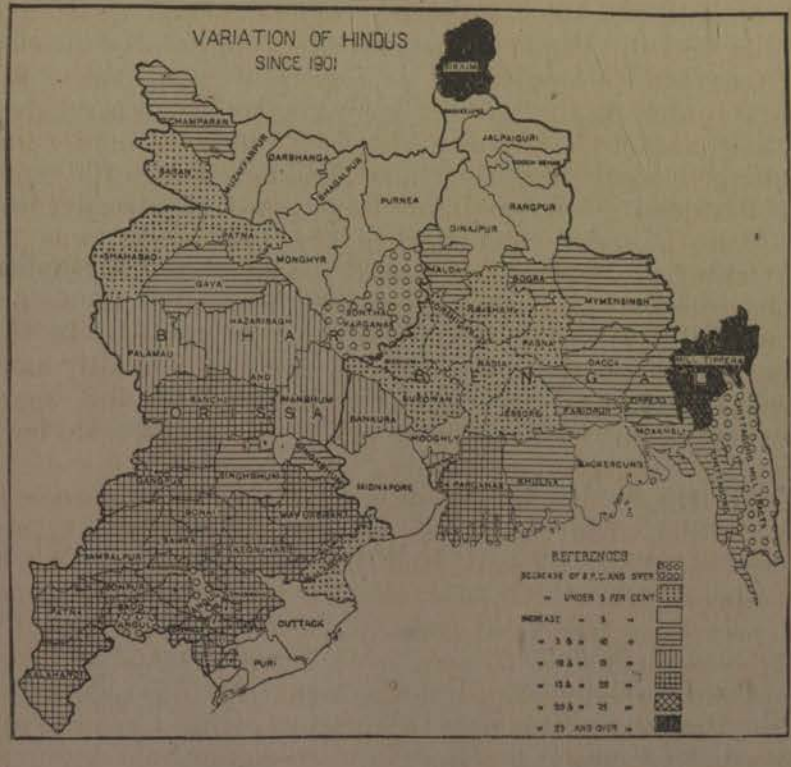
Hindu community is in a majority in the States of Cooch Behar and Hill Tippera, and also in Calcutta, where it represents over two-thirds of the total population.



In Bihar and Orissa over one-third of the total Hindu population is found in North Bihar, where Hindus number nearly $11\frac{3}{4}$ millions, or more than the aggregate for both South Bihar and Orissa. Proportionately, however, they are in greatest strength in Orissa, the holy land of Hinduism, where 97 out of every 100 inhabitants belong to that religion. South Bihar comes next with 90 per cent., while the Chota Nagpur Plateau comes last with 72 per cent. In Ranchi and Singhbhum the Hindus are outnumbered by the Animists, but elsewhere they preponderate. Excluding these two districts, the sparsest Hindu population is found in Purnea (56·6 per cent.) and then in the Chota Nagpur States (57 per cent.).

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

439. In Bengal the Hindus have increased by nearly 4 per cent. since 1901, the ratio of increase being 2·3 per cent. less than it was in the preceding decade. They have made the greatest advance (6·6 per cent.) in East Bengal, where their proportionate strength is least, but where the people generally seem to have unusual procreative energy. Central Bengal comes next with an improvement of 5·2 per cent., and then North Bengal with a little under 3 per cent. West Bengal, where Hindus are in greatest strength, shows the least progress, the ratio of increase being under 2 per cent. In all the districts of this Division the Hindus have increased less rapidly than members of other religions, so that their proportionate representation in the total population has fallen since 1901.

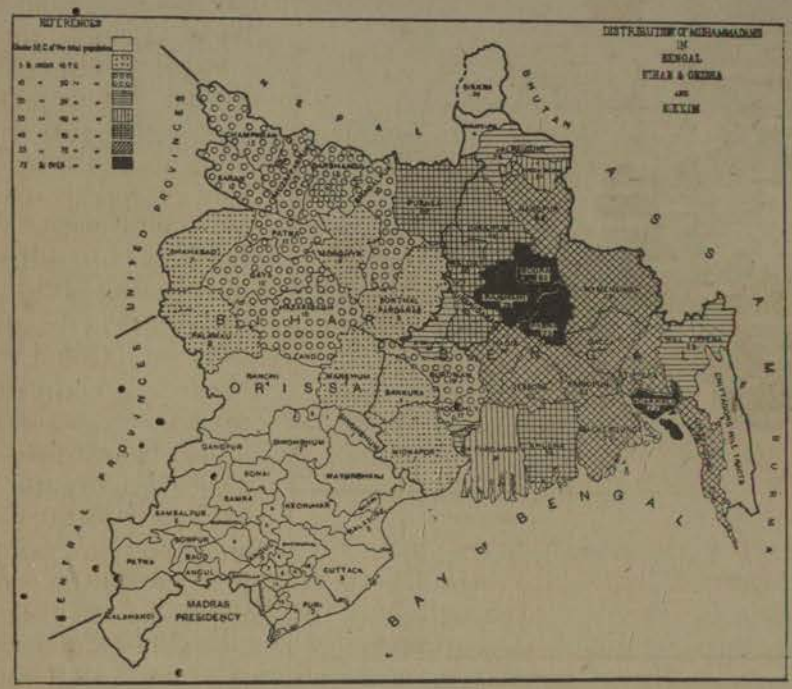


The Hindu population of Bihar and Orissa has grown at exactly the same rate as that of Bengal. The greatest expansion is in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where it is 12 per cent.: as will be shown later, the increase would have been even greater, had it not been that many who were entered as Hindus in 1901 were returned as Animists at this census. Elsewhere, there

has been a very slight growth, for North Bihar registers an increase of a little over 1 per cent., South Bihar of a little under 1 per cent., and Orissa of only half per cent.

DISTRIBUTION OF MUSALMANS.

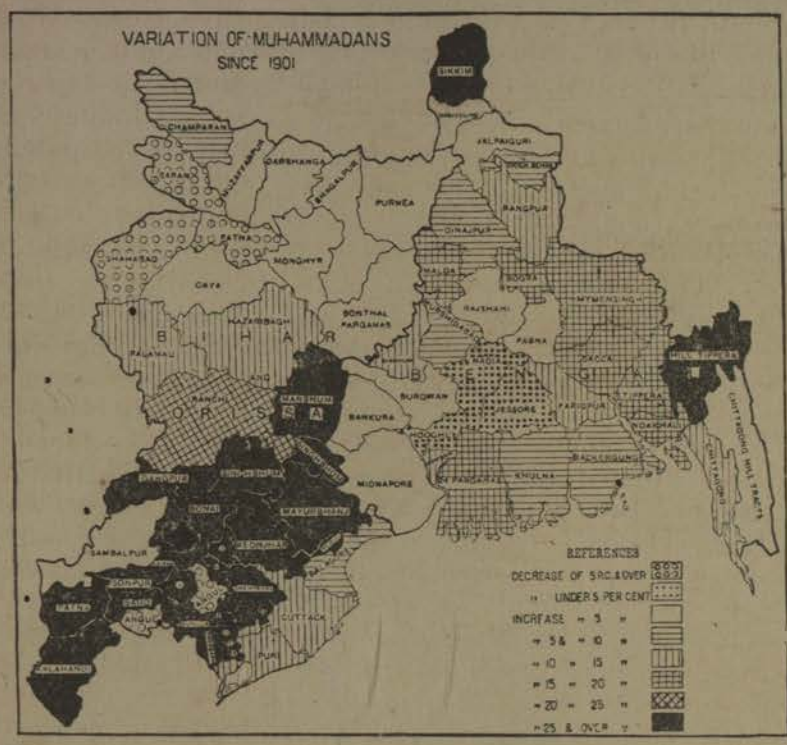
440. Musalmans predominate throughout Bengal, except in the south-west, the extreme north and the extreme south-east of the Presidency. To the south-west, in West Bengal, they constitute only 13 per cent. of the population and are in a small minority compared with Hindus : in one district (Bankura) they are outnumbered by the Animists, and in Midnapore they only slightly exceed the latter. In Central Bengal they represent 48 per cent. of the population, but if Calcutta is excluded, 50 per cent. : in this city the population is mainly composed of immigrants from outside, among whom Hindus predominate, there being five of them to every two Musalmans. Islam prevails over Hinduism in three of the four districts of the Division, the exception being the 24-Parganas, where, however, 282,761, or nearly one-eighth of the inhabitants, are Hindu immigrants from outside. Both in Calcutta and in the metropolitan districts (24-Parganas, Howrah and Hooghly) the Hindu community is largely recruited by immigration, there being 1,009,772 Hindus, but only 346,899 Musalman immigrants : in other words, there are approximately three Hindus to every one Musalman in the immigrant population. The preponderance of Musalmans is more pronounced in North Bengal, where their proportion to the total population is 59 per cent. They are in a minority in Jalpaiguri, Darjeeling, Dinajpur and the State of Cooch Behar ; in the remaining districts they account for 50 per cent. (Malda) to 82 per cent. (Bogra) of the inhabitants. In East Bengal as a whole they are more than twice as numerous as the Hindus, and in Noakhali and Chittagong they outnumber the latter by more than 3 to 1. They are in a minority in Hill Tippera and the Chittagong Hill Tracts, while in Khulna they are only slightly more numerous than the Hindus ; elsewhere their distribution is fairly uniform, the proportion varying only from 63 per cent. in Faridpur to 77 per cent. in Noakhali. East Bengal contains more than half the aggregate number of Muhammadans in the whole Presidency, North Bengal a little over a quarter and Central Bengal slightly less than a sixth.



441. In Bihar and Orissa the Musalmans form a small minority. Purnea alone contains nearly a quarter of the total number : the figures for this district bring up the proportionate strength of the Musalman population in North Bihar to 16 per cent. Champaran follows next with 15 per cent., and there are only seven other districts in which the ratio is 10 per cent. or more, viz., Saran, Muzaffarpur, Darbhanga, Bhagalpur, Patna, Gaya and Hazaribagh. It is somewhat remarkable that the followers of the Prophet are relatively more numerous in North Bihar, which has been from ancient times the home of Hinduism and Brahman domination, than in South Bihar, where there are old Muhammadan centres such as Patna and Monghyr. In Orissa, where the Afghans ruled for several centuries, they cannot claim more than 2·7 per cent. of the population, which is less than the figure returned for the Chota Nagpur Plateau (4·3 per cent.). In the latter Division there are approximately 17 Hindus and 5 Animists to every Musalman. The Kishanganj subdivision of Purnea is the most distinctively Musalman part of the province, Islam being the religion of two-thirds of its inhabitants.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

442. In Bengal as a whole the Musalmans have increased by 10·4 per cent. since 1901. Their advance has been greatest in the tracts where they are most numerous, viz., East Bengal, where the rate of growth is 14·6 per cent., and North Bengal, where it is 8·2 per cent. Far less progress has been made in West Bengal and Central Bengal, where the increment represents 4·9 per cent. and 3·1 per cent., respectively.



The rate of increase in Bihar and Orissa is only 4 per cent. In all parts of this Province Musulmans have progressed, except South Bihar, where there is a falling off of 20,654 or 2·8 per cent. The decline is accounted for by the losses sustained by the Musalmans living in towns, who have decreased by 22,976, or 15 per cent., owing to epidemics of plague and other diseases. In the Chota Nagpur Plateau the Musalmans are now more numerous by 17·5 per cent. than in 1901, and in Orissa by 10·4 per cent., but in North Bihar they have increased by only a little over 3 per cent.

RELATIVE GROWTH OF MUSALMANS AND HINDUS.

443. In Bengal the Musalmans are increasing more rapidly than the Hindus, the percentage of increase among them during the last decennium being nearly thrice as great as it is among their Hindu neighbours. This is no new feature, but has been in operation for the last 30 years. During that period the Hindus of Bengal have added only 16 per cent. to their numbers, while the followers of the Prophet have an addition of 29 per cent. Nowhere have the latter made such progress as in East Bengal, where they are more numerous by 50½ per cent. than they were in 1881: the corresponding ratio for Hindus is a little under 26 per cent. The only area in which the Hindus are increasing more rapidly than the Musalmans is Central Bengal, where the balance is turned in their favour by the immigration of Hindus from up-country to Calcutta and the 24-Parganas. The causes of the relatively more rapid growth of Musalmans were examined by Mr. Gait in 1901, and his conclusion was that it was due not to conversion but to greater fecundity. The contributory causes were found to be (1) the greater frequency of widow re-marriage, (2) less disparity in the ages of husband and wife, (3) a more nutritious dietary and (4) greater prosperity.

	VARIATION PER CENT., 1901—1911.		VARIATION IN PROPORTION PER MILLE OF TOTAL POPULATION, 1901—1911.	
	Hindu.	Musalman.	Hindu.	Musalman.
Bengal	+ 3·9	+ 10·4	− 17·7	+ 11·5
West Bengal	+ 1·7	+ 4·9	− 8·6	+ 2·7
Central Bengal	+ 5·2	+ 3·1	+ 3·6	− 6·3
North Bengal	+ 2·9	+ 8·2	− 18·3	+ 1·9
East Bengal	+ 6·6	+ 14·6	− 16·2	+ 13·8
Bihar and Orissa	+ 3·9	+ 4·0	− 9·9	− 1·0
North Bihar	+ 1·2	+ 3·3	− 5·8	+ 2·2
South "	+ 0·9	− 2·8	+ 1·7	− 3·3
Orissa	+ 0·6	+ 10·4	− 2·6	+ 2·4
Chota Nagpur Plateau	+ 12·1	+ 17·5	− 12·6	+ 1·3

444. In Bihar and Orissa there is practically no difference between the percentages of increase for members of the two religion since 1901, but this is partly due to the losses sustained by death among the Musalmans living in

towns. The figures for the Chota Nagpur Plateau are, moreover, misleading, for many who were returned as Hindus in 1901 are now returned as Animists. It is safer therefore to take a longer period for purposes of comparison. Taking the 30 years 1881—1911, we find that the ratio of increase among Musalmans has been 11 per cent., or only about 3 per cent. more than among Hindus. In South Bihar the adherents of Islam have decreased by over 7 per cent., whereas the Hindu community is stationary; but in every other division the growth of Musalmans has been relatively greater.

445. The most interesting points brought out by an examination of the figures for the last decennium is (1) that the growth of the Hindu population has been exactly the same in Bihar and Orissa as in Bengal and (2) that the growth of the Musalman population in Bihar and Orissa is very little greater than that of the Hindus in either Province and far below that of the Bengal Musalmans. The Bihari Musalman is in little better circumstances than his Hindu neighbour, though he has the advantage of more nourishing food. He is however a poor man compared with his co-religionist of East Bengal, and there is this further important difference that he favours early marriage, whereas the latter does not. The deleterious effects of early marriage are too well known to require explanation, and it will be sufficient to quote figures to show the difference in this respect between the Hindus and Musalmans of Bengal and the similarity between followers of those two religions in Bihar and Orissa. Out of every 100 Musalman females aged 10—15 in Bengal only 56 per cent. are married, whereas the proportion for Hindu females is as high as 67 per cent. In Bihar and Orissa, however, early marriage is nearly as common among the Musalmans as among the Hindus, the proportion of married women to the female population of this age period being 51 and 54 per cent., respectively.

446. Further light is thrown on the causes of the greater rapidity of growth among the Musalman community by the statistics for women at the child-bearing age, *i.e.*, 15 to 40. From the marginal statement, showing the percentage of unmarried, married and widowed to the total number of women at this age, it will be seen that there is a great difference between the social practices of Hindus and Musalmans in Bengal. There the number of married women among Musalmans is 11 per cent. greater than among Hindus, while there is a corresponding deficiency of Musalman widows. These differences are due to the greater prevalence of widow marriage among the followers of Islam. A very different state of affairs is found in Bihar and Orissa. In this Province there is very little difference between the proportional figures for Hindus and Musalmans, owing presumably to the greater prevalence of widow-marriage among the low castes and semi-Hinduized aboriginals, who bulk largely in the population.

	HINDU.			MUSALMAN.		
	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.	Unmarried.	Married.	Widowed.
Bengal	2	76	22	2	87	11
Bihar and Orissa ...	3	84	13	3	85	12

To this it should be added that in Bengal the actual number of women who are married, and have therefore the power to contribute to an increase of population, is much greater among the Musalmans, whereas in Bihar and Orissa Musalman married women are an insignificant minority. In Bengal there are approximately four married Musalman women to every three married Hindu women at the child-bearing age. It therefore follows that, if their fecundity were equal, the actual increase of the Musalmans would exceed that of the Hindus by about one-third. In Bihar and Orissa, on the other hand, the disproportion is very great, there being about 55 Hindu married women to every 6 Musalman married women. In view of their small numbers, and of the fact that the proportion per cent. of married women among them is almost exactly the same as among the Hindus, there is little prospect of the Musalmans in this Province multiplying more than the Hindu community.

	NUMBER OF MARRIED WOMEN AT THE AGE OF 15—40.	
	Hindu.	Musalman.
Bengal	3,238,185	4,183,288
Bihar and Orissa ...	5 463,307	636,498

447. The fecundity, however, of the Hindus is not so great as that of the Musalmans. Proof of this proposition, if any is required, is afforded by the marginal figures

FECUNDITY OF MUSALMANS.

showing the number of children who were under 10 years of age at the time of the census (*i. e.*, children born between 1901 and 1911 who were living at the time of the census) per 100 married females aged 15—40. It will be seen that the proportion of children among Musalmans is higher than among Hindus in every natural division except North Bengal, where it is the same, and West Bengal, where a large number of the Hindus are of aboriginal descent. It may fairly be inferred that the relative excess of children in the Muhammadan community is due to their greater fecundity. It may be added that the Animists are far more prolific, the number of children of the same age to 100 married females aged 15 to 40 being 200 in Bengal and 223 in Bihar and Orissa.

PROVINCE AND DIVISION.	NUMBER OF CHILDREN UNDER 10—		
	PER 100 MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40.		MUSALMANS (COLUMN 2) PER 100 HINDUS. (COLUMN 3)
	Musalmans.	Hindus.	
1.	2	3	4
Bengal	**188**	**171**	**110**
West Bengal	151	156	97
Central Bengal	168	166	101
North Bengal	194	194	100
East Bengal	194	178	109
Bihar and Orissa	**176**	**165**	**107**
North Bihar	177	161	110
South Bihar	162	160	101
Orissa	172	151	114
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	190	183	104

To sum up the main conclusions briefly, the absolute growth of Musalmans, in Bengal must be greater than that of the Hindus, because of (1) their numerical superiority, (2) their greater fecundity and (3) the larger number of married females at the child-bearing age. Their rate of growth must also be greater on account of the last two factors, and also because of social practices which favour reproduction, viz., widow marriage and, to a small extent, polygamy.

PHYSIQUE OF HINDUS AND MUSALMANS.

448. In order to ascertain whether there is any difference between the physique of Hindus and Musalmans which might throw light on their comparative physical powers, statistics have been compiled of the heights and weights of *healthy* prisoners, aged 20 to 45, on their admission to jail: prisoners were selected for the purpose, as there is no other means available either of getting a reliable record of age, weight and height, or of knowing that the persons examined are in good health. The result is to show that there is little difference between members of the two religions. The figures, however, may be of some anthropological interest and are, therefore reproduced in the margin, together with figures for aboriginal races, such as Kandhs (Khonds) Mundas, Oraons and Santals. Briefly they show that Hindu and Musalman males are almost exactly on the same level, both as regards height and weight, but tha the aboriginal is a smaller and lighter man. Among the women, Hindus and aboriginals closely approximate, but the Musalman woman is both shorter and lighter than either.

RELIGION.	MALES AVERAGE.			FEMALES AVERAGE.		
	No. examined.	Weight.	Height.	No. examined.	Weight	Height.
		Lbs. ozs.	Ft. in.		Lbs. ozs.	Ft. in.
Hindus ...	746	110 11	5 4¼	524	94 9	4 11⅛
Musalmans ...	719	111 2	5 4¼	390	94 5	4 10⅝
Aboriginals ...	181	105 5	5 3⅛	139	94 8	4 11⅛

The results for males, it may be added, are in consonance with the results of 28,000 observations made by Lieutenant-Colonel W. J. Buchanan, I.M.S., Inspector-General of Prisons, Bengal. As a result of these observations he deduced a formula showing what should be approximately the relation of weight to height in healthy adult male Bengalis and Beharis between the ages of 25 and 45. He took 100 lbs. to be the approximate standard weight of a man 5 feet high, and pointed out that the weight should increase 3 lbs. for every inch above that height up to 5 feet 7 inches.* This standard was intended for Hindus and Musalmans and does not apply to aboriginals.

ANIMISM.

449. Animism is a term applied, for want of a better, to that amorphous form of religion of which the basis is "the belief which explains to primitive man the constant movements and changes in the world of things by the theory that every object which has activity enough to affect him in any way

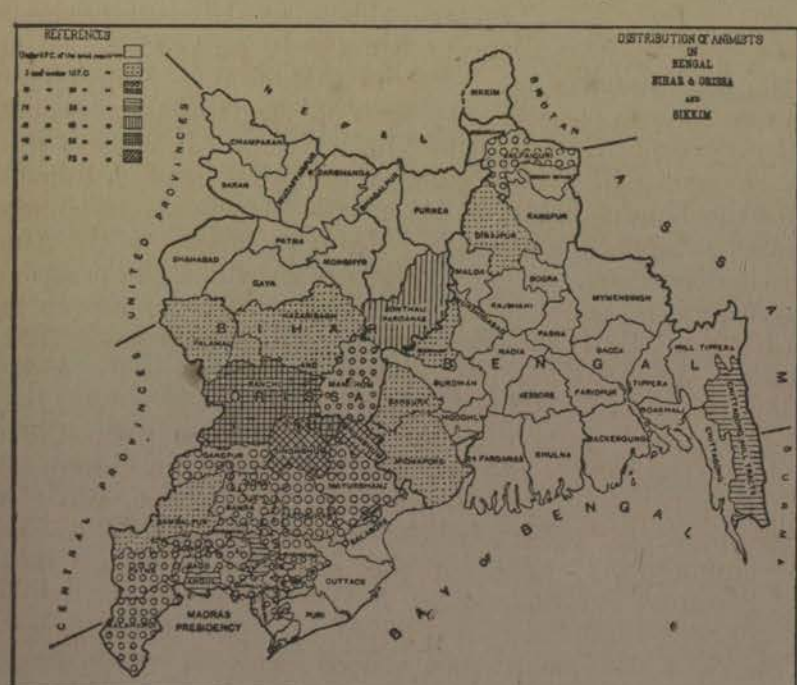
* *Manual of Jail Hygiene*, 1900

is animated by a life and will like his own."* It peoples the world with spirits, which have the power to influence man directly. They may be wandering spirits incapable of being represented by idols, or they may be resident in some object or body, either animate or inanimate: the latter becomes a 'fetish,' endowed with power to protect or injure man. According to Tiele, "the religions controlled by Animism are characterized first of all by a varied, confused and indeterminate doctrine, an unorganised polydæmonism, which does not, however, exclude the belief in a supreme spirit, though in practice this commonly bears but little fruit; and in the next place by magic, which but rarely rises to the level of real worship. . . . In the Animistic religions, fear is more powerful than any other feeling, such as gratitude or trust. The spirits and the worshippers are alike selfish. The evil spirits receive, as a rule, more homage than the good, the lower more than the higher, the local more than the general. The allotment of their rewards or punishments depends not on men's good or bad actions, but on the sacrifices and gifts which are offered to them or withheld."† The spirits are mostly malevolent, for the rude mind with difficulty associates the idea of power and benignity. Man lives surrounded by spirits inimical to his health and well-being, who must be periodically propitiated, either in order to ward off their hostility or to induce them to relinquish their victims. The Animist has consequently a firm belief in the functions and supernatural powers of sorcerers. The latter are not strictly priests, but merely diviners and exorcists: they do not form an organized order, nor is their function hereditary.

The number of spirits requiring proficiency is constantly being added to, and the process shows the recaptivity of the primitive mind to modern conditions. The Sauria Paharia of the Sonthal Parganas, for instance, ascribes epidemics of small-pox or cholera to evil spirits having been brought into his country by train. He exercises them by constructing a rude model of a train, which he wheels through the village into the jungle, thus symbolically casting the evil spirit out of the village. The Oraons again believe in a spirit known as Murkuri, *i.e.*, the thumper, which is believed to be imminent in Europeans. If illness or fever attacks a Oraon after he has been patted on the back by an ignorant, but sympathetic, European, he firmly believes that Murkuri has passed from the body of the European to his own.

DISTRIBUTION OF ANIMISTS.

450. Nearly half the total number of Animists in Bengal are residents of West Bengal, where nearly 300,000 (the majority of whom are Santals) are found in the lateritic districts of Birbhum, Bankura and Midnapore. The other Animistic centre consists of Malda, Dinajpur and Jalpaiguri, where there are over 238,000. Those in Malda and Dinajpur are mostly Santals from the Sonthal Parganas, who have migrated to the Barind, which is fast being cleared away by them. In Jalpaiguri they are chiefly tea-garden coolies from Chota Nagpur. The only other districts in which Animists are found in any considerable



* W. Crooke, Imperial Gazetteer of India (1907, Vol. I, p. 431)
† Outlines of the History of Ancient Religions, p. 10.

strength are Mymensingh and the Chittagong Hill Tracts, where they consist for the most part of Koches and Tiparas respectively.

In Bihar and Orissa the Animistic element is far stronger, the Animists numbering 2,720,288. Out of this number, however, all but 70,128 are inhabitants of the Chota Nagpur Plateau, which is a remote tract, the refuge of aboriginal races, over which neither Hindu civilization nor the Musalman power obtained any hold. They are found in greatest strength in the Sonthal Parganas and Ranchi, which between them contain nearly half the total number, but proportionately they are most numerous in Singhbhum, where they represent 56 per cent. of the population.

VARIATIONS SINCE 1901.

451. The number of Animists in Bengal has risen since 1901 by no less than 65 per cent. Here it is due almost entirely to immigration. In Hooghly, for instance, the number of Animists has increased eight-fold, viz., from 2,766 to 21,288, but only 2,851 were born in the district and 18,437 were new-comers, the great majority being Santals from Midnapore and Bankura, and nearly all the remainder Oraons from Ranchi. In Birbhum their number has risen to 54,592, but about two-thirds of them are Santal immigrants from the Sonthal Parganas. The immigration of Santals is also mainly responsible for the large increases in Malda, Rajshahi and Dinajpur, while in Jalpaiguri the addition of 88,769 is the combined result of natural growth, immigration, and the entry of the religion of aboriginal tribes being changed from Hindu to Animist. This change also accounts for the increase in Mymensingh, where the Garos are now returned as Animists, and in the Chittagong Hill Tracts, where similar returns were made for the Murungs, Kukis and Khamis, and also, to a large extent, for the Tiparas.*

452. In Bihar and Orissa the Animists have increased by 438,874 or 19·2 per cent. The increase is due partly to the natural growth of hardy and prolific aboriginals, and partly to variations of practice in recording their religion. The effect of these variations may be very clearly seen from the marginal figures, showing the increase or decrease per mille in the proportion of Animists and Hindus to the total population of six districts in the Chota Nagpur Plateau. These figures sufficiently indicate how the results are affected by the difficulty of distinguishing Hindus from Animists, and by the different standards adopted at each census. In four of the six districts, viz., Palamau, Manbhum, Singhbhum and the Sonthal Parganas, the proportional strength of the Hindus increased in 1901, and there was a corresponding decrease among Animists : the results are now exactly the reverse. In Hazaribagh, on the other hand, Animists increased at the cost of the Hindus in 1901, but at this census the tendency was to record aborginals or semi-aborginals as Hindus ; consequently, the Hindus have recovered their position. The only district in which the practice appears to have been uniform is Angul, where aboriginals were consistently returned as Animists both in 1901 and 1911 ; the result is that since 1891 the proportional strength of Animists has risen from 2 to 290 per mille, while that of Hindus has fallen from 997 to 708 per mille.

DISTRICT.	Animists.		Hindus.	
	1901—1911.	1891—1901.	1901—1911.	1891—1901.
Hazaribagh	- 19·4	+ 11·3	+ 17·3	- 14·7
Palamau	+ 8·7	- 30·3	- 6·5	+ 28·6
Manbhum	+ 56·4	- 59·9	- 62·6	+ 55·3
Singhbhum	+ 99·5	- 103·9	- 12·4	+ 5·6
Sonthal Parganas ...	+ 39·1	- 64·8	- 49·1	+ 47·9
Angul	+ 67·1	+ 220·6	- 67·5	- 221·4

In Manbhum the Animists have doubled their numbers since 1901, the actual increment being 106,868, or nearly a quarter of the total increase for the province. All but 11,436 of them were born in the district, and the increase, which appears *primâ facie* extraordinary, must be ascribed to the greater strictness of enumerators regarding the entry of religion. The increase in the Sonthal Parganas is a little under 100,000 (16 per cent.), while Ranchi and Singhbhum have additions of 11 and 15 per cent., respectively. In all three districts the census was carried out with great care, and the results must be attributed to a more correct entry of the religion of aboriginal tribes. The only district in Chota Nagpur in which there has been a decrease is Hazaribagh, where Animists have declined by

* Altogether 16,957 Tiparas were returned as Animists in this district, but not one in Hill Tippera.

15 per cent. This decline may point to the absorption of aboriginals by Hinduism, natural in a district which borders on Bihar, an ancient home of Brahmanism, and in which the inhabitants are mostly semi-Hinduized ; more probably, however, it should be ascribed to the standard of the enumerators being different from that of 1901. Outside the Chota Nagpur Plateau, the advance of Animists is greatest in Purnea, where 29,971 were enumerated as against 295 in 1901 : one-third of these were immigrants from the Sonthal Parganas. Their growth in Bhagalpur (from 3,060 to 22,515) is little less remarkable but here it is not dependent on immigration, the number of Animist immigrants being under 3,000, of whom 2,000 came from the Sonthal Parganas.

453. BUDDHISTS. A small minority of the Buddhists are Chinese, who have settled in Calcutta. Practically all the remainder are found in three widely separated tracts, viz., in the south-east of Bengal, in the extreme north of that province, and in Orissa. Their distribution is shown in the marginal statement, from which it will be seen that, so far from losing ground, Buddhism is making headway. The history of Buddhism in these three tracts is very different. In the south-eastern tract Buddhism is, to some extent, a survival of early Buddhism, which was introduced by Buddhists from Bengal or Bihar in the 10th century. When the Musalman conquest took place, a number of the Buddhists fled to the hills in the interior, where they converted the hill tribes. The majority of the Buddhists, however, are Maghs, mostly the descendants of Arakanese pirates who settled in Bengal during the 17th and 18th centuries, or of peaceful cultivators who migrated to Chittagong and the neighbouring districts at two different periods, viz., in 1638, when a revolution took place in Arakan, and at the close of the 18th century, when Arakan was conquered by the Burmese. The descendants of these later immigrants are known as Roang (*i.e.*, Arakan) Maghs. There is also another class known as Rajbansi or Barua Maghs, who are the offspring of Magh mothers and Bengali fathers and have followed their mothers' religion. Their Buddhism is strongly tinged both with Animism and Hinduism, but during the last half century there has been a revival, due to the preaching of Buddhist priests from Burma, and a Buddhist association has been started in order to preserve the purity of their faith.

	1911.	1901.
Chittagong Division	173,194	149,739
Backergunge	8,828	7,220
Hill Tippera	5,997	5,999
Total ...	***188,019***	***162,958***
Darjeeling	47,905	44,044
Sikkim	28,915	20,544
Jalpaiguri	8,054	6,291
Total ...	***84,874***	***70,879***
Cuttack	161	2
Puri	273	...
Orissa States	1,431	717
Total ...	***1,865***	***719***

454. The Buddhism of the northern area is also a curious mixture. Its adherents belong to three different races, viz., the Nepalese, Bhotias and Lepchas. The Buddhism of the Nepalese dates back to the days when it was the religion of Northern India, but it is overlaid with Hinduistic and Animistic beliefs and practices. The Buddhists of Nepal took over the whole body of Animistic deities, both benevolent and malignant, while from the Hindus they adopted not only Saivism but also Saktism, with Tantric mysticism and the esoteric cult of female deities. The Buddhism of the Bhotias and Lepchas was introduced by Lamas from Tibetan monasteries, who travelled south and converted the people. In it can be traced the pre-Buddhistic beliefs of the Tibetans known as the Bonpo religion, which is little more than demonolatory. "The rites of religion are chiefly valuable in averting the anger or malice of an evil spirit, and all sickness is caused by such possession. The *Bongtno* or sacrificial priest is the cunning expert who indicates the offended demon, and prescribes the proper sacrifice of cow or pig or goat or fowl needed to appease him. As a perpetual offering to ward off danger, each household keeps a little basket containing rice and a small silver coin."* If the family's resources are so exhausted that they cannot keep the basket full, they will, in simple faith, deposit a few grains of rice, wrapped up in a leaf, as a pledge to be redeemed when better days come.

* Rev. J. Graham D.D., *On the Threshold of Three Closed Lands.*

455. The Buddhists in Orissa are nearly all Saraks, of whom 1,833 returned their religion as Buddhism, their distribution being as shown in the margin. Attention was first drawn to the Buddhistic Saraks of Orissa by Mr. Gait in the Bengal Census Report of 1901, in which he pointed out that Sarak is derived from *Sravaka*, the Sanskrit word for "a hearer," which was used by the Buddhists for the second class of monks, who mainly occupied the monasteries. At the census of 1901 only the Saraks of Baramba were shown as Buddhists, the others being entered as Hindus, though those of Tigiria and Cuttack claimed to have the same religion as their caste fellows. The Saraks, who are also known as Saraki Tantis, are mostly weavers, though some have taken to cultivation. They worship Buddha, together with the Brahmanic deities, and eat neither flesh nor fish. They neither employ Brahman priests nor observe Hindu festivals, but have a festival of their own on the full moon day of Baisakh and Kartik, the latter being the anniversary of the day of Buddha's birth, death and attainment of Nirvana.

Cuttack	...	161
Puri	...	272
Orissa States	...	1,400
Baramba	...	*773*
Tigiria	...	*412*
Dhenkanal	...	*200*
Athgarh	...	*15*

456. The number of Sikhs enumerated in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa is 4,499, or 13 times as many as in 1901. Of the total number 932 are immigrants enumerated in Calcutta, and 1,185 (or over half the aggregate for Bihar and Orissa) are inhabitants of Shahabad, the greater number (1,071) belonging to the town of Sasaram. An old Sikh community has been established in this town for many generations.* They are Agraharis by caste and mostly traders by occupation, and have traditions pointing to migration from the Punjab, while their physique and features point to a northern origin. There has been a revival of Sikhism among them since 1901,* as a result of which the Sikh tenets have been more strictly observed. A school has been started at which instruction is given in the Sikh scriptures, and many of their neighbours have embraced their religion. Altogether, 548 Agraharis were recorded as Sikhs, and the remainder belong mainly to castes of artificers and traders, notably Kaseras, Sonars and Kasarwanis. There is another small community of Sikhs in Patna city, where one of the sacred shrines of the Sikhs commemorates the birth-place of Guru Govind Singh. A third isolated section is found in Hazaribagh, where there is a Sikh temple (*sangat*) at Chatra, the founder of which is said to have been a descendant of a disciple of Nanak himself. A further note on the Sikhs of Bihar will be found in the second part of this chapter.

SIKHS.

457. Since 1901 the number of Jains has risen from 7,831 to 11,411, of whom 6,782 were enumerated in Bengal and 4,629 in Bihar and Orissa. The great majority are Marwari immigrants engaged in mercantile pursuits, who leave their wives at home: there are approximately eight males to every three females. There are comparatively few indigenous Jains, though Bihar was the birth-place of their religion. Its founder, Mahavira, was born at Vaisali (the modern Basarh in the district of Muzaffarpur), spent a great part of his life in Bihar proclaiming his doctrines, and died at Apapapuri (the modern Pawapuri in the Patna district). Ancient Jain shrines in Patna city, Rajgir and Pawapuri still attract Jain pilgrims, and there are small Jain colonies there and also in Hazaribagh, where the Parasnath mountain commemorates the Nirvana of Parsvanath, the 24th Jaina: nearly one-fourth of the Jains in Bihar and Orissa were enumerated in the two districts of Patna and Hazaribagh. The Jains appear once to have had a number of settlements in the neighbourhood of Parasnath, notably in Manbhum and Singhbhum. Jain traditions refer to the travels of Mahavira in the surrounding territory, and local legend also attests their presence, for the people still speak of the rule of the Sarawaks or Saraks and point to the temples they built. Jain remains are found in Manbhum, while in Singhbhum their copper mines may be seen in different parts of the country. These early Jains were the Sravaka or Jain laymen engaged in secular pursuits, and their descendants are still known as Saraks, though they no longer follow the Jain religion.†

JAINS.

* In 1901 they were returned as Hindus.

† *See* Bengal Census Report of 1901, pp. 427-8, Muzaffarpur District Gazetteer, pp. 13-14, Patna District Gazetteer, pp. 20, 21, 61, 215, Singhbhum District Gazetteer, pp. 23—25, Manbhum District Gazetteer, pp. 48—52, and Notes on the Geography of Old Bengal by M. M. Chakravarti, J. A. S. B., 1908, pp. 285-6.

There are three main sects of Jains known as Digambars, Swetambars and Sthanakdwasis. The Digambars hold that all the Tirthankars went about naked and that Mahavira himself prescribed absolute nudity, at least for ascetics (*sadhus*). They do not clothe their images and they divest themselves of their upper garments when eating: they also believe that women cannot attain Nirvana. The Swetambars, on the other hand, hold the doctrine of nudity, but assert that the use of white clothes was prescribed. They decorate their images with clothes and jewellery, and do not deny women the hope of salvation. The Sthanakdwasis (also known as Dhundias) are an offshoot of the Swetambars, who differ from them mainly in denouncing idolatry, with its accompanying ritual and ceremony, and in denying the efficiency of pilgrimages as a means of shaking off the bondage of *karma*. In their view man can only attain spiritual development and final emancipation by self control, purity of conduct and self-sacrifice.

BRAHMOS.

458. The number of Brahmos in both provinces is 3,543 or only 372 more than in 1901, a fact which shows that this sect is attracting few fresh recruits. The actual numbers, however, give no idea of the extent to which the Brahmo doctrines have spread. Though they have not permeated, they have profoundly influenced the intellectual Hindus of Bengal, and many thousands are Brahmos at heart, but not in name. With the diffusion of higher ideas, for which the Brahmo Samaj is partly responsible, and with the spread of English education and more frequent intercourse with Europe and America, the modernist Hindu feels no particular necessity to secede from the main body of his co-religionists and enrol himself as a Brahmo. There is now a considerable body of persons, calling themselves or called by others Neo-Hindus, among whom there is a place for a monotheist who desires to throw off the trammels of caste and to put his views of social reform into practice. There is greater tolerance towards the heterodox, and among the latter the spirit of revolt which led to the establishment of the Brahmo Samaj is dying out. The present tendency is for Brahmos to be re-absorbed in the main body of Hindus. Those who still proclaim themselves Brahmos are mainly townsmen; only 574 Brahmos were enumerated in rural areas, and 1,529, or 43 per cent. of the total number, were inhabitants of Calcutta.

There are three sections of Brahmos, viz., the Adi Samaj, the Nababidhan Samaj and the Sadharan Samaj. The Adi Samaj, or "original association", lays greater stress on renunciation of idolatry than on social reforms, and keeps to the caste system so far as possible, *i.e.*, so far as it does not conflict with religious belief. Its members call themselves Theistic Hindus, the main differences between them and other Hindus being that they are monotheists. The Nababidhan Samaj or New Dispensation, founded by Keshab Chandra Sen, is less conservative and more electic. It does not find inspiration only in Hindu works, but in the scriptures of other religions. The most progressive and influential section is the Sadharan (common) Samaj, which repudiates caste distinctions and holds advanced views regarding social practices, such as the zenana system, the position of women, etc. This is, in fact, much more of a distinct sect than the other two branches, and most Brahmos belong to it. Altogether 2,444 or over two-thirds of total number of Brahmos returned their caste as Brahmo, *i.e.*, they disclaimed the Hindu caste system, and most of them may be assumed to be members of the Sadharan Samaj. Of the remainder, more than half were Kayasths, and less than one-fourth were Baidyas: the members of other castes numbered only 237.

ARYA SAMAJ.

459. The Arya Samaj is a sect which has made its appearance in the local returns of religion since the last census, and now numbers 4,085. As is well known, this sect was founded by Dayananda Saraswati, who inculcated monotheism and proclaimed the infallibility of the Vedas. The Aryas claim the latter as authority for their tenets, and their aim is to purge Hinduism of what they consider later accretions. They repudiate polytheism, idolatry and the sacrifice of animals, and, on the social side, denounce the evils of early marriage, have no objection to the remarriage of widows, and advocate the reform of the caste system. The Samaj has practically no adherents in Bengal, but has made headway in Bihar notably in Patna, where four-fifths of the total number are found. The establishment of the Samaj in this district owes its origin to Dayananda

Saraswati himself. He first visited Patna and Dinapore in 1872, and discussed religious subjects, such as the attributes of God, the worship of idols and the marriage of children, with the local Pandits. He is said to have spoken in Sanskrit and made but little impression in the limited and conservative circle he addressed. Five or six years later he revisited Dinapore and delivered a series of lectures decrying polytheism, idol-worship, infant marriage, enforced widowhood, prostitution, the use of intoxicants, the eating of flesh, gambling, litigation, dishonesty in its various forms, etc. At the same time he inculcated monotheism, salvation by one's own actions (*karma*), chastity, adult marriage, vegetarianism, total abstinence from wine, etc. This time he preached in Hindi, the local vernacular, and succeeded in winning a number of converts. An Arya Samaj was established at Dinapore, and the new doctrines thence spread to Bankipore and villages in the interior. Some schools and an orphanage called the "Dayananda Orphanage" have been established at Dinapore, but the majority of the Aryas are found in the Phulwari thana, which accounts for 2,575, or over three-fourths of the total number (3,363) in the district. Unlike the United Provinces, where the Samaj is largely recruited from the educated classes, and where the higher castes preponderate among its members, the Aryas of Patna are mostly members of the lower castes, such as Kurmis, Kahars, etc.; its doctrines have found favour with only a limited number of Hindus and Musalmans of the higher classes. The explanation is that the theory of the submergence of caste in the Arya community appeals most to the lower classes, who regard the new system as improving their position and bringing them on a level with the upper classes. Moreover, the custom of widow marriage was already an established custom with many of them, and the sanction given to this practice by the new faith was no small attraction.

KUMBHIPATIAS.

460. The Kumbhipatia sect, which has hitherto not found a place in the returns for religion in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, appears to have first attracted notice about 1874. The leader of the sect at this time was one Mukund Das. who spent some years at Puri as an Achari Vaishnava, and between 1840 and 1850 established himself at Joranda near the Kapilas hill in the Dhenkanal State. There he led a life of austerity, tending the sick pilgrims who came to the shrine. After living in retreat for many years, he appeared as the apostle of a new faith. He proclaimed that the idols worshipped by the Hindus were merely stone and wood, and that the worship of such destructible articles was of no avail. The Creator of the Universe was Alekh or Mahima, a spiritual being without form, omnipresent and omniscient, and the road to salvation lay in his worship. The former of these two names means the inexpressible or indescribable, while the latter signifies glorious. Mukund himself became known as the Mahima Guru or Mahima Swami, and his disciples as the Kumbhipatias, because they, like Mukund Das himself, used the bark (*nat*) of the *kumbhi* or yellow cotton tree (*Cochlospermum gossypium*) to cover their nakedness. He also denounced the caste system, and would eat food cooked by any one except a Raja, a Brahman, a Bhandari and a Dhoba—the Raja because he was responsible for the sins committed in the State, the Brahman because he accepted gifts from sinful persons, the Bhandari because he shaved sinners, and the Dhoba because he washed their clothes. He would not enter anybody's house, but used to take his food on the public road in a broken earthen pot. He moved about from village to village, never staying more than one night at one place. He taught his disciples and followers to bathe early in the morning and to make obeisance to Alekh at sunrise and again at sunset, turning their faces to the sun and prostrating themselves seven times in the morning and five times in the evening. He also enjoined them not to eat anything after sunset and before sunrise, and not to take any medicine in case of illness. He died in 1875 and was buried at Joranda in Dhenkanal. As he was regarded as an incarnation of the deity and believed to be immortal, his death came as a shock to his followers. Some renounced the new faith, but others remained faithful, and fresh life was given to the cult by a new leader called Bhima Bhoi.

461. Bhima Bhoi was born about 1855 and belonged to a poor Kandh (Khond) family in Sonpur, being employed as in his boyhood as a cattle herd. Though born blind and unable to read and write, he was possessed of considerable natural powers and had no small poetical ability. On attaining

maturity he began to compose verses, in the form of prayers to the deity, which his followers regarded as inspired and committed to writing. These verses are in easy flowing Oriya, and it is said that their style would do credit to a scholar. At an early age he became a follower of Mukund Das, and on his death became one of the leaders of the sect. His disciples increased rapidly, especially in Sambalpur, where men of all classes and castes, except the Brahmans, embraced the new faith: a few Brahmans also threw away their sacred threads, but such cases were exceptional. In 1880 Bhima Bhoi signalized his crusade by an outrage committed in the Jagannath temple. He was inspired by the belief that if the image of Jagannath was destroyed, it would convince the Hindus of the futility of their religion and they would embrace the true faith. In obedience to his command, a body of Kumbhipatias, mostly residents of Sambalpur, marched to Puri, and tried to break into the shrine of Jagannath. A struggle ensued, in which one of them was killed. Some of his followers fell away, partly on account of this failure and partly because of the conduct of Bhima Bhoi himself. A woman with whom he consorted became pregnant, and Bhima Bhoi endeavoured to deceive his followers by telling them that the woman would give birth to Arjun, who would root out all unbelievers. When the child was born, they found, to their surprise, that the woman had given birth to a girl. Bhima accounted for this by saying that it had been revealed to him that the child would be a female, who would destroy the unbelievers by means of her charms. The child, however, died a few days later. Bhima then gave out that she was a fairy, who quitted this world because she found it filled with vice. He was now deserted by a number of his followers, who formed a separate faction, but was still adored and honoured by the remainder. He eventually died in 1895 at Khaliapali in the Sonpur State, which is a centre of the cult.

462. The Kumbhipatias are divided into two sections, viz., the Sannyasis who are ascetics, and the Ashrikas or laymen. The former renounce the world and are celibates. Their life is moddled on that led by their master, the Mahima Swami. Like him, they beg from door to door, have no caste, and take their food only during the day-time at an open place beside a public road. They eat food cooked by people of any caste except a Raja, Brahman, Bhandari and Dhoba, and will not stay anywhere for more than a day, or beg twice from the same house. They do not bathe, have long matted hair, and wear only a girdle of bark or cloth. The Ashrikas or laymen do not renounce the world or married life, but, like certain monastic orders, wear clothes coloured with *geru* (yellow ochre). They do not observe Hindu ceremonies and will not eat anything between sunset and sunrise. They do not kill any animal for food, but eat fish, and the flesh of goat and deer, if supplied by others. They remain in caste and observe caste restrictions, except as regards eating together, for one Kumbhipatia will eat with another without distinction of caste. A Kumbhipatia may marry one of the same caste who is not a Kumbhipatia, but where their number is sufficient, the Ashrikas in each caste tend to form a separate community, having no intercourse with the other members of the caste. Their marriage ceremonies are very simple. The marriage is performed on the road outside the bride's house and is accompanied by oblations to Alekh and invocations of that sacred name. They bury their dead in a sitting posture with the face to the east. Mourning lasts ten days, and on the eleventh day the family undergoes a ceremony of purification. They change their cooking pots, and wash their whole body, including their teeth, and all their garments with water in which cowdung has been steeped; they also drink the urine of a calf mixed with cowdung water.

463. In several respects there appears to be traces of Buddhism in the cult. Bhima Bhoi himself called his *guru*, the Mahima Swami, an *avatar* of Buddha, and several indications of a Buddhistic belief have been brought to light by Babu Nagendra Nath Basu in his recent book *Modern Buddhism in Orissa*. According to information gathered by him, even the attack on the Puri temple was due to the desire to bring to light the image of Buddha, and he points out that the scriptures of the sect are full of Buddhistic references, such as the statement—"In the Kaliyuga the devotees are passing their lives in disguise, though they have not yet seen the form of the incarnation of Buddha, in the hope that the *gaddi* (seat) of the Sunya will be established in the Province of Bihar. The Alekh will, through his creative

power, assume the form of a human being, in the incarnation of Buddha, for the good of his devotees, who will thus attain emancipation." Briefly his conclusion is: "The Mahimadharmists of the Garhjats of Orissa are simply Buddhists. Like other Buddhists of the Mahayana School they are passing their days in the firm belief and hope that Buddha will again be incarnated." The traditions of the Kumbhipatias, as well as their present practices, point to some connection with the early Buddhists or Jains. They say that in the early ages saints, who did not cover their nakedness with so much as a rag or the bark of a tree, came to the hilly tracts of Orissa and were merciful to the sinners who lived like beasts in the forests, tending their sick and distressed: this, it will be remembered, was also the practice of Mukund Das. They, at length, gave up the cult of nakedness in obedience to a Mahima Guru, who bade his disciples wear the bark of the *kumbhi* tree. The fact that the Kumbhipatias now wear the yellow garb of the Jains and Buddhists, and, like the Jains, do not take any meal after sunset, lend colour to the conjecture that the nude sages of the tradition were Digambara Jains: Jains, as is well known, were common in parts of Chota Nagpur and Orissa at an early period.

464. It is extremely difficult to obtain reliable information regarding the esoteric beliefs of the sect, as they are revealed only to the initiated, but from the enquiries made by Mr. B. C. Mazumdar of Sambalpur, who succeeded in gaining the confidence of some Kumbhipatias, they appear to be as follows. The soul of the father is reincarnated in his son. To attain salvation, one should not be reborn. Man is sinful, because he does not repress his sexual instincts. Perfection is attained when one is free from all sexual desire. Every morning the Kumbhipatias have to give themselves up to absorbed contemplation on the organs of generation, without any feeling of such desire. For the specially initiated, strict celibacy is essential.* Others may marry and beget children, but they must only have intercourse with their wives at periods favourable for the fertilization of the ovum. If they observe this rule, though they beget children and must therefore be born again, they will be free from sexual passion, and attain salvation at the next birth. Initiation confers a secret virtue by which man and woman are rendered incapable of procreation, even though there may be sexual union. God is an unseen power manifested by the organs of generation, but is not to be identified with them or their functions. God is, in fact, an omnipresent creative energy, but is not visible or expressible, and is therefore called Alekh. These doctrines are certainly not Buddhistic but phallic.

465. The history and practices of the sect reveal a strong antagonism to Hinduism and the Brahmans. Mukund Das appealed to the lower and middle classes, decried the caste system, and inveighed against the forms of worship practised by orthodox Hindus. Bhima Bhoi, himself of low caste, is said to have openly reviled the religious system of the Hindus, and, whatever his motive, attacked the temple of Jagannath. The Kumbhipatias do not worship the Hindu gods and goddesses, and will not eat food cooked in the house of a Brahman. Some, like the Jains, will not bathe, not because there is any fear of their inadvertently taking life, but because they declare that true purity is purity of mind, and Brahmanic ablutions are of no avail. They do not cremate their dead, as they do not believe in the purity of fire, but bury them. Men of all castes are admitted into their ranks. Though they only marry within their castes, they do not observe other caste restrictions among themselves.

466. The total number of Kumbhipatias who returned their religion as such at the census was only 755, of whom most were residents of Sambalpur, Angul and the States of Athgarh, Keonjhar and Dhenkanal. There is reason, however, to believe that their number is much greater than would appear from the returns. From Balasore it is reported that Alekh worship has spread among the lower class Oriyas. A number of monasteries *(maths)* of the sect are also said to be in existence in Cuttack, as well as in a number of the Orissa States, viz., Mayurbhanj, Keonjhar, Dhenkanal, Baud, Daspalla, Talcher, Sonpur, Pal Lahara, Athmallik, Rairakhol and Kalahandi. The total number of Kumbhipatias has, in fact, been estimated at not less than 25,000.†

*Bhima Bhoi himself had two children (both still alive), a boy and a girl, and explained to his horrified followers that he brought them into the world in order to create an ideal man and an ideal woman.

† Nagendra Nath Basu, *Modern Buddhism in Orissa* (1911), pp. 170—2.

The chief centre of pilgrimage is Joranda, where the Mahima Guru died and was buried. Here an annual gathering is held on the full moon-day of Magh, when the faithful Mahimas and also orthodox Hindus make offerings at his tomb. The offerings chiefly consist of money, tobacco, cigars, *ghi* and cocoanuts. The Guru was very fond of smoking, and hence tobacco and cigars are considered the most acceptable offerings. The cigars, after being offered, are distributed to the votaries, who smoke them as *prasad*.

467. The members of the sect belong to a number of different Oriya castes, the most strongly represented being Chasas, Koltas, Khairas, Gandas and Gonds : only three Brahmans returned themselves as Kumbhipatias. The cult is known indiscriminately as Alekh, Mahima or Kumbhipatia, the meanings of which have already been explained. The term Kumbhipatia, however, is, in some places, a misnomer. The Mahima Guru is said to have told his 64 disciples that they could wear cloth instead of bark. After his death the followers of Bhima Bhoi and Gobind Das (another disciple) took to clothes dyed yellow, while others kept to the old custom. Others again wore the yellow robe, but put a bark girdle round the waist.

468. One section, also called Alekh, which is reported from Puri, is said to be distinct from other sections, but their doctrines seem much the same. Their founder is said to have been one Artratran Das, who flourished about 60 years ago. Like Bhima Bhoi, he preached the doctrines of Alekh, the formless one, and denounced idolatry. He similarly composed religious poems, besides giving utterance to mysterious sayings (*malika*). When disease, drought, etc., come, the people refer to these sayings as prophetic. His immediate followers were given a staff and long conical cap to wear, and these insignia are worn by their modern successors. He set up a number of *gadis* or seats of the formless deity, which appear to consist merely of shapeless mounds of earth. Offerings made there were eaten together by his disciples without regard to caste distinctions, and this practice is still kept up to some extent.

469. The Birsaits form, according to the census returns, a microscopic sect in Chota Nagpur, but there is reason to believe that their number is really greater, for in one district, at least, those Mundas who described themselves as Birsaits were entered in the schedules as Animists. The founder of the cult was one Birsa, a Munda, who was educated in the German Mission School at Chaibasa. He was apparently at first a Lutheran Christian, but apostacized : as will be shown later, he derived a number of his ideas from the Christian teaching he had received. In 1895, while still a youth, he appeared in Ranchi as the preacher of a new faith, and his doctrines, which were largely political, spread rapidly owing to the agrarian unrest prevalent among the Mundas. For many years the latter had been seething with discontent in consequence of the encroachments of Dikkus, *i.e.*, foreigners (Hindus or Musalmans), who ousted them from their lands and robbed them of cherished rights. There had been persistent agitation among them, as a result of which they put forward claims extending to the absolute proprietorship of the soil, subject only to payment of Government revenue. Their rights, it was urged, were those of the first-comers inherited from their forefathers, the transmission of such rights being exemplified in the story of Abraham. This agitation—the *Sardari Larai*, as it was called—was at its height when Birsa came on the scene. By representing himself as divine, he obtained unbounded influence, and under his control the movement assumed a two-fold character, political and religious. He tried to stem the progress of Christianity among the aboriginals by forming a new religious sect or caste, to include, among others, perverts from Christianity. The main object of the movement however remained the same, viz., the assertion of the supposed ancient rights of the aborigines in the soil and over the jungles, the motive idea being that by an organised revolt they would be able to upset the authority of Government, and, by the institution of a reign of terror, compel submission to their demands.

BIRSAITS.

470. Birsa took advantage of a violent thunderstorm, when lightning struck the ground near him, to declare that he had received a divine message—an idea prompted, no doubt, by his memory of God speaking to the Israelites from Mount Sinai amid thunder and lightning. He followed this up by

various tricks which invested him with a reputation for supernatural powers. He shut himself up in his house and gave out that he ate only once in eight days, being sustained miraculously from heaven. He said that he was going up to heaven and would not be seen again on earth for so many days, during which, of course, he hid himself. He next proclaimed himself an incarnation of the deity (Bhagwan), who had come as the saviour of all persons who joined his standard; those who did not join him were doomed to destruction. As a visible proof of his pretensions, he painted himself with turmeric and showed himself at a window in the dusk, after which it was given out that his body frequently changed into the colour of gold, this being supposed to be a sign of divinity. He also claimed divine powers of healing. A mother brought him her sick child; Birsa mumbled some prayers and laid his hand on the child's head. The child actually recovered, though not immediately, and the mother declared that it was caused by Birsa's prayer—in fact, that he had performed a miracle. People flocked in from all parts, bringing their sick, and in many cases their dead, but Birsa performed no more miracles: to account for his failure, he told the people that their faith was too weak. In a few months the bulk of both the Oraon and Munda population in Ranchi were convinced Birsaits, and Christians even became disciples of the new redeemer.

471. His preaching was a strange medley of admonitions in favour of purity and asceticism, and of injunctions to his followers to defy the Government and its officers. The worship of idols and devils must be abandoned. There is but one God, he said, and to him alone worship is due. This doctrine appealed to the Mundas, as they said it was an economical religion, saving them the expense of sacrifices. Thursday (Brihaspati, which he translated as the birthday of Birsa) was set aside for the worship of God, and work was forbidden, as on the Christian Sunday. Birsa had no definite ritual, but prayed to God in a style based on his recollections of Christian prayers. His followers had to wear a sacred string, the *paitha*, as a distinctive mark, men round the neck and women in their hair. When questioned by his followers on the subject of marriage, he said that they could not have more than one wife, but took two wives himself. He inveighed against the sins of stealing, lying, murder, etc., and ordained that white pigs and white fowls were unclean; when he issued a proclamation that they should be destroyed, his orders were obeyed in the Munda households throughout the district. He also foretold a deluge which would destroy all but those round him. It was wasted labour therefore to continue to weed the crops, and as the people would have no further need of cattle for ploughing, etc., they should turn them all loose. The Government money would be turned to water, and it was useless to keep it: the people should therefore at once spend all they had in purchasing clothes. In consequence of these instructions cultivation among the Mundas was stopped, thousands of cattle were turned loose into the jungles, and all the clothes available at local markets were rapidly bought up.

472. His teaching became gradually more and more political and incendiary, its refrain being that the people were to rise, drive out or slay all foreigners, and establish the Munda Raj. Birsa would lead them to victory: if the Government tried to oppose him, its guns would be turned into wood, and its bullets into water. No one in future was to obey the Government, but Birsa; no one was to pay rent any more, as all land was to be rent-free. He was arrested, tried and convicted to 2½ years' imprisonment. On the night he went to jail an incident occurred which was regarded as an omen and did much for his cause. It was raining heavily, and an old tool shed in the jail compound collapsed. This was taken to be a sign of God's anger at Birsa's incarceration, and the news spread like wildfire. By the time it got to Birsa's own part of the country, rumour had it that the jail walls had fallen in and that Birsa was coming back to his people. He was released in 1897 on the occasion of the Jubilee of Queen Victoria, and promptly resumed his campaign. He gathered some of his followers at the old Hindu temple in Chutia, a suburb of Ranchi, desecrated the images in the temple, and held a dance in its precincts. Some of his men were captured by the police, but Birsa managed to escape, and for some time kept to the jungles in the south of Ranchi and in Singhbhum. Meetings were held

by night in the jungle, always in different places, and with every precaution against surprise. The final outbreak took place on Christmas Eve, 1899, when the Christians were attacked simultaneously in various places from Ranchi to Chakradharpur. The Birsaits burnt their houses and in the glare of the fires shot down with their arrows those who came out; they were even bold enough to attack the European missionaries at various mission stations. The authorities took prompt action and the revolt was quickly suppressed, Birsa having, however, some skirmishes with the troops before he took to flight. There were a large number of women among his followers, who did good work in the fighting line. Birsa himself showed no lack of courage, but was never hit. On one occasion, he painted his face with gold saying that he was the Messiah, and exposed himself on a rock during heavy rifle fire to show that he could not be killed. Whenever any of his followers was struck, he invariably told them that it was due to the weakness of their faith. Birsa was eventually tracked down and captured, but, before his trial was concluded, died in prison in June 1900 at the early age of 22 or 24.

473. The Mundas had, and have, a firm belief in his supernatural powers. While he was in jail, no Munda believed he was really confined. They alleged that he had gone up to heaven, and that the authorities had only a clay figure in jail, which they pretended was Birsa. When, after his release from jail, he disappeared for about nine months, it was given out that he had left the earth for a time, but would return again. Some Mundas even now do not believe that he is really dead, and steadfastly expect his return. There is said to be a movement to induce his younger brother to revive the cult, but the latter has not the enterprise or enthusiasm of Birsa, and the Birsa religion seems doomed to die of inanition.

KHERWAR MOVEMENT.

474. A similar movement in the Sonthal Parganas is that known as the Kherwar movement. Kherwar, according to the Santals, was their original name, and the aim of the movement is a return to the golden age when the Kherwars worshipped God (Chando) only and were undisputed lords of the soil. It appears to have been first noticed in 1871, when a Santal named Bhagrit (Hinduized as Bhagirath) set up as a religious teacher, exhorting the Santals to give up eating pigs and fowls, as well as the drinking of liquor, and to abandon the worship of Marang Buru for that of the one true God. The burden of his preaching, however, was that the land belonged to the Santals, and no rent should be paid for it. He used to have a tray loaded with grain carried round at his meetings and would ask who made the grain. The reply would be Chando or God. He would next ask "Who cultivated the grain"? The answer would be "We cultivated the grain." Bhagirath then would say: "If we cultivated the grain and God made it, why should we pay rent"? His adherents were to be known as Kherwars or Safahor (clean men), and were to rise at a given signal and drive all non-Kherwars, *i.e.*, foreigners of all kinds, out of the land. After this he would reign over them, his subjects being called upon to pay a plough tax of one anna per plough and no rents or taxes. He was eventually arrested, convicted and imprisoned, and the movement collapsed. It has, however, been revived more than once, and from time to time new *babajis* have sprung up, who are credited with thaumaturgic powers, such as the power of curing disease, procuring offspring for the childless, etc. There are still many Safahor in the district, who will not eat pigs and fowls or drink intoxicating liquor, but worship Mahadeo and never kill animals except in sacrifice. In this and other respects there is a decided tendency to adopt Hinduistic practices, but many of the *babajis* have been pervert Christians and their teaching shows traces of Christian influences. The movement is especially apt to revive in times of scarcity when the people attribute their misfortunes to their having fallen from a state of pristine purity when they worshipped only one God.*

JEWS.

475. There are altogether 2,018 Jews in the two provinces, of whom 1,919 are resident in Calcutta. They consist of two main classes, viz., domiciled Jews and Asiatic immigrants. Among the former a certain number are European Jews, some of

* Further details will be found in the Sonthal Parganas Gazetteer, pp. 145—157.

whom are Sephardim, *i.e.*, descendants of the Spanish Jews that were driven out of Spain by the Inquisition. The higher classes are Anglicized, and some of their members have risen to distinguished positions in the world of commerce or in the service of the State. The latter are mostly new-comers from Arabia or Asiatic Turkey, who when they arrive are ignorant of English. Nearly one-third of the Jews in Calcutta returned their language as English, and practically all the rest spoke either Hebrew or Arabic. Three-fifths were born in Calcutta, and one-sixth in Arabia.

ZOROASTRIANS AND CONFUCIANS.

476. The other religions have comparatively few representatives and are foreign to Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. The Zoroastrians consist of Parsi traders from the west of India. The Confucians are Chinese who have come to Bengal in increasing numbers since 1901. Nearly all the latter are found in Calcutta, where there is a growing Chinese colony composed mainly of boot-makers and carpenters. In this city the Chinese aggregate 2,560, who are nearly equally divided between Buddhism and Confucianism.

RACES AND SECTS OF CHRISTIANS.

RACES OF CHRISTIANS.

477. In Bihar and Orissa 6,224 persons were returned under the head of Europeans and allied races (*i.e.*, Australians, Americans, etc.), the number of Armenians and Anglo-Indians* being 92 and 3,405 respectively. In Bengal all three communities are much more strongly represented, there being 24,388 persons who are Europeans or members of allied races, 1,063 Armenians and 19,833 Anglo-Indians. Their greater strength in the Presidency is due to Calcutta, which accounts for 55 per cent. of the Europeans and allied races, 77 per cent. of the Armenians and 71 per cent. of the Anglo-Indians in Bengal. Bihar and Orissa contains more than thrice as many Indian Christians as the latter Province.

EUROPEANS.

478. The number of Europeans is artificially inflated by Anglo-Indians returning themselves as Europeans. Special inquiries were made in selected towns where there is a considerable Anglo-Indian community, and it was ascertained that three-tenths of the persons who called themselves Europeans, were really Anglo-Indians. The returns in railway settlements were far more accurate, there being a misdescription of race in only one-tenth of the entries. This greater degree of accuracy is probably the effect of the railway authorities keeping a register in which their employés are classified as Europeans and East Indians,† and also to the fact that the census staff is composed of railway officers whom the Anglo-Indian subordinate has no chance of deceiving.

479. Nine-tenths of the Europeans are British subjects, and among them the most numerous are the English. The marginal statement shows the strength of the chief European nationalities in Bihar and Orissa and in Calcutta: figures for Bengal are not available as statistics of European nationalities were not compiled in Eastern Bengal. In the two provinces* 14,751 persons, or nearly half the total number of Europeans, were born in the United Kingdom, and of these 11,028 returned England or Wales as their birth-place. There are no less than 5,007 children of European parentage under 12 years of age, representing one-sixth of the total number of Europeans, but, fortunately for the vigour of the race, the number between 12 and 15 who have had to be kept out in this country is very small, the aggregate being only 769.

RACE.	Bihar and Orissa.	Calcutta.
English	4,374	9,215
Irish	617	990
Scotch	573	1,584
German	184	280
French	75	212

DENOMINATIONS OF EUROPEANS.

480. In both provinces the Anglican communion is most strongly represented among the European community, 56 per cent. in Bengal and 64 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa being members of it. One-fifth in Bengal and a little over one-fifth

* For the meaning of "Anglo-Indian," see paragraph 51 below.
† This is another term for "Anglo-Indians."

in Bihar and Orissa are Roman Catholics, while Presbyerians account for one-tenth in the former and for 7 per cent. in the latter province.

ANGLO-INDIANS.

481. The designation Anglo-Indian is used, under the orders of the Government of India, for the community of mixed descent hitherto known as Eurasians. From the preceding remarks it will be seen that their number is really greater than that shown in the returns owing to persons who had no title to that designation entering themselves as Europeans. On the other hand, there is reason to believe that a small number of Indian Christians returned themselves as Anglo-Indians. In some cases the names by which they are baptized, *e.g.*, David or Samson, lend themselves to such deception, but in other cases it is not easy to pass themselves off as Anglo-Indians under the scriptural names given them by missionaries. There is consequently a tendency to abandon names like Job, Benjamin, etc., and to assume European (especially Scotch) names. Since 1901 the number of Anglo-Indians in the two provinces has risen by 10 per cent., though there has been a small decrease in Calcutta.

DENOMINATIONS OF ANGLO-INDIANS.

482. The Roman Catholic Church has by far the greatest number of Anglo-Indian adherents in either province, the proportion being 58 per cent. in Bengal and 55 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa. The Church of England follows next with a percentage of 32 and 37 per cent., respectively: nearly all the remainder are either Baptists, Methodists or Presbyterians. Compared with 1901 the Church of Rome has a gain of 1,779 persons among this community, while the English Church has lost 670. This change is mainly accounted for by Calcutta, where Roman Catholics are more numerous by 1,240 and Anglicans are less numerous by 1,229 than hey were ten years ago.

	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
oman Catholic ...	12,189	1,864
nglican Communion ...	6,705	1,268

FERINGIS OF EASTERN BENGAL.

483. The figures for Anglo-Indians include the Feringis of Eastern Bengal, who number 1,202 and are mostly resident in Backergunge, Noakhali and Chittagong: all but 14 were returned as Roman Catholics. They are descendants of the Portuguese pirates and adventurers, who either swept the seaboard in their own galleys or were retained as gunners in the service of the Nawabs of Bengal. They ntermarried with the women of the country, and their descendants are now carcely distinguishable from their native neighbours. In some parts they elapsed into paganism, and were only reconverted about half a century ago. n Noakhali they have given up marrying non-Christians and retain their Portuguese names, though these have become corrupted, *e.g.*, Manuel is now Ianu and Fernandez is Fernan. In Chittagong they form connections with Iagh and Musalman women, but do not marry them unless they are baptized. The children inherit the names of their fathers, whether they are the offspring f concubines or not; if illegitimate, public acknowledgment by the parents ntitles them to aliment and recognition. In manners and habits they esemble natives, and they are even darker in colour. Their religion, dress nd names are practically the only things that distinguish them from their eighbours. They adopt English Christian names, but the surnames are still Portuguese, such as DeBarros, Fernandez, DeSouza, DeSilva, Rebeiro, DeCruz, DaCosta, Gonsalvez, etc.

FERINGIS OF MIDNAPORE.

484. There is another small community of Feringis near Geonkhali in the Midnapore district, who are descendants of some Portuguese gunners whom the Raja of Mahisadal brought from Chittagong in the latter half of the 18th century to protect his property against Maratha raids. These soldiers of fortune settled on some rent-free land which the Raja gave them, and intermarried with the women of the country. Their descendants relapsed into paganism and acquired an evil reputation as thieves and robbers, though visited occasionally by Roman Catholic priests. In 1838 they were visited by the Revd. J. Bower and Mr. R. Hamfray, the former of whom described them as "nominal Christians with scarcely any sign of Christianity except a few images of the Virgin Mary and Saints, no public worship or prayer, no scriptures, no sacraments." A

number were baptized by Mr. Bower and became Protestants : at present some of them are Protestants and some Roman Catholics. They bear both Bengali and Portuguese names, such as DeCruz, Rosario, and Lobo, but they are Bengalis in everything but name and religion. This community numbers 129.

ARMENIANS.

485. The Armenians have been established in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa for nearly three centuries. They appear to have made their way across India as pioneers of foreign trade and had formed a settlement in Sutanuti (the site of the modern Calcutta) at least 60 years before the foundation of Calcutta by Job Charnock.* Tombstones in the old town of Bihar point to their having settled there in the first half of the 17th century, and from 1645 onwards there was an Armenian community at Chinsura, at the head of which was the wealthy family of merchants known as the Margars. In 1665 the Armenians obtained a *farman* from Aurangzeb giving them permission to form a settlement in Saiyadabad, the commercial suburb of Murshidabad, and in 1688 they received charters from the East India Company granting them free trade in the Company's territory with full liberty in the exercise of their religion. The Company, indeed, went further, for it undertook to give a site for a church, and to defray the cost of building one of timber, in any of its settlements in which there were 40 or more Armenians. At this period trade appears mainly to have engaged their energies, but they also had considerable political influence : it was largely due to the Armenian merchant Khojah Sarhad, who accompanied the embassy of 1715 to the court of Farrukhsiyar, that the British obtained the right of free trade from the Mughals. Others rose to high office under the native rulers of Bengal ; Gurgin Khan (Khojah Gregory), originally a cloth seller, became Commander-in-Chief under Mir Kasim Ali, and a number of Armenians were officers in the army under him.†

486. The number of Armenians returned at this census is 1,155 or only 74 more than in 1901 : all but 92 were enumerated in Bengal, and four-fifths of the total number were residents of Calcutta. A considerable number are new arrivals from Persia, and in particular from Julfa : when they land, they are ignorant of English, but they learn the language quickly and rapidly assimilate European ways. Calcutta being regarded as a good place at which to give Armenian boys a start in life, and the knowledge of English a valuable commercial asset, they are constantly being sent there from Persia to receive an English education. Half the number of Armenian males in Calcutta were born in Persia, but the number of females hailing from that country was insignificant : over one-fourth of those born in Persia were under 15 years of age. Three-fourths were returned as members of the Armenian Church and less than three-eighths as speaking Armenian, the remainder using English habitually.

INDIAN CHRISTIANS.

487. The marginal statement shows the advance made by the principal Christian Missions since 1901, and also the total addition to the number of Indian Christians. There has been an increase of no less than 50 per cent., but the rate of progress is far slower in Bengal than in Bihar and Orissa, where numerous conversions are being made among the aboriginal tribes. While the total number of Christians in Bengal has risen by only 23,150 or 21·7 per cent., there is an increase of 95,767 or 55·5 per cent. in Bihar and Orissa. Nearly the whole of the increase in the latter Province has taken place in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, where an addition of 93,969 has been registered, of which Ranchi claims 52,397 and the adjoining State of Gangpur

DENOMINATION.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Total, 1911.	Total, 1901.	Increase, 1901-11.
Roman Catholic	28,885	113,257	142,142	90,399	51,843
Lutheran	976	99,276	100.252	69 294	30,958
Anglican	18,003	32,242	50,247	35,599	14,648
Baptist	22,903	10,853	33,756	20 207	13,549
Presbyterian	4,113	1.074	5,189	3,663	1,526
Methodist	3,037	1,169	4,206	2,566	1,640
Congregationalist	2,336	12	2,348	1,918	430
ALL DENOMINATIONS ...	83,260	258,544	341,804	227,763	114,041

*A tombstone over the grave of an Armenian lady, the wife of "the late charitable Sookeas," in the churchyard of St. Nazareth, Calcutta, has an inscription of which the date corresponds to 1630 A. D.

† M. J. Seth, *History of the Armenians in India* (1897), pp. 34—80.

31,934. In Ranchi the proportional growth since 1901 has been 42 per cent., and the converts now number 177,112 or 13 per cent. of the population: there are, in fact, more than twice as many Indian Christians in this district as in the whole of Bengal.

488. All the three missions at work in Ranchi have shared in the increase, but the greatest advance has been made by the Roman Catholic Church, the members of which now outnumber the Lutherans, as shown in the margin. The spread of Christianity in the adjoining State of Gangpur is perhaps even more remarkable. In 1901 there were only 1,758 Christians in the State, but the number has now risen to 33,692, and, next to Ranchi, is greater than that returned by any district or State in either Province. The work in this State is mainly an extension of that carried on in Ranchi; two-thirds of the converts are Roman Catholics, nearly all the remainder being Lutherans.

Denomination.	1911.	1901.
Roman Catholic	77,844	54,401
Lutheran	75,581	57,468
Anglican	23,856	13,078

489. As a rule, persons converted to Christianity were returned as "Native Christians," and their caste of origin was not entered in the schedules. In the case of converts, however, recruited from among the Himalayan races or from aboriginal tribes in Chota Nagpur and the Sonthal Parganas, the name of the caste, tribe or race is commonly retained, and there was no objection to its being entered in the schedules. The marginal statement gives details of the numbers so returned, from which it will be seen how largely the aboriginal races bulk among the converts. In Bihar and Orissa the Christian community includes 112,738 Oraons, 80,508 Mundas, 28,400 Kharias and 7,896 Santals, and these four races between them account for nearly nine-tenths of the Indian Christians. In Darjeeling the Lepchas have shown the greatest readiness to accept the Christian faith, but little progress has been made in winning over the Nepalese races. In addition to the 1,240 persons who returned themselves as Lepchas by race, there were 1,598 persons recorded simply as Native Christians whose language was Lepcha, thus giving a total of 2,838 Lepchas or more than two-thirds of the total number of Indian Christians in the district.

RACES OF INDIAN CHRISTIANS.

Caste or tribe.	Number of persons.
DARJEELING.	
Lepcha	1,240
Jimdar	215
Kami	164
Oraon	125
Murmi	120
Limbu	104
Newar	102
Mangar	85
Gurung	71
Khas (Chhetri) ...	58
Damai	40
Bhotia	37
Munda	24
Sunuwar	23
Sarki	16
Gharti	13
Unspecified	1,397
Others	102
SONTHAL PARGANAS	
Santal	7,037
Sauria Paharia ...	407
Mahli	291
Mucdi	47
Kamar and Lohar ...	43
Jadupatia	42
Dom	18
Bhuiya	17
Mal Paharia	17
Unspecified	1,741
Others	71
RANCHI.	
Oraon	88,647
Munda	66,992
RANCHI—*concluded.*	
Kharia	19,273
Kamar and Lohar ...	574
Asur	284
Chik	220
Pan	137
Kurmi	75
Bhuiya	49
Turi	30
Unspecified	547
Others	284
PALAMAU.	
Oraon	7,340
Munda	234
Bhuiya	127
Unspecified	27
Others	18
SINGHBHUM.	
Munda	4,852
Ho	1,197
Oraon	443
Kamar and Lohar ...	72
Unspecified	836
Others	179
ORISSA STATES.	
Oraon	16,251
Kharia	9,124
Munda	8,190
Unspecified	4,711
Others	22

490. One reason why the aboriginal tribes are more receptive of Christianity than other communities is that a convert to Christianity is not so completely cut off from his relations and friends. In parts of Ranchi, for instance, where the Christian community is strongly represented, not only have their heathen brethren no objection to eating with the Christians, but a renegade Christian can be re-admitted into his original tribe. A further attraction is the hope of obtaining assistance from the missionaries in their difficulties and protection against the coercion of landlords. Keenly attached to their land and having few interests outside it, they believe that the missionary will stand by them in their agrarian disputes, and act as their legal advisers. It must not be imagined that Christian missionaries hold out such offers as an inducement

CAUSES OF CONVERSION.

to the aboriginals to enroll themselves in the Christian ranks, but the knowledge that the missionaries do not regard their duties as confined to the cure of souls, but also see to the welfare of their flock, has undoubtedly led to many conversions. To their credit, be it said, the missionaries have not failed in their trust, and the agrarian legislation,* which is the Magna Charta of the aboriginal, is largely due to their influence. Unfortunately, this belief also leads to a certain amount of desertions, self-interested converts going from one denomination to another in the hope that a change of pastors will further their interests. A number of these converts, moreover, have, before now, apostacized on finding out that conversion failed to secure the temporal benefits they expected, as the missionaries declined to support preposterous claims. Perverts from Christianity have been prominent among agrarian agitators, and have displayed bitter animosity against their former pastors.

It may be noted here that Christianity has had some effect on the tribal customs even of those who have not embraced it. "There is, I believe," wrote the Deputy Commissioner of Ranchi in 1903, "no question that a generation or two back, the Mundas invariably burnt their dead; but with the spread of Christian customs and with the diminution of the fuel supply, for the last generation or so, burial has almost entirely superseded cremation, and there are very few Mundas now who can say what the ancestral custom was. The Christmas festival is now generally recognized among even the heathen Mundas as the *Paus Parab*, and I have no doubt that in another ten years it will be confidently claimed as a traditional Munda festival."*

491. Among the Hindus of the plains, Christian converts are mostly drawn from among the lower classes, to whom Christianity means an accession of respectability as well as a cleaner and purer life. Those ranking higher in the social scale have more to lose, for conversion means excommunication. If his family do not turn the convert out, they themselves will be outcasted. The result is that he loses his home and his share in the land, and is left without friends or means of livelihood. Their helplessness in these circumstances is one of the economic difficulties the missionaries have to face. A social difficulty is often presented by the low origin of the converts, for, though caste is alien to Christianity, the influences of immemorial tradition still persist. In Nadia, for instance, one of the problems which the missionaries have long had to solve is the treatment of Muchis who become converts. Their customs, *e.g.*, eating flesh of cattle that have died and been thrown outside the village, are repugnant to other Christians, as well as to Hindus, and the Muchis have long been regarded as scarcely within the pale. Even the lapse of 30 years appears to have made little difference in their position. In 1878 one of the missionaries wrote regarding these Muchi Christians, as they were called. "Their Christian brethren have ever regarded them with loathing and animosity. Besides personal dislike, a selfish consideration actuated the other sections in their treatment of these brethren. They found that by denouncing the Muchis, they obtained perfect toleration, and even caste recognition, among their neighbours: but to own the Muchis and treat them as brethren in Christ would have severed the dubious tie which they wish to maintain with the outer circle. Accordingly, for all these years their effort has been to ostracise those poor brethren, and even to drive them beyond the pale of Christianity. If a native pastor ventured to baptise a Muchi infant, he was threatened with desertion by the rest of his people; when a poor Muchi brother ventured into a church, the congregation indignantly protested; if they presumed to approach the holy table, the other communicants declared they would withdraw."† A recent account states:—"The Church, even at the present time, finds it hard to receive them in a whole-hearted way, sometimes even refusing to eat or smoke with them; and it is an uncommon thing for inter-marriages to take place with other Christians, though there are cases on record. The problem of how to get the Bengali Church to receive the Bhratrigan‡ in the same way in which they receive Christians from Mahomedanised or from ordinary Hindu castes, has vexed all right-thinking Christians for many years. In former years feasts were given, and all were invited

* H. C. Streatfeild, *Variations in Tribal Practices and Belief*, J. A. S. B., Part III, 1903.

† Nadia District Gazetteer, p. 140-1.

‡ A name, meaning "Brethren", now given to the Christian Muchis.

and were more or less forced to eat together, but such harsh methods were not entirely crowned with success. The more successful way has been to try by education to raise the social status of the Bhratrigan."* With this laudable object, they have been forbidden to carry on their old industry or to eat the flesh of animals that have died: they have been taught to weave coarse cloth, to keep their houses clean, and to send their children to school.

CHRISTIAN MISSIONS.

492. The pioneers of Christian missionary enterprise in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa were friars or priests belonging to the Augustinian, Jesuit and Capuchin orders. Both the Augustinians and Jesuits appeared on the scene in the second half of the sixteenth century and made their headquarters in Hooghly or at Bandel in its neighbourhood. From this centre the Jesuits sent out several missionaries. One penetrated the Sundarbans, and another went to Chittagong, where he was put to death. By 1603, however, a mission had been established in the latter district, while in 1620 a branch was set up at Patna, where the Mughal Viceroy of Bihar secretly embraced Christianity. In 1632, Hooghly was captured and sacked by the Mughals. one of the reasons assigned for the attack being their anger at the success of the missionaries in proselytizing. Some of the priests were slain, and others carried off captive to Agra, but the Augustinians returned a few years later and have since lived at Bandel. The Capuchins, to whom Tibet and Nepal were assigned as a mission field, made Chandernagore their headquarters in 1703. Within a few years they extended their operations first to Patna, then to Patan in Nepal, and finally to Lhasa itself. The missionaries at Lhasa were driven out in 1745, and fell back on Patan, where they had received grants of land from the Newar Kings and succeeded in making a number of converts. They were not long left in peace, for in 1769 they were expelled by the less tolerant Gurkhas, who had overcome the Newars and made themselves masters of Patan, Katmandu and the whole Nepal valley. They then retired with their surviving converts to Bettiah, where the Capuchins had been in residence since 1745; one of them had obtained the favour of the Raja of Bettiah by curing his wife of a serious illness and had received a grant of land. The Raja gave the refugees an asylum and allowed them to settle both in Bettiah and Chuchari, where the mission has maintained its existence till the present day.

493. Protestant missionaries did not appear in Bengal till about two centuries after the Jesuits and Augustinians began their labours. The first Protestant missionary was Kiernander, who settled in Calcutta in 1758, and the first organized mission was that started by the Baptist Missionary Society, which in 1793 sent out Carey and Thomas to Bengal. The success of this mission is sufficiently attested by the fame and achievements of the faithful band who laboured at Serampore, then a Danish settlement. They were the first to translate the Christian scriptures into the different languages of India. They establisned the first schools for non-Christian children in the north of India, and the first college for the education of native catechists, published the first native newspaper in India and printed the first books in Bengali. In 1796 the London Missionary Society was started, and two years later its first missionary appeared at Chinsura, which was under Dutch rule. The Church of England did not attempt direct missionary work till the next century, for till 1813 missionaries were prohibited from residing in the Company's territory, and it was not till 1814 that the episcopal see of Calcutta was founded. From that time the work of the Church of England developed steadily, its chief agencies being the Church Missionary Society, which sent out its first representative in 1814, and the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, which in 1820 started by sending out Dr. Mill as head of the Bishop's College at Calcutta. The first missionary of the Church of Scotland was Alexander Duff, who in 1844 devoted himself to the evangelization of rural districts, such as Nadia and Hooghly. Next year a Lutheran mission, known as Gossner's Mission, was started in Ranchi.

494. The limits of space preclude an account of the subsequent development of mission work, but one feature may perhaps be alluded to here, viz.,

* North of India Church Missionary Gleaner, November 1909.

the fact that many of the pioneers of Christianity have been of non-British origin. The Augustinians were Portuguese, the Jesuits were mostly Portuguese, Italians and French, the Capuchins were Italians. Kiernander was a Swede; Gossner's Mission, now known as the German Evangelical Lutheran Mission, was manned by Germans; the first Protestant missionaries in the Himalayas were Moravians, while the Scandinavian Lutheran Mission among the Santals of the Sonthal Parganas was founded by a Dane and a Norwegian.

495. The principal bodies now at work in the two Provinces are as follows:—(1) The Roman Catholic Church, in which the missions come within the following ecclesiastical jurisdictions. The Archbishop of Calcutta exercises control over practically all Bengal as well as Chota Nagpur, Bhagalpur and Orissa, and is assisted by Suffragan Bishops at Dacca and Krishnagar. The Diocese of Krishnagar comprises the districts of Nadia, Jessore, Khulna, Murshidabad, Faridpur, Dinajpur, Bogra, Malda, Jalpaiguri, Rangpur, Rajshahi and Cooch Behar: within these districts the Milan Mission is at work, The jurisdiction of the Bishop of Dacca extends over Dacca, Noakhali, Mymensingh, Pabna, Chittagong and Comilla. Bihar is under the Archbishop of Agra and his Suffragan Bishops of Allahabad and Bettiah: the latter place is the headquarters of the Prefecture Apostolic of Bettiah and Nepal, which is the sphere assigned to the Capuchins of the Tyrolese Province. In addition to these, there is the Portuguese Mission, which is administered by the Bishop of Mylapur, who is subordinate to the Archbishop of Goa. This mission owns churches at Calcutta, Bandel and Chinsura, and also in the Dacca and Backergunge districts. (2) The Anglican Communion is represented by the Church Missionary Society, the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, the Oxford Mission and the Dublin University Mission, besides the Church of England Zenana Mission. (3) The Lutheran bodies are the German Evangelical Lutheran Mission, which is mainly concentrated in Chota Nagpur and the neighbouring States, and the Scandinavian Lutheran Mission, which has its headquarters in the Sonthal Parganas. The latter is also known as the Indian Home Mission to the Santals, because it was the intention of its founders to raise in India all the funds required for its maintenance. (4) The chief Baptist missions are the London Baptist Missionary Society, the American Free Baptist Mission, the American Church of God Mission and several Australasian missions, viz., South Australia, Victoria, New South Wales, Queensland, West Australia and New Zealand. (5) The Presbyterians mostly belong to the Church of Scotland Mission, which also includes the Guild Mission (so called from its being supported by the Guilds of the Church), and the Universities Mission, which is supported by the Scottish Universities. Other Presbyterian missions are the United Free Church of Scotland Mission, and the Presbyterian Church of England Mission. (6) The Methodists maintain the American Methodist Episcopal Mission, the Methodist Episcopal Church Mission, and the Wesleyan Mission, while (7) the Congregationalists keep up the London Missionary Society. Other minor missions are mostly undenominational: among them may be mentioned the Regions Beyond Mission, the Open Brethren, the Hephzibah Faith Mission, the Bengal Evangelistic Mission, the Disciples of Christ, the Church of Christ Mission, and the Church of God.

ROMAN CATHOLIC MISSIONS.

496. Since 1901 the number of Indians who have become Roman Catholics has risen from 90,299 to 142,142, *i.e.*, by 52 per cent. Only about one-fifth of the total number are found in Bengal, where they are most numerous in Dacca. Altogether, there are over 11,000 Indian Roman Catholics in this district, which is followed *longo intervallo* by Calcutta with 4,000, by Nadia and the 24-Parganas with about 3,000 each, and by Midnapore with 1,200. In no other district of Bengal does their number come up to 1,000.

The chief centre of Catholic missionary enterprise in Bihar and Orissa is Ranchi, where a mission has been established since 1874. During the last 10 years the number of converts in this district has increased by 23,443 or 43 per cent., but even greater success has been obtained in Gangpur, where the members of the communion now aggregate 22,382. The mission had no stations in that State in 1901, but one has since been started and work is also carried on from adjoining stations in Ranchi. In Palamau, where a

Jesuit mission was started at Mahuadand in 1895, the number of converts (7,703) has fallen off slightly during the last decade, but Champaran, with 2,358 Indian Christians, shows a slight advance. The only other district with over 1,000 converts is Singhbhum, where work has been carried on by the Jesuits for over 40 years: here the Church of Rome has made no headway during the last 10 years.

LUTHERANS.

497. The Lutherans come next to the Roman Catholics in numerical strength, but their distribution is far more localized, all but about 1,000 being found in Bihar and Orissa. In this Province two-thirds (75,581) are inhabitants of Ranchi, where the German Evangelical Lutheran Mission has been established since 1845. It was originally known as Gossner's Mission, but in 1869 it was split up into two sections, one of which joined the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel. During the last 20 years it has had remarkable success in proselytizing. The number of its converts increased from 19,000 in 1891 to thrice that number in 1901, and since then there has been an addition of 18,000 or 33 per cent. The operations of the mission have also been extended to Gangpur, where there are now 11,000 converts. Nearly 5,000 Lutherans are found in the Sonthal Parganas, where the Scandinavian Lutheran Mission was established in 1867.* There is also a community of Lutheran Christians numbering 4,000 in Singhbhum, while 2,000 are found in Manbhum.

ANGLICAN COMMUNION.

498. The number of Indian Christians belonging to the Anglican Church is only half that of the Lutherans and rather more than a third of the number of Roman Catholics. Since 1901 they have increased by 14,648 or 41 per cent., and the increase would have probably been greater had it not been for a change of classification. At the last census persons who returned themselves simply as Protestants without specifying any particular denomination, and whose denomination could not be traced by subsequent inquiries, were grouped with members of the Anglican Communion, it being thought that the majority of persons who returned themselves as Protestants were members of the Church of England. It was however ascertained that this was not the case, and that many Dissenters also use this vague designation. Accordingly, at this census, they have been classified under the head "Protestant (Unsectarian or sect not specified)".

499. In Bengal, the Indian members of the Anglican Communion are most numerous in Nadia (5,746), the 24-Parganas (4,774), Calcutta (2,908) and Jalpaiguri (2,128): the aggregate for the rest of the Presidency is under 2,500. There has been a slight growth in the 24-Parganas, but the Christian community is stationary in Nadia, while Calcutta shows a decrease. In Jalpaiguri however, the Anglican Christians have increased by 27 per cent., mainly as the result of a Christian colony which was established for Santals in the Western Duars about 20 years ago. The area reserved for this colony is 14 square miles, which was at first covered with dense reed jungle and infested by wild beasts. It is now divided into ten villages, each of which has a headman chosen by the villagers. The affairs of the colony are managed by a council of headmen, presided over by the native pastor. At the present time there are about 1,500 Christian and 500 other colonists, all of whom are Santals. Those who are not Christians sign a pledge to abstain from intoxicating drink and heathen sacrifices, and to abide by the rules of the colony. Every acre of available land is under cultivation, the people are prosperous, and the colony is self-supporting*.

500. There are comparatively few converts in Bihar and Orissa outside the districts of Ranchi, the Sonthal Parganas, Singhbhum and Hazaribagh, which between them contain 30,000. Five-sixths of this number are aboriginals in Ranchi, where there has been a growth of nearly 11,000 or 82 per cent. since 1901: the ratio of increase is far in excess of that attained by any other mission in this district. The number of converts has also been nearly doubled in the Sonthal Parganas, where the Church Missionary Society has been established since 1862, and it has been more than doubled in Hazaribagh, where the Dublin University Mission started work in 1892. In Singhbhum, which is under the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, the number of the Christian is very

* Jalpaiguri District Gazetteer, pp. 44-45.

little greater than in 1901, but this may possibly be due to the emigration of converts to the tea gardens and elsewhere.

BAPTISTS.

501. Though not so strongly represented, the Baptists have converts in every district of Bengal. They have made most progress in Eastern Bengal, where their missionaries have laboured among the Namasudras. In the Dacca Division their number (11,251) has risen by 3,000 since 1901, while in the Rajshahi Division it has risen from 886 to 2,418. In the 24-Parganas they now number 2,785, or nearly double as many as in 1901 : here they are called *Dubit*, *i.e.*, those who are immersed in water, in contradistinction to members of the Church of England, who are dubbed *Chhitan* or sprinklers, in allusion to their method of baptism.

In Bihar and Orissa nearly all the Baptists are Oriyas, 6,143 being enumerated in the Orissa Division and 3,759 in the Orissa States: in the former division all but 1,000 of the Indian Christian community belong to the Baptist Church. The mission has now been at work for nearly a century, and though its adherents are still far from numerous, it has done an immense amount of indirect good. The Baptist missionaries were the first to start properly conducted schools, while the Cuttack Mission Press, which has the distinction of being the oldest press in Orissa, has sent forth a stream of civilizing literature.

PRESBYTERIANS.

502. Half the total number of Presbyterians are found in Darjeeling, where missionaries of the Church of Scotland are spreading the Gospel among the hill tribes, especially the Lepchas. Since 1901 the number of their converts in Darjeeling has risen from 1,775 to 2,563, or 65 per cent. of the total number of Indian Christians in the district. The census figure, however, falls short of the real number, for 1,002 persons did not return any denomination but called themselves simply Christian without specifying any denomination. Assuming that 65 per cent. of these were converts of the Church of Scotland, the total comes to 3,213, which almost exactly tallies with the number (3,207) borne on the books of the mission. The affairs of each Christian community are managed by its own *panchayat* or Presbytery, and the branches established in the various villages are self-supporting, building their own churches and paying partially for their pastors. The sphere of the mission operations also extends to the Duars, and there is a body of 831 converts in Jalpaiguri, chiefly tea garden coolies.

METHODISTS.

503. Since 1901 the number of Indian Methodists has increased by 1,640 or 64 per cent. They now aggregate 4,206, of whom nearly half are found in Burdwan and Bankura. Since 1901 their number has risen from 306 to 828 in the latter district, where educational and evangelistic work is vigorously carried on, especially among the Santals, while a college has been established at the head-quarters station.

CONGREGATIONALISTS.

504 The Congregationalists are found in greatest strength in the 24-Parganas, where the number of converts has risen from 1,277 to 1,815 since 1901. Outside that district there are only 533 Indian members of the denomination.

PART II—GENERAL.

HINDUISM.

WHAT IS A HINDU.

505. THE question has often been asked "What is a Hindu," but it cannot be said that the answers have been altogether satisfactory. The term itself appears to be of Persian origin and to have been originally geographical, designating the people who lived on the further side of the Indus.* Its connotation has in the course of centuries been widely extended, and, as pointed out by

* Yule and Burnell, *Hobson-Jobson* (1886).

Sir Alfred Lyall, it signifies not exclusively religion, but also a country and to a certain extent a race. "When a man tells me he is a Hindu, I know he means all three things taken together—religion, parentage and country. Hinduism ..... means a civil community quite as much as a religious association. A man does not become a Hindu, but is born into Hinduism."*

DEFINITIONS OF HINDUISM.

506. The definitions which have, from time to time, been propounded lay stress on one or other of these three aspects. Elsewhere, Sir Alfred Lyall virtually defines Hinduism as the employment of Brahman priests—"A man is not a Hindu because he inhabits India, or belongs to any particular race or state, but because he is a Brahmanist". Barth, again writes: "The sectarian or neo-Brahmanic religions, which we embrace under the general designation of Hinduism, constitute a fluctuating mass of beliefs, opinions, usages, observances, religious and social ideas, in which we recognise a certain common ground-principle, and a decided family likeness indeed, but from which it would be very difficult to educe any accurate definition. At the present time, it is next to impossible to say exactly what Hinduism is, where it begins and where it ends. Diversity is its very essence, and its proper manifestation is "sect," sect in constant mobility, and reduced to such a state of division that nothing similar to it was ever seen in any other religious system."† In this passage Barth lays stress on the religious aspect of Hinduism, but elsewhere he emphasizes its social system as its characteristic feature. "In sectarian India at present, and since the appearance of foreign proselytising religions, caste is the express badge of Hinduism. The man who is a member of a caste is a Hindu; he who is not, is not a Hindu. And caste is not merely the symbol of Hinduism; but, according to the testimony of all who have studied it on the spot, it is its stronghold. It is this, much more than their creeds, which attaches the masses to these vague religions, and gives them such astonishing vitality."‡

One Hindu writer describes Hinduism as a collective name for a group of religions, but points out that obedience to its social laws is the real criterion. "The path pointed by Vaishnavism is different from the path pointed by Saivaism; both of these, again, differ from the path pointed by Vedantism. Yet all who follow these and other paths are Hindus. There is probably no religion in the world which allows so much freedom of religious conviction.....Hinduism, in fact, is more a social than religious organisation. It includes all shades of faith—monotheism, pantheism, agnosticism, atheism, polytheism, and fetishism. So long as a Hindu conforms to the customs and practices of his society, he may believe what he likes.§" Sir William Hunter similarly defined Hinduism as being a social league and a religious alliance. "As a social league, it rests upon caste, and has its roots deep down in the race elements of the Indian people. As a religious alliance, it represents the union of the Vedic faith of the Brahmans with Buddhism on the one hand, and with the ruder rites of the non-Aryan peoples on the other .....Hinduism is not only a social league resting upon caste; it is also a religious alliance based upon worship. As the various race elements of the Indian people have been welded into caste, so the simple old beliefs of the Veda, the mild doctrines of Buddha, and the fierce rites of the non-Aryan tribes, have been thrown into the melting-pot, and poured out thence as a mixture of precious metal and dross, to be worked up into the complex worship of the Hindu gods||."

THE CENSUS AUTHORITIES AND DEFINITIONS.

507. Since the first census of 1872 attempts have been made by the census authorities in Bengal to evolve a definition of Hinduism, but without much success. In 1872, Mr. Beverley wrote:—"It is difficult to say where the line should be drawn which is to separate the pure Hindu from the low castes which have adopted some or other form of Hinduism. The problem can only be satisfactorily solved by a clear definition of what we mean

* Asiatic Studies, Vol. II, p. 288.
† The Religions of India (1882), p. 153.
‡ The Religions of India (1882), Preface p. XVII.
§ Hindu Civilization under British Rule, Vol. I, pp. 77, 87.
|| Brief History of the Indian Peoples, pp. 96, 98.

by Hinduism, and no one has ventured as yet to lay any such definition. What is to be the test of faith which is to distinguish the real Hindu from the semi-Hinduised aboriginal? Which of the gods in the Hindu panthion shall be made to step down and decide between them? Shall a belief in Krishna or in Durga constitute a pure Hindu? Or shall those only be classed as Hindus from whose hands a Brahman will receive water? Shall the disposal of the dead be made the test, and the various castes be distributed according as they practise cremation or burial? Or shall some form of creed be extracted from the Sastras which we may make those subscribe to who are henceforth to enjoy the dignity of being styled Hindus. Some practical shibboleth of the kind is required, it is clear. Without some such test no two men will agree in the classification of the numerous aboriginal tribes and castes in India who profess Hinduism in some or other of its multifarious forms. This difficulty of classification is one of peculiar force in Lower Bengal. Here we have a great variety of aboriginal or semi-aboriginal tribes who have been brought into contact with the Aryan Hindus and have been partially civilised by them. Living for centuries side by side, the two communities have acted and reacted on each other. On the one hand, the savage tribes have renounced their barbarism and adopted many of the rites and customs of the invaders; on the other, the Hindu religion has itself been debased from the Vedic monotheism of the Middle-land. . . And just as we find in the present day tribes in every stage of civilization, so does the Hindu religion in Bengal assume a Protean form, from the austere rites practised by the shaven pandits of Nadia to the idol-worship of the semibarbarous Buna. The Bauris, Bagdis, and Chandals of the lower delta; the Kochs and Paliyas of Dinajpur and Rangpur; the Dosadhs and Musahars of Behar, with many others, are probably all of aboriginal extraction, but have adopted as their religion a form of Hinduism, and can scarcely be classed as other than Hindus."

508. In 1881, again, Mr. (now Sir J.) Bourdillon, the then Census Superintendent, wrote: "The Sikhs and Muhammadans, the Jews and Parsis, have an individuality which it is impossible to mistake; the Christians profess a faith which separates them from all other classes of the community: and the Buddhists and Jains, though they have been said to possess much in common, differ from each other, and from the people who surround them, in dogma, ritual and manners. Here, however, tangible definition cease, and the remaining religions shade into each other by such imperceptible gradations, and are separated by such impalpable partitions, that it is impossible to say where one ends and the other commences: so that the border land between each one and the next is a misty valley now widening and now narrowing but always thick with the exhalations of ignorance and the fogs of doubt. 'What is a Hindu?' asked Mr. Beverley and the question has often been asked before and since without eliciting any satisfactory reply. No answer, in fact, exists: for the term in its modern acceptation denotes neither a creed nor a race, neither a church nor a people, but is a general expression devoid of precision, and embracing alike the most punctilious disciple of pure Vedantism, the Agnostic youth who is the product of Western education, and the semi-barbarous hillman, who eats without scruple anything that he can procure and is as ignorant of the Hindu theology as the stone which he worships in times of danger and sickness."

509. An attempt was made at this census to ascertain whether it was possible to lay down any criterion by which Hindus might be distinguished from non-Hindus, and the opinion of representative Hindu gentlemen and associations was invited on the subject. They were asked to state which of the following tests, proposed by the Census Commissioner, could be applied, and whether there were any others which should, in their opinion, be substituted for them:—(1) Do the members of the caste or tribe worship the great Hindu gods? (2) Are they allowed to enter Hindu temples or to make offerings at the shrine? (3) Will good Brahmans act as their priests? (4) Will degraded Brahmans do so? In that case, are they recognised as Brahmans by persons outside the caste, or are they Brahmans only in name? (5) Will clean castes take water from them? (6) Do they cause pollution, by touch or by proximity?

The result was an extraordinary divergence of opinion, the views expressed varying according as Hinduism was regarded as connoting religion,

social system or race, or a combination of any two or all three. There was, however, a general admission that no one test was possible and that the last five questions, while referring to religious, as well as social, disabilities, were merely matters of social practice.

Owing to the composite character of the Hindu pantheon, the worship of the great Hindu gods was generally considered to be insufficient to distinguish a Hindu from a non-Hindu. It was realized that such a test would exclude from the pale of Hinduism many who were recognized as belonging to it, *e.g.*, low castes worshipping minor Hindu deities, the Arya Samaj, etc., and that no such limit was feasible. As was pointed out by more than one of those consulted—"A Hindu may be monotheist; he may or may not believe in a personal god; he may worship some of the minor deities, or he may be a worshipper of ghosts and spirits or any natural phenomenon. An atheist, a polytheist, a believer in evil spirits, a monist and a dualist, all are Hindus." It would, moreover, be impossible to decide what deities come under the category of the great Hindu gods. The gods regarded as great in one locality or by one section are, as often as not, relegated to a secondary position in a different locality or by a different community. Apart from this, it would be impossible to distinguish between Hindus and Buddhists, for the Hindu gods and the gods of later Buddhism coalesce, Kali being worshipped by Hindus and Buddhists alike, while Narayan and Siva are often worshipped by Buddhists as Lokeswar, Jagannath and Sayambhu.

510. A number of Hindus would, however, accept worship as the criterion of Hinduism, if it meant worship of any of the gods or goddesses of the Hindu Pantheon. On this point it need merely be remarked that their number is legion and that it is impossible to say which is or is not a Hindu god. "The Panthpon is formed of heterogeneous elements in which all the religious systems which have arisen in the course of centuries have left their several contributions."* It includes gods representing natural phenomena, *e.g.*, the sun, earth, moon, mountains and rivers; gods of the imagination, such as beneficent or evil spirits and deities of disease; ghost-gods, such as the spirits of the dead; man-gods, such as living heroes and saints; and animal-gods, such as snakes, cows, etc.† Inanimate objects also are personified and worshipped: the writer worships his pen, the trader his weights and measures, the cultivator his plough, etc. A stone, according to the Hitopadesa, becomes a god when set up by priests.

The number of gods is, moreover, constantly being added to. The latest recruit appears to be the goddess of plague, who has been apotheosized in Gaya under the name Plague Mai or Bombai Ka Mayan: the latter designation is due to the fact that plague first appeared in Bombay. In some villages this new goddess has been given a place in the Devi Mandap and receives offerings like Sitala, the older goddess of epidemic disease. Recently also there appears to be a tendency to apotheosize India as a whole, and we are informed that "the motherland is the synthesis of all the goddesses that have been and are still being worshipped by Hindus."‡

511. The other tests proposed were rejected almost unanimously, on the ground that they would deny the title of Hindu to many who were universally recognized as Hindus. The right to enter Hindu temples and make offerings at the shrine cannot be regarded as a criterion. Only the clean castes are allowed to enter the majority of temples, and this privilege does not confer on them a monopoly of the title of Hindu. The worship of the gods and making of offerings are, in any case, carried on by proxy. A man of low caste will not be allowed to enter the temple of which he is the owner, that right being reserved to the Brahman whom he employs to perform ceremonies in it. Even non-Hindus may make offerings to Hindu gods. It is reported that offerings have before now been made at Kalighat by Christians, and that there is a temple of Kali in Bowbazar Street which is known as Firinghi Kali, the priest of which, a good Brahman, augments his income from the offerings of Eurasians. It is well known that certain castes are not allowed to

* Barth, Religions of India, page 252.

† E. W. Hopkins, India Old and New, 1901.

‡ *Swaraj* 1st April 1900 [cf. "The mother they all worship is India—the India which stretches from the Himalayas to the southernmost part of Ceylon. This is the India of their religion," Ramsay Macdonald, *Awakening of India*, page 307.]

enter the temple of Jagannath at Puri, but these castes are recognised as Hindus and are allowed to perform ceremonies outside the temple.* Similarly, at Gaya certain castes, known as Patit Hindus, viz., Chamars, Dhobis, Doms and Muchis, are not allowed to enter the Vishnupad temple or the Akshayavata shrine when performing *sraddha*, though they may make offerings at other *vedis*. Briefly, the low castes are excluded from the temples simply because they are unclean castes and not because they are not Hindus. A man may rank so low in the social scale that he cannot be allowed to participate actively in worship, but he is a Hindu all the same.

512. The general tendency of the Hindu gentlemen consulted was to regard Hinduism as a matter of belief rather than of social or even religious practice. The Pandits, on the other hand, considered that Hinduism consisted in the observance of the customs and usages prescribed in the Vedas,† recognition of the hierarchy of caste, and acknowledgment of the supremacy of the Brahmans. The majority of the laymen were liberal in their views: some, indeed, went so far as to treat it as faith "all-tolerant, all-complaint, all-comprehensive, all-absorbing" saying that there was no reason why any one in the world, whatever his race, should not be recognised as a Hindu by religion, if he simply professed to be one. They would not acknowledge, however, that any one not a Hindu by birth could be a member of Hindu society. This seeming tolerance is due to the heterogeneous character of Hinduism as a religion. "Within its pale we have sects as divided from each other as members of the Society of Friends are from Roman Catholics. We have followers of the Vedas, of Brahmanism, of Buddhism and of the polydaemonistic tribal cults of the aboriginal populations and of eclectic schools, religious and philosophical, of every kind and class" ‡. At one end of the scale is the monotheist or cultured pantheist, at the other end is the ignorant peasant, whose religious beliefs and practices are scarcely distinguishable from Animism pure and simple.

513. In spite of their divergencies, however, the Hindus have a common religion, of which there are two salient features, viz., (1) religious objection to the slaughter of cows and (2) veneration, or at least acknowledgment of the supremacy, of Brahmans. The latter again is closely connected with the institution of caste with the Brahman holding pride of place at its head. The Hindu castes constitute Hindu society, the distinguishing feature of which is its hierarchical basis. "The only uniting tie between these sharply differentiated bodies is a certain amount of common tradition, a common language for a number of them, and for all a common religion, which consists in being disciples of the Brahmins". § Though a man may be a Hindu by belief or, to be more precise, entertain Hinduistic beliefs he cannot be a member of Hindu society unless he is member of a recognized caste. Briefly, there is a clear distinction between religion and social system: the former is a matter of belief, the latter of custom. From the religious aspect Hinduism is all embracing, but socially it is a close corporation.

MLECHCHAS.

514. There is similar uncertainty about the modern meaning of the word Mlechcha. Manu contrasted Aryas with Mlechchas, the latter living in a different country and speaking a different language. The land of the Aryas was the region between the Himalayas and the Vindhya mountains: outside this lay the country of the Mlechchas or barbarians, *i.e.*, mostly the aboriginal races. According to this definition, the Deccan was comprised in the Mlechcha country, but other writers, such as Vasishtha, imposed no such limitation. In classical works the nations to the west were called Mlechchas, but not those to the east or north. The Chinese, Burmese and other eastern nations are never spoken of

* In Section 7 of Regulation IV of 1809 the following are mentioned as persons of low caste who were not permitted to enter the temple of Jagannath at Puri—(1) Loli or Kasbi, (2) Kalal or Sunri, (3) Machhua, (4) Namasudra or Chandal, (5) Ghuski, (6) Gazur, (7) Bagdi, (8) Togi or Nurbaf, (9) Kahar-Bauri and Dulia, (10) Rajbansi, (11) Pirali, (12) Chamar, (13) Dom, (14) Pan, (15) Tiyar, (16) Bhuinmali, and (17) Hari. The same list is given in Regulation XI of 1810 except that the Piralis do not appear in it. If entering the temple constituted a claim to recognition as Hindus, the Piralis would be Hindus one year and non-Hindus the next.

† One Pandit, however, informed me that, in his opinion, if Vedic practices only were considered, the European who ate beef and drunk wine had a good claim to be considered a Hindu.

‡ E. T. Atkinson, Notes on the History of Religion in the Himalaya of the N. W. P., pp. 2-3.

§ S. V. Ketkar, The History of Caste in India (1909), p. 16.

as Mlechchas, but the Muhammadans are often so described. In modern Bengali the word Mlechcha is a term of abuse for those who do not adopt the rules of cleanliness (*achara*) of the Hindus. In other words, it has lost its geographical meaning and distinguishes Hindus on the basis of religious practice. It is still also used as a designation for foreigners, but there appears to be some difference of opinion as to how far it should be applied to such races as the Chinese and Japanese. On the whole, the general view appears to be that the term is confined to the Western nations. While those who go to Europe and America are liable to excommunication, voyages to China and Japan involve no such penalties.*

THE UNTOUCHABLES.

515. While the educated Hindus regard Hinduism as a matter of religious belief rather than of religious or social practice, the vast majority of Hindus will not admit that a man is a Hindu unless he confirms to certain standards—in short, does what a Hindu does. He, in fact, takes the definition given by Mr. Gait in 1901—"Hinduism is not so much a form of religious belief as a social organization, and a man's faith does not greatly matter so long as he recognizes the supremacy of the Brahmans and observes the restrictions of the Hindu caste system." Even if we accept the religious criterion of belief, it is obvious that there are many grades of Hindus, the Brahmans being at the top and those now generally known as "the depressed classes" or "untouchable" at the bottom. As regards the position of the latter a modern Bengali writer remarks—"It is all the same to the Brahmans whether they call themselves Hindus or not. They are just as much untouchables as they were before. Their adoption of Hindu religion causes some amount of amusement, and sometimes gives rise to a certain amount of indulgent contempt. No Brahman will, however, minister to these classes. If a Brahman is found to do so, he becomes instantly degraded, and his position is considered even lower than that of the new proselytes. The luckless minister becomes at once one of the great 'untouchables.' So much for the new proselytes. The fate of those who have adopted Hinduism for a much longer period is not materially different after thousands of years. They are still untouchables. To a Brahman it makes no difference whether the man is a Santal or Naga, Hari or Bagdi. They are all equally unclean. Their touch means contamination, water touched by them is polluted. Their religion of Hinduism makes no difference. But the Brahmans are not the only class that holds itself aloof. A Kayasth, Baidya or a member of the Navasakh class will hold himself equally aloof and consider himself polluted by any association with the class, just as a Brahman will do. Here, as in many other things, the Brahman leads and the others follow." The utter contempt in which these pariahs are held may be gathered from the same writer's remark.—"A Hari or Dom—both Hindus—and a dog will be hunted out of a *Puiardalan*, with equally little ceremony and equally little hesitation. If anything, the dog will get off the more cheaply than the other two, as they are supposed to know better."†

That the above is no exaggerated account may be seen from the treatment accorded to the Gandas, a low caste of weavers and helots in Orissa. They are so degraded that a twice-born Hindu considers it necessary to bathe if he is touched by one of them: formerly a Brahman was defiled by a Ganda even casting his shadow over him. They are not allowed to draw water from the village tank, the village barber will not shave them, the village washerman will not wash their clothes. No orthodox Hindu rides a cart if a Ganda happens to drive it, wears a garment if a Ganda has stiched it, sits on a floor if a Ganda has *liped* it (*i. e.*, plastered it with cow-dung), drinks wine if a Ganda has distilled it, or purchases vegetables if a Ganda sells them. A Ganda in suffering receives no sympathy, and the door of Hindu charity is ordinarily closed against him. Until recently, moreover, no Ganda child was allowed to join the village school, and though they

* Ketkar quotes the case of two young Hindus, of whom one went to Europe and the other to Japan, and, on their return to India, had to pay a fine which was inflicted on them by the Brahmans. The former was fined Rs. 150, because he went to a Mlechcha country. The latter was fined Rs. 120, not because he visited a non-Arya country, but because he crossed the sea and did not observe due rites and ceremonies on the way. *History of Caste in India* (1909), p. 80.

† U. N. Mukherjee, *A Dying Race* (1909), pp. 34, 37 and 38. The present popularity of the term 'untouchable' appears to be largely due to this writer's interesting monograph.

are now allowed to attend it, they must sit apart from other Hindu boys. They cannot enter a Hindu temple, take part in Hindu religious ceremonies, or even build their houses in the village with other Hindus.*

INITIATION AND THE GURU.

516. One distinguishing feature of Hinduism consists of initiation (*diskha* or *mantragrahan*) which is performed when a Hindu boy is 8 or 9 years old. The Guru informs him what god is to be the peculiar deity of his worship and whispers in his ear a *mantra*, *i.e.*, some mystic syllables, through which he can obtain remission of sins and future happiness. This *mantra* the lad must keep an inviolable secret; its daily repetition is a solemn duty. Initiation is regarded as conferring spiritual franchise and bringing the boy into direct communication with God. The Guru renders spiritual revelation possible, for he acts as a medium between God and his disciple. Throughout the life of the latter the Guru is his spiritual guide, and receives almost divine veneration. A person who has passed the age at which he should have been initiated, without having the ceremony performed, is held to be impure and to be incompetent to perform religious ceremonies with efficacy. No orthodox Hindu will take knowingly food or water from such a man, even though he belongs to his own caste or family. He cannot enter into heaven or attain salvation by absorption into the divine essence, but will be condemned to *narak* (purgatory) and subject to re-birth. For this reason people dare not die without initiation, and the ceremony is frequently performed upon their death-bed. It is not surprising therefore that some Hindus consider initiation the most distinctive feature of Hinduism and the only possible criterion between the Hindu and non-Hindu.

THE *Chutia*.

517. A distinctive external sign of Hindu laymen is the *chutia* or as it is also called *shikka* or *tikki*, *i.e.*, a lock of hair, worn on the crown of the head. It distinguishes them from the Muhammadans on the one hand and from the Hindu monastic orders on the other. The practice of wearing this lock dates back to very ancient times, and cutting it off was regarded as the greatest of punishments. This, indeed, was the punishment for heinous crimes imposed on Brahmans who could not be put to death. It is said in the *Mahabharata* that, when Asvathama was convicted of killing the sons of the Pandavas, his top-knot was torn out of his head. In commemoration of this, and symbolically to heal the raw wound on his head, every Hindu when taking his daily bath sprinkles a little oil before anointing his body. Dressing the top-knot and tying it are regarded as a daily religious duty by all Hindus, and there are distinctive *mantras* to be uttered on this occasion. One of the ten sacraments (*sanskaras*) of the Hindus is *Churakaran*, a ceremony which takes place three years after birth. The ceremony consists of the tonsure of the hair of the head, only the *chutia* being left. Its significance, according to the *Artha Sastra* (by Chanakya or Kautilya), is that it must be a preliminary to learning the art of writing and calculation: this rule the writer makes compulsory for all the four sections of the Hindu community. Further reference to this ceremony, in connection with the question of initiation into caste, will be found in Chapter XI.

518. The Oriyas shave the greater parts of their heads, leaving the top-knot on the crown. The people of Bihar keep a central top-knot, though they do not shave the rest of their heads. The Bengali, like the Oriya, used to shave his head and leave the *chutia*, but many of the educated classes have discarded this with other old customs. A small minority have effected a compromise, and keep a thin lock of hair. When visiting Europeans, they brush it down closely, so that it does not appear, but when among orthodox Hindus they take care to make it visible, if not conspicuous: with this object some even tie an umbrella band round it when they are in orthodox company. A valued Bengali Brahman correspondent, to whom I owe the above information, informs me that he gave up wearing a *chutia*, but having occasion to visit Bihar on work which would bring him into contact with conservative Hindus, he allowed it to grow again. On one occasion he entered a Vedic school and, as soon as he did so, all the recitations stopped. He was taken for a non-Hindu, for his lock, being of recent growth, was small and not of the same decent length as in Bihar. He had to show his holy

* Sambalpur District Gazetteer, p. 67.

thread, as well as his top-knot, to prove that he was not only a Hindu but a Brahman before they would resume their recitations. He observed a sequel of this incident the same evening. Two of the Vedic pupils quarrelled, and one abused the other, saying "*Tum Bangali hogaya*, *i.e.*, you have become a Bengali." The other asked why he was insulted in this way, and the reply was "Your top-knot is very short." "On another occasion, when I was in Madras, my top-knot saved me. It was raining hard and I took shelter under a temple portico, where a number of Christian boys were also taking shelter. As the temple door was opened and the image of the deity became visible, I made a *pranam*. The Christian boys exclaimed, 'Look, a Muhammadan is bowing.' I asked why they took me for a Muhammadan. They said, 'Because you keep the hair on your head.' I took off my cap and showed my top-knot, and they were satisfied that I was a Hindu."

RELIGIOUS DISABILITIES.

519. The result of the inquiry referred to above was to show that anything in the nature of an uniform standard is impossible. It was recognized that Hinduism being a term connoting not only religion but also race, birth-place and social organization, it is difficult to say whether a man is within the pale or not on the basis of the proposed tests, some of which refer to his beliefs, others to his social standing, and others to his relations to Brahmans. The Census Commissioner decided therefore that instead of raising the question whether the members of particular castes should be "regarded as Hindus" or not, a list should be prepared of the castes and tribes contributing more than 1 per mille to the total population, and returned and classed as Hindus, which qua castes do not conform to certain standards or are subject to certain disabilities, viz., (1) deny the supremacy of the Brahmans*; (2) do not receive the *mantra* from a Brahman or other recognized Hindu Guru; (3) deny the authority of the Vedas; (4) do not worship the great Hindu gods; (5) are not served by good Brahmans as family priests; (6) have no Brahman priests at all; (7) are denied access to the interior of ordinary Hindu temples; (8) cause pollution, by touch or within a certain distance; (9) bury their dead; (10) eat beef and do not reverence the cow. In accordance with the Census Commissioner's instructions, inquiries were made in each district regarding the castes which would come within any one or more of these categories, and the result is shown below.

Caste or Tribe.	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.	
	Total No.	Categories.	Total No.	Categories.
Bagdi ...	1,015,738	5, 7, 8	...	...
Baishnab (Bairagi)	423,985	1, 5, 6, 9	78,739	9
Bauri ...	313,654	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10	292,503	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Beldar ...	...	...	88,921	2, 5
Bhuinmali ...	91,973	5, 7, 8	...	...
Bhuiya ...	69,044	2, 5, 6, 7, 8	663,757	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Bhumij ...	90,282	1, 5, 6, 7, 8	272,672	5
Bind ...	...	...	134,818	5
Chakma ...	58,672	1, 5, 6	...	...
Chamar ...	136,553	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10	1,114,467	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Chasadhoba ...	57,550	5	...	...
Dhoba or Dhobi	228,052	5, 7, 8	376,623	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Dom ...	173,991	5, 6, 7, 8, 10	241,903	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Dosadh ...	...	...	1,189,274	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Ganda ...	...	...	211,775	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10
Gareri ...	...	...	92,435	5

* This category includes two distinct groups, *viz.*, (*a*) certain sectarian groups which owe their origin to a revolt against the Brahmanical supremacy; and (*b*) the aboriginal tribes and also certain low castes who, being denied the ministrations of Brahmans, retaliate by professing to reject the Brahmans.

† Here again there are two groups, viz., (*a*) castes derived from ascetics and (*b*) low castes imperfectly Hinduized.

Caste or Tribe.	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.	
	Total No.	Categories.	Total No.	Categories.
Hari ...	173,706	5, 6, 7, 8, 10	119,468	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10
Ho ...	...	...	419,221	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Jogi or Jugi ...	361,141	1, 5, 6, 7, 9	...	...
Kaibartta (Jaliya)	326,988	5	...	...
Kalu ...	111,562	5, 7	...	...
Kalwar ...	...	...	180,825	5, 7, 8
Kamar ...	263,392	7	...	...
Kandh (Khond)	...	...	302,883	1, 2, 5, 6, 7
Kandra ...	...	...	155,806	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9
Kaora ...	112,281	5, 6, 7, 8, 10	...	...
Kapali ...	154,418	5, 7	...	...
Kewat ...	...	...	42),506	5
Kharia ...	...	...	105,472	5, 6, 7
Kharwar ...	...	...	85,876	5
Koch ...	125,046	5	...	...
Kora ...	46,497	1, 2, 5, 6 ,7, 8, 10	48,983	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9
Kumhar ...	...	...	513,327	5
Mal ...	108,163	5, 6, 7, 8, 10	...	...
Mallah ...	...	...	362,927	5, 7
Malo ...	247,200	5	...	...
Muchi ...	455,236	2, 5, 7, 8, 10	31,339	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Munda ...	67,252	1, 2, 5, 6, 8	410,440	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Musahar ...	...	...	626,795	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Namasudra ...	1,908,728	5, 7, 8	...	...
Nuniya ...	...	...	319,102	5
Oraon ...	165,337	1, 5, 6, 8	474,673	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10
Pan ...	...	...	464,046	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10
Pasi ...	...	...	150,142	2, 5, 6, 7, 8
Patni ...	63,447	5	...	...
Pod ...	536,568	5, 7 8	...	...
Rajbansi ...	1,805,833	5, 7	...	...
Rajwar ...	...	...	131,971	5
Santal ...	669,420	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10	1,399,450	1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10
Savar ...	...	...	191,798	2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9
Shaha ...	324,927	5, 7	...	...
Sonar ...	55,295	5, 7	...	...
Subarnabanik ...	109,429	5	...	...
Sunri ...	119,325	5, 7, 8	257,114	5, 7, 8
Sutradhar ...	177,433	5, 7	...	...
Tanti ...	...	...	613,277	5, 7
Teli ...	...	...	1,071,906	5, 7
Tipara ...	130,025	1, 5	...	...
Tiyar ...	215,270	5, 7, 8	60,897	5, 7, 8

520. This list merely summarizes the reports received and must be accepted with reserve. The utmost care has been taken to place the castes under the different categories only when there was a general consensus of opinion about them, and to reject views that were manifestly based on misconception; but in other cases I was not in a position to judge of the correctness or incorrectness of the reports received, and errors may have been made. The variations of opinion were remarkable. In one district a caste would be included under one or other of the heads, in another it would be excluded. Such divergencies were most pronounced in Bihar and Orissa, especially as regards castes that in Chota Nagpur or Orissa are only semi-Hinduized, but elsewhere have a respectable status.

In neither Province has any caste been placed under the third or fourth category. Several castes were returned under the third category, but they are all at such a low level of education that they are not in a position to pronounce any opinion about the Vedas. In fact, they scarcely know what the Vedas are and cannot be said either to accept or reject them. A number

of castes were also returned under the fourth category, but though the great Hindu gods are not regularly worshipped by them, they recognize their divinity and render them occasional homage: Devi under one form or another is almost universally worshipped either regularly or occasionaly. It is therefore difficult, if not impossible, to affirm positively that any castes do not worship the great Hindu gods. Several castes have, moreover, been excluded from the second class, though it was reported that they came under it. This is due to the fact that among the Baishnabs the Nityananda Gosains "open the door of fellowship to all sorts and condition of men, be they Brahmans or Chandals, high caste widows or common prostitutes." These Gosains are unquestionably recognised as Hindu Gurus, and the Baishnabs certainly receive *mantras* from them. As regards the eighth class, it must be remembered that, largely as a result of the growing popularity of travelling by train and the necessities imposed on travellers, the idea of pollution by touch is ceasing to have its old hold over the mind of the Hindus, though it is still as potent as ever among orthodox Hindus of the old school and high caste widows. The burial of the dead, is moreover, often due merely to poverty. Members of the depressed classes who cannot afford fuel for cremation will light a small fire near the corpse as a humble substitute, which will, they believe, have the same purifying effect as actual cremation. Even the degraded classes, who eat beef, will not kill a cow for food or purchase beef, but merely eat the flesh of cows that have died a natural death. It is doubtful whether they can be said not to revere the cow. Personally, I should be inclined to say that they revere it when alive, but not when dead.

521. Many of the castes or tribes entered in the list are either frankly animistic or contribute largely to the ranks of Animists. Their Hinduism is often doubtful or more than doubtful. At home where their manner of worship and general method of life are known, they are not regarded as Hindus: but when they go far afield they arrogate the title. In Bengal, for instance, more Mundas and Oraons were returned as Hindus than as Animists, but in Bihar and Orissa there are four Munda Animists to every Munda Hindu, while among the Oraons the Animists out-number the Hindus by eight to one. Altogether there are 28 castes or tribes in Bengal, and 30 in Bihar and Orissa, of whom some were returned as Hindus and others as Animists, the figures being as shewn in the margin.

	Hindus.	Animists.
Bengal	937,551	823,280
Bihar and Orissa	3,988,111	2,696,118

HINDUIZATION OF ABORIGINALS.

522. A large proportion of the Hindus in any case consist of persons of aboriginal descent, whose Hinduization is of recent date and often not very deep The lateritic uplands of West Bengal and the fringe of the Chota Nagpur plateau were, even a few centuries ago, the home of non-Aryan races who were regarded as outside the pale of Hinduism. The *Brahmanda* section of the *Bhavishyat Purana* (compiled in the 15th century) describes Birbhum as a jungle tract inhabited by a small black race, with little morality and no religion. In Varahabhumi (which included Manbhum and the western portion of Bankura), the inhabitants were said to be robbers by profession, irreligious and savage by nature, worshipping none but rude village deities. They ate snakes and flesh of all kinds, drunk spirituous liquor, and lived chiefly by plunder and by chase; their women were, in garb, manners and appearance, more like Rakshasas than human beings. These races my be identified with the Bagdis, Bauris and Bhumij, who swelled the ranks of the Chuars in the latter part of the 18th century. These banditti, who gave the British infinite trouble during the early days of their rule, were, according to Mr. Grant, "robbers of a swarthy black, like the neighbouring mountaineers of the north and west, now for the most part received as converts to the established system of Hindu faith.*"

523. The process of Hinduization is apparent even at the present time in the case of the tribes and castes of Orissa. In many cases they consist of two sections, one frankly Animistic and the other Hindu. Thus, the Kandhs

* J. Grant, Analysis of the Finances of Bengal (1787), Fifth Report, 1812.

(Khonds) of the Khondmals are a purely aboriginal race with a language, religion and communal organization of their own; the Kandhs of Puri have lost all knowledge of their language, are completely Hinduized, and in every way resemble the lower Oriya castes. Not only do they look on themselves as good Hindus, but they are regarded as such by their orthodox Hindu neighbours, who will put up in their villages, or stay in their houses, although they would consider themselves polluted by doing so in the case of Savars, Bauris, and other aboriginal races. Some of the Gonds again are purely Animistic, others have a recognized position in the Hindu hierarchy. The higher section of Raj Gonds, who probably are the descendants of tribal chiefs, have so good a status, that Brahmans will take water from them: many, indeed, wear the sacred thread and surpass their mentors in the minutiæ of ceremonial observance, even having the wood with which they cook their food washed before it is used for the fire. Among them, however, some are still found who worship the old tribal god and place cow's flesh to their lips wrapped in cloth,* in the belief that thereby they will avert his anger. A similar example of the division of a race is afforded by the Savars, of whom there are three sections, the wild Animist Savars of the hills, the Savars or Suars of Puri, who actually serve as cooks in the temple of Jagannath,† and the Sahars who have been Hinduized and, in the process, have modified their name. All are descendants of non-Aryan tribes who were overwhelmed by the advancing wave of Aryan invasion. The greater part were swept into the hills where they remained isolated and untouched by Aryan influences. A minority remained in the plains and became the serfs of the conquerors, whose religion and language they gradually adopted. "Hinduism in Orissa, holds out to all an ascending scale of ceremonial purity. The backward aboriginal tribes outside the pale of Hinduism, like the Khonds, set up a Hindu god, get a Hindu priest to minister them, adopt some of the customs of the pure Hindus, and thus become, in time, recognized as low class Hindus. The more energetic, again, of the low castes within the pale of Hinduism gradually raise themselves to higher standards of ceremonial purity, and the more wealthy members among them even raise themselves to membership of some higher castes. Not only does Hinduism in Orissa, even at the present time, absorb the less civilized tribes outside its pale, but there is also a process of evolution in active operation among the recognized Hindu castes themselves.‡"

524. The employment of a Brahman as a priest is the seal of absorption into Hinduism. The Brahman may be a low Brahman, a kind of hedge priest, but it is sufficient for aboriginals if a Brahman ministers to them instead of a man of their own race. Day by day also the Brahmans gain good ground as they are accepted by priests by the low Hindu castes or *anacharania* classes, who rise in the social scale if a Brahman ministers to them instead of the priests or Pandits of their own caste. Sometimes they employ Brahmans in opposition to their Pandits, sometimes in addition to the Pandits, and sometimes when the Pandits' families are extinct. The manner in which the Brahmans steadily supplant the latter is very clearly exemplified in the case of the temples of Dharma, originally the second member of the Buddhist triad. These are falling into the hands of Brahmans, who worship Dharma either as a incarnation of Vishnu or as a form of Siva. One instance may suffice to illustrate the process. Near Navadwipa, in the district of Nadia, there is a temple of Dharma, which till two or three generations ago had a low Hari as the hereditary priest. Hogs and cocks, both abominations to the Hindus, were openly sacrificed, but votive offerings formed the main source of the Hari's income. Brahmans kept aloof from the temple, until some of them suffering from what they took to be incurable diseases came as a last resource. They were cured, and then the question arose: How could they make the offerings which they had promised in case of a cure? They would not make their offerings through a Hari, and no good Brahman would do so. At last, a low Brahman consented

* This is clearly a symbolical eating of beef, and the cloth is presumably intended to preserve their status as Hindus.

† According to legend, the original image of Jagannath was found in the country of the Savars. For a further account of this interesting race see Chapter XI.

‡ N. K. Bose, *The Hindus of Puri*, Calcutta Review, 1891.

o serve for a consideration. Gradually, other Brahmans came to make herings through him, and he and the Hari became practically joint owners f the temple. The Hari tolerated the Brahman, as he ensured contributions rom Brahmans. The Brahman tolerated the Hari, as the temple gave him living, but he made the Hari abstain from sacrificing hogs and cocks penly in front of the temple: such sacrifices were made in the jungle ehind the temple. The Hari family having died out, the Brahman is now he owner of the temple, and Dharma is worshipped as a form of Siva; but close observer will find that the *Naibidya* (a daily offering of rice) is ivided into two parts, one offered to Dharma and the other to Siva.

MODERN TENDENCIES OF HINDUISM.

525. Among the educated classes of Bengal there has been a revival of Hinduism both from the more purely religious and the metaphysical aspect. The work of the Theosophical Society has had not a little to do with this change, the Hindus being taught to examine the treasures hidden in their own scriptures. Vedantism has gained ground, the Ramkrishna Mission being one of its direct results. Many Hindus now call themselves simply Vedantists; others designate their religion Sanatan Dharma *i.e.*, the everlasting religion, meaning Hinduism in its pristine and immemorial form. The most cultured are either monotheists or pantheists, and their attitude towards other forms of faith is one of toleration. Though not idolaters themselves, they do not look upon idolatry with horror. They even countenance it to some extent, for truth has many facets, and there are many ways of attaining salvation. At the same time, many of them hold advanced social views, which their conservative brethren would stigmatise as heterodox. Caste restrictions are relaxed, especially in the matter of eating and drinking together, *e.g.*, at private parties or picnics and on railway journeys. Forbidden food, cooked and served by low caste servants or Musalman khitmatgars, is commonly eaten in hotels and refreshment rooms. Even in private houses many do not trouble to make sure that the cook is a Brahman or that other servants belong to castes from which they may take water. The feeling of tolerance also extends, to a small degree, to intermarriages between members of different subcastes, especially among Kayasths and Baidyas. Such marriages are contrary to custom and are condemned by formal resolutions recorded at caste meetings. When they take place, the offenders are outcasted, but after a time the community relents. The offence is condoned by a special resolution, and the offenders are let off with a fine, which is nominal if they are poor. Such cases are still comparatively rare, but as each occurs, the feeling against them loses in strength. In this, as in other respects, practice lags behind principle. Another modern tendency which calls for some notice is the active or passive neglect of the authority of the Brahmans as a final court of appeal in matters affecting the status of castes and their social practices. Hitherto it has been the acknowledged privilege of the Brahman Pandits to interpret the *Sastras* and to declare whether any deviation from the orthodox rules may be allowed. Of late years, however, a number of castes have advanced new claims, or adopted new practices, if not in defiance of, at least without the sanction, of the Brahmans. They convene meetings presided over by, and confined to, members of their own caste and by means of resolutions settle questions that previously were adjudicated upon by Brahmans only.

526. The principal organization for the dissemination of modern Vedantist views in Bengal is the Ramkrishna Mission. The mission is so named after Ramkrishna Paramhansa, whose pure life, religious fervour and mystical views attracted a number of thoughtful Hindus before his death in 1886. Ramkrishna himself expounded his doctrines by means of parables and allegories, and was deeply imbued with the spirit of Vedanta philosophy. It was left to the greatest of his disciples, Swami Vivekananda (the son of a Calcutta lawyer, whose original name was Narendra Nath Dutt) to organize his followers and give practical effect to his teaching. Vivekananda spent his

VEDANTISM. RAMKRISHNA MISSION.

life advocating Vedanta principles in India, America and England, and in 1897 founded the Ramkrishna Mission. The name shows an infiltration of English ideas and its organization and methods of propaganda resemble those of Christian Missions, *e.g.*, educational institutions, medical work, and the use of the printing press. While using modern methods for his propaganda, Vivekananda was true to the old catholic spirit of Hinduism, for he proclaimed that all existing religions are different paths leading to one God: all the paths are equally right, and every sincere seeker after truth is sure to attain God, whatever may be the path he chooses for himself. "As different streams, having their sources in different places, all mingle their water in the sea, so the different paths which men take through different tendencies, various though they appear, and crooked or straight, all lead to one Lord."* From the religious point of view, therefore, the Mission he founded is Vedantist, but its most prominent characteristic is that it finds inspiration in the spiritual and literary treasures of India: it is this vindication of the spiritual independence of India that largely appeals to the modern Hindu. Socially the members of the Mission hold advanced views, for the eating of meat is not prohibited, travel in foreign land is countenanced, and non-Hindus are admitted such as the late Sister Nivedita (Miss Margaret Noble.)

OCCULTISM IN BENGAL.

527. Occultism appears to have appealed strongly to the better Hindu classes of recent years. One sect in which appears to play a considerable part is called Jyoti Swarup Upasna. It was established by one Shivanarayan Paramhamsa of Ghazipur who came to Bengal about 20 to 25 years ago. He worshipped the Sun, Moon and Fire and preached that these are the manifestations of God. To gaze upon the sun and moon, regularly and with rapt attention, and to offer *hom* in fire were the most virtuous and spiritual of all acts. He believed in no caste system and no idol worship, and he advocated *pranayam*, *i.e.*, the regulating of the breath, the theory being that every man has only a certain number of breaths allotted for his lifetime. If a man uses them sparingly, he can prolong his life and, by concentration of mind, attain supernatural powers. A similar, if not the same, sect is that of which the founder is said to have been the late Shama Charan Lahiri of Benares, who on retirement from Government service became a *yogi's* disciple. Shama Charan Lahiri is said to have made a number of converts in Bengal.

OCCULTISM IN BIHAR.

528. The same tendency is noticeable in Bihar, where a desire to study occultism has come over the educated classes during the last few years. They believe that, by the study and practice of *Yoga*, they will learn the mysteries of life and death and eventually realise the 'self.' Among them, it is said, the only important worship is that of the Guru or spiritual teacher and the One Supreme Being. They are seekers after truth, who try to lead an unimpeachable moral life and show toleration for the faith of others, whether Hindus or non-Hindus.

RADHASWAMIS.

529. The leading sect of this kind is that known as Radhaswami, the founder of which was Siva Dayal Singh of Agra, who died in 1878. His chief disciple was the late Rai Saligram Singh Bahadur, Postmaster-General of the United Provinces, who succeeded in making a number of converts before his death in 1898. He was succeeded by Pandit Brahma Sankar Misra of the Accountant-General's Office in that Province, after whose death in 1907 the leadership of the sect was disputed, but Babu Kamala Prasad, a pleader of Ghazipur, received the votes of the majority and was elected their spiritual leader. A full account of the esoteric doctrines of the sect was given in the United Provinces Census Report of 1901 (pages 78—80) and it will be sufficient merely to mention briefly, and in popular language, their main features as professed in Bihar at the present time. The object of the sect is the purification of the soul and the eventual salvation of the spirit. When it is released from the bondage of mind and matter, rebirth ends: the spirit reaches, and remains in, the presence of the Supreme Being, without however

* The World's Parliament of Religions, Vol. I, pages 242, 243.
* J. Buchanan, The Moon Endureth (1912), pages 206-207.

losing its individuality. This consummation is to be secured by a kind of *Yoga* (called *Surat Shabd Yoga*, a practice of the word and spirit), under the direct guidance of the Guru. The latter, who is also called the *Santsatguru*, is regarded as an incarnation of God and the channel of spiritual enlightenment. Transmigration is believed in : the consumption of animal food and intoxicating liquor is prohibited. But perhaps the most prominent feature of the cult is Guru veneration. All castes are eligible for admission to the sect. The neophyte has not to give up his profession, cut off his connection with his family, or abandon the social practices of Hindus. The doctrines of the cult have appealed forcibly to the educated classes of Bihar, and some Bengalis in Chittagong have also embraced it.

PILGRIMAGES.

530. While Vedantism and Occultism have found increasing favour among the cultivated classes, the religious fervour of the ordnary Hindu is kept alive by the ease and cheapness with which pilgrimages can be made. By enabling even the poorest to perform a pilgrimage, the railways have helped to stimulate and give new life to Hinduism. On the other hand, the journey being cheap and easy, the peasant is apt to regard it with less solemnity. He makes straight for the large centres and neglects the smaller shrines that he would have visited when the journey was made by road. Now, moreover, that he can reach his goal within 24 hours or a few days, instead of having to plod along the road for days or weeks, he spends a shorter time at the place of pilgrimage, and leaves it with attenuated devotions.

HARI SABHAS.

531. Another potent influence in reviving or invigorating the faith of the people has been the establishment and multiplication of Hari Sabhas. These are religious institutions which appear to have been started on an extensive scale only during the last half century, but are now common in the towns and villages of Bengal. They are Vaishnava in conception, their object being spiritual development by means of *bhakti*, or devotion to Krishna or Hari. It is recognized that *inan*, or salvation by knowledge, is an abstruse subject, the study of which is beyond the capacity of the ordinary man. *Bhakti* is therefore adopted as the easiest and surest means of salvation. The Sabhas assemble once a week, either in a building erected as their meeting place or at the house of one of the members. A Pandit is engaged to read and explain the text of the Srimat Bhagabat and other Puranas, while a *kirtan* party is engaged for chanting the name of Hari and singing songs about the life of Krishna and Gauranga. One indirect result is that the *kula purohit* is being supplanted by the Hari Sabha Pandit, who is maintained by the subscriptions of the Sabha : in other words, the common priest is substituted for the family priest.

The Hari Sabhas mark the introduction of a new leaven in Hinduism. The ordinary Hindu can take no part in the *pujas* by which the gods are approached. Worship is confined to vicarious offerings and *mantras* uttered by the priest. The latter is sole celebrant, and the worshipper stands apart. In the Hari Sabha not only are *pujas* offered at festivals, such as the Dol and Janmastami, but such occasional celebrations are supplemented by regular religious and moral lectures. The meeting house not being a temple, all may gather there and join in the devotional exercises : worship is, in fact, congregational, which is an idea alien to Brahmanism. The conception of a divine personality is brought home to the assembled people both by the sacred books and by the devotional songs in praise of Chaitanya, which form a leading part of the programme. Though these Sabhas are essentially Vaishnava institutions, Saktas are also attracted by them.

GITA AND THEOSOPHICAL SOCIETIES.

532. The Hari Sabhas are practically informal associations for the maintenance of religious meetings. The expenses of a Pandit, of a meeting house, if any is built, and other incidental charges are met by subscriptions. Gita societies, on the other hand, have a regular constitution with a secretary and committee or managing body. Their object is to present the doctrines of the Gita in popular form and to debate on the religious truths it contains : they perform much the same functions in cities as the Hari Sabhas in villages. The interpretations put on passages in this noble work are unfortunately

sometimes fantastic and dangerous ; it is well known that in recent years the Anarchists have sought to further their propaganda by such misconstructions. In the towns of Bihar the place of Gita societies is taken by Theosophical societies. The members, who belong to the educated and well-to-do classes, meet to discuss religious topics, and the reading of the Gita is common, some Theosophical societies even having Gita classe-

HINDU SECTS.

533. It was decided not to attempt to obtain a record of Hindu sects, previous experience having shewn that the results are so inaccurate or incomplete as to be of little or no statistical value. A large majority, moreover, of the Hindus do not owe allegiance to any sects. Many are recently Hinduized and have a very elementary conception of the Hindu religion : they are content with their recognition as Hindus and, under this name, worship their old gods. Others, and those the greater number, have a favourite deity, but also revere other members of the Pantheon and join in their worship on days set apart for it. Their standpoint is that of the ninth century hunter described in a recent collection of stories and poems, who worshipped the Christian Trinity, the Virgin Mary and the Saints, but at the same time made occasional obeisance to the old moss-grown altar of Apollo "for Gods are kittle cattle and a wise man honours them all." The attitude of many a Hindu is, in fact, that of the old Brahman, who "in his private worship first made an offering to his chosen deity, Narayan (Vishnu), and then threw a handful of rice broadcast for the other deities, and hoped, by thus recognizing their existence and authority, to keep them in good humour towards himself."* Though it was felt to be out of the question to obtain statistics of the actual number of adherents of different sects, the opportunity was taken to make inquiries about the establishment of new sects or to collect information about changes in the older sects. The following notes are compiled from the reports received.

It has been a peculiarly difficult task to obtain reliable information regarding different sects, as their members are averse to informing the uninitiated of their beliefs and practices. A further difficulty is presented by the fact that the secrecy of some sects has led to misunderstanding and consequent misrepresentation. Their esoteric doctrines not being known, they are regarded with prejudice, and popular belief attributes to them the celebration of gross orgies and disgusting obscenity. It is therefore not an easy task to arrive at a knowledge of their inner beliefs, to distinguish between fact and fiction.

534. An account of the Kartabhajas was given in the last Census Report to which the reader is referred for information regarding its history and development. According to Jogendra Nath Bhattacharyya they are a "disreputable Guru-worshipping sect," "The exhibition of fervent love is," he says, "their only form of religious exercise. At their secret meetings they sing some songs as a cloak for familiarities which cannot be described".† These statements are indignantly repudiated. According to a member of the founder's family, who has furnished me with an account of the sect, their meetings are never held in secret. They are held weekly on Friday evening in the house of the Mahashaya or preceptor, and are attended by his Varatis. *i. e.*, his immediate followers and disciples. They are neither secret nor exclusive, and outsiders may, if they like, attend them : on important occasions formal invitations are issued to outsiders as well as to the neighbouring members of the sect. The meetings commence with the singing of religious songs taken from their holy book, the Bhaber Gita, which is followed by a general religious discussion on various topics, including the interpretations to be put on the songs. They end with the distribution of *sirni* (sweetmeats dedicated to God) amongst those present. "These meetings, or *majlis* as they are generally styled, are simply religious and social gatherings."

KARTABHAJAS.

* W. J. Wilkins, Modern Hinduism, page 302.
† Hindu Castes and Sects, pages 485-8.

535. The accounts of this sect have hitherto been drawn mainly from outside sources. A brief summary may therefore be given of the beliefs which the sect itself claims to hold. They say that Kartabhaja does not mean a worshipper of the headman, but a worshipper of the Creator. They do not use the designation themselves, but Satya Dharma or Sahaj Dharma, *i.e.*, the true or easy religion. "Its object," writes my informant, "is to call forth the latent divinity in man. This it seeks to accomplish not by renouncing the world and its cares as something transitory and illusive, but by going through life's struggles manfully and heroically, sustained by love for mankind and reverence for nature. Far from being atheists, as some writers have described us, we believe in the existence of a personal God, whom we can love and adore. The *mukti* or salvation we seek to attain is not one of annihilation or of absorption, but one in which we shall live in subordinate co-operation with the supreme Godhead. We have no outward characteristics that would mark us out, no marks on the forehead or elsewhere, no special garb, no particular ornament or instrument. Neither have we any secret signs, nor any secret rites and ceremonies. Ours is not a Guru-worshipping sect, as some have taken it to be. In fact, as a safeguard against any possible misconception as to the rights and obligations of a religious preceptor, and the consequent misuse of his privileges, the terms Guru and Sishya are never employed among us. On the contrary the words used are Mahashaya and Varati, of which the former, (as in the combination Guru Mahashaya) means simply a teacher; and the latter (derived from Pr. *Varat*, meaning need) signifies one in need of spiritual instruction, or more simply a student. The Mahashya is merely a teacher and has no right to exact any divine homage from his Varatis.

"The duties enjoined on the members are *inter alia* the following:—(1) Never to utter any untruth. This injunction is so strictly observed by the majority of the members, that our sect has come to be called the Satya Dharma sect. This also explains the presence of the word Satya in the names, such as Satya Charan and Satya Das, given to the children of our members. (2) Every day to repeat the *mantra* at least three times in the prescribed manner on five occasions, viz., early in the morning when rising from bed, then again after morning ablutions, in the noon after bathing, before dinner in the evening, and lastly at night when retiring to bed. (3) To hold Fridays sacred and observe them with fasting, religious meditation and discourses, and, where practicable, to hold or attend in the evening a *majlis* or religious meeting of the sect. (4) To abstain from meat and intoxicating liquors. (5) To attend diligently the festivals held at Ghoshpara, and to pay or remit someting to the *gaddi* in recognition of the spiritual headship of the Karta. The members are at perfect liberty to follow the customary rules and usages of their families and communities, and it is only in matters purely spiritual that they are amenable to the control of the sect. From the spiritual point of view all members stand on the same footing. No distinctions based on caste, wealth, etc., are recognized."

536. At the same time, it must be admitted that popular belief credits the Kartabhajas with immoral practices. One Hindu gentleman declares that the meetings are held at the dead of night in secluded houses, that women lend their bodies to their spiritual leaders in the belief that thereby they pave the way to salvation, and that the disgusted villagers not infrequently break up the meetings and assault the members, their gatherings consequently ending in a *sauve qui peut*. On the other hand, another independent Hindu gentleman, whose knowledge and absence of bias entitle his views to respect, writes—"Many of their doctrines are couched in somewhat mystic language, and most of their religious practices are kept concealed from men who do not belong to their sect. Misunderstandings and misrepresentations have necessarily arisen with regard to their practices, which have brought them under the lash of historians and poets, such as Akkay Kumar Dutt and Dasarathi Ray. I have known some men belonging to this sect whose life gives a lie to these misrepresentations. That it is merely a branch of Vaishnavism is apparent from the name of "Sahaj Dharma". Even before the appearance of Chaitanya, this name was current among the Vaishnavas: the great poet Chandi Das in his esoteric poems has two or three *padas* entirely devoted to the exposition of this Sahaj Dharma, or easy religion. There is no room for doubt that the Kartabhajas have derived most, if not all, of their devotional practices from this

and other mystic works of the great Vaishnava teachers. There seems to be, however, this difference that while the Vaishnavas laid greater stress on the element of *Bhakti* (love) and self-abrogation, the Kartabhajas pay more attention to the self, or more properly the ego (herein adopting the principles of Vedanta), seeking thereby to bring out in prominence the latent deity in every soul. The moral precepts of both sects are much the same, and also to a great extent the methods of realization, which in both cases are very difficult, though nominally called *sahaj* or easy."

According to another correspondent, the original principle of the Kartabhajas was the very antithesis of sensuality. Their principle was *Magi hijre minshe khoja Tabe habire kartabhaja*, *i.e.*, men and women must remain as eunuchs. In other words, they must avoid all sorts of sexual connection: they will then be real worshippers of the Karta (God). The underlying belief is that only by sexual self-restraint can one avoid the cycle of rebirth. This idea is said, perhaps falsely, to be carried so far that, before initiation the neophyte has to stand stark naked in the presence of some young girls to test his powers of restraint.

BAULS.

537. The same idea of the evils of procreation, as leading to rebirth in a world of misery, appears to be the basis of the beliefs of the Bauls, another Vaishnava sect. One man, who gave up the sect in disgust, declared that, in order to attain supernatural powers, the members drink a certain liquid filth consisting of an organic discharge.* It is said that they are desirous of emulating the amorous feats of Krishna; knowing that they have not the same divine power of being able to enjoy sexual connection without issue ensuing, they believe that such perfection can only be attained by imbibing this vile draught. In public they appear as religious minstrels, whose manner of life has earned them their name, which is a corruption of Batul, meaning madman. They do not shave or cut their hair, go about in motley garb, and sing devotional songs to the accompaniment of stringed instruments called *gub-guba-gub*. Their dress consists of a cone-shaped skull cap and a coat made of dirty rags patched together.

SATIMA SECT.

538. It is reported that a new sect, called Satima from the name of their deity, Satima, *i.e.*, Sati or Durga, has recently sprung up in Murshidabad, Nadia and Calcutta. They are not ascetics but marry, have children and lead an ordinary social life: sometimes the males keep their hairs and nails long, while the females wear matted hair. Friday is a sacred day among them, when they meet in the evening for religious services. Their leader, who may be male or female, is believed to have occult powers and to be able to speak of past, present or future events. The eating of meat and drinking of intoxicating liquor are prohibited. When ill, they do not use medicines, but besmear their bodies with the dust taken from the quadrangle containing Satima's altar, and drink a beverage made of tamarind squeezed into water†. The females mix freely with the males, and it is said that chastity is not held in much regard by them, although they profess to be the worshippers of Sati, chastity incarnate. This sect, it is reported, "seems to be an offshoot of Kartabhajas, the difference being in the object of their worship. Kartabhajas worship their Guru, whom they call Karta, and ascribe divinity to him, while the Satimas worship Sati, a female principle as their Godhead". The supposition that the sect is of Kartabhaja origin is confirmed by similarities of practice. The Kartabhajas hold Friday sacred, meet in the evening, and abstain from meat and spirits. Moreover, the wife of Ram Saran Pal, the founder of the Kartabhajas, was named Satima, and a handful of dust from the foot of the tree where she was buried is believed to "cure any disease and cleanse from any sin.‡"

KALACHANDI.

539. A small Vaishnava sect has recently appeared in Nadia, which is known as Kalachandi from the name of its founder Kalachand, who is also called Kalachand Pagal,

* See also J. N. Bhattacharyya's Hindu Castes and Sects, page 483.

† I am informed of a case in which a respectable Hindu gentleman suffering from illness took such a mixture from one of the Satimas (a Pod by caste) in the hope of cure, but died in great pain the same night. When his friends wanted doctors to prescribe for him, the Satimas dissuaded them saying that it would rouse the anger of Satima.

‡ Statistical Account of Bengal, Vol. II (Nadia and Jessore).

i.e., the madman. The latter claims to have direct communion with God and to receive divine inspiration. Idolatry is discouraged though not prohibited ; his followers also differ from other Vaishnavas in having no *tirthas* or places of pilgrimage. Men of all castes are admitted, but the members are mostly of low caste.

MANIK KALI'S CULT.

540. In the south of Midnapore there is a sect known as the followers of Manik Kali. The original founder of this sect appears to have been a Kaibartta, named Hedaram Das, who lived at Gopinathpur in the Jalamutha *pargana* towards the end of the 18th century. Hedaram Das was a man of a religious turn of mind who composed books in Oriya : his books are preserved at Gopinathpur together with his wooden slippers. The slippers are regularly worshipped and also one of his books called Agam Puran. The Agam Puran is said to contain the prophecies of Hedaram, but no one knows what they are, as the book is held in such awe that it is believed that a look into it is fatal to mortal man. Hedaram appears to have been a poet rather than an active preacher, and it was left to Manik Ram Kali to disseminate his doctrines. Manik in early life followed his caste occupation of a potter, studying the works of Hedram and becoming imbued with his doctrines. He appeared as a preacher some time after 1865 and inculcated a simple system of morality, insisting on truth being spoken, and teaching his disciples the virtues of constant repetition of the name Krishna or Ram. Whenever obeisance was made to Manik by any of his followers, his response was the well-known saying *Jata dharma sthata jaya* "*i.e.*,' prosperity follows the observance of Dharma." Caste distinctions were more or less obliterated. He and his disciples did not scruple to partake of food cooked by any of his followers whatever their caste ; the restcritions of caste were also ignored in marriages between them. He succeeded in securing several thousand converts from among the low caste people of Jalamutha and the neighbouring *parganas*, and not a few Kaibarttas became his disciples. Wealthy men prepared golden anklets for his feet (one of which was disfigured by elephantiasis), while his disciples worshipped him as an *avatar*. Festivals were observed in his honour, in all of which Manik was made to play the part of an idol. During these festivals hundreds of maunds of rice and curry were cooked and distributed among the people, who partook of them freely and without regard to caste distinctions. Manik died at an advanced age about 15 years ago; since his death the number of his followers has diminished.

SHAINS.

541. A new sect called simply Shains is said to have sprung up in Bankura within the last few years. The information regarding this sect is scanty, but it appears that its founder was a Bengali called Bhagwan Shain and that its members refuse to recognize any deity whom they cannot see. The Guru alone is worshipped. His injunctions are not to lie, steal or cohabit with women, but to associate with good men *(sadhus)* and try to know one's self. Speaking truth and the attainment of self-knowledge are ideals common to many other Hindu sects.

SHIKSHAPARAS.

542. The Shikshaparas are a small offshoot of the Vaishnava sect in Central Bengal. According to the reports received, the followers of this cult hold that Krishna is the only male principle in the universe, and that all else constitutes his *Prakrti* or female principle. A woman belonging to the sect is said to look upon Krishna as her spiritual husband and her mundane husband as a conventional appanage. She regards the Guru as Krishna's representative on earth, accords him the same veneration as Krishna himself, and has no objection to giving him the privileges of a husband. Caste distinctions are obliterated, and members belonging to different castes partake of food together.

SECTS IN BIHAR.

543. Bihar is not so prolific of new sects as Bengal, and most of those in existence have had their origin in the north of India, such as the Arya Samaj and the Radhaswami cult already described. The following is a brief account of other sects which still maintain their hold, though they appeal to a limited circle.

SHEONARAYANIS.

544. The origin and beliefs of the Sheonarayanis were described in the last Census Report. Briefly. they believe in one formless God and have a sacred book called the

Sabda Granth, which lays down that salvation can be attained only by faith in God, control of the passions and obedience to the Guru. All castes are admitted to membership, but marriage take place only within the caste: a Sheonarayani Chamar, for instance, will not marry the daughter of a Sheonorayani Dosadh. The members are nearly all recruited from low castes, especially Dosadhs and Chamars: in Champaran Chamars are practically its only representatives. Idolatry, the eating of flesh and the drinking of intoxicating liquor are proscribed, but the latter two practices are gaining ground and the tombs of Gurus are worshipped, offerings of fruit and sweetmeats being made at them. The sect does not appear to be progressive.

KABIRPANTHIS.

545. The Kabirpanthis have a considerable number of representatives in Bihar, where the sect is mainly confined to the lower classes. They are followers of Kabir, who, as is well known, endeavoured to establish a religion that would embrace both Hindu and Musalman, rejecting distinctions of caste, sect and rank and preaching the equality of man. The pure doctrines he inculcated have been obscured by later accretions. One God only is worshipped and idolatry is forbidden, but these principles are so far departed from, that Kabir is regarded as an incarnation of God, and offerings of fruit and sweetmeats are made at the tombs *(samadhis)* of the Mahants to the accompaniment of *arati*, ringing of bells, etc. There are two classes consisting of *grihasthas*, who lead an ordinary social life, and of ascetics who are supposed to be celibates: some, however, keep concubines, and the children of such illicit unions are recognized as members of the community. They profess to discard caste restrictions, but converts belonging to clean castes from whom water may be taken by Hindus will not allow converts recruited from low castes, such as Chamars and Dosadhs, to eat with them; the cook must, moreover, be a Brahman or Rajput.

Some Kabirpanthis are also found in Orissa, and especially Sambalpur. The sect is mostly recruited from weaving castes, such as the Pankas, so much so that the Brahmans call it the weaver's religion, but it also includes a number of Agarias: the weavers predominate, their own explanation being that the sect is specially intended for them because Kabir himself was a weaver. The sect now recognizes caste, and practically its only social result is that the Kabirpanthi members of a caste frequently form a separate endogamous division, and are distinguished from the others by abstaining from meat and liquor. The worship of idols is also prohibited, but practice lags behind precept, and there is a tendency to idolatry.

NANAKSHAHIS.

546. Nanakshahis are also found in scattered colonies in some districts, such as Shahabad and Saran. The original tenets of the founder have been almost lost sight of. Images are kept in their *maths* and worshipped, and Guru worship is a prominent feature of these modern professors of Nanak's faith. Celibacy is not strictly adhered to, for marriages are contracted or irregular unions are formed.

DARIAPANTHIS.

547. The founder of the Dariapanthi sect was one Daria Sahib, who is said to have been born in the 18th century at Dharkunda, a village 20 miles south of Buxar in Shahabad. Its members are also known as Satnamis from their invocation of God as Satnam, the true name; but they have no connection with the Satnami sect of the Central Provinces and Sambalpur. It is an order of ascetics, who are not allowed to marry, eat animal food or drink spirituous liquor. Members of all castes may join, and those belonging to clean castes, *i. e.*, castes from whom a Hindu will take water, eat together. Only the Supreme Being is worshipped, and no idols are kept in the *maths*. Only the Mahants of these *maths* may wear beards and moustaches; the others shave. No funeral ceremonies are observed: the dead are buried in a sitting position at the side of a ditch. The chief seat of the sect is Dharkunda, where the hereditary Guru lives: the present Guru is fifth in the line of descent.

SATNAMIS.

548. The Satnami sect of Sambalpur was founded between 1820 and 1830 A. D. by a Chamar named Ghasidas, who proclaimed the perfect equality of all men and the worship of the one true god under the title of Satnam or the true name. He inculcated seven cardinal principles, of which the following are the most important.

His followers were to abstain from drinking spirituous liquor and from eating meat and certain vegetables, such as chillies and tomatoes, because their colour resembles blood. Idol worship was prohibited, cows were not to be used for ploughing, and oxen were not to be worked after midday. Caste was abolished, and all men were to be socially equal except the family of Ghasidas, in which the priesthood of the cult was to be hereditary.

ABDHUTAS.

549. The Abdhutas are a sect found in the Orissa States and the Khurda subdivision of Puri, who also worship the "Name." The founder of the sect was one Banamali Das, who about 50 years ago took up his abode in one of the caves at Khandgiri, and taught that only the sacred name should be worshipped. The name is, in fact, Brahma or God, and the worship of the name is the worship of God. All men are of one caste and should eat and drink together. The original monotheistic character of the faith is now almost obscured: the worship of the Guru and of his sandals has been substituted for the worship of the name. Members of the sect are either ascetics who wear round their necks a small metal plate with the word "Name" engraved on it in Oriya, or are laymen, mostly of low caste, who do not observe caste rules among themselves. The Abdhutas hold meetings which they call *Sattsanga i.e.*, associations of good men, and gather together every year at the Khandgiri caves on the Magh Saptami day.

SUNYA BHAJANI.

550. A recent Oriya sect, only 10 or 15 years old, is that called Sunya Bhajani, regarding which there is very little information. It is said that its adherents regard the sky or atmosphere as the Godhead, believe in the incarnations of Vishnu, and have a firm faith that the Kali Yuga is drawing to a close, and that Vishnu will be reincarnated in the house of a Brahman at a Kakatpur in the Gop thana of Puri, after which the golden age will be ushered in. They eat and drink together, but marry only within their respective castes. The name of the sect and its adoration of Sunya, the Void, may point to an infiltration of Buddhist ideas.

SIKHS.

SIKHS.

551. It would appear from the account of Buchanan Hamilton that a century ago the followers of the Sikh religion were fairly numerous in Bihar. He spoke of the Sikh sect in Bihar as being considerably more numerous than any of the five that "since the time of Sankaracharya had been usually considered orthodox." Their doctrines had made much more progress in Bihar (*i.e.*, Patna and the north of the Gaya district) and Shahabad than in Gorakhpur; Rekabganj in the suburbs of Patna was "by far the greatest place of worship in these countries." At the latter place Buchanan Hamilton met one Govinda Das, who was the chief of a *bang*, or division of the sect, presiding over 360 *gaddis* or thrones, *i.e.*, "a considerable but indefinite number of places where there is a seat, called a throne, for his reception." There were other Sikh priests in the same two districts (Bihar and Shahabad), who claimed independent jurisdiction. The Sikhs mentioned by Buchanan Hamilton seem to have been lax followers of Nanak, for he noted that they "follow exactly the same customs that they did before their admission; they observe the same rules of caste, employ the Brahmans as *purohits* in every ceremony, and in all cases of danger worship exactly the same gods; they abandon only the daily worship of the family god (*kuladevata*)."*

552. Both the followers of Nanak, the first Guru, and Govind Singh, the tenth and last Guru, are still found in the Province. The former, who are known simply as Sikhs, shave their heads like Hindus, believe in the Adi *granth* or first *granth* compiled by Arjun, and not in the volume compiled by Govind, and practise the early form of initiation known as *charanahol* or initiation by the feet (from *charan*, foot, and *gholna* to melt). The earliest form of this ceremony, which is said to have been instituted by Nanak himself, consisted of drinking water in which the Guru had bathed, but

* Montogomery Martin's *Eastern India*, Vol. I., pages 211 and 214; Vol. II, pages 448-449.

Angadh, the second Guru, thought it sufficient to give neophytes a draught of water in which he had bathed his feet and not his whole body. In Bihar the majority of these Sikhs appear to belong to one or other of two sects known as Udasi or Nanakshahi.

The followers of Guru Govind are practically confined to Patna and Sasaram in the district of Shahabad. They are known as Singhs or lions, an appellation assumed by Govind and given by him to his adherents. They revere the *granth* of Govind Singh, and wear the five Ks (*kakkars*), viz., the *kesh* or long hair, the *kirpan* (a small knife with an iron handle round which the hair is rolled), the *kanga* or wooden comb, the *kachh* or drawers, and the *kara* or iron bangle for the wrist. They also strictly observe the five injunctions of Govind Singh that no Sikh should smoke, cut or shave his hair, eat flesh killed according to Muhammadan custom, have connection with Muhammadan women, or eat with any one but a true Sikh (*Musli nal judh na karna*, euphemized at Patna to *Muhammad ki bakri ke sath judh na karna*, *i.e.*, do not enter into a duel with the goat of Muhammad).* Neophytes are admitted into the brotherhood by the *khanda ka pahul* or initiation with the dagger—*pahul* is believed to be derived from *pahila*, first. This is a form of lustration by water which has been sanctified by the immersion of steel, and was introduced by Govind Singh, who had a firm belief in the virtues of steel. The priest stirs with a dagger some water in which a sweetmeat called *batasa* has been mixed, repeating verses from the *granth*. The priest sprinkles the water on their eyes, their faces, and the tops of their heads, after which each of them drink it. They then take from his hands the *kara prashad*, or sacramental food, and give it to one another in token of fraternity. This is a mixture of *ghi* (clarified butter), unpurified brown sugar, and fine flour mixed together with water; the term means the sweetmeat of good will (*karai*, confection and *prashad*, good will).

553. The Singhs of Patna are particularly strict in their observances, as is only natural considering that they are the custodians of the Har Mandir, a temple which marks the birthplace of Guru Govind Singh and enshrines his cradle, his shoes, and a copy of the *granth*, in which the Guru is said to have written his name with a point of an arrow. The temple is one of the sacred places of the Sikhs, who visit it on pilgrimage. Patna is one of the few places in India where the Sikh religion may still be seen in something like its primitive purity. "At Patna," writes Mr. Macauliffe, "the Sikhs pay the strictest attention to the injunctions of Guru Govind. Sleeping or walking, they are never without the habiliments known as the 'five Ks.' So strong is the aversion of the more orthodox among them to Hindus, that they will not even partake of food cooked by their hands. This is carrying orthodoxy a long way, but still further it is carried when they will not partake of food cooked even by a Sikh who has not on his person all the five Ks."†

554. At Sasaram the Sikhs are mainly composed of Aghraharis, who follow the trade of cloth and grain merchants, and are divided into two classes, viz., the Singhs and the Munas or Munrias. The Singhs, who form the majority, are followers of Guru Govind Singh, and observe a rite of initiation which corresponds to the *pahul* of orthodox Sikhs. This ceremony, which they call *khanda amrit chakhao* or the *charna amrit chakhao*, is performed in the presence of five Sikhs. The neophyte has to put on the *karad*, *kara*, *kachh* and *kanga*, drink the *charna amrit* (*i.e.*, sugar and water mixed and stirred with a dagger), and finally partake of the *kara prashad*. This latter sacrament is also taken on the last day of the month, during festivals and in fulfilment of vows: one special feast at which all members of the caste attend is held annually during the rainy season on the 16th *Bhado*. Any neglect or failure to keep the hair and beard unshorn, to eschew the hookah and to wear the articles of dress already mentioned is visited with excommunication, even though it may be due to such an accidental circumstance as illness. The

* These observances were originally designed for military purposes. Long hair tied round the head with knives enclosed in it, was a protection against sword cuts; moustaches and beards gave a martial appearance. The drawers fastened by a waistband were more suitable for a soldier than the loose garments of a cultivator. The permission to eat flesh, except that of the cow, was intended to give physical strength, and the prohibition of tobacco was designed to prevent strength being impaired.

† M. Macauliffe, *The Sikh Religion under Banda and its present condition*. Calcutta Review. Vol. LXXIII.

offender can only be re-admitted into the brotherhood by paying a fine, and again going through the purifying ceremony of the *charna amrit*. The Munas are followers of Nanak and shave like other Hindus.

The two sects intermarry to a slight extent, as a Singh Agrahari can marry his son to the daughter of a Muna, if a ceremony, known as *pabitri*, is performed, *i. e.*, if the girl goes through a ceremony of initiation, at which she worships Govond Singh's *granth* and drinks the *charna amrit*. She is considered to have entered the community of Singh Agraharis by performing this rite, and the marriage is rendered possible. There is, however, a strong objection among the Singhs to any of their daughters marrying a Muna boy: such a marriage is looked on as a disgrace to the family.

555. Although the Agraharis have retained some of the forms of Sikh ceremonial, they have in many ways relapsed into Hinduism. The common class have no scruples about worshipping the images of Hindu gods or adopting the religious customs of their Hindu neighbours. Although they still continue to worship the *granth*, which is, they aver, their *ishtdevata* or favourite god, they also recognize a *kuldevata* or family god. The latter may be any member of the regular Hindu pantheon such as Devi, Durga, Hanuman, Mahabir, or even less orthodox gods, such as Narsingh or the Panch Pir—the adoration of the latter is due possibly to the fact that Sasaram is a Muhammadan town. The leavening influence of Hinduism may also be seen in their domestic and social ceremonies, such as funerals and marriages. They perform *sraddha* in the same way as other Hindus, and go on pilgrimage to Gaya to make offerings for the souls of their ancestors. In fact, as regards funeral obsequies, the Singh Agraharis are differentiated from other Hindus only by the fact that they do not shave their hair as a sign of mourning. The marriage customs obtaining among them are also generally the same as among the Hindu community; but occasionally the more orthodox perform a special ceremony called *anand'i*, which is, they say, the old form of marriage. At this ceremony, Brahmans do not officiate, but Sikh Gurus, who recite *mantras* from the *granth*. Sikh Gurus also are the sole celebrants at the *khanda amrit* and *kara prashad*, but for other ceremonies Brahmans are commonly employed. In this respect they have followed the same tendency as other Sikhs. "The Sikhs of the Punjab have now completely relapsed into idolatry and, excepting that they still wear long hair, retain a few other external marks of the Sikh religion, and pay a reverence to the *granth*, which they carry to adoration, their worship in all respects resembles that of the Hindus. They adore idols, visit Hindu places of pilgrimage, bathe in rivers sacred in the estimation of the Hindus, and spend their substance on presents to Brahmans. They employ Brahmans to marry them, to read services of purification, to perform their funeral obsequies, and, generally, all the duties for which the laity of every religion are want to employ priestly agency." *

MUHAMMADAN SECTS.

Modern Sects.

556. Modern Muhammadan sects in the two Provinces appear to owe their origin to one or other of two beliefs. The first is that, in the beginning of each century of the Hejira or Musalman era, God raises up an Imam, as his messenger and agent, to reform the faith. The second is that in the last days the Mahdi will appear and wage war with Dajjal or Anti-Christ, who will hold sway over an unregenerate world, and that Christ, descending on earth, will assist the Mahdi to overthrow Anti-Christ. The supremacy of Islam will then be established, and all the world will be converted to the true Faith. Historically, most of the modern sects appear to be off-shoots of the Wahabi movement, which requires a somewhat detailed account on account of the effect which it has had on Muhammadan religious life in the two Provinces during the last century.

* M. Macauliffe, *The Sikh Religion under Banda and its present condition*, Calcutta Review, 1881, Vol. LXXIII, p. 163.

557. The founder of the Wahabi movement was an Arabian named Muhammad Ibn Abdul Wahab,* who appeared as a reformer in the middle of the eighteenth century. The religious system set up by him was one of simple Puritanism, the object of which was to restore Islam to a purer form of faith by stripping off the accretions which overlaid it. It claimed the right of private interpretation of the Koran, rejecting the authority of Hanifa, Malik, Shafi and Hanbal, the four Imams or founders of the orthodox schools, which bear their name. The cult of the dead and the worship of saints were sternly interdicted, and last, but not least, the obligation to carry on *jihad* or war against infidels was proclaimed in no uncertain voice.

WAHABI MOVEMENT.

558. The chief apostle of the Wahabi faith in India was one Saiyad Ahmad, a native of Rai Bareli, who proclaimed :— "The law of the Prophet is founded on two things : first, the not attributing to any creature the attributes of God ; and, second, not inventing forms and practices which were not current in the days of the Prophet and his successors, or Caliphs." Angels, spirits or saints have no power to remove difficulties or grant the attainment of any wish or desire. To believe that they can control human affairs, and to make offerings to them in that belief is infidelity. True and undefiled religion consists in adhering to the practices which were observed in the time of the Prophet and in avoiding all such innovations as marriage and funeral ceremonies, adorning of tombs, the erection of large edifices over graves, lavish expenditure on the anniversaries of the dead, street processions and the like.† These doctrines are fundamental tenets of the modern sects of Bengal.

SAIYAD AHMAD.

In 1822 Saiyad Ahmad made a pilgrimage to Mecca and there became a disciple of Wahab. On his return to India, inspired by the belief that he was the Imam of the 13th century of the Musalman era, he began a crusade against the veneration of *pirs* and the erection of shrines, denying the efficacy of offerings in the name of deceased persons, and preaching a holy war against infidels. At Patna the seed fell on fruitful ground, for there a number of Maulvis had already become disciples of Abdul Haq, a bigoted Wahabi of Benares. They now became ardent followers of Saiyad Ahmad, and as the movement gathered force, Patna was its chief centre. In 1826 Saiyad Ahmad announced that the time had come for a *jihad* against the Sikhs, and a fanatical war followed. The army and coffers of the Wahabis were replenished by supplies of men and money from Bihar and Bengal, and, in spite of reverses, the Wahabis overran the frontier, capturing Peshawar in 1830.

559. The success of the Wahabis in the north emboldened the Wahabis of Bengal to rise under one Titu Miyan. Encouraged by some successes against small detachments sent out against them, the Wahabis roamed through the 24-Parganas, Nadia and Faridpur from November 1831 to March 1832, plundering villages, defiling and forcibly converting Hindus, and maltreating orthodox Musalmans. They proclaimed that the Musalmans had resumed their hereditary rights of sovereignty and issued proclamations calling on the authorities and local zamindars to acknowledge their supremacy. At length, in March 1832, Government sent out a strong force, which met and defeated the rebels in a pitched battle, during which Titu Miyan was killed and 350 of his followers were taken prisoners. With his death and the imprisonment of 140 of his followers, the rising collapsed before it had time to extend beyond a small compass.

TITU MIYAN.

In 1831, shortly before this *emeute*, Saiyad Ahmad had been killed in battle, and his death was a serious blow to the movement, for the jurists had ruled that a *jihad* could only be carried on by an Imam If, therefore, Saiyad Ahmad was dead, the *jihad* must cease. His Caliphs were, however, equal to the emergency. A rumour spread that in the midst of the battle a cloud of dust had encircled the Imam, that he was never afterwards seen alive, nor could his body be found. The Patna Maulvis professed to

* Calcutta Review, April 1870, p. 89, and *The Indian Musalmans* (1871), p. 54.
† D. S. Margoliouth, *Muhammadanism*, p. 180.

be convinced, and declared that God, displeased with the faint-hearted Musalmans of India, had withdrawn the Imam from the eyes of men and concealed him in a cave in the mountain. When his followers proved the sincerity of their faith by uniting to carry on a *jihad*, he would reappear and lead them on to victory as before. These statements fell upon willing ears, and the movement sprang up with renewed vigour. In 1868 Government at length resolved to stamp out the conspiracy. A number of the ringleaders were arrested and convicted. The Musalmans realized the danger of the conspiracy and publicly proclaimed their disapproval of the Wahabi doctrines.

560. Throughout all these years Patna was "the focus of sedition, the Wahabi preachers finding that their audiences flagged when nothing more was urged than the purification of their lives. From this place a propaganda was carried on among the Moslems both of Indian and the neighbouring countries."† Two of their greatest leaders, Wilayat and Inayat Ali, were inhabitants of Patna. The former, after a tour through Bengal, took Bombay, Hyderabad and Central India as his special field. The latter concentrated his efforts on the districts of Malda, Bogra, Rajshahi, Pabna, Nadia and Faridpur. Karamat Ali of Jaunpur carried the movement eastwards from Faridpur into Dacca, Mymensingh, Noakhali and Backergunge. Zain-ul-Abdin, a native of Hyderabad, who had been converted by Wilayat Ali on his tour through Southern India, worked in Tippera and Sylhet. "The minor missionaries were innumerable, and a skilful organization enabled them to settle in any place where the multitude of converts made it worth their while. In this way, almost every one of the fanatic districts had its permanent preacher, whose zeal was sharpened from time to time by visits of the itinerant missionaries, and whose influence was consolidated and rendered permanent by the central propaganda at Patna." "They have," wrote the Magistrate of Patna, "under the very nose and protection of Government authorities, openly preached sedition in every village of our most populous districts, unsettling the minds of the Musalman population, and obtaining an influence for evil as extraordinary as it is certain."*

561. Since the Wahabi trials, the name Wahabi has been abandoned, mainly it would seem because the fear inspired by the breaking up of the conspiracy and the punishment of its leaders still persists to such an extent, that Wahabis are afraid to call themselves such. The Wahabis now assume one or another of two names, viz.—(1) Ahl-i-Hadis or the people of the traditions, so called because they claim a right to interpret for themselves the Hadis (the traditional sayings of Muhammad not found in the Koran), or (2) Ghair-Mukallid, meaning nonconformists or dissenters, as they do not follow the doctrines of any of the four Imams of the Sunni sect. The designation Rafi-yadain is also sometimes applied to them, because they raise both hands in prayers before genuflection and prostration and fold them at the breast and not at the navel like Sunnis : the name means, literally, raising both hands at the time of prayer.

AHL-I-HADIS.

562. The Ahl-i-Hadis are so strongly in opposition to orthodox Musalmans as to regard them as little more than infidels and their mosques as little better than Hindu temples. They regard it as their duty to take possession of the latter if possible, and have at times had recourse to the civil courts to assert a right to worship in them. In prayer, they pronounce the word Amen in a loud voice ; the use of music and the beating of drums at marriage festivities—according to some, their use renders the marriage illegal—the offering of sweetmeats, etc., to the spirits of deceased ancestors, and visits to the tombs of saints are all forbidden. Even a pilgrimage to the grave of the Prophet at Medina is looked on with disfavour, and some have been known to return from their Haj pilgrimage after visiting Mecca only. The Mazakarah-i-Illamiyya of Arrah is the Central Association of the sect in Bihar. To celebrate its twenty-first anniversary, a conference was held in January 1911 at Muhammadpur Kowari in the district of Darbhanga, at which a large number of the Ahl-i-Hadis gathered together from different parts of India. According

* *The Indian Musalmans* (1871), p. 50.

to a leaflet issued by the Secretary of the conference, their objects are—(1) to organize a missionary movement, with the object of presenting Islam to non-Muhammadans in all its purity and simplicity; (2) to help new converts in a suitable manner; (3) to inculcate the necessity of education, especially religious education, for Muhammadans; and (4) to preach the blessings of the peaceful rule of the Government. The object of the annual conferences is to give the Ahl-i-Hadis an opportunity to proclaim their views without let or hindrance. They complain that Muhammadans of different sects take part in the proceedings of other Anjumans, Shias attending Sunni Anjumans and *vice versâ*, with the result that nothing is said which would give offence to any of the conflicting sects. This they consider a sacrifice of honesty to courtesy; at their own conference they speak boldly and without fear.

563. The sect is in considerable strength in Arrah, where its members have started a Madrasa of their own in opposition to the Hanafi Madrasa. In Patna it is said to be gaining ground, some Sunni Maulvis even joining it. The converts are mostly drawn from the uneducated lower classes, but include some well-to-do hide merchants. They have little real influence, but publish leaflets denouncing the celebration of the Muharram and Sunni practices. The members shave off their moustaches, and are careful not to let their trousers reach the ankle: the most zealous wear black *nagris* and use black handkerchieves. There are very few of them in Gaya, but in Saran they are fairly numerous, and they are also strongly represented in the Rajmahal subdivision of the Sonthal Parganas. In Darbhanga they seem to have made considerable advance during the last 10 years, and claim to have strength of over 3,000. The village at Rahimabad in thana Tajpur is the head-quarters of the sect in this district: from this centre its principles have been quietly propagated. In Champaran the Ahl-i-Hadis movement has made slow but sure progress: unlike other districts, where the better classes of Musalmans will have nothing to do with the movement, the educated Musalmans are said to have a leaning towards its doctrines. Some years ago the Hanafis of Bettiah tried to prevent its members from worshipping in the town mosque, and the result was a civil suit, in which the Ahl-i-Hadis succeeded in establishing a right of entry. Their doctrines do not appear to have found much favour outside Bihar. A few years ago, for instance, one of their missionaries visited Bankura, but had to leave without making a convert. In Nadia, however, there are said to be a number of the Ahl-i-Hadis in the Meherpur and Kushtia subdivisions. The sect made some headway in Sambalpur about 10 years ago, when a wing of a Madras regiment with some Ahl-i-Hadis sepoys was stationed there. There was such friction between them and the orthodox Hanafis, who persisted in calling them Wahabis, that they contemplated building a mosque of their own, but this project died of inanition when the regiment left.

AHMADIAS.

564. The Ahmadias are the most important new Musalman sect in Bihar and Orissa. The founder of this sect was one Mirza Gulam Ahmad, who was born at Kadian in the Punjab in 1839. He appears to have received a good education in Persian and Arabic, and was for some years a clerk in the office of the Deputy Commissioner of Sialkot. In 1880 he published the first part of an work called the *Barahin-i-Ahmadiyya*, in which he claimed to be a divinely inspired reformer. In another part of the same work, published two years later, he gave an account of some revelations, in which he was addressed as Christ, and of a vision in which he learned that he and Jesus Christ had one and the same essence. At the end of 1888 he published a manifesto stating that he was commanded by God to accept an oath of allegiance (*bait*) from the people and convert them to his faith. Finally, in 1891, he issued a proclamation announcing that he was the promised Mahdi and Messiah, whose coming was foretold both in the Bible and Koran.

465. He declared that the Christian doctrine of the death and ascension of Christ was false, and also the Musalman belief that, when Jesus Christ was crucified, God sent down an angel who assumed his appearance while the real Christ was translated to Heaven. Jesus, he declared, did not die on the cross but only swooned: he did not rise from the dead, but only recovered from the

swoon; he did not ascend to heaven, but came to Afghanistan and India to preach to the lost tribes of Israel; and he now lies buried in one of the streets of Srinagar in Cashmere. Messiah, Mahdi and Krishna were merely so many names or titles, and Ahmad claimed them all. He was Mahdi, for he would reform the Musalmans; he was Messiah, because he would reclaim the Christians, who did not follow the true teachings of Christ; he was Krishna because he will bring back the Hindus to the pure teaching of the Rishis. "Heavenly signs support my claim, my prayers are accepted; future events are made known to me, and the deep and secret things, of which none but God has knowledge, are revealed to me." Ahmad was denounced by the Musalmans as a heretic, and a *fatwa* was issued excommunicating his followers. Marriage with them, burial in Muhammadan grave-yards, entrance into mosques, were all prohibited. In spite of this, Ahmad continued his propaganda and gained disciples. He eventually died in 1908 at Lahore and was buried in his native village. His successor is Hakim Nasiruddin who was elected by a majority of the votes of the Ahmadias.

566. An interesting feature of the career of Mirza Gulam Ahmad is the astuteness with which he employed modern methods to spread his doctrines and turned to account the affairs of the day. He was a voluminous writer, explaining his doctrines in three books called the *Fateh Islam*, the *Tauzih-i-Maram* and the *Izala-i-Auham*. Plague having appeared in some villages of the Punjab in 1897, Ahmad announced that he had received vision in which he saw plants of a dark colour being planted by angels which the angels told him, would bring forth the plague. On the strength of this vision he prophesied the outburst of a widespread epidemic of plague in the Punjab. His prophecy was fulfilled. He was bitterly opposed to the Arya Samaj, but was ready to meet them in debate and have the merits of his and their claims decided by argument. When he published his first work, he offered to pay Rs. 10,000 if it could be refuted. He also announced that he would pay Rs. 1,000 to any one who could prove that Jesus had shown more heavenly signs than he had. The latter challenge involved a civil suit, the claimant being a Musalman.

567. The chief points of difference between the beliefs of the Ahmadias and orthodox Musalmans are as follows. Orthodox Musalmans hold that the Mahdi will be a warrior who will convert the heathen at the edge of the sword, whereas the Ahmadias deny the advent of any such Mahdi or Messiah. They regard Ahmad as the true Mahdi and Messiah and say that he came to establish the supremacy of Islam by peaceful means. They believe that divine revelation still continues, and that Ahmad was a specially favoured recipient of revelations from God. All the religions of the world have their source in truth, but they have become corrupted. The Prophet Muhammad revealed the same great truths as are contained in other religions and recapitulated them in the Koran. All religions having the same basis of truth, the Koran repeats the truth contained in the Vedas, the Bible, the Gita, the sayings of Buddha, etc.

One significant feature of the cult is its opposition to Christianity. According to Musalman belief, when the end of the world approaches, Dajjal (Anti-Christ) will rule, and the powers of evil will reign till Christ reappears and, with the help of Mahdi, overthrows Dajjal and converts the whole world to Islam. The Ahmadia rejects this doctrine and identifies Dajjal with the teachings of the Christian Church, such as the atonement and divinity of Jesus Christ. In fact, he holds that the prophecy of the advent of Dajjal has been fulfilled by the spread of Christian missionaries.

568. The Ahmadia doctrines appear to have been first introduced in Bihar in 1893, when a Musalman missionary of Bhagalpur became a convert. The movement has already gained a considerable number of adherents from among the educated and well-to-do classes. They are most numerous in Bhagalpur and Monghyr, which form one section with a committee affiliated to the Sadar Anjuman Ahmadia, *i.e.*, the central committee at Kadian. Funds are raised for the propagation of the Ahmadia doctrines and for the publication of its monthly magazine, the *Review of Religions*. A general meeting is held almost every year at Kadian, at which the members of the sect meet from all parts of India. In Monghyr the Ahmadias have met with

considerable opposition from the orthodox Musalmans. At a large meeting held at Monghyr in June 1911 the claims of Mirza Gulam Ahmad were debated, and after long controversy he was denounced as a heretic and renegade. The sect has even made its way into Orissa. Some educated Musalmans of Cuttack embraced its doctrines during a visit to Gurdaspur, and in their turn succeeded in winning over some of their co-religionists in Puri: their total number is however small. The Ahmadias themselves claim that there are at least 500,000 of their sect in different parts of India.

THE PAGAL PANGTI.

569. In Mymensingh there is a small body of Musalmans whose social practices are so peculiar, that its members are known as the Pagal Pangti, *i.e.*, the mad class. The founder of the sect was one Karim Darwesh, who is said to have come from Arabia and to have settled at Nibar Kandi in the Kaliganj police-station about 100 years ago. He was a Pathan by caste, and his followers also claim to be Pathans. They believe in the Koran and the Prophet, but do not circumcise their boys. They neither marry Musalmans not belonging to their sect, nor take meals prepared by the latter or by any Hindu. They refuse to charge interest on loans, or to take any price for the marriage either of a bride or bridegroom. Perhaps the most peculiar of their practices is that they do not use *palkis*, umbrellas or shoes.

PRACTICES COMMON TO HINDUS AND MUSALMANS.

570. Before concluding this chapter, some reference may be made to certain practices common to Hindus and Musulmans. It must however be explained that the members of both religions who indulge in them are uneducated persons at the bottom of the social scale and that they are not representative of either Hinduism or Islam. With many of the Hindus religion means merely a propitiation of evil spirits, while many of the Musulmans do not know what the tenets of Islam are. As one Musalman gentleman told me—"They profess to be Musulmans, but to them Islam is only circumcision and eating cow's flesh." In some places, moreover, the Musulmans are descendants of Hindu converts, whose Hinduism was little more than Animism. Even after conversion they maintain their primitive beliefs and continue to observe the same ceremonies as their Hindu neighbours. In Purnea, low class Musalmans and Hindus worship Geians* *i.e.*, the spirits of dead men, their shrines being nothing more than two long bamboos stuck in the ground. Humble offerings (sugar, spices, bread and flowers) are made to the trees in which other evil spirits reside, and are subsequently placed in an earthen vessel and exposed at the nearest cross-roads. It is believed that the evil spirits are thereby bribed to leave the village and that they attach themselves to the first man who touches them. Another popular deity, who is revered by low Hindus and Musalmans alike, is Devata Maharaj, with his door-keeper Hadi, who are represented by a long bamboo planted in the ground, from which are suspended an old winnowing-basket, a bow, an old fishing net and a hook. In this district so-called Musalmans commonly make offerings to purely Hindu deities, as well as to the village godlings, a Hindu being employed to make the actual sacrifice. They celebrate Hindu festivals with their Hindu neighbours and also frequent the shrine of Kali. Attached to almost every house is a little shrine called Khudai Ghar or God's house, where prayers are offered indifferently to Allah and Kali.*

571. Even among the higher classes there is a tendency to retain Hindu customs after conversion to Islam. As an example of this may be mentioned a community found in Shahabad, who claim descent from two Rajput soldiers of fortune who served under the Mughal Emperor and rose to high office, one embracing Islam, while the other remained Hindu. The family is now divided into two branches. The descendants of one retain their Rajput purity of race; the descendants of the other are Musalmans, who still call themselves Rajputs† and till a comparatively recent date observed

* Purnea Settlement Report.

† About 500 Musalman Rajputs were returned from Shahabad.

characteristic Hindu customs. Pandits were called in to fix auspicious dates for marriages, and Hindu rites were practised during the marriage ceremony. Beef was not eaten till half a century ago; and though it is eaten now, it must be obtained from outside, no cattle being slaughtered in the village itself.

572. Many other superstitious practices are observed by Musalmans in different parts. In case of illness or snake-bite, a Hindu *ojha* or exorcist is called in, who recites *mantras* containing the names of Hindu gods or goddesses. In some parts Musalman women, when pregnant, will not cross a river. In Bengal, Musalmans make offerings through Hindu priests to Manasa, the goddess of snakes. Both in Bihar and Bengal they propitiate the goddesses of disease, such as Ola Bibi and Sitala, when epidemics break out. Musalman women in Bihar also join in the annual sun-worship known as Chhat Puja, in the firm belief that its omission will bring down on them the anger to Chhati Mata and lead to some calamity.

There are also numerous instances of Hindus adopting Musalman practices, such as the worship of the Panch Pir. Hindus who have adopted this cult will not eat meat unless the animal has been duly slaughtered by a Musalman. In parts of Bengal, Hindus make offerings (*shirni*) to Satyapir, who has been Hinduized under the name of Satya Narayan. They also frequent the shrines of Pirs in the belief that the Pirs have power to help them and avert misfortune. The *pirsthan*, as the shrine is called, is also visited on several special occasions. New-born babes are brought there, and their heads pressed down in obeisance. When a cow calves, first-fruits of her milk are offered. Newly married brides and bridegrooms go there on the way to the latter's house and make their salutations.

573. Perhaps the most interesting example of common celebration o religious rites is the Muharram, in which low caste Hindus join. though the apparently regard it as a merry festival instead of a sad memorial service Nowhere, however, so far as the writer is aware, is there such latitude as i Bihar. In some places, it is reported, low-caste Hindus actually worshi Hasan and Husain, as gods. Childless husbands and wives, even amon good Hindu castes, (*e.g.*, Kayasths, Agarwalas and Rajputs), vow that, if the have a boy, he shall serve as a *paik* during the Muharram for a certain numbe of years. Similar vows are made if a boy falls ill or passes through som crisis, the fulfilment of the vow being conditional on recovery from sickness or escape from misfortune. On the seventh, eight and ninth days of th Muharram, batches of these *paiks* may be seen running barefooted from on *akhara* to another, each with a yak's tail in his hand, small bells girdle round his waist, and a cone-shaped turban on his head specially made for th occasion. The boys, and sometimes the whole family, abstain from salt. animal food and all luxuries during the period of their service as *paiks*. This generally is three to five years, but occasionally a boy is dedicated as a *paik* for his lifetime. On the tenth day of the Muharram, Hindus take their sick to the procession so that they may touch the *tazias*, and throw *lai* (fried rice mixed with *gur*) and cowries on the *tazias*, keeping a little of the *lai* to give to the sick or to serve as a safe-guard against the evil eye. Women in some places even put on green *saris* and perform the *makham* like the Musalmans. Hindus also contribute to making *tazias* and the up-keep of the village *imambaras*: in Darbhanga town nearly the whole of the paraphernalia that is brought out during the Muharram is said to be owned by Hindus.

THE INSIGNIA OF HINDU SECTS.

Tilaks OR SECTARIAN MARKS.

574. The Hindu sects are distinguished by a number of different *tilaks*, *i.e.*, marks worn on the forehead or elsewhere. The mark is applied, with sandalwood paste or any of the other substances prescribed for the purpose, on the following 12 parts of the body;—the forehead, the neck, the two arms, the chest, the navel, the right and left sides, the lobes of the ears, the head and the back. The wearing of the *tilak* appears to be a custom dating back to

the time of the Vedic Aryans and to be as old as the *hom* ceremony itself. At the end of that ceremony the celebrant was enjoined to put marks on his forehead, on the lower part of the neck, on the top of his arms, and on the lower part of his breast. They were to be made with ashes and *ghi*, mixed together on the sacrificial ladle, and applied with the fore-finger. Their virtue and necessity were pointed out by Raghunandan, the great law-giver of Bengal, who quoted a passage from the *Mahabharata* to the effect that, after bathing, the *tilak* was to be affixed with mud, and after *hom* with ashes, in order to save one from such sins as the sight of Chandals and others. He also referred to a passage in the *Brahma Purana* saying that without the *tilak* gifts of cows, offerings to fire, the recital of holy texts, libations of water to the Manes, were all worthless. According to this *Purana*, a vertical mark was to be made with mud and three horizontal marks with ashes, but a Dwija or twice-born might make his *tilak* with sandal paste. The *Brahmanda Purana* further distinguished between the effect produced by the different fingers used for making the mark. The thumb was said to ensure good health, the middle finger longevity, the ring-finger wealth, and the fore-finger emancipation. Four different kinds of *tilaks* were prescribed for the four *varnas*. The Brahman's *tilak* was known as Urdhapundra, which is defined as consisting of two vertical lines joining at the lower end: in Bengal the angle between them is now-a-days generally rounded as shown in figure No. 1. The Kshattriya had to have a Tripundra, the Vaisya an Ardhachandra or half moon, and the Sudra a Bartul or circular mark, as shown in figures 2—4. In spite of the fact that the Urdhapundra was intended for Brahmans, the Vaishnavas generally wear it in one form or another, while the Saivas prefer the Tripundra.

VAISHNAVA *Tilaks*.

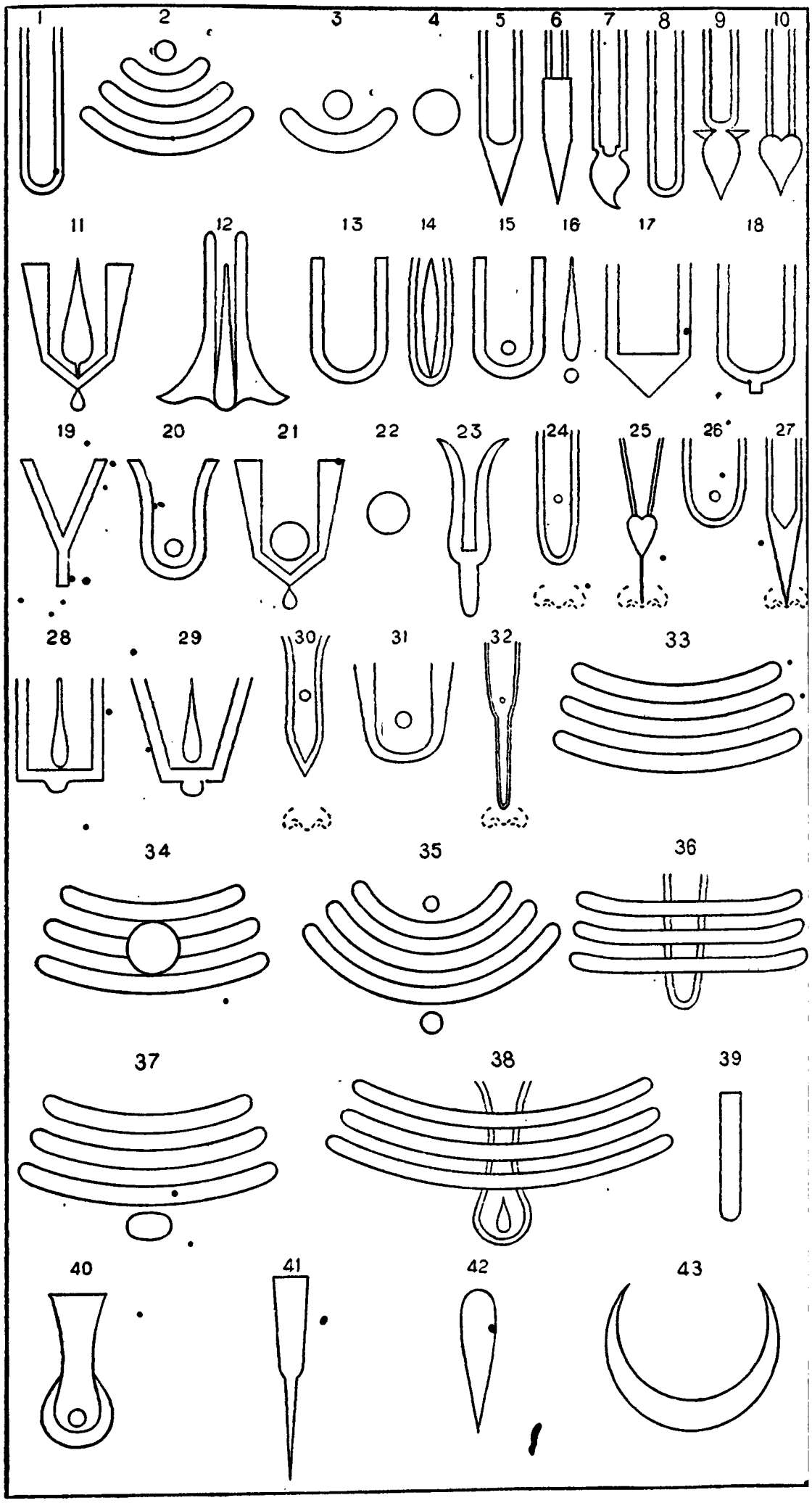
575. The Vaishnavas are strict about the wearing of the *tilak*: a devout Vaishnava, in fact, rarely omits to mark all 12 parts of the body. In addition to vertical marks, figures of the conch-shell *(sankh)*, wheel *(chakra)*, club *(gada)* and lotus *(padma)*, which Vishnu holds in his four hands, are marked on other parts of the body: the various names of Radha and Krishna are also stamped on them. The four emblems and the names are frequently carved on wooden stamps, with which they are marked on the body. The Vaishnava forehead mark is also called Harimandira. The lower part of this mark is said to represent a door-sill, and the vertical lines the sides of a door: hence the name Harimandira. According to a Vaishnava authority, the *Haribhaktibilasa* (composed in 1562 A.D.), Harimandira is really the abode of God, for the open space represents Vishnu and the two side lines Brahma and Siva.

BENGAL.

Six forehead marks commonly worn by Bengal Vaishnavas are shown in figures 5—10. Numbers 5 and 6, are worn by followers of Nityananda Prabhu and Nos. 7 and 10 by followers of Adyaita Prabhu. Number 8, which is called Nupur (foot ornament), is worn by followers of Gadadhar Prabhu, and No. 9 by followers of Acharyaya Prabhu. Each of these *tilaks* is supposed to consist of two parts, the upper part representing the Urdhapundra, and the lower part, a leaf, a flower or an ornament; and they are named accordingly, *e.g.*, as Bansapatra or bamboo leaf, Batapatra or banyan-tree leaf, and Tilapushpa or *til* flower.

BIHAR.

The different Vaishnava sects of Bihar have also distinctive *tilaks*, mostly variants of the Urdhapundra and many suggesting the shape of the trident. The Ramanujas, who are the largest sect in Bihar, are generally distinguished by that numbered 11: the outside lines are white, the inner symbol red or yellow: this symbol is called Sri. The Ramanandis have the same mark, except that the symbol in the centre is white. A white *tilak* is worn by the Lashkaris, who are so called because they are supposed to join in battle for their faith if called upon. Some Vaishnavas have simply a red Sri, without vertical lines on either side. A peculiar variety of Ramanuja *tilak* is No. 12, which is called Bargain and is prevalent among the Babhans (Bhumihar Brahmans) of Tirhut. The usual Ballabhacharya *tilak* is numbered 13: it is used more especially by the Agarwalas. That of the Madhavacharyas, which bears the number 14, has the inner line black and the outer lines white. The Gayawals


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of Gaya favour this mark, but omit the side lines. The Nimavats have a circular black or white mark between white lines * (No. 15), while the Ramprasadis wear No. 16. Other Vaishnava *tilaks* are those numbered 17—22. Number 22, which is known as *bindu*, is not confined to Vaishnavas, but worn by the Hindu public generally; when made of saffron, it is used exclusively by Vaishnava females. That numbered 23 is worn by Achari Vaishnavas in the Gaya district and is called Gangacharya.

ORISSA.

In Orissa the Vaishnava sects have an extraordinary variety of *tilaks*—it is said that there are 40 or 50 different kinds. The accompanying sketch shows nine of the principal kinds. Number 24 shows the *tilak* of the Atibadi sect: the vertical lines are white and the circular mark, which is also white, is placed a little above the bridge of the nose. Number 25 is characteristic of the Adait Acharyayas, No. 26 of the Vishnuwamis, No. 27 of the Madhavacharyas—the last extends from the top of the forehead to the tip of the nose. Number 28 distinguishes the Acharis and No. 29 the Ramanandis; in both the latter cases the outer lines are white, the inner line red. Number 30 is the *tilak* of the Bakreswar Pandits, No. 31 of the Sisus (both being white) and No. 32, which is yellow, of the Syamanandis; this latter *tilak* also extends from the top of the forehead to the tip of the nose.

SAIVA, SAKTA AND OTHER *tilaks*.

576. The Saivas have several *tilaks* called Tripundra, of which the most common are Nos. 33 and 34; they are made with ashes or sandal-wood paste and vary in colour accordingly. Number 35, which is made with the latter, is worn more especially by Maithil Brahmans and the Pandas of Baidyanath. Another form of the Saiva mark is No. 36, which is applied with ashes: it is mostly used in Tirhut. A common Sakta *tilak* is numbered 37, the Tripundra in this case is made of ashes, but the *bindu*, or round mark below, is red. Another *tilak* found in Tirhut is No. 38. The Kabirpanthis of Bihar have a vertical *tilak* of red and the Sheonarayanis of black, as shewn in No. 39. Among the former No. 40 (a yellow mark called Bhaktahi) and 41 are also found: the last extends from the tip of the nose to the top of the forehead. Number 42 is occasionally found among Nanakshahis, while No. 43 is peculiar to Ganapatyas or worshippers of Ganesh.*

* I am indebted for drawings and notes, from which the above account has been compiled, to Mahamahopadhaya Hara Prasad Sastri, Pandit Gangadhar Sastri, Pandit Deva Datta Tripathi (of Dalippur in Shahabad), Babu Raj Kishore Das, Manager of the Jagannath Temple at Puri, Rai Bahadur Jamini Mohan Das, Deputy Magistrate, Babu Syam Narayan Singh, Deputy Magistrate, and Babu Newal Kishore Sahai, Revenue Head Assistant, Patna Commissioner's office.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—General distribution of the Population by Religion.

Religion and Locality.	Actual number in 1911.	Proportion per 10,000 of population in—				Variation per cent., increase (+) or decrease (−).			Percentage of net variation.
		1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1901—1911.	1891—1901.	1881—1891.	1881—1911.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
HINDUS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	52,694 397	6,218	6,384	6,341	6,484	+ 3·9	+ 3·4	+ 4·7	+ 11·3
BENGAL	20,945,379	4,523	4,700	4,767	4,882	+ 3·9	+ 6·2	+ 5·0	+ 15·9
West Bengal	6,971,160	8,233	8,319	8,324	8,396	+ 1·7	+ 7·1	+ 3·1	+ 12·3
Central ,,	4,084,617	5,056	5,020	5,000	5,000	+ 5·2	+ 5·5	+ 3·3	+ 14·6
North ,,	4,011,633	3,788	3,921	3,974	4,008	+ 2·9	+ 4·2	+ 3·2	+ 10·7
East ,,	5,977,969	3,089	3,251	3,360	3,475	+ 6·6	+ 6·9	+ 10·3	+ 25·8
BIHAR AND ORISSA	31,749,018	8,260	8,359	8,276	8,435	+ 3·9	+ 6·4	+ 4·4	+ 8·1
North Bihar	11,725,133	8,314	8,372	8,364	8,378	+ 1·2	+ 0·2	+ 5·8	+ 7·4
South ,,	7,022,638	9,041	9,024	9,029	8,997	+ 0·9	− 3·7	+ 2·9	− 0·02
Orissa	4,059,744	9,693	9,719	9,746	9,735	+ 0·6	+ 6·8	+ 8·7	+ 16·8
Chota Nagpur Plateau	8,941,503	7,224	7,250	6,840	7,066	+ 12·1	+ 8·8	− 6·1	+ 16·3
MUSALMANS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	27,920,666	3,295	3,209	3,276	3,217	+ 9·5	+ 7·7	+ 9·0	+ 28·6
BENGAL	24,237,228	5,234	5,119	5,068	4,969	+ 10·4	+ 8·8	+ 9·7	+ 31·8
West Bengal	1,138,052	1,344	1,317	1,299	1,295	+ 4·9	+ 9·8	+ 4·3	+ 18·8
Central ,,	3,884,959	4,809	4,872	4,907	4,923	+ 3·1	+ 4·3	+ 2·9	+ 10·8
North ,,	6,360,037	5,927	5,908	5,929	5,957	+ 9·2	+ 5·3	+ 3·6	+ 18·0
East ,,	12,854,180	6,755	6,617	6,505	6,349	+ 14·6	+ 12·4	+ 16·9	+ 50·5
BIHAR AND ORISSA	3,683,438	958	968	1,072	1,085	+ 4·0	+ 1·5	+ 5·2	+ 11·0
North Bihar	2,316,202	1,643	1,621	1,614	1,606	+ 3·8	+ 0·5	+ 6·5	+ 10·6
South ,,	723,854	982	985	959	999	− 2·8	− 3·1	− 1·6	− 7·3
Orissa	113,708	272	249	239	238	+ 10·4	+ 11·0	+ 9·0	+ 33·7
Chota Nagpur Plateau	529,674	428	415	569	569	+ 17·5	+ 14·6	+ 11·4	+ 49·7
CHRISTIANS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	398,011	47	35	26	19	+ 42·6	+ 44·0	+ 49·9	+ 179·7
BENGAL	129,746	28	25	21	19	+ 21·7	+ 29·5	+ 13·9	+ 79·5
West Bengal	13,782	16	11	8	6	+ 45·8	+ 49·0	+ 41·5	+ 209·0
Central ,,	66,395	82	79	69	67	+ 8·8	+ 20·7	+ 6·0	+ 38·9
North ,,	17,257	16	9	3	2	+ 90·5	+ 169·7	+ 78·6	+ 817·9
East ,,	32,312	17	16	14	14	+ 20·0	+ 22·4	+ 21·2	+ 77·9
BIHAR AND ORISSA	268,265	70	47	34	18	+ 55·5	+ 55·0	+ 97·0	+ 310·7
North Bihar	6,473	5	4	3	3	+ 20·5	+ 32·6	+ 6·1	+ 69·5
South ,,	5,440	7	6	6	5	+ 17·7	+ 0·3	+ 13·7	+ 34·3
Orissa	5,145	12	12	12	11	+ 2·8	+ 7·9	+ 16·6	+ 29·4
Chota Nagpur Plateau	251,207	203	145	143	73	+ 59·5	+ 60·9	+ 120·1	+ 343·5
ANIMISTS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	3,451,088	407	343	327	251	+ 26·7	− 2·6	+ 39·7	+ 76·2
BENGAL	730,780	158	109	92	85	+ 65·1	+ 21·3	+ 16·5	+ 133·4
West Bengal	342,604	405	352	368	297	+ 19·1	+ 2·6	+ 28·7	+ 56·0
Central ,,	30,622	38	16	13	2	+ 148·3	+ 27·7	+ 677·0	+ 2,347·8
North ,,	282,960	264	102	44	8	+ 163·7	+ 156·9	+ 459·3	+ 3,689·0
East ,,	74,594	39	19	20	63	+ 127·8	+ 6·8	− 63·8	− 19·0
BIHAR AND ORISSA	2,720,288	708	625	617	453	+ 19·2	− 6·9	+ 45·0	+ 63·2
North Bihar	52,186	37	2	18	13	+ 1,446·2	− 86·4	+ 49·3	+ 215·0
South ,,	9,172	12	4	5	9	+ 240·6	− 27·3	− 48·4	+ 27·7
Orissa	3,770	21	20	...	12	+ 4·5	...	...	+ 101·1
Chota Nagpur Plateau	2,650,160	2,141	2,088	2,947	2,247	+ 16·9	− 6·3	+ 45·9	+ 61·4
BUDDHISTS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	248,793	30	27	27	23	+ 14·5	+ 11·7	+ 24·9	+ 59·3
BENGAL	246,866	53	50	48	42	+ 14·0	+ 11·8	+ 24·8	+ 59·2
West Bengal	118	·1	·1	·1	1	+ 34·1	+ 23·9	− 80·4	− 67·5
Central ,,	2,561	3	4	3	3	− 14·7	+ 31·7	+ 17·8	+ 32·2
North ,,	58,023	52	51	46	21	+ 11·2	+ 16·9	+ 122·6	+ 189·1
East ,,	188,164	99	96	97	99	+ 15·4	+ 10·0	+ 11·0	+ 41·0
BIHAR AND ORISSA	1,927	1	·2	·1	·1	+ 128·6	− 43·5	+ 36·8	+ 201·8
North Bihar	10	·01	·04	·02	...	− ·0·8	+ 67·7	...	...
South ,,	25	·03	·03	·1	...	+ 13·6	− 50·4	...	...
Orissa	434	1	·01	·3	·02	+ 10,750·0	− 96·9	+ 1,742·9	+ 6,100·0
Chota Nagpur Plateau	1,458	1	1	·03	·3	+ 90·6	+ 152·6	− 87·8	− 85·3
OTHERS.									
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA	28,000	3	2	3	6	+ 99·9	− 35·2	− 45·7	− 31·7
BENGAL	15,643	4	3	4	3	+ 43·7	− 35·8	+ 55·5	+ 43·6
West Bengal	1,598	2	1	1	5	+ 293·2	− 31·0	− 83·6	− 56·6
Central ,,	9,401	12	9	8	5	+ 39·8	+ 14·7	+ 63·5	+ 162·4
North ,,	3,344	3	3	4	4	+ 19·1	− 22·4	+ 6·3	− 1·7
East ,,	1,300	1	1	4	·2	+ 34·7	− 86·4	+ 2,847·6	+ 457·9
BIHAR AND ORISSA	12,357	3	1	1	9	+ 295·8	− 33·0	− 84·3	− 60·4
North Bihar	2,310	1	1	1	·02	+ 173·7	− 49·7	+ 7,196·7	+ 9,943·5
South ,,	6,553	8	1	1	·1	+ 560·6	+ 0·3	+ 1,548·3	+ 10,821·7
Orissa	306	1	1	3	4	+ 54·0	− 82·6	− 31·3	− 78·9
Chota Nagpur Plateau	3,186	3	1	1	45	+ 193·4	+ 45·4	− 97·5	− 92·0

The figures in columns 5 and 6 for Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, for Bihar and Orissa and for the Chota Nagpur Plateau are exclusive of Sambalpur and the Orissa Feudatory States, as the figures for 1891 and 1881 are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—Distribution by Districts of the main Religions.

District and Natural Division.	Number per 10,000 of the population who are—															
	Hindus.				Musalmans.				Animists.				Others.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**6,218**	**6,384**	**6,341**	**6,484**	**3,295**	**3,209**	**3,276**	**3,217**	**407**	**343**	**327**	**251**	**80**	**64**	**56**	**48**
Bengal	**4,523**	**4,700**	**4,767**	**4,882**	**5,234**	**5,119**	**5,068**	**4,969**	**158**	**103**	**92**	**85**	**85**	**78**	**73**	**64**
WEST BENGAL	**8,233**	**8,319**	**8,324**	**8,396**	**1,344**	**1,317**	**1,299**	**1,295**	**405**	**352**	**368**	**297**	**18**	**12**	**9**	**·12**
Burdwan	7,984	7,968	8,030	8,049	1,888	1,876	1,921	1,898	152	137	39	46	26	19	10	7
Birbhum	7,024	7,289	7,436	7,764	2,381	2,235	2,137	2,033	584	466	429	182	11	10	8	1
Bankura	8,696	8,740	8,604	8,743	454	558	424	444	841	799	970	812	9	3	2	1
Midnapore	8,781	8,845	8,822	8,878	636	664	651	652	516	484	521	453	17	7	6	17
Hooghly	8,103	8,207	8,142	8,053	1,668	1,759	1,832	1,937	195	26	19	...	9	8	7	10
Howrah	7,867	7,903	7,925	8,009	2,073	2,039	2,043	1,936	33	1	3	4	37	32	29	31
CENTRAL BENGAL... ...	**5,056**	**5,020**	**5,000**	**5,000**	**4,809**	**4,872**	**4,907**	**4,923**	**38**	**16**	**13**	**2**	**97**	**92**	**80**	**75**
24-Parganas	6,989	6,804	6,877	6,902	3,013	3,024	3,051	3,733	49	5	2	...	69	67	70	65
Calcutta	6,750	6,505	6,517	6,280	2,696	2,948	2,931	2,778	1	...	...	·8	553	547	502	562
Nadia	3,972	4,036	4,192	4,338	5,953	5,895	5,762	5,573	18	...	...	...	57	49	46	39
Murshidabad	4,688	4,827	4,958	5,174	5,197	5,077	4,946	4,809	103	85	74	·7	10	11	22	10
Jessore	3,799	3,871	3,905	3,962	6,186	6,124	6,039	6,036	8	...	·1	...	7	5	5	2
NORTH BENGAL	**3,738**	**3,921**	**3,974**	**4,008**	**5,927**	**5,908**	**5,929**	**5,957**	**264**	**108**	**44**	**8**	**71**	**63**	**53**	**27**
Rajshahi	2,132	2,223	2,124	2,157	7,756	7,763	7,873	7,842	109	11	2	·1	3	3	1	1
Dinajpur	4,499	4,636	4,758	4,782	4,884	4,957	5,159	5,255	604	401	69	10	13	6	13	3
Jalpaiguri	6,063	6,790	6,596	6,326	2,631	2,902	3,265	3,535	1,152	193	93	55	184	115	45	34
Darjeeling	7,141	7,542	7,665	8,171	356	370	448	527	405	138	...	40	2,098	1,930	1,887	1,262
Rangpur	3,370	3,605	3,719	3,892	6,577	6,366	6,272	6,099	44	20	2	·1	8	9	7	9
Bogra	1,695	1,804	1,887	1,918	8,229	8,182	8,047	8,031	62	12	25	...	4	2	1	1
Pabna	2,480	2,514	2,638	2,756	7,511	7,483	7,339	7,242	3	...	...	...	6	3	3	2
Malda	4,636	4,962	5,021	5,337	5,333	4,807	4,720	4,638	326	209	258	24	5	2	1	1
Cooch Behar	6,906	7,019	7,023	7,094	3,079	2,967	2,950	2,896	3	4	17	7	12	10	10	3
EAST BENGAL	**3,089**	**3,251**	**3,360**	**3,475**	**6,755**	**6,617**	**6,505**	**6,349**	**39**	**19**	**20**	**63**	**117**	**113**	**115**	**113**
Khulna	4,954	4,941	4,862	4,849	5,022	5,046	5,139	5,144	11	3	...	·6	13	10	8	7
Dacca	3,564	3,729	3,865	4,048	6,396	6,226	6,038	5,910	4	·003	2	·01	46	45	45	42
Mymensingh	2,566	2,781	3,011	3,235	7,344	7,141	6,902	6,679	84	74	85	85	6	4	2	1
Faridpur	3,652	3,786	3,882	4,006	6,320	6,190	6,098	5,975	...	...	...	...	28	24	20	17
Backergunge	2,962	3,115	3,159	3,296	6,974	6,829	6,791	6,669	·01	...	...	...	64	56	50	45
Tippera	2,768	2,934	3,124	3,363	7,223	7,034	6,867	6,633	...	...	...	...	9	8	9	4
Noakhali	2,306	2,404	2,457	2,577	7,685	7,588	7,533	7,415	...	...	...	·02	9	8	10	8
Chittagong	2,502	2,352	2,343	2,430	7,219	7,153	7,169	7,032	4	5	1	...	475	490	487	487
Ditto Hill Tracts ...	926	2,915	2,405	1,997	331	398	454	718	2,155	3	45	·1	6,388	6,684	7,096	7,285
Hill Tippera	6,885	6,877	6,670	1,032	2,329	2,615	2,698	2,818	18	154	...	6,148	268	354	632	12
Bihar and Orissa ...	**8,260**	**8,359**	**8,276**	**8,435**	**958**	**968**	**1,072**	**1,035**	**703**	**625**	**617**	**453**	**74**	**48**	**35**	**27**
NORTH BIHAR	**8,314**	**8,372**	**8,364**	**8,378**	**1,643**	**1,621**	**1,614**	**1,606**	**37**	**2**	**18**	**13**	**6**	**5**	**4**	**3**
Saran	8,846	8,818	8,818	8,826	1,152	1,181	1,181	1,173	...	...	...	...	2	1	1	...
Champaran	8,486	8,511	8,551	8,579	1,499	1,475	1,438	1,410	...	...	...	...	15	14	11	11
Muzaffarpur	8,764	8,771	8,771	8,774	1,233	1,226	1,227	1,224	...	...	...	...	3	3	2	2
Darbhanga	8,734	8,786	8,787	8,825	1,258	1,211	1,209	1,174	...	...	...	...	4	3	4	1
Bhagalpur	8,880	8,977	8,911	8,973	1,008	1,002	962	944	104	15	122	80	8	6	5	3
Purnea	5,663	5,761	5,856	5,824	4,178	4,233	4,141	4,170	151	2	...	4	8	4	3	2
SOUTH BIHAR	**9,041**	**9,024**	**9,029**	**8,987**	**932**	**965**	**959**	**999**	**12**	**4**	**5**	**9**	**15**	**7**	**7**	**5**
Patna	8,901	8,833	8,848	8,772	1,059	1,147	1,134	1,213	...	...	...	...	40	18	18	15
Gaya	8,969	8,933	8,923	8,903	1,028	1,064	1,060	1,097	·3	...	...	...	3	1	2	1
Shahabad	9,376	9,271	9,276	9,232	703	725	720	747	9	...	...	...	12	4	4	1
Monghyr	9,014	9,029	9,033	9,006	959	951	942	952	35	13	18	36	12	7	7	6
ORISSA	**9,693**	**9,719**	**9,746**	**9,735**	**272**	**248**	**239**	**238**	**21**	**20**	**...**	**12**	**14**	**13**	**15**	**15**
Cuttack	9,686	9,708	9,712	9,717	301	278	273	264	·01	...	...	...	13	14	15	19
Balasore	9,609	9,645	9,744	9,688	293	264	244	251	83	79	...	46	15	12	12	15
Puri	9,796	9,819	9,815	9,833	189	170	165	158	...	...	...	...	15	11	20	9
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU	**7,224**	**7,350**	**6,340**	**7,066**	**428**	**415**	**569**	**569**	**2,141**	**2,088**	**2,947**	**2,247**	**207**	**147**	**144**	**118**
Hazaribagh	8,373	8,100	8,247	8,371	1,035	1,016	966	961	673	867	754	663	19	17	13	5
Ranchi	3,967	3,995	3,941	3,889	369	353	320	297	4,361	4,600	5,068	5,471	1,282	1,052	671	343
Palamau	8,540	8,605	8,319	8,299	839	845	845	834	508	421	734	861	113	129	113	6
Manbhum	8,077	8,703	8,150	8,942	585	493	446	430	1,256	702	1,891	408	32	22	13	220
Singhbhum	4,197	4,321	4,225	9,869	111	88	59	51	5,573	4,578	5,617	14	119	113	89	66
Santhal Parganas ...	5,122	5,613	5,134	5,403	933	840	691	696	3,864	3,493	4,141	3,863	56	54	34	39
Angul	7,078	7,753	9,967	7,603	17	19	12	17	2,897	2,226	20	2,220	8	2	1	60
Sambalpur	9,429	9,223	Not available		48	56	Not available		469	609	Not available		44	12	Not available	
Orissa Feudatory States	8,701	8,744	"		39	38	"		1,158	1,303	"		107	12	"	
Chota Nagpur ditto ...	5,716	5,920	4,743	9,912	103	93	93	98	4,175	5,986	5,162	...	1	1	...	...
SIKKIM	**6,674**	**6,491**	...	...	**5**	**4**	...	...	...	...	...	...	**3,321**	**3,505**	...	...

In the calculations for each Province and Natural Division those areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—CHRISTIANS. NUMBER AND VARIATION.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	ACTUAL NUMBER OF CHRISTIANS IN—				VARIATION PER CENT.			
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1881.	1901-1911.	1891-1901.	1881-1891.	1881-1911.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**398,011**	**279,094**	**191,253**	**127,572**	**+ 42·6**	**+ 45·9**	**+ 49·9**	**+ 212·0**
Bengal	**129,746**	**106,596**	**82,339**	**72,289**	**+ 21·7**	**+ 29·5**	**+ 13·9**	**+ 79·5**
WEST BENGAL	**13,782**	**9,463**	**6,312**	**4,460**	**+ 45·6**	**+ 49·9**	**+ 41·5**	**+ 209·0**
Burdwan	3,820	2,960	1,408	910	+ 29·1	+ 110·2	+ 54·7	+ 319·8
Birbhum	813	819	522	48	- 0·7	+ 56·9	+ 987·5	+ 1,593·8
Bankura	1,012	363	132	56	+ 178·8	+ 175·0	+ 135·7	+ 1,707·1
Midnapore	4,166	1,974	1,545	740	+ 111·0	+ 27·8	+ 108·8	+ 463·0
Hooghly	851	759	633	655	+ 12·1	+ 19·9	- 3·4	+ 29·9
Howrah	3,120	2,588	2,072	2,051	+ 20·6	+ 24·9	+ 1·0	+ 52·1
CENTRAL BENGAL	**66,395**	**61,141**	**50,656**	**47,790**	**+ 8·6**	**+ 20·7**	**+ 6·0**	**+ 38·9**
24-Parganas	16,027	13,822	12,982	10,192	+ 16·0	+ 6·5	+ 27·4	+ 57·2
Calcutta	39,551	37,925	28,997	30,214	+ 4·3	+ 30·8	- 4·0	+ 30·9
Nadia	9,132	8,091	7,297	6,440	+ 12·9	+ 10·9	+ 13·3	+ 41·8
Murshidabad	413	391	540	470	+ 5·6	- 27·6	+ 14·9	- 12·1
Jessore	1,272	912	840	474	+ 39·5	+ 8·6	+ 77·2	+ 168·4
NORTHERN BENGAL	**17,257**	**9,058**	**3,358**	**1,880**	**+ 90·5**	**+ 169·7**	**+ 78·6**	**+ 817·9**
Rajshahi	323	351	105	121	- 8·0	+ 234·3	- 13·2	+ 166·9
Dinajpur	1,964	779	511	457	+ 152·1	+ 52·4	+ 11·8	+ 329·8
Jalpaiguri	5,501	2,486	357	159	+ 121·3	+ 596·4	+ 124·5	+ 3,359·7
Darjeeling	7,689	4,467	1,502	842	+ 72·1	+ 197·4	+ 78·4	+ 813·2
Rangpur	599	453	343	86	+ 32·2	+ 32·5	+ 298·8	+ 596·5
Bogra	161	40	15	27	+ 302·5	+ 166·7	- 44·4	+ 496·3
Pabna	500	166	162	114	+ 201·2	+ 2·5	+ 42·1	+ 338·6
Maida	430	173	72	26	+ 148·6	+ 140·3	+ 170·4	+ 1,553·8
Cooch Behar	90	143	291	48	- 37·1	- 50·9	+ 506·3	+ 87·5
EAST BENGAL	**32,312**	**26,934**	**22,013**	**18,159**	**+ 20·0**	**+ 22·4**	**+ 21·2**	**+ 77·9**
Khulna	1,693	1,275	963	747	+ 32·8	+ 32·4	+ 28·9	+ 126·6
Dacca	13,194	11,556	10,476	8,799	+ 14·2	+ 10·3	+ 19·1	+ 49·9
Mymensingh	2,181	1,291	211	151	+ 68·9	+ 511·4	+ 39·7	+ 1,344·4
Faridpur	5,810	4,641	3,539	2,741	+ 25·2	+ 31·1	+ 29·1	+ 112·0
Backergunge	6,541	5,591	4,659	3,717	+ 17·0	+ 20·0	+ 25·3	+ 76·0
Tippera	410	292	182	199	+ 40·4	+ 60·4	- 8·5	+ 106·0
Noakhali	743	662	641	588	+ 12·2	+ 3·3	+ 9·0	+ 26·4
Chittagong	1,430	1,237	1,191	1,055	+ 15·6	+ 3·9	+ 12·9	+ 35·5
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	172	252	18	49	- 31·7	+ 1,300·0	- 63·3	+ 251·0
Hill Tippera	138	137	133	113	+ 0·7	+ 3·0	+ 17·7	+ 22·1
Bihar and Orissa ...	**268,265**	**172,498**	**108,914**	**55,283**	**+ 55·5**	**+ 58·4**	**+ 97·0**	**+ 385·3**
NORTH BIHAR	**6,473**	**5,374**	**4,052**	**3,820**	**+ 20·5**	**+ 32·6**	**+ 6·1**	**+ 69·6**
Saran	437	314	278	282	+ 39·2	+ 12·9	- 1·4	+ 55·0
Champaran	2,775	2,417	2,100	1,936	+ 14·8	+ 15·1	+ 8·5	+ 43·3
Muzaffarpur	893	719	371	372	+ 24·2	+ 93·8	- 0·3	+ 140·1
Darbhanga	766	710	380	325	+ 7·9	+ 86·8	+ 16·9	+ 135·7
Bhagalpur	1,102	775	536	578	+ 42·2	+ 44·6	- 7·3	+ 90·7
Purnea	500	439	387	327	+ 13·9	+ 13·4	+ 18·3	+ 52·9
SOUTH BIHAR	**5,440**	**4,623**	**4,608**	**4,051**	**+ 17·7**	**+ 0·3**	**+ 13·7**	**+ 34·3**
Patna	2,585	2,562	2,833	2,588	+ 0·9	- 9·6	+ 9·5	- 0·1
Gaya	349	253	174	96	+ 37·9	+ 45·4	+ 81·3	+ 263·5
Shahabad	700	375	277	276	+ 86·7	+ 35·4	+ 0·4	+ 153·6
Monghyr	1,806	1,433	1,324	1,091	+ 26·0	+ 8·2	+ 21·4	+ 65·5
ORISSA	**5,145**	**5,004**	**4,638**	**3,976**	**+ 2·8**	**+ 7·9**	**+ 16·6**	**+ 29·4**
Cuttack	2,406	2,652	2,723	2,342	- 9·3	- 2·6	+ 16·3	+ 2·7
Balasore	1,458	1,274	1,075	815	+ 14·4	+ 18·5	+ 31·9	+ 78·9
Puri	1,281	1,078	840	819	+ 18·8	+ 28·3	+ 2·6	+ 56·4
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	**251,207**	**157,497**	**95,616**	**43,436**	**+ 59·5**	**+ 64·7**	**+ 120·1**	**+ 478·3**
Hazaribagh	1,786	1,163	889	552	+ 53·6	+ 30·8	+ 61·1	+ 223·6
Ranchi	177,473	124,958	75,693	36,263	+ 42·0	+ 65·1	+ 108·7	+ 389·4
Palamau	7,783	7,908	6,676	18	- 1·6	+ 18·5	+ 36,988·9	+ 43,138·9
Manbhum	4,500	2,910	1,582	552	+ 54·6	+ 89·9	+ 17·8	+ 715·2
Singhbhum	8,200	6,961	4,864	2,988	+ 17·8	+ 43·1	+ 62·8	+ 174·4
Santhal Parganas	10,163	9,875	5,943	3,057	+ 2·9	+ 66·2	+ 94·4	+ 232·5
Angul	69	33	19	6	+ 109·1	+ 73·7	+ 216·7	+ 1,050·0
Sambalpur	2,793	714	...	...	+ 291·2	...	...	...
Orissa Feudatory States ...	38,422	2,962	...	...	+ 1,197·2	...	...	...
Chota Nagpur States	18	18	...	...	+ 38·5	...	...	...
SIKKIM	**285**	**135**	...	...	**+ 111·1**	...	...	...

The figures in columns 4 and 5 for Bihar and Orissa and for the Chota Nagpur Plateau are exclusive of the figures for Sambalpur, the Orissa Feudatory States and the Chota Nagpur States, as figures for 1891 and 1881 are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—Races and Sects of Christians (actual number).

Sect.	European.		Anglo-Indian.		Indian.		Total.		Variation (increase + or decrease −).
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	1911.	1901.	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BENGAL	16,671	8,780	10,541	10,494	43,048	40,212	129,746	106,596	+23,150
Anglican Communion	9,473	4,838	3,409	3,296	9,447	8,558	39,021	38,440	+ 581
Armenian	498	271	12	5	9	4	799	535	+ 264
Baptist	315	275	228	239	11,783	11,120	23,960	16,428	+ 7,532
Congregationalist	84	64	24	26	1,199	1,137	2,534	2,044	+ 490
Greek	142	49	3	1	3	1	199	142	+ 57
Lutheran	185	46	6	1	524	452	1,214	353	+ 861
Methodist	371	194	150	219	1,503	1,534	3,971	3,395	+ 576
Minor Protestant Denominations.	25	30	8	16	56	82	217	187	+ 30
Presbyterian	1,984	677	685	261	1,985	2,130	7,722	5,350	+ 2,372
Protestant (sect unspecified)	272	150	103	93	379	485	1,482	...	+ 1,482
Quaker	3	...	1	...	...	...	4	...	+ 4
Roman Catholic	3,151	2,139	5,858	6,331	15,003	13,877	46,364	38,895	+ 7,469
Salvationist	1	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	+ 1
Syrian (Romo-Syrian)	...	...	1	1	2	...	4	...	+ 4
Sect not returned	74	31	46	3	1,134	826	2,114	823	+ 1,291
Indefinite Beliefs	93	16	7	2	16	6	140	4	+ 136
BIHAR AND ORISSA	3,930	2,386	1,766	1,639	127,490	131,054	268,265	173,498	+94,767
Anglican Communion	2,574	1,475	659	609	18,504	13,738	37,559	22,665	+ 14,894
Armenian	10	2	...	...	...	...	12	39	- 27
Baptist	62	77	59	82	5,309	5,544	11,133	5,612	+ 5,521
Congregationalist	8	8	...	1	6	6	29	7	+ 22
Greek	4	1	...	1	...	...	6	25	- 19
Lutheran	63	65	6	6	48,228	51,048	99,416	69,326	+ 30,090
Methodist	58	33	25	27	554	615	1,312	464	+ 848
Minor Protestant Denominations.	3	7	2	3	60	47	122	341	- 219
Presbyterian	264	156	28	16	528	546	1,538	1,230	+ 308
Protestant (sect unspecified)	27	14	7	4	161	147	360	...	+ 360
Quaker	1	...	...	...	...	...	1	...	+ 1
Roman Catholic	829	530	976	888	53,992	59,265	116,480	69,467	+ 47,013
Sect not returned	10	10	4	2	148	98	472	3,318	- 3,046
Indefinite Beliefs	17	8	...	...	...	...	25	4	+ 21

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—Distribution of Christians per mille—(*a*) races by sect, and (*b*) sects by race.

Sect.	Races distributed by sect.				Sects distributed by race.			
	European.	Anglo-Indian.	Indian.	Total.	European.	Anglo-Indian.	Indian.	Total.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
BENGAL	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000	196	162	642	1,000
Anglican Communion	562	319	216	301	367	172	461	1,000
Armenian	30	1	0·1	6	963	21	16	1,000
Baptist	23	22	275	185	23	19	936	1,000
Congregationalist	6	2	28	20	58	20	922	1,000
Greek	8	0·2	0·04	2	960	20	20	1,000
Lutheran	9	0·3	12	9	190	6	804	1,000
Methodist	22	18	36	31	142	93	765	1,000
Minor Protestant Denominations	2	1	2	2	253	111	636	1,000
Presbyterian	105	45	49	59	345	122	533	1,000
Protestant (sect unspecified)	17	9	10	11	285	132	583	1,000
Quaker	0·1	0·04	...	0·03	750	250	...	1,000
Roman Catholic	208	579	348	357	114	263	623	1,000
Salvationist	0·03	...	...	0·01	1,000	...	...	1,000
Syrian (Romo-Syrian)	...	0·1	0·02	0·03	...	500	500	1,000
Sect not returned	4	2	24	16	50	23	927	1,000
Indefinite Beliefs	4	1	0·2	1	779	64	157	1,000
BIHAR AND ORISSA	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000	23	43	964	1,000
Anglican Communion	641	372	125	140	108	34	858	1,000
Armenian	2	...	...	0·04	1,000	...	...	1,000
Baptist	22	41	42	42	12	13	975	1,000
Congregationalist	3	0·2	0·04	0·1	552	34	414	1,000
Greek	1	0·2	...	0·02	833	167	...	1,000
Lutheran	20	4	384	371	1	0·1	999	1,000
Methodist	14	15	5	5	69	40	891	1,000
Minor Protestant Denominations	2	2	0·4	0·4	82	41	877	1,000
Presbyterian	67	13	1	6	273	29	698	1,000
Protestant (sect unspecified)	6	3	1	1	114	31	855	1,000
Quaker	0·1	...	...	0·003	1,000	...	...	1,000
Roman Catholic	215	548	438	434	12	16	972	1,000
Sect not returned	3	2	1	1	74	22	904	1,000
Indefinite Beliefs	4	...	...	0·1	1,000	...	...	1,000

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—Religions of Urban and Rural Population.

Natural Division.	Number per 10,000 of Urban population who are—					Number per 10,000 of Rural population who are—				
	Hindu.	Muslman.	Animist.	Christian.	Others.	Hindu.	Muslman.	Animist.	Christian.	Others.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
BENGAL	**6,728**	**2,975**	**17**	**203**	**77**	**4,373**	**5,388**	**168**	**16**	**55**
West Bengal	8,009	1,790	45	138	18	8,250	1,309	433	7	1
Central Bengal	6,531	2,810	11	277	71	4,602	5,320	45	32	0·4
North Bengal	5,427	4,104	3	173	293	3 701	5,967	269	13	50
East Bengal	5,353	4,480	6	80	81	3,031	6,813	40	16	100
BIHAR AND ORISSA	**7,507**	**2,240**	**72**	**147**	**34**	**8,287**	**913**	**730**	**67**	**3**
North Bihar	7,286	2,602	9	89	14	8,345	1,614	38	2	1
South Bihar	7,313	2,550	...	80	57	9,164	816	13	2	5
Orissa	8,381	1,430	1	176	12	9,745	226	22	6	1
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	7,713	1,518	374	363	32	7,214	406	2,177	200	
SIKKIM	...	...	...	...	...	**6,674**	**5**	...	**32**	**3,289**

CHAPTER V.*

AGE.

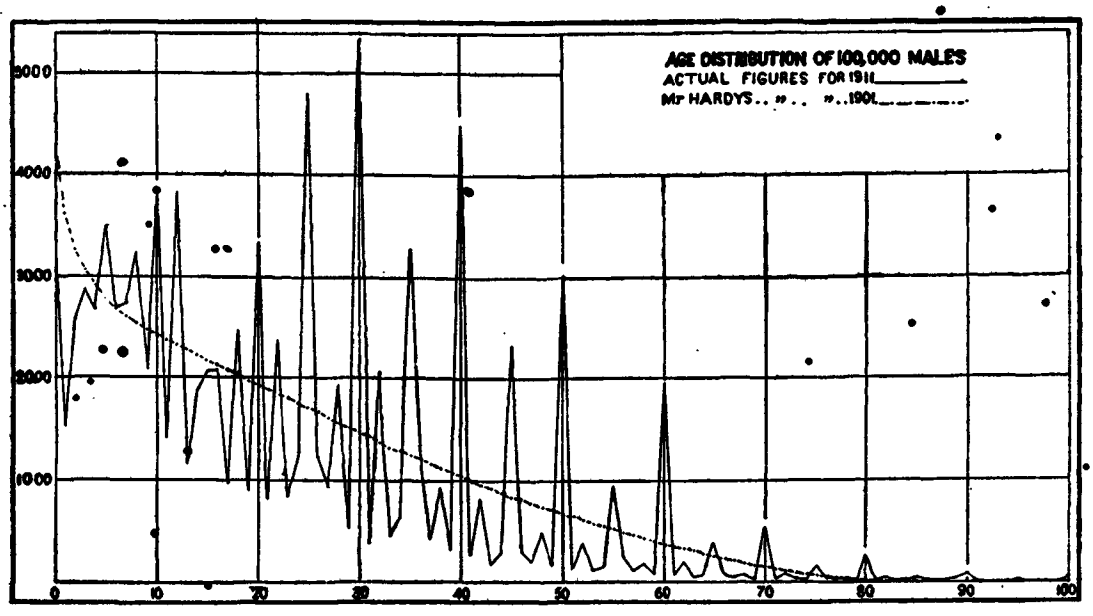
577. Introductory. The statistics of age are contained in Imperial Table VII of the volume of tables, where they are distributed according to civil condition and religion, *i.e.*, among the unmarried, married and widowed of each religion. The figures in this table are given separately for each year up to 5, after which they are arranged by quinquennial groups up to 70, those who are 70 and over being grouped together. In accordance with modern statistical practice, the age 0 indicates infants under one year of age, while the first number in each age group indicates the age reached and the last number the age not yet reached. The group 5—10, for instance, includes persons who are 5 years old but not yet 10 years old, *i.e.*, those whose completed ages are either 5, 6, 7, 8 or 9 years. The statistics of age in relation to sex, marriage, education, infirmities, etc., are discussed in other chapters. The present chapter deals with the general distribution by age of the total population and of members of different religions, and also with the age returns of the principal castes, tribes and races, the figures for which will be found in Table XIV. The vital statistics of the two Provinces will also be briefly examined in connection with the question of the longevity and fecundity of the people and the changes in their age distribution since the previous census. Proportional figures illustrating the more important features of the statistics are given in the following subsidiary tables at the end of this chapter :—

I.—Age distribution of 100,000 of each sex by annual periods.
II.—Age distribution of 10,000 of each sex in each Province and natural division.
III.—Age distribution of 10,000 of each sex in each main religion.
IV.—Age distribution of 1,000 of each sex in certain castes.
IV-A.—Proportion of children under 12 years of age and of persons over 40 to those aged 15—40, and also of married females aged 15—40 per 100 females, in selected castes.
V.—Proportion (1) of children under 10 and of persons over 60 to those aged 15—40, and (2) of married females aged 15—40 per 100 females, in each district and natural division.
V-A.— Ditto for each of the principal religions.
VI.—Variation in the population at certain age periods.
VII.—Reported birth-rate by sex and natural divisions.
VIII.—Reported death-rate by sex and natural divisions.
IX.—Reported death-rate by sex and age in the last decade, and in selected years, per mille living at the same age according to the census of 1901.
X.—Reported deaths from certain diseases per mille of each sex.
XI.—Infantile mortality.

578. Inaccuracy of the Returns. The age returns are one of the curiosities of the Indian census. The instructions regarding them are simple enough, viz., that the number of years which each person has completed is to be entered, and that children less than one year old are to be entered as infants. The latter rule was laid down in order to prevent the number of months they had lived being entered, and so avoid the risk of that number being confused with years in compilation. These are really counsels of perfection, for the great mass of the people have but the vaguest idea of their age. The supervising staff enumerators can exercise no effective check, for they have quite as nebulous ideas on the subject, and blithely take down the wild guesses made by the people themselves. It must not be imagined that the entries are even approximately correct. Among the illiterate it is not uncommon for an old man to say he is "probably 25," and for a father to give his age as less than that of his son. Many simply plead entire ignorance, but others, and they the great majority, give such ludicrous replies as *bis chalis*, *i.e.*, 20 or 40. There is, it is true, a record of the birth of the higher and middle

*This chapter has been written in collaboration with my Personal Assistant, Babu Naba Gauranga Basak, M.A., Deputy Magistrate and Deputy Collector.

class Hindus, viz., the horoscope in which the astrologer records the day hour and minute of birth, as well as the star under which a child is born. These papers are carefully consulted before marriages take place and are sometimes produced in legal proceedings, but otherwise they are rarely referred to. The enumerator would not be allowed to examine them, even if he wanted to do so, and in any case would not be able to understand them. Inaccuracy is a characteristic of the ignorant, and it has been found that the accuracy of the age returns corresponds to the extent to which education is diffused. In Bengal, Bihar and Orissa the number of literate persons is extremely small. Out of every 1,000 persons, only 112 are literate among the males and barely 8 among the females, though the test of literacy is a very modest one, viz., the ability to write a letter to a friend and to read the reply to it. The number able to recollect their age is probably even smaller.



579. In a population, such as that of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, which is increasing by natural reproduction, the returns for age should show the greatest number of persons as being under one year of age, and the number should steadily decrease in subsequent years, as shown by the dotted curve in the above diagram. This is very far from being the case, and it will be seen that other absurdities are painfully numerous. There is a general fondness for multiples of 5, especially the even multiples (10 and its multiples), and also for even numbers. In particular, there is (1) a marked deficiency in the figures for the age 0—1 and specially for the age 1, (2) a heaping up of figures about the age 25—30 at the expense of the preceding and following ages, and (3) a special preference for the numbers 25, 30 and 40, and also for 12 and 3, the former of which seems to be the favourite number among the non-multiples of five, while the latter is a favourite number in early years. Over two-fifths of the population returned their age as 0, 5 or multiples of five, though these constitute only about one-fifth of the numbers open to them. Among the numbers other than 0, 5, or multiples of five, even numbers were selected by one-third and odd numbers by only one-fifth of the population. The fondness for even numbers is attributed by Sir Athelstane Baines, K.C.S.I., to the quaternary system of calculation, which is largely in vogue in this country :* the anna, for instance, is divided into 4 pice, the rupee into 16 annas, and the seer into 16 chittacks. The predilection for multiples of 10 appears to be much greater among the aged. Of the persons returned as aged 60 and over, two-thirds plumped on 60, 70 or 80 as their age, and one-third chose the remaining 27 numbers.

COMMON ERRORS.

580. The very small number returned as one year old is illustrated by the marked fall in the graph at that age. This appears to be due, partly to the rule that children under one year of age should be entered as infants, and partly to the usual practice of counting the current year as part of one's age.

*Journal of the Royal Statistical Society, June 1908, p. 295

Though the enumerators were instructed to record the number of years actually completed and (in order to avoid confusion between months and years) to enter the word infant for children under one year of age, it is very likely that many children in their second year, who should have been returned as one year old, were actually returned as two years old. Many more children, being still at the breast and so popularly known as infants, were probably returned as such, and were therefore classed as under one year of age in the course of tabulation. There is also a deficiency in the number returned for the age 0, *i.e.*, under one year of age, which is probably due in part to the omission of a certain number of infants from the return. The preliminary record was prepared about three weeks before the date of the census, and it is not unlikely that some new births during the intervening period escaped notice when the enumerators went their rounds on the census night in order to bring the preliminary record up to date. On the other hand, it must be stated, in fairness to them, that some enumerators showed meticulous care over such entries. One man even entered every detail but sex for an unborn child, as he was quite sure it would be born before the day of the census and wanted his record to be absolutely complete. The sex, he explained, could easily be filled in when the child was born. It is also possible that the age of some infants was returned in months, which were taken for years in the course of compilation.

The deliberate mis-statement of age is another fruitful source of errors in the age returns. The heaping-up of the figures about the age 25 to 30 illustrates the general desire to be considered young that exists amongst men approaching middle age, especially amongst widowers who are either anxious to marry again or who have already married young girls. With females the proneness to mis-statement occurs at an earlier age. According to the *Sastras*, Hindu girls should be married before they attain puberty: hence, the ages of grown-up Hindu girls are often under-stated if they are still unmarried. On the other hand the ages of married girls, especially those who become mothers at an early age, are often over-stated. Exaggeration of age is also very common amongst the aged of both sexes and especially amongst females.

UTILITY OF THE STATISTICS.

581. In spite of all their glaring defects, the statistics of age have some value, because (*i*) there is no better material on which to base an estimate of the longevity of the people and their birth and death-rates; (*ii*) by the law of large numbers, the positive and negative errors, *i.e.*, the effects of exageration and under-statement, tend to cancel one another to a certain extent; (*iii*) the effects of the plumping on certain favourite numbers can be eliminated by a careful process of smoothing or adjustment; and (*iv*) the nature and degree of error from census to census may be assumed to be constant.* The age statistics consequently have a relative value, and help to bring to light changes in the age distribution due to famine, plague or other disturbing causes. As on previous occasions, an English actuary was engaged to prepare a memorandum on the age tables and rates of mortality, and it was hoped that his work would be finished in time for the incorporation of his conclusions in the report. This hope has not been fulfilled, but it is expected that the memorandum will shortly be published. As it will deal fully with the age statistics and the deductions to be made regarding the birth and death-rates and the longevity of the people, after eliminating the errors by elaborate processes of adjustment, there will only be a brief discussion in this chapter of some of the more obvious features presented by the statistics.

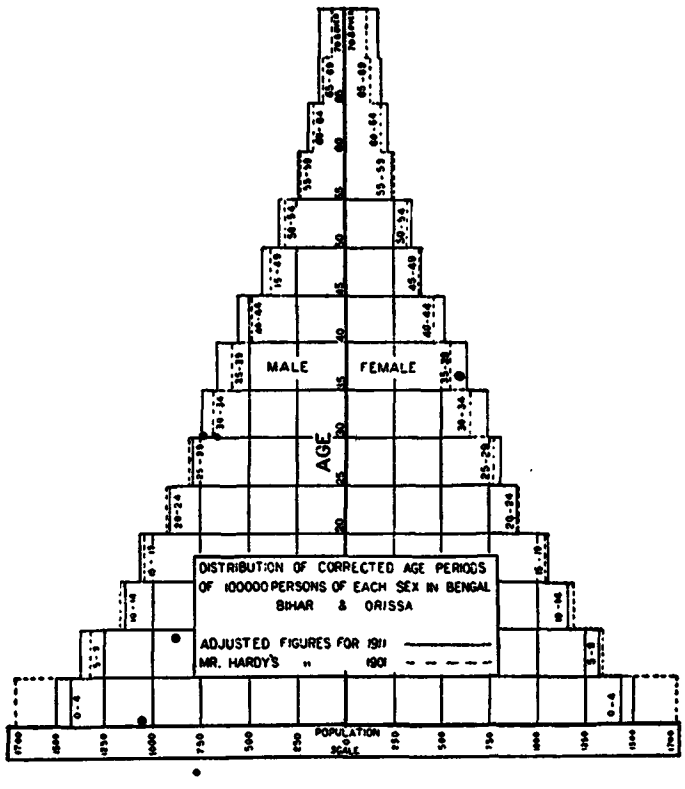
MEAN AGE.

582. The mean age is the average age of the persons who were alive on the date of the census, and not the mean duration of life. It necessarily depends largely on the proportion of young children and old persons to the total population. An increase in the birth-rate will result in a larger proportion of children and lower the mean age. Conversely, where the number of children is small and old persons are numerous, the mean age will be high. A high mean age may, therefore, mean either a long average span of life, or a small proportion of children consequent on a low birth-rate, or both. On the other hand, a reduction of the mean age may be due to a decrease in the average longevity, or to an increase

* Graphs prepared to illustrate the age distribution (1) of males in general, of Hindu males and females, and of Muhammadan males in 1911, (2) of males in general and Hindu males in 1901, and (3) of females in general in 1891, show wonderful similarity in almost all the important details.

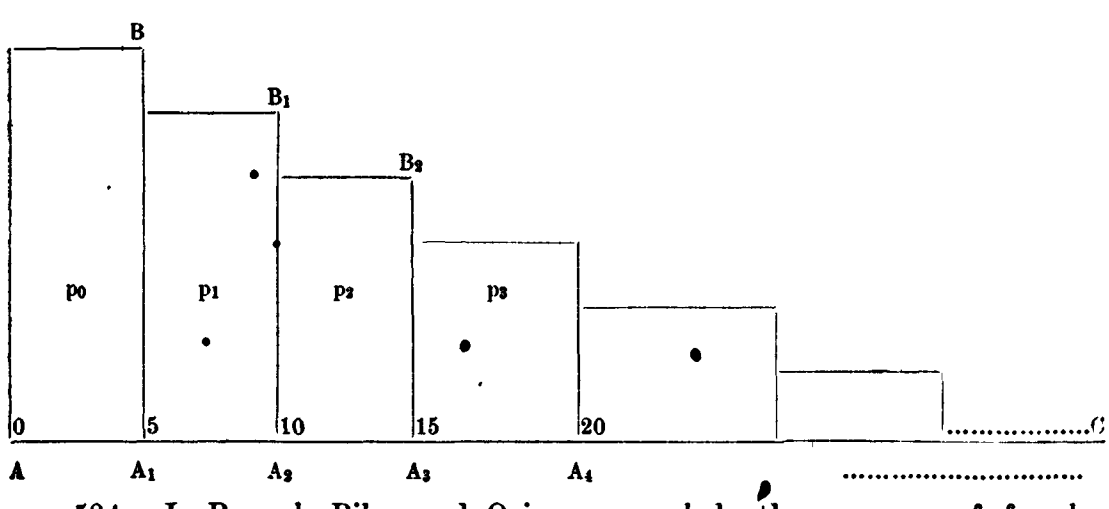
in the birth-rate, or to both. In fact, like all large statistical averages, the figures for mean age are of value rather for the questions they suggest than for the answers they supply. From the statistics of mean age we cannot draw any definite conclusion regarding the relative fecundity or longevity of different communities without also examining their age distribution and vital statistics.

583. The mean age of the people at each of the last four censuses has been given for each natural division in Subsidiary Table II, and for the main religions in the two provinces as a whole in Subsidiary Table III. In order that the figures for 1911 may be comparable with those for the previous census, they have been calculated in the manner adopted in 1901. Briefly, the irregularities in the age statistics have been roughly adjusted by an arithmetical process known as "Bloxam's method of smoothing," and then the mean age has been calculated from the adjusted figures in the method described on page 390 of the last Census of India Report, Administrative Volume.* That the adjustment according to Bloxam's method is a rough one, will be seen from the marginal diagram, in which the adjusted figures thus obtained and Mr. Hardy's figures for 1901 have been plotted side by side for facility of comparison. The figures for the mean age based on the adjusted age statistics are, therefore, only approximate, but, the errors involved in the calculation being practically constant, they have some relative value and may be utilized for comparison between different censuses, localities and religions, and also between the sexes.



* The rule which has been quoted from the French Census Report for 1891, is briefly as follows:—"Determine the total number of persons living at the close of each age period. The sum of these totals multiplied by 5, the difference of the age divisions, and raised by 2½ times the number of persons dealt with, gives the number of years lived. The mean age is obtained by dividing this last number by the number of persons living."

This rule, writes Babu Naba Gauranga Basak, can be easily established thus:—



VARIATIONS IN MEAN AGE.

BY SEX.

584. In Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, as a whole, the mean age of females has been higher than that of males at all the censuses—a fact which suggests (i) greater longevity among females and (ii) an excess of males among children. The question of relative longevity by sex, religion and

locality will be discussed in a subsequent paragraph, and that of the sex proportions in the next chapter. The figures given separately for each natural division show that the higher mean age of females is a special feature of the new Province of Bihar and Orissa, where it is common to all the natural divisions in spite of differences of religions. These figures also show that it is no new feature, but equally noticeable at each successive census. In Bengal, on the other hand, and in Central Bengal and East Bengal in particular, females have a lower mean age than males. One explanation of the difference between the two provinces is the immigration of a large number of adult males from Bihar and Orissa to Bengal.

BY RELIGION.

585. For comparison between different religions, localities and censuses it is preferable to take only the figures for males, as the returns of their ages are more reliable than those of females. As shewn in the marginal table, Hindus have the highest mean age in each Province, but are closely followed by the Christian community in Bengal. Next in order come the Musalmans of Bihar and Orissa, and the Animists enumerated in Bengal. As already demonstrated in Chapter IV, the Hindus are less prolific than the Muhammadans or Animists, and have consequently a smaller proportion of children, which explains their higher mean age. The relative longevity of the three communities does not appear to have much to do with the variations in their mean age. The Christians stand second in

RELIGION.	MEAN AGE.		PROPORTION OF CHILDREN PER 100 MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40.		PROPORTION OF PERSONS OVER 60 PER 100 AGED 15—40.	
	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.	Bengal.	Bihar and Orissa.
Hindu	25·6	24·6	171	165	12	13
Muhammadan ...	23·3	24·2	186	176	10	15
Animist	23·8	22·1	201	220	11	11
Christian	25·4	21·8	175	232	9	10

° Page 264—*concluded.*

Let the age line AC be divided into quinquennial periods AA_1, A_1A_2, A_2A_3, etc., and let the rectangles AB, A_1B_1, A_2B_2, etc., on them represent the population aged 0-5, 5-10, 10-15, and so on. Also, for convenience sake let p_0 = rectangle AB = population aged 0-5 ; p_1 = rectangle A_1B_1

= population aged 5-10 ..... etc. and
$P_1 = p_1 + p_2 + p_3$ ..... etc.
= population aged *5 and over* .....
$P_2 = p_2 + p_3 + p_4$ .....
= population aged *10 and over*
etc. etc.
and $P = p_0 + p_1 +$ .....
= total population.

Now take the age period AA_1 (0-5). Each of $P_1 = p_1 + p_2$ ..... persons has completed the 5 years "0 to 5" and so all of them have lived $5 \times P_1$ years.

Also presuming the population p_0 to be *uniformly* distributed over the age period AA_1 we may *roughly* take each of these p_0 persons to have completed $\frac{1}{2}$ years, and hence the total number of years lived by p_0 persons to be $\frac{1}{2} \times p_0$ years. Thus for the period AA_1 (0-5) we get $5P_1 + \frac{1}{2}p_0$ years.

Similarly for the periods A_1A_2, A_2A_3 ..... we get—

$5P_2 + \frac{1}{2}p_1$ years
$5P_3 + \frac{1}{2}p_2$ „
etc. etc.

Hence the total number of years lived by the entire population P

$= (5P_1 + \frac{1}{2}p_0) + (5P_2 + \frac{1}{2}p_1) +$ .....
$= 5(P_1 + P_2 + P_3$ .....$) + \frac{1}{2}(p_0 + p_1 + p_2$ .....$)$
$= 5(P_1 + P_2 + P_3$ .....$) + \frac{1}{2}P$
∴ the mean age of the population

$= M = \frac{5(P_1 + P_2$ .....$) + \frac{1}{2}P}{P}$ (I) This formula gives the rule quoted above.

$= \frac{5(P_1 + P_2 +$ .....$)}{P} + \frac{1}{2}$ (II)

Remembering that
$P_1 = P - p_0$
$P_2 = P_1 - p_1$
$P_3 = P_2 - p_2$
or
P_{14} = persons aged *70 and over* (and is therefore given).
$P_{13} = p_{13} + P_{14}$
$P_{12} = p_{12} + P_{13}$
etc. etc.

The terms P_1, P_2, P_3, etc., successively can be calculated very easily. The sum of these terms multiplied by 5 and divided by the total population P, and then increased by 2·5 gives the mean age. This rule given by formula II will be found to be very simple and convenient for application.

Bengal but last in Bihar and Orissa, probably because of the large number of adult Europeans and Anglo-Indians in Bengal and their comparative paucity in Bihar and Orissa. The difference between the mean ages of Animists in Bengal and their congeners in Bihar and Orissa is attributable to the former being largely composed of male immigrants in the prime of life.

BY LOCALITY.

586. The mean age is highest in Central Bengal, which contains Calcutta and the mill towns of the 24-Parganas, and in which the proportion of adult male immigrants is consequently highest. West Bengal, with Howrah, Kharagpur and several industrial towns along the Hooghly, in which a large number of such immigrants are found, comes next, and then South Bihar, North Bihar and Orissa. The mean age is comparatively low in North Bengal, and still more so in East Bengal, where a high birth-rate raises the proportion of children. It is lowest in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, which is inhabited mainly by prolific aboriginal races, in whose villages swarms of young children may be seen. In all the natural divisions the mean age has increased in a greater or less degree during the last decade.

BIRTH-RATE.

587. Statistics based on the crude birth-rate, *i.e.*, the birth-rate calculated on the total population, are of value for considering the progress or decline of a community in a series of years or for comparing communities that are known to have nearly, if not exactly, the same age and sex composition. Strictly speaking, however, they are not a correct measure of the fecundity of the people, as they depend not only on the number of births and of adults producing offspring, but also on the number of young and old persons, who contribute nothing to an increase in the population. It is on this account that the crude birth-rate often remains stationary, or even shows a rise, after a severe famine, in spite of the reduced vitality of the people. The explanation of this seeming anomaly is that the famine carries off more of those at the two extremes of life, *i.e.*, the young and the old, and comparatively few virile adults, on whom the population depends for reproduction. To form a correct idea of the relative fecundity of different communities, we may examine the proportion of children under 10 years, or the number of births per 100 married females of reproductive age, *i.e.*, between 15 and 40 years of age. The proportions may also be calculated on all females of child-bearing age in order to allow for illegitimate births, the number of which, however, is extremely small.

FECUNDITY BY LOCALITY.

588. The marginal table shows for each natural division the proportion of births in 1901-10 and also of children who were under 10 years of age in 1911 per (*i*) 100 persons, (*ii*) 100 females aged 15—40 and (*iii*) 100 married females of the same age. The ratio of births during the last decade per 100 married females of the reproductive age (15—40) is highest in the Chota Nagpur Plateau (261), and next highest in North Bengal (246), South Bihar (243) and East Bengal (242). The position of South Bihar is probably due rather to a more accurate and complete registration of births than to any really high birth-rate, as the proportion of children in that division is somewhat small, besides which the population has increased but slightly during the last decade. So far as the birth-rate and the proportion of children are concerned, North Bengal does not appear to be inferior to East Bengal in any way, but its death-rate being higher, the population has not increased as rapidly as in East Bengal. The people in West Bengal, Central Bengal and Orissa appear to be less prolific than elsewhere.

PROVINCE AND NATURAL DIVISION.	PER 100 PERSONS.		PER 100 FEMALES OF 15—40.		PER 100 MARRIED FEMALES OF 15—40.	
	Births.	Children under 10.	Births.	Children under 10.	Births.	Children under 10.
Bengal	**38**	**30**	**189**	**148**	**233**	**181**
West Bengal	33	26	162	121	210	157
Central Bengal ...	34	26	175	132	224	167
North Bengal ...	40	32	202	161	246	195
East Bengal	40	32	203	161	242	190
Bihar and Orissa	**41**	**29**	**201**	**143**	**241**	**170**
North Bihar	40	29	198	139	234	164
South Bihar	43	28	204	136	243	160
Orissa	39	26	192	124	229	152
Chota Nagpur Plateau	42	31	213	158	261	192

FECUNDITY BY RELIGION.

589. The proportion of children per 100 married females of the reproductive age (15—40) may be taken as a fair index of the relative fecundity of different communities. The ratio is highest among the Animists in all the natural divisions of the two provinces; the Muhammadans come next and then the Hindus. It cannot be said that these results are much affected by migration, for it is mainly adult males who migrate. Women are but poorly represented among migrants and children under 10 years of age still more so. The inevitable conclusion seems to be that fecundity is greatest among Animists and lowest among the Hindus, the Muhammadans having an intermediate position. In North Bengal, however, the Hindus appear to be equal to, and in West Bengal superior to, the Muhammadans in productiveness. These conclusions are supported by the statistics of births prepared in the Sanitary Commissioner's office.

VARIATIONS IN FECUNDITY SINCE 1891.

BY LOCALITY.

590. During the decade 1891-1901 the proportion of children per 100 married females of the child-bearing age fell, to a greater or less extent, in most of the districts of the two provinces and among the followers of all religions in each natural division, except in North Bengal. This fall in the proportion of children, indicating as it does a general decrease in the fecundity of the people, was attributed in part to the deliberate avoidance of child-bearing.* During the last decade, however, the proportion of children has increased everywhere in the new Province of Bihar and Orissa, except in (*i*) Darbhanga, which suffered from famine in 1907 and 1909, (*ii*) Balasore, where infantile mortality is abnormally high, and (*iii*) the Chota Nagpur Plateau as a whole, and Singhbhum and the Sonthal Parganas in particular. In Bengal, on the other hand, the proportion has decreased still further in the majority of the districts of West Bengal, Central Bengal and East Bengal, but has increased in North Bengal. As the proportion of children has been calculated on married females of the reproductive age, on whom the birth-rate mainly depends, and on whom the effect of migration is comparatively small, it may fairly be assumed that the variation in the proportion is due to a corresponding variation in the actual fecundity of the people. Hence, the general conclusion seems to be that, whatever may be the causes, the fall in the fecundity of the people in 1891-1901 has been made good to a certain extent in Bihar and Orissa, but has proceeded further in Bengal. North Bengal is an exception to this rule, as fecundity there shows a steady increase since 1891.

BY RELIGION.

591. The general inferences drawn above are equally applicable to the Hindus and the Muhammadans. Both communities show a steady decline in fecundity since 1891 in West Bengal, Central Bengal, East Bengal, and also in the Chota Nagpur Plateau. Both now show an increase in reproductive power in North Bihar, South Bihar and Orissa, where fecundity declined in 1891-1901. In North Bengal the Muhammadans have exhibited a steady increase in prolificness since 1891, while among the Hindus there was a decrease in 1891-1901, which has been more than made good by the increase in 1901-1911.

FECUNDITY BY CASTE.

592. The age distribution of 1,000 of each sex among the more important castes is given in Subsidiary Table IV, in which the age periods selected are 0—5, 5—12, 12—15, 15—40 and 40 and over. Subsidiary Table IV-A, which has been specially compiled to illustrate the relative fecundity and longevity of different communities, shows for each of these castes the proportion (1) of children under 12 years of age to persons aged 15—40 and to married females of the same age period, (2) of persons over 40 years of age to those aged 15—40, and (3) of married females aged 15—40 to females of all ages. As might be expected from what has already been said about the relative fecundity of the main religions, the proportion of children per 100 married females aged 15—40 (the reproductive age) is highest among the aboriginal

* Mr. Gait took the proportion of children per 100 persons, and attributed the fall in the proportion to (1) a tendency to postpone the age of marriage, (2) the gradual spread of the prejudice against the remarriage of widows and (3) the deliberate avoidance of child-bearing (*vide* paragraphs 398 and 399 of the Bengal Census Report of 1901). The proportion per 100 married females aged 15 to 40, which is here discussed, obviously cannot have any connection with the first two causes.

races of Chota Nagpur, such as Santals (266), Mundas (268) and Oraons (242). It is also high among the tribal Hindu castes, *e.g.*, Pod (236), Rajbansi (224), Namasudra (221), etc. One interesting feature of the age statistics of castes may be noticed here, viz., that where a tribe is in process of being Hinduized, the Hindu section has, as a rule, a smaller proportion of children than their Animist brethren. In other words, Hinduization is accompanied by a reduction of fecundity, and, as will be shown in a subsequent paragraph, by an increase of longevity. This feature is common to all but three of the tribes shown in the margin. and it cannot be said that the results are affected by the returns of age being more accurate for the Hindu than for the Animistic section, for the standard of education is much the same in both cases.

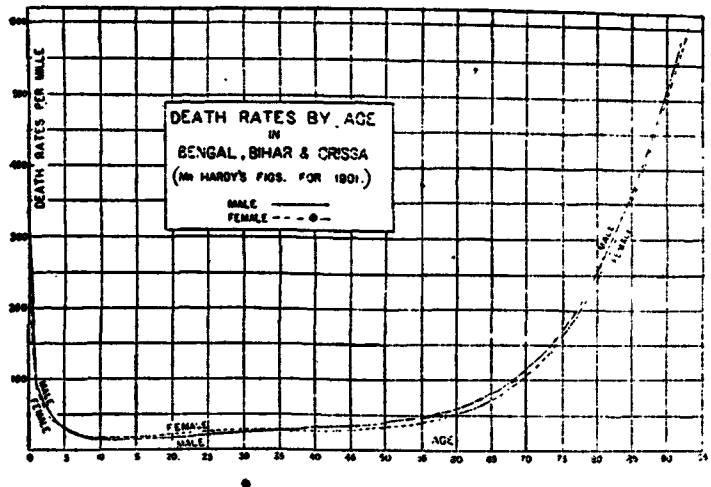
PROPORTION OF CHILDREN UNDER 12 PER 100 MARRIED FEMALES OF 15—40.

Caste or Tribe.	Animist.	Hindu.
Bengal		
Garo	237	187
Munda	187	201
Oraon	200	187
Santal	238	216
Tipara	217	253
Bihar and Orissa		
Bhumij	243	237
Kandh	215	204
Munda	268	226
Oraon	242	254
Pan...	217	214
Santal	266	213

Among the different Hindu castes it is difficult to find any correlation between social status and fecundity. The proportion varies very little among castes ranking high and low in the social scale. In Bengal, after the aboriginal and tribal castes, come (in order) Sunri (220), Baidya (209) Kayasth and Goala (201), Kaibartta, both unspecified and Chasi (200) Brahman (199), Bhumij, Jogi, Jalia Kaibartta (198), Rajput (195), Teli and Tili (192), Tanti (190), Sadgop (187), Bagdi (185) and Chamar (163). In Bihar and Orissa the aboriginal tribes are followed by Rajput (217) Bhuiya (212), Musahar (207), Brahman (194), Goala (194), Babhan (193) and Chasa (191). We should not forget, however, in comparing the figures for the different castes, that the figures are not very accurate, and that the degree of literacy, which affects the accuracy of their age returns, is not the same.

DEATH-RATE BY AGE AND SEX.

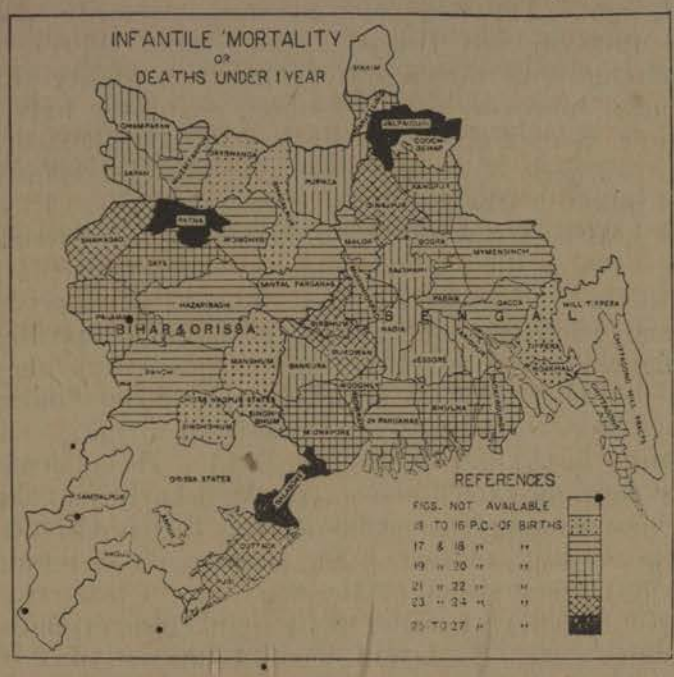
593. As shown in Subsidiary Table IX and illustrated in greater detail in the marginal diagram, the death-rate is abnormally high among infants under one year of age being over 250 per mille. It then falls sharply to about 100 per mille at one year of age, and rapidly decreases as the age increases up to ten. After this the fall in the death rate still continues, but very slowly, till it reaches the minimum somewhere between 10 and 15. The death-rate then begins its upward course, slowly up to 40—50, but more and more rapidly beyond that period.



The death-rate is universally higher among males than among females, with one exception, viz., that at the reproductive age of 15—40 females in Bengal die at a more rapid rate than males. This is presumably due to child-birth with its attendant dangers, which are all the greater because of the want of skilled midwifery, the ignorance of hygiene and last, but not least, premature motherhood. In Bihar, though marriage takes place at an early age, girls are not allowed to meet their husbands until they attain puberty. Moreover, being more accustomed to manual labour in the open air, they are physically better fitted to bear children without injurious after-effects. Turning to the causes of death, it will be seen from Subsidiary Table X that among females the mortality from all diseases is lower than among males, with one exception, viz., that in Bihar and Orissa they succumb more to plague—a feature which will be discussed in the next chapter.

INFANTILE MORTALITY.

594. Infantile mortality is extraordinarily high in the two Provinces dealt with in this report, one out of every 5 children dying within a year of birth. The incidence of deaths among children under one year of age is highest in Orissa, where they account for 26 per cent. of the total number of deaths and represent one-fourth of the actual births. In four other natural divisions 20 per cent. or more die within a year, viz., West Bengal (22), North Bengal (21), South Bihar (21) and Central Bengal (20). The incidence of mortality is comparatively low in East Bengal (18), and is least in the Chota Nagpur Plateau and North Bihar (17). Calcutta, in spite of its medical facilities, and comparatively good sanitation, etc., (but, be it noted, on the other hand a bad milk supply) has the highest death-rate among infants, viz., 31 per cent., and of the districts, Balasore and Jalpaiguri, with 27 per cent. each. Then come Patna (25), Cuttack (24), Puri (24), Burdwan (24) and Dinajpur (24). The mortality is comparatively small in Tippera (16), Bhagalpur (16), Manbhum (16) and Noakhali (15), and the minimum is reached in Singhbhum (13). The map in the margin shows the rates of infantile mortality in the different districts of the two provinces.



One noticeable feature of the statistics of infantile mortality is that the rate of mortality is universally higher among male than among female children, though it is an admitted and well known fact that in this country greater care is taken of male lives. It is, however, also a familiar fact that male infants are more delicate and difficult to rear than female infants.

CAUSES OF INFANTILE MORTALITY.

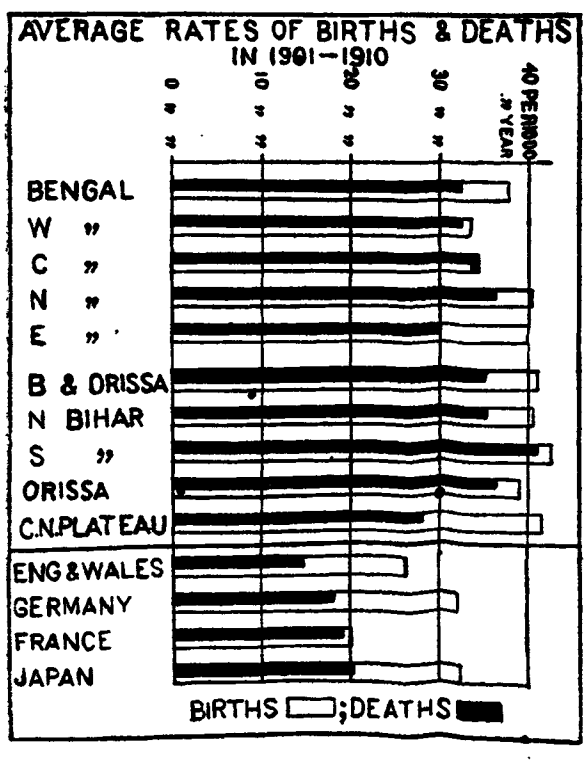
595. The causes of high infantile mortality are several. Debility from birth is the all too frequent consequence of early marriage, or the result of the poor vitality of parents, especially in malarious areas where persistent fever weakens the system. Among the labouring classes many of the mothers are poorly-fed cooly women, who continue to work to the very end of their pregnancy, with the result that they give birth to weakly, and not infrequently premature, infants, who succumb during the first few hours, days or weeks of external life. Of direct causes the principal are unskilful midwifery and disregard of the rules of hygiene, the lying-in-rooms being generally dark, damp and ill-ventilated out-houses. An account of the treatment of the mother and child will be given in Chapter VII. Here it may be stated that the practice of cutting the umbilical cord with dirty instruments (*e.g.*, a piece of split bamboo, or a conch shell) and of applying cow-dung ashes to the freshly cut end causes a very large number of deaths among healthy infants every year. Cleanliness is often conspicuous by its absence, and the application of antiseptic dressings is very rare. Other dangers that threaten the young child are caused by insufficient clothing, combined with exposure, and often in the case of girls neglect, as well as by ignorance of the proper treatment of infantile diseases. The most deadly of the latter are pulmonary diseases, bronchitis, diarrhœa and measles. It cannot be said that infants suffer from any wilful withholding of their natural nourishment, for Indian mothers are generally excellent nurses. On the other hand, owing to poverty and malaria, the failure of nursing powers is not uncommon. In such cases unsuitable substitutes for proper artificial food help to undermine the health of the infants.*

* Reports of the Sanitary Commissioner, Bengal, for 1901, 1903 and 1904.

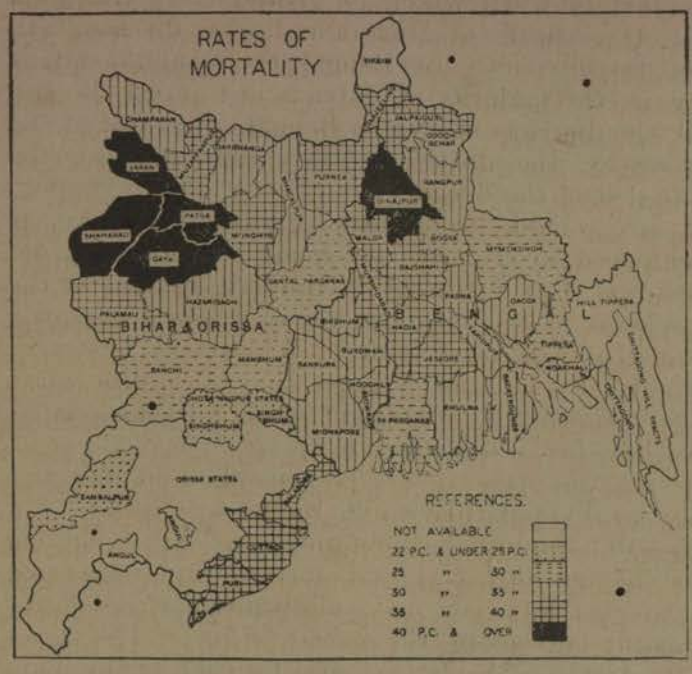
596. A very large proportion of the deaths occur within the first month of life, but statistics are not available except for Calcutta. The number who fail to survive even for this short time may be gathered from the following note kindly contributed by Major W. W. Clemesha, I.M.S., Sanitary Commissioner of Bengal. The note is concerned primarily with the statistics compiled for 1909 by Dr. Pearse, the Health Officer of Calcutta, but throws so much light on the causes of infantile mortality, that it is quoted *in extenso*. It may, however, first be stated that over half of the children that died within a year of birth actually died in the first month. "All who have studied the subject of infant mortality in this country recognize that the causes of infant deaths fall under two main heads. First, conditions connected with the health of parents, such as premature marriage and the prevalence of such wasting diseases as malaria, which particularly affect the well-being of the mother. The second head is equally important, viz., the extremely insanitary conditions of child-birth and the appalling ignorance prevalent. The figures given by Dr. Pearse demonstrate these points to a most remarkable extent. Out of something like 2,700 children that die within the first month, more than 1,200, or nearly 50 per cent., come under the heads of premature birth and debility at birth. These deaths obviously come under the first heading named above: probably early marriage is the preponderating factor, because malaria is comparatively rare in Calcutta. Under the second heading practically another 1,000 children die of tetanus and convulsions, diseases which are occasioned by the ignorance in matters of hygiene relating to child-birth on the part of the mother and those attending to her. It appears that under these two heads about 2,200 out of 2,700 deaths can be accounted for. Grave social conditions, such as child marriage, are things which are difficult to alter and which the spread of education alone can hope to remedy. Deaths which are occasioned by tetanus are, however, entirely preventible. Even a little ordinary cleanliness and a little common knowledge would reduce the death-rate nearly one-half. Concerning the mortality of children between the ages of one month and one year, the causes are many and various. Bronchitis and chest troubles generally appear to account for a very large number of deaths. The children are not sufficiently clad in the cold weather, and, further, it is the weakly child (*i.e.*, the child of immature parents) which is most likely to contract fatal lung trouble."

DEATH-RATE BY LOCALITY.

597. Though the crude birth-rate is very high, the death-rate is also high, and hence the excess of births over deaths is much smaller than in European countries. As regards the natural divisions of the two provinces, the death-rate is highest in South Bihar (41·2) and next highest in Orissa (36·5) and North Bengal (36·2). Then follow in order North Bihar (35·4), Central Bengal (34·3) and West Bengal (32·4). The rate of mortality is comparatively low in East Bengal (30·1) and is lowest in the Chota Nagpur Plateau (28·0). The last two natural divisions are conspicuous for a rapid growth of population and for high birth-rates. As regards individual districts, the average rate of mortality was highest during the decade in Patna (47·50) and next highest in Gaya (41·56), both of which have suffered from plague. After Gaya come Dinajpur, a malarious district (40·77), Saran (40·50) and Shahabad (40·13,) both of which are plague-stricken districts, Rajshahi (39·85), Nadia (38·94), Darjeeling (38·52), Balasore (37·70), Palamau (36·85), Monghyr (36·84), Jalpaiguri (36·66),



Jessore (36·41), Cuttack (36·39), Purnea (36·38) and Murshidabad (36·28). The average death-rate during the decennium was under 30 per mille in Bogra (29·93), Ranchi (28·01), 24-Parganas (27·28), Sonthal Parganas (26·98), Manbhum (26·52), Mymensingh (25·70) and Tippera (25·17), and was lowest in Sambalpur (22·89) and Singhbhum (22·81). The map in the margin will show at a glance the average rates of mortality during the decade in the different districts of the two provinces.



In Bihar and Orissa as a whole the rate of mortality is higher than in Bengal, except at the reproductive age. This seems due in part to famine or scarcity, which affects the vitality of the young and the old more than that of adults: it is of rare occurrence in Bengal, but has visited parts of the new Province during the last decade.

DEATH-RATE BY RELIGION.

598. The Muhammadans are believed to have greater vitality, *i.e.*, greater ability to withstand disease, and therefore a lower death-rate than the Hindus. This seems true for Bihar and Orissa as a whole and for each of its natural divisions: the excess of the Hindu death-rate is especially noticeable in Orissa and North Bihar, which are centres of orthodox Hinduism. In Bengal, on the other hand, and in North Bengal, Central Bengal and East Bengal in particular, the figures do not appear to corroborate this belief, as in these natural divisions the Muhammadans have decidedly a higher average death-rate than the Hindus. In West Bengal the difference (0·1 per mille) in the death-rate of the two communities is so small that their vitality may be regarded as equal.

AVERAGE DEATH-RATE PER MILLE FOR 1901-10.

Province and Natural Division.	All Religions.	Hindus.	Muhammadans.	Difference (columns 3-4).
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**33·8**	**35·0**	**33·8**	**+ 1·2**
Bengal	**32·7**	**32·4**	**33·2**	**- 0·8**
West Bengal	32·4	32·6	32·5	+ 0·1
Central Bengal	34·3	33·3	35·4	- 2·1
North Bengal	36·2	34·7	37·3	- 2·6
East Bengal	30·1	29·7	30·3	- 0·6
Bihar and Orissa ...	**35·2**	**36·3**	**33·5**	**+ 2·8**
North Bihar	35·4	35·8	32·7	+ 3·1
South Bihar	41·2	41·3	39·8	+ 1·5
Orissa	36·5	36·8	26·4	+ 10·4
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	28·0	29·0	28·0	+ 1·0

599. Turning to the figures for individual districts as given in the Sanitary Commissioner's report for 1910, an abstract of which is given in the marginal table, we find that in 1910 the Hindus had a higher death-rate than the Muhammadans in every district of South Bihar and Orissa, and in all the districts of North Bihar except Saran. In the Chota Nagpur Plateau, however, they had a lower death-rate in Ranchi, Singhbhum and the Sonthal Parganas, and a

Province and Natural Division.	Death-rate per mille on population of 1901.		Excess of Hindu death-rate over Muhammadan death-rate.	Number of districts in which the death-rate was higher in 1910 among—	
	Hindus.	Muhammadans.		Hindus.	Muhammadans.
Bengal	**29·4**	**33·0**	**-3·6**	**10**	**17**
West Bengal ...	26·2	25·1	+1·1	5	1
Central Bengal ...	28·6	29·8	-1·2	2	3
North Bengal ...	35·1	40·1	-5·0	...	8
East Bengal ...	30·3	31·2	-0·9	3	5
Bihar and Orissa	**37·5**	**33·5**	**+4·0**	**15**	**4**
North Bihar ...	38·0	34·1	+3·9	5	1
South Bihar ...	43·5	36·2	+7·3	4	...
Orissa	31·5	26·9	+4·6	3	...
Chota Nagpur Plateau.	31·6	28·6	+5·0	3	3

higher incidence of mortality in the remaining districts. The excess of the Hindu death-rate was greatest in Puri, which is visited every year by a large number of Hindus, many of whom die of cholera and other diseases and help to swell the death-roll of the district. In Bengal the Muhammadans had a higher rate of mortality in the majority of districts of Central Bengal and East Bengal and in all the districts of North Bengal. In most of the districts of West Bengal, however, the death-rate was higher among the Hindus both in 1910 and in the rest of the decade.

LONGEVITY BY SEX.

600. In order to draw any reliable inferences regarding longevity, as evidenced by a large or small proportion of old persons, it is desirable to eliminate persons at the other extreme of life, the relative excess or deficiency of whom necessarily affects the proportion of the aged as well as of adults. Where, for instance, the proportion of children to the total population is large, that of adults must necessarily be smaller and, *a fortiori*, the proportion of old persons smaller still. In order therefore to see how far a high or low proportion of the aged is due to greater or less longevity, the proportion of persons aged 60 and over should be calculated, not on the total population which includes children, but on the number of adults aged 15—40. The ratio so obtained may, after making allowance for the inaccuracy of the age returns, be taken as a fair indication of relative longevity. We must also, however, make allowance for the effects of migration, migrants being mainly persons in the prime of life. The statement in the margin gives comparative figures by sex for each of the main religions and for each natural division. As females have a greater mean age and a lower death-rate than males, it might naturally be expected that they would be more long-lived, and that the proportion of the old per 100 adults aged 15—40 would consequently be higher among them than among males. Subsidiary Tables IV-A, V and V-A show that this is really the case—generally in Bengal and almost universally in Bihar and Orissa, though the proportion of aged males in the latter province is artificially raised by the emigration of its adult males. It might be suggested as a possible hypothesis that exaggeration of age is probably more common among females, but that is not a sufficient explanation of the fact that, compared with the other sex, females have a marked excess of old persons.

PROPORTION OF PERSONS AGED 60 AND OVER PER 100 AGED 15—40.

NATURAL DIVISION.	ALL RELIGIONS, 1911.		HINDU.		MUSALMAN.		ANIMIST.	
	Male.	Female.	M.	F.	M.	F.	M.	F.
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	*11*	*13*	*11*	*14·5*	*11*	*11*	*10·2*	*11·3*
Bengal	*11*	*12*	*11*	*14*	*10*	*10*	*11*	*11*
West Bengal	11	13	11	14	11	13	11	14
Central Bengal ...	10	13	10	15	10	12	11	10
North Bengal ...	10	10	10	12	10	10	12	8
East Bengal	11	11	12	13	11	9	12	9
Bihar and Orissa	*11*	*15*	*11*	*15*	*13*	*16*	*10*	*12*
North Bihar	13	17	13	17	11	16	12	12
South Bihar	13	17	12	16	18	19	12	10
Orissa	11	15	11	15	12	16	9	10
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	9	12	9	12	10	12	10	12

As regards religions, an apparent exception to this general rule is afforded by the Animists of Central Bengal, North Bengal and East Bengal, among whom old women are relatively less numerous than old men; but in these divisions the Animists are mostly immigrant labourers from Chota Nagpur, who naturally leave their old women at home. As regards localities, the greater longevity of females is common to all divisions except East and North Bengal, where their average duration of life is the same as that of the males. This is mainly the result of religion, for, as will be shown later, the longevity of females is greater among Hindus than among Musalmans, and the latter are in a majority in these two divisions. It is noticeable that it is among the Musalmans and Animists that the females yield place to the males, and not among the Hindus, who represent only 31 and 37 per cent. respectively of the population.

BY RELIGION.

601. In Bengal the average span of life of Musalman and Hindu males is the same except in East Bengal, which is least affected by immigration from outside. Elsewhere,

there is a large influx of adult Hindu males from Bihar and Orissa and the United Provinces, who reduce the proportion of old persons. The returns of religion for 1,350,000 immigrants enumerated in Calcutta and the metropolitan districts show that there are three Hindus to every Muhammadan. Bearing this factor in mind, it may be granted that on the whole the Hindu males have longer lives, though the difference is small. That this is not a new feature will be seen from the marginal table. The Muhammadans of Bihar and Orissa, and especially of South Bihar, seem to have a longer span of life than their co-religionists in Bengal. The figures for Hindu females are especially interesting, as they show that the Hindu woman's chances of life are better than those enjoyed by the adherents of any other religion whether male or female. This phenomenon is probably due, in part at least, to the comparative rarity of widow re-marriage and to the number of virgin widows in the Hindu community, which again is the result of early marriage. Hindu widows not being allowed to marry again, are not exposed to the dangers of child-birth, and wives may escape them altogether if their husbands die before the marriage is consummated. Moreover, they lead a carefully regulated life, and it is matter of common knowledge among Hindus that their widows are less subject to disease and illness than other women. On the other hand, in Bihar and Orissa, where widow re-marriage is common among the lower classes, the Hindu females appear to have a shorter span of life than the Muhammadan women.

Natural Divisions.	1901.				1891.			
	Hindu.		Musalman.		Hindu.		Musalman.	
	M.	F.	M.	F.	M.	F.	M.	F.
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**12**	**15·5**	**11·2**	**12**	**12·4**	**16·5**	**13·7**	**13·3**
Bengal	**12**	**15**	**11**	**11**	**12**	**16**	**12**	**13**
West Bengal	11	15	12	14	11	15	11	14
Central Bengal ...	12	17	11	13	12	18	12	14
North Bengal	11	12	10	10	12	14	11	12
East Bengal	13	15	11	11	14	17	12	12
Bihar and Orissa	**12**	**16**	**14**	**16**	**13**	**17**	**15**	**18**
North Bihar	12	17	14	16	13	17	14	17
South Bihar	12	17	17	20	14	18	19	21
Orissa	11	16	11	16	12	18	12	19
Chota Nagpur Plateau	9	12	10	12	11	14	11	13

Among Animists the proportion of old persons to adults is lower than in any other religion, from which we may infer that their duration of life is shorter. The difference is slight, and in some divisions they appear at first sight to be longer lived than Hindus. If, however, we base the calculation on the number of persons aged 40 and over (instead of 60 and over), it will be found that the Animists are inferior to the Hindus in every natural division. The explanation of this apparent anomaly seems to be the greater illiteracy of the Animists, and consequently the greater inaccuracy of their age returns: only 5 per mille of them can read and write. It is more than probable that many Animists who should have been returned as 40 to 60 years of age, were actually returned as 60 and over, so that the number of Animists aged 60 and over was swelled at the expense of those aged 40—60.

Natural Divisions.	Proportion of persons (both sexes) over 40 per 100 persons aged 15—40.		
	Hindu.	Animist.	Musalman.
Bengal ...	**49**	**44**	**42**
West Bengal ...	51	46	49
Central Bengal ...	49	44	46
North Bengal ...	46	43	41
East Bengal ...	49	39	41
Bihar and Orissa	**52**	**44**	**54**
North Bihar ...	55	45	54
South Bihar ...	55	46	63
Orissa	54	41	52
Chota Nagpur Plateau	46	44	45

602. From what has already been said, it may be assumed that the difference in the longevity of the people in different localities is largely determined by the extent to which migration proceeds and by the religion of the population. North Bihar, where there is a high death-rate, has the largest proportion of old persons. The co-existence of a high death-rate and a large proportion of the old seems to be due partly to the migration of adults who have a comparatively small death-rate, and partly to a really longer duration of life. The proportion is least in the Chota Nagpur Plateau, though it has a healthy climate and low birth-rate; but here the short-lived Animists are in greatest strength, and the majority of the Hindus are of the same stock as the Animists.

By locality.

In North Bengal also the proportion of old persons is small, but the death-rate there is higher than elsewhere in Bengal. In this division therefore it is probably the unhealthy climate that is mainly responsible for the short span of life of the people.

LONGEVITY BY CASTE.

603. One curious feature of the returns of age for different castes has already been alluded to, viz., that the Hinduized members of the aboriginal tribes have greater longevity than the non-Hinduized. Remembering that the degree of literacy, and consequently the accuracy of the age returns, of the Hindu and Animist members of these aboriginal tribes is practically the same, and that they are equally affected by migration, it may fairly be inferred that there is some truth in the generalization that Hinduization decreases the prolificness, but increases the longevity of aboriginal tribes. Among the different Hindu castes there does not appear to be any correlation between social status and relative longevity. In the case of males the proportion of the old among such varied castes as Namasudra, Brahman, Kayasth, Bagdi, Pod, Jogi, etc., is practically the same, viz., 50 or 51 per 100 aged 15—40. The figures for females are however very different, and show that women belonging to castes that have a low status in Hindu society have shorter lives than the males. The figures given in the margin are for Bengal: but the proportions are similar in Bihar and Orissa, where for instance the ratio for Musahar males is 55 and for Musahar females 45.

CASTE OR TRIBE.	PROPORTION OF PERSONS OVER 40 PER 100 AGED 15—40.			
	ANIMIST.		HINDU.	
	M.	F.	M.	F.
Bengal.				
Garo	51	28	67	36
Munda	43	24	48	25
Oraon	52	38	47	27
Santal	52	41	52	38
Tipara	51	38	48	37
Bihar and Orissa.				
Bhumij	42	41	43	60
Kandh	39	37	43	44
Munda	44	53	50	55
Pan	35	33	42	43
Santal	37	37	55	42

CASTE.	PERCENTAGE OF PERSONS AGED 60 AND OVER TO THOSE AGED 15—40.	
	Male.	Female.
Namasudra ...	50	44
Rajbansi ...	52	42
Santal (Hindu) ...	52	38
Chamar	42	40
Sunri	64	45
Jogi or Jugi ...	51	47
Jalia Kaibartta ...	49	45

AGE OF HINDU WIDOWS.

604. One of the most remarkable features of the returns is the long age enjoyed by Hindu widows. Both in Bengal and in Bihar and Orissa, the number of those aged 60 or more is nearly half the total number of Hindus of that age including both males and females, whether married, unmarried or widowed. If, moreover, we calculate the proportion of widows aged 60 and over on the number of adult widows (*i.e.*, aged 15-40), we find that it is 55 per cent. in Bengal, while in Bihar and Orissa the aged widows actually outnumber those of an adult age. Even after allowing for exaggeration of age, it must be admitted that Hindu widows have exceptionally long lives. This is due to the causes already referred to, viz., that so many escape the dangers of attending child-birth either partially or altogether, and that they lead carefully regulated and sheltered lives. On this point, I may be permitted to quote from a Hindu author,* who writes :—"It has been remarked, and I believe it is in most cases borne out by facts, that a Hindu widow generally lives to a very great age. Her simple and abstemious habits, her devotional spirit, her scanty meal once a day, her abstinence from food of any kind on the eleventh day of the increase and decrease of the moon, besides other days of close fasting, all contribute to prolong her existence. It is a common expression used by a Hindu widow, 'Shall I ever die? Yama seems to have forgotten me?' If the statistics of the land are consulted, it will assuredly be found that Hindu widows enjoy a longer life than the adult male population, because the latter are subject to irregularities and other adverse contingencies of life, from which the former are almost entirely free. It is not uncommon to see a

* S. C. Bose, *The Hindoos as they are* (1883), pages 243-44.

Hindu widow of eighty, ninety or a hundred years of age." It is a commonplace of writers to lay stress on the hardships of the life of the Hindu widow—the author just quoted, in fact, says that in the Hindu widow "nature seems to have exemplified the symbol of misery associated with longevity"—but the fact remains that her lot, hard as it may often be, ensures an unusually long span of life.

AGE DISTRIBUTION.

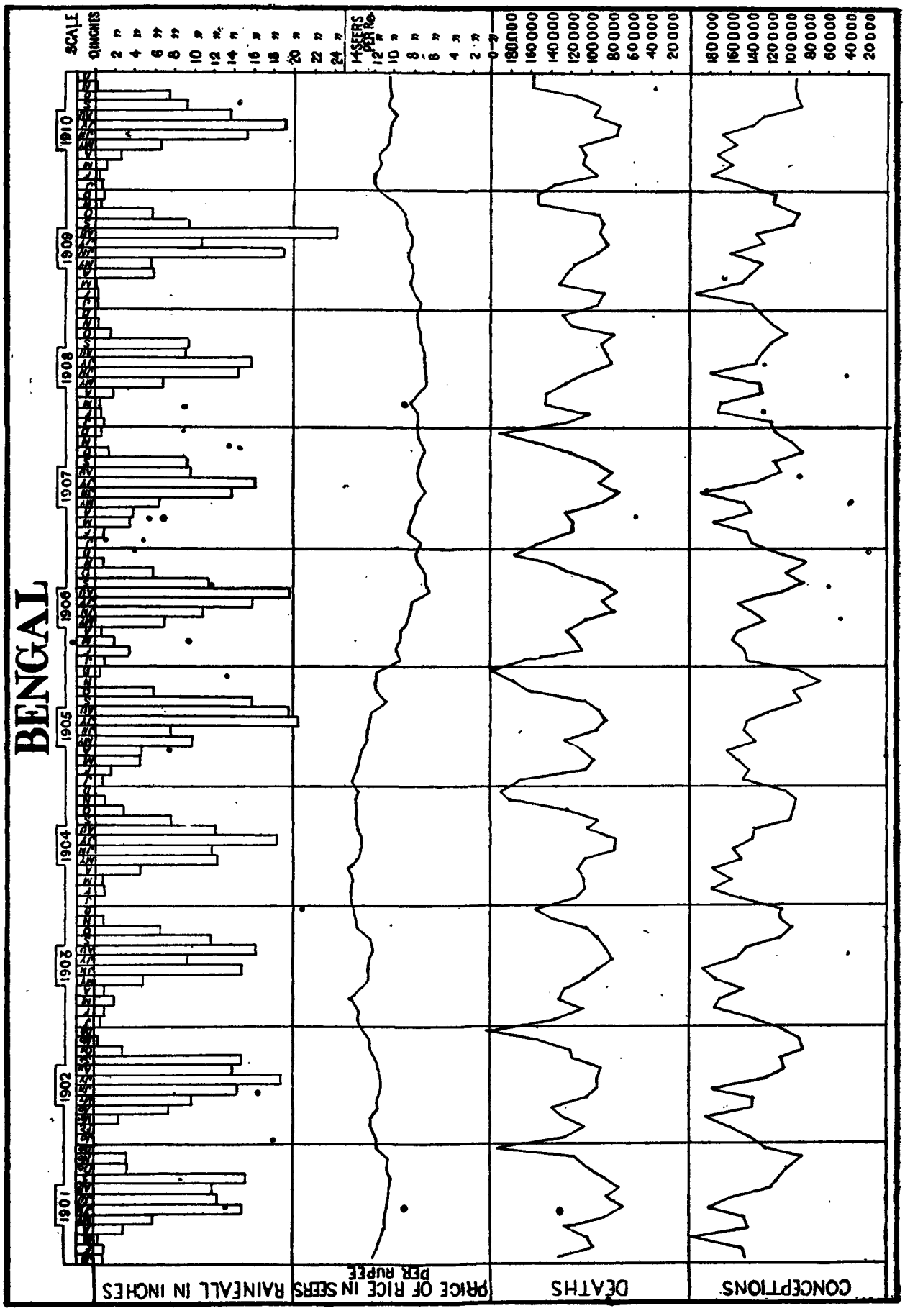
605. An interesting fact, first pointed out by M. Sundbarg before the International Statistical Institute at Christiana in 1899, may be mentioned here, viz., that in almost all countries the proportion of persons aged 15—50 to the total population is uniformly about half. Emigration tends to reduce the proportion slightly and immigration to increase it, unless the immigrants are married. It is a logical inference that in a progressive community the number in the age group 0—15 is far greater than the number of persons aged 50 and over, while in a stationary population the proportions are more equal. After allowing for the fact that the age statistics of this country are not very accurate, it will be seen that the figures for the two provinces (given in the marginal table) corroborate, to a certain extent, M. Sundbarg's theory and the inference drawn therefrom. Another fact noticed by M. Sundbarg, viz., that the rates of mortality in the age groups 0—15 and 50 and over are much the same, and the inference that variations in the age distribution do not affect the general rate of mortality, do not appear to hold good in this country.

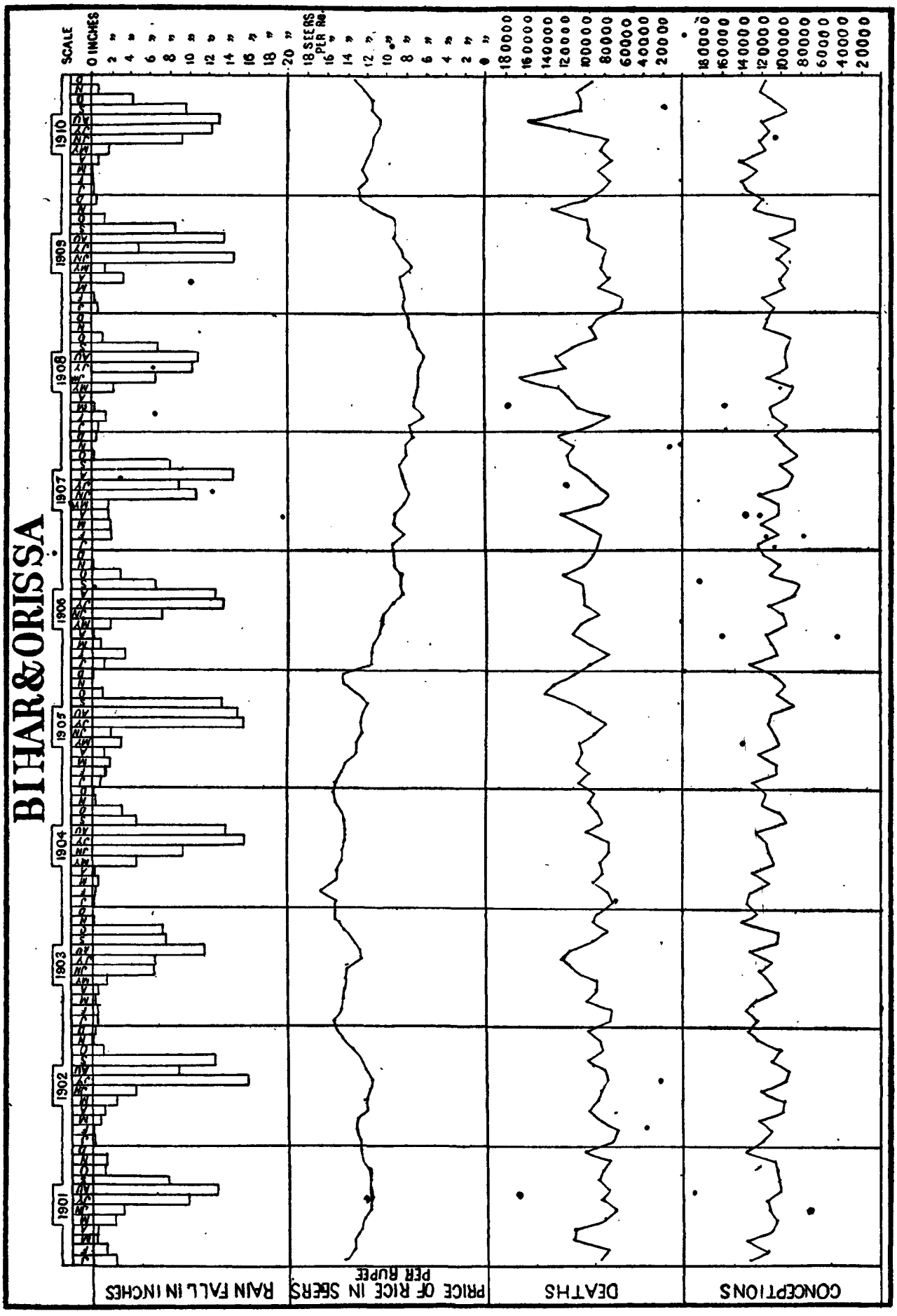
LOCALITY.	DISTRIBUTION PER 1,000 IN 1901.			Variation per cent. in 1901—1910.
	0—15.	15—50.	50 and over.	
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**404**	**493**	**103**	**6·7**
Bengal	**408**	**497**	**97**	**8·0**
West Bengal	365	521	114	2·8
Central Bengal	365	529	106	4·5
North Bengal	418	493	89	8·0
East Bengal	435	474	91	12·1
Bihar and Orissa ...	**402**	**488**	**110**	**5·1**
North Bihar	393	490	117	1·9
South Bihar	383	497	120	0·7
Orissa	382	499	119	0·9
Chota Nagpur Plateau ...	432	475	93	14·0

VITAL STATISTICS AND SEASONS.

606. The full-page diagrams given in this chapter illustrate some interesting interrelations between the seasons and vital occurrences. These diagrams, it may be explained, show the range of prices, the quantity and monthly distribution of rainfall (which directly affect the outturn of the crops), and the rise and the fall of the death-rate and birth-rate in both provinces in the 10 years 1901-1910. The rainfall is shown at the top of the diagrams, the vertical columns representing the quantity in each month from January to December. The curve next to this shows the prices of food in seers per rupee; as prices rise, the curve falls. The third curve shows the number of deaths for the same months as the rainfall and food-prices curves. The bottom curve shows the births occurring in the ninth month later, *i.e.*, with the rainfall, food-price and deaths of January are plotted the births of the following October and so on, so that the curve relates to conceptions and not to actual births.

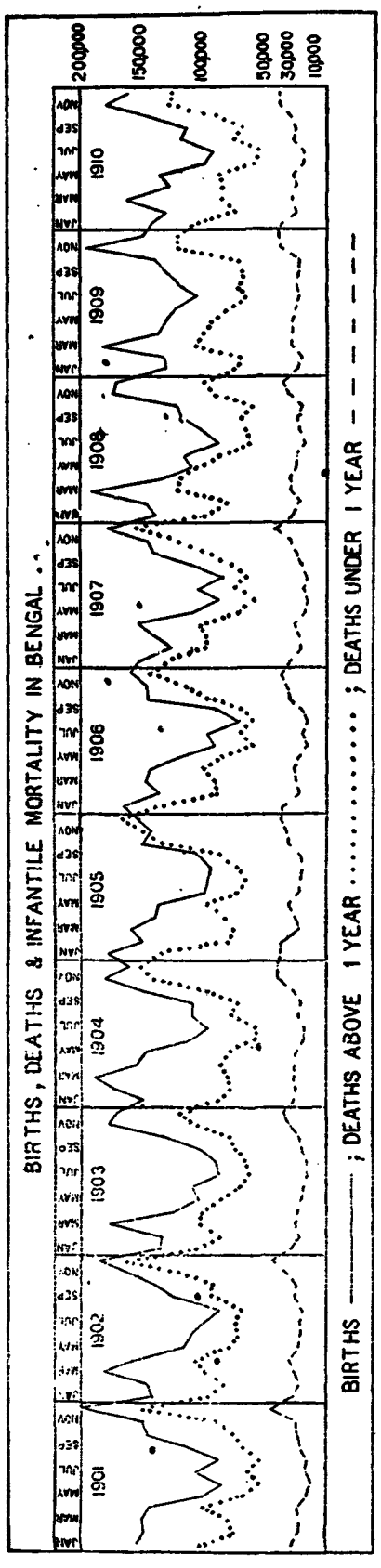
In Bengal mortality is greatest in December and falls rapidly until February, which marks the culminating point of the people's recovery from the fever season (September to December). The death-rate rises slightly in March and April, owing probably to epidemics of cholera, and then steadily decreases till it reaches the minimum in June or July, when the rains break. After July the mortality rises slowly as the monsoon progresses, but rapidly when the monsoon recedes and the malaria season sets in. Briefly, February, June and July may be regarded as the healthiest, and the early part of the cold weather as the unhealthiest, period of the year. It is in the healthy months that the reproductive forces are most likely to come into play. That this is really the case will be seen from the conception curve, the course of which is the inverse of death curve, *i.e.*, when the mortality curve rises, the conception curve falls, and *vice versa*. There are two seasons for conceptions—one in February and March and the other in June and July, months which precede and follow the hot weather. The number of conceptions steadily decreases from July to November when the minimum is reached. After November it rapidly rises till it reaches its maximum in


BENGAL
SCALE
INCHES
SEERS PER Re.
RAINFALL IN INCHES
PRICE OF RICE IN SEERS PER RUPEE
DEATHS
CONCEPTIONS
1901
1902
1903
1904
1905
1906
1907
1908
1909
1910


BIHAR&ORISSA
SCALE
0 INCHES
2 "
4 "
6 "
8 "
10 "
12 "
14 "
16 "
18 "
20 "
18 SEERS PER Rs.
16 "
14 "
12 "
10 "
8 "
6 "
4 "
2 "
0 "
18 0000
16 0000
14 0000
12 0000
10 0000
8 0000
6 0000
4 0000
2 0000
1901
1902
1903
1904
1905
1906
1907
1908
1909
1910
RAIN FALL IN INCHES
PRICE OF RICE IN SEERS PER RUPEE
DEATHS
CONCEPTIONS

February or March, the first season of conceptions. It then falls slightly in April or May, to rise again during the second season in June or July.

In Bihar and Orissa fluctuations are smaller but more numerous than in Bengal. Further, the Bengal curves are better defined and follow a more regular monthly course during each year of the decade. This is due to the fact that Bengal is a homogeneous province, while Bihar and Orissa consists of three sub-provinces, which have very little in common and present very marked contrasts. The larger fluctuations in Bengal are also partly due to its larger population. The graphs represent absolute figures, and hence, even if the birth and death-rates were the same in the two provinces, the fluctuations must be in the ratio of their populations, *i.e.*, as 23 to 19. This effect of population may be eliminated if ratios are taken instead of the absolute figures, as in the diagram at the end of the chapter, where the conditions of each natural division are briefly discussed.



607. Some inter-relations between conceptions, deaths, the price of food-grains and rainfall may be briefly noticed here. In each year the food-grain curve rises (*i.e.*, food-grains become cheaper) shortly after the rainy season, and is at its height in the cold weather. This is only to be expected, for first the early rice and then the winter rice comes into the market. Prices, however, take some time to make their effect felt, and consequently a period of cheapness is not altogether synchronous with an increase of conceptions. The latter are most numerous, not when the price of grains is lowest, but shortly afterwards. In Bengal there is not so close a connection between deaths and prices owing largely to the fever season. The effect of this disturbing factor is that mortality rises steadily as prices fall; after December, however, there is a decrease in mortality accompanying a fall in the range of prices till March or April.

CONCEPTIONS, DEATHS, PRICES AND RAINFALL.

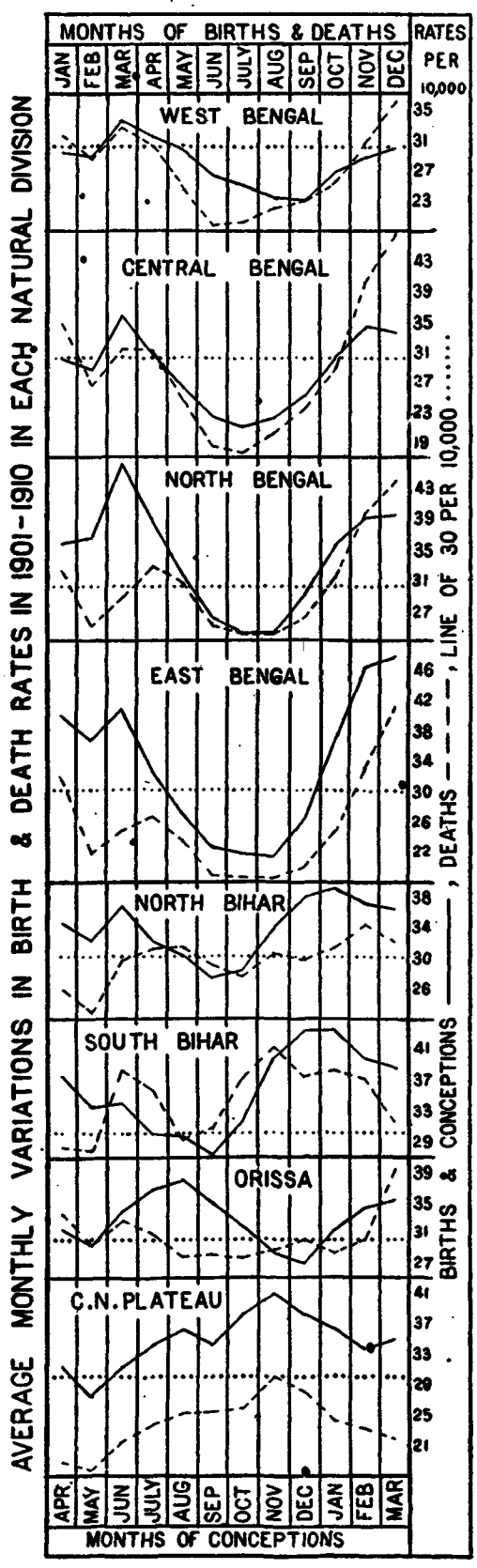
608. If the conception curve is moved forward nine months, so as to convert it into a birth-curve, it will be found that it rises and falls synchronously with the death-curve: in other words, the number of births and deaths increases and decreases simultaneously. At the very moment when death is reducing the number of the living, their vacant places are being filled by new births. *A priori*, it might seem possible that this phenomenon is due to infantile mortality. Deaths among infants under one year of age constitute one-fifth of the total number of deaths, and a very large proportion of infants do not even live a month. The marginal diagram, however, in which deaths under one year and deaths over one year have been separately plotted with the births, shows that this theory is not tenable. The explanation is, of course, that the birth-rate depends on the conditions obtaining at the time of conception. Conceptions are most numerous in the healthiest months, whereas the periods (9 months later) at which births take place are unhealthy, so that a high birth-rate

SYNCHRONOUS BIRTH AND DEATH-RATES.

is synchronous with a high death-rate. The reverse is equally true, viz., that births are fewest in healthy months, when deaths are fewest, because there are less conceptions in the unhealthy season, nine months earlier. It may perhaps be added that infantile mortality, by shortening the period of suckling, diminishes the intervals of child-bearing,* and therefore helps to keep up a high birth-rate.

MONTHLY VARIATIONS IN BIRTH AND DEATH-RATES.

609. In the marginal diagram the average monthly rates of births and deaths in 1901—1910 (and not the absolute numbers) have been plotted for each natural division: the months of births and deaths are placed at the top, and the months of conception at the bottom. The birth and death curves are much the same in all the divisions of Bengal, and are nearly identical in Central Bengal, North Bengal and East Bengal, which are more homogeneous than West Bengal. The description already given of the movement of the curves for Bengal also applies to its natural divisions; but some differences in detail may be noticed. In East Bengal, which is the healthiest of all the divisions in the Presidency, the death-rate never exceeds the birth-rate, whereas in the other three divisions the rate of mortality exceeds that of birth in the unhealthy months of the year.



Turning to the graphs for Bihar and Orissa, we see that the conception and birth curves for North Bihar and South Bihar correspond closely. What is more striking is that the death curve for South Bihar very closely follows that for Chota Nagpur from June to December, the fever season and the season of recovery being apparently the same. In both cases the maximum death-rate is reached in August, after which mortality steadily decreases till the end of the year. The curves for Bihar Proper (North Bihar and South Bihar) show that there are two seasons for conceptions. One occurs in June, as in Bengal, but the other, which is more important, comes earlier, viz., in January. At this time, be it noted, the winter rice crop has been reaped, and the people being in good condition, their reproductive forces are active. After June the conception curve steadily falls until September, as in Bengal, but then, unlike Bengal, it begins its upward course and goes on rising till it reaches the zenith in January. In North Bihar the death-rate is lowest in February, after which it rises steadily until May. Then it remains fairly constant, but with small fluctuations, till it rises to its maximum height in November. In South Bihar, however, the maxima are reached in March, the culminating point of the plague season, and in August.

* Newsholme's Vital Statistics, pp. 74-75.

In Orissa the number of conceptions is highest in March and August, *i.e.*, somewhat later than in Bengal, and is at its minimum in May and December. The death-curve, which does not follow the birth-curve so closely as in the other natural divisions, is at its zenith in December, as in Bengal, and then, after a slight fall in February and a rise again in March, goes on falling up to July, after which it begins to rise as in Bengal. In the Chota Nagpur Plateau the birth and death-rates are at a minimum in February. They then rise steadily, and after a slight fall in June or July reach the maximum in August, after which they begin going down until February. In Chota Nagpur, as in East Bengal, the death-rate is always below the birth-rate, which it follows very closely. The reproductive principle shows the greatest strength in November, when it is least active in Bengal.

From the above account it will be seen why the graphs for Bihar and Orissa as a whole, which are only a combination of the dissimilar graphs for heterogeneous natural divisions, are not only ill-defined, but also show numerous small fluctuations, which are otherwise inexplicable.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE I.—AGE DISTRIBUTION OF 100,000 OF EACH SEX BY ANNUAL PERIODS.

AGE.	MALE.			FEMALE.		
	Hindu.	Musalman.	Average.	Hindu.	Musalman.	Average.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Total	*100,000*	*100,000*	*100,000*	*100,000*	*100,000*	*100,000*
0	3,087	3,668	3.152	3,279	3,424	3,305
1	1,448	1,870	1.525	1,617	1,489	1,594
2	2,461	3,199	2,595	2,691	3,173	2,779
3	2,766	3,401	2.881	3,151	3,405	3,197
4	2,591	3,060	2,676	2,683	2,974	2,736
5	3,407	3,884	3,494	3,371	3,388	3,373
6	2,581	3,017	2.660	2,568	2,754	2,602
7	2,641	3,122	2,728	2,901	2,974	2,914
8	3,163	3,582	3,239	2,757	3,000	2,801
9	2,021	2,385	2,087	2,092	2,023	2,080
10	3,839	3,910	3,852	2,963	3,058	2,980
11	1,339	1,828	1,428	1,412	1,464	1,422
12	3,759	4,182	3,836	2,901	2,728	2,870
13	1,108	1,364	1,155	1,087	1,072	1,043
14	1,858	1,930	1,871	1,613	1,798	1,647
15	2,104	1,835	2,055	1,890	1,628	1,842
16	2,054	2,099	2,062	2,118	2,210	2,135
17	988	946	980	1,088	995	1,071
18	2,515	2,350	2,485	2,486	2,805	2,544
19	901	888	899	962	1,026	974
20	3,459	2,735	3,327	3,842	4,064	3,882
21	836	724	816	1,092	889	1,055
22	2,431	2,148	2,380	2,250	2,516	2,298
23	842	743	824	808	714	791
24	1,332	1,106	1,291	1,295	1,251	1,287
25	5,008	3,863	4,800	4,548	4,840	4,601
26	1,237	1,108	1,214	1,056	1,174	1,077
27	931	921	929	958	807	931
28	1,954	1,795	1,925	2,014	1,896	1,992
29	513	561	522	709	541	678
30	5,606	4,135	5,339	5,213	5,006	5,175
31	398	405	389	480	365	459
32	2,065	1,982	2,050	1,758	1,820	1,769
33	449	432	450	432	359	401
34	650	504	623	508	430	490
35	3,412	2,647	3,273	3,098	2,645	3,016
36	1,272	1,316	1,280	1,255	1 121	1,231
37	437	428	435	425	340	410
38	910	1,022	930	866	851	863
39	307	335	312	381	302	367
40	4,631	3,866	4,492	4,495	4,524	4,500
41	246	315	259	338	246	321
42	789	889	807	742	734	741
43	184	146	185	250	131	228
44	240	307	265	231	256	236
45	2,377	2,087	2,315	2,200	1,994	2,163
46	294	314	298	362	254	342
47	198	198	198	264	170	247
48	492	527	498	517	473	509
49	158	150	157	200	136	188
50	3,076	2,735	3,014	3,369	3,530	3,398
51	146	146	146	169	127	161
52	395	404	397	429	422	428
53	117	121	118	122	70	112
54	154	140	151	201	163	194
55	954	913	947	1,017	934	1,000
56	249	214	243	258	235	254
57	118	121	118	134	88	126
58	187	171	184	250	226	246
59	82	80	82	99	92	98
60	1,910	2,061	1,937	2,789	2,836	2,797
61	76	111	82	118	123	115
62	177	257	192	247	269	251
63	41	78	48	62	51	60
64	57	85	62	73	83	75
65	391	438	399	553	474	539
66	69	78	71	51	57	52
67	46	53	47	56	50	55
68	71	61	69	84	73	82
69	22	35	24	32	21	30
70	552	571	555	809	882	822
71	29	31	29	21	39	24
72	66	97	72	69	78	71
73	17	12	16	13	12	13
74	13	17	14	10	23	12
75	143	158	146	178	176	178
76	13	11	13	19	17	19
77	11	16	12	10	21	12
78	18	16	18	30	27	29
79	7	14	8	8	11	9
80	244	238	247	356	392	362
81	14	10	13	13	17	14
82	23	24	23	16	29	18
83	4	8	5	8	3	7
84	8	4	7	4	8	5
85	32	45	34	41	39	41
86	7	4	6	6	4	6
87	3	4	3	6	5	6
88	10	4	9	5	8	5
89	44	9	38	4	5	4
90	91	71	87	58	86	63
91	2	6	3	...	3	1
92	2	10	3	...	3	1
93	1	1	1	1	2	1
94	2	1	2	...	4	1
95	11	11	11	10	12	10
96	4	6	5	3	1	3
97	...	...	...	3	3	3
98	3	4	3	2	4	2
99	3	1	3	3	4	3
100	18	33	21	23	36	25

The figures in columns 4 and 7 show the averages for both religions, the figures being combined in proportion to the relative number of these religions in the area for which they were compiled, viz., Bengal as constituted at the time of the census.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—Age distribution of 10,000 of each sex in each Province and Natural Division.

	Age.	1911.		1901.		1891.		1881.	
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Bengal, Bihar and Orissa.	0—1	316	326	285	291	317	333	232	233
	1—2	137	148	158	150	141	152	235	250
	2—3	282	310	297	328	293	323	292	322
	3—4	312	351	314	351	335	373	351	384
	4—5	295	306	293	306	307	318	320	320
	5—10	15,61	1,538	1,521	1,490	1,556	1,474	1,554	1,444
	10—15	1,209	994	1,247	1,015	1,219	974	1,139	901
	15—20	840	890	856	896	818	837	756	765
	20—25	759	903	752	884	702	827	711	842
	25—30	909	933	896	905	840	894	882	934
	30—35	806	777	795	778	808	819	859	856
	35—40	657	559	625	551	645	566	629	551
	40—45	573	547	596	584	637	609	632	633
	45—50	370	328	372	330	365	318	353	316
	50—55	367	384	392	406	394	410	409	441
	55—60	170	169	168	168	167	168	163	165
	60 and over	437	535	449	567	466	605	478	638
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	5
	Mean age	*24·4*	*24·5*	*24·3*	*24·5*	*24·0*	*24·8*	*24·2*	*25·2*
West Bengal.	0— 5	1,160	1,229	1,196	1,257	1,253	1,313	1,293	1,276
	5—10	1,385	1,344	1,397	1,356	1,424	1,306	1,366	1,190
	10—15	1,201	968	1,221	960	1,181	884	1,112	850
	15—20	951	1,058	920	996	881	907	895	892
	20—40	3,245	3,206	3,143	3,130	3,173	3,290	3,280	3,429
	40—60	1,604	1,600	1,675	1,682	1,649	1,678	1,593	1,699
	60 and over	454	591	448	619	439	622	456	658
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	6
	Mean age	*25·4*	*25·9*	*24·8*	*25·8*	*24·7*	*26·1*	*24·8*	*26·6*
Central Bengal.	0—5	1,165	1,385	1,207	1,387	1,281	1,541	1,323	1,413
	5—10	1,295	1,363	1,328	1,340	1,326	1,246	1,434	1,347
	10—15	1,135	956	1,159	957	1,123	871	1,074	866
	15—20	897	991	864	909	838	894	760	791
	20—40	3,511	3,220	3,514	3,145	3,200	3,194	3,256	3,204
	40—60	1,564	1,526	1,649	1,656	1,647	1,598	1,629	1,670
	60 and over	433	559	479	606	485	656	519	703
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	6
	Mean age	*25·5*	*25·1*	*25·1*	*25·5*	*24·9*	*25·7*	*25·1*	*26·2*
North Bengal.	0— 5	1,396	1,616	1,360	1,585	1,448	1,645	1,396	1,527
	5—10	1,662	1,708	1,634	1,663	1,574	1,516	1,619	1,582
	10—15	1,090	894	1,127	905	1,089	853	1,100	861
	15—20	793	956	779	983	766	895	715	814
	20—40	3,206	3,171	3,215	3,194	3,182	3,211	3,105	3,176
	40—60	1,461	1,329	1,470	1,281	1,515	1,352	1,566	1,470
	60 and over	400	426	415	459	446	528	494	614
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	6
	Mean age	*24·2*	*25·6*	*23·8*	*23·1*	*24·1*	*23·8*	*24·3*	*24·7*
East Bengal.	0— 5	1,473	1,609	1,455	1,584	1,541	1,679	1,541	1,630
	5—10	1,635	1,686	1,603	1,643	1,592	1,584	1,574	1,517
	10—15	1,256	1,044	1,293	1,061	1,235	1,002	1,168	942
	15—20	859	1,029	859	1,003	827	956	769	866
	20—40	2,981	3,013	2,951	2,971	2,906	2,951	2,969	3,016
	40—60	1,358	1,189	1,383	1,235	1,412	1,384	1,473	1,409
	60 and over	438	430	456	483	485	544	512	615
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	4	5
	Mean age	*23·6*	*23·3*	*23·3*	*22·8*	*22·5*	*23·4*	*23·8*	*24·2*
North Bihar.	0—5	1,286	1,310	1,274	1,309	1,298	1,374	1,375	1,449
	5—10	1,619	1,498	1,563	1,453	1,616	1,468	1,573	1,457
	10—15	1,211	945	1,261	987	1,214	957	1,144	892
	15—20	786	692	824	749	764	680	716	645
	20—40	3,053	3,292	3,008	3,221	2,961	3,196	3,084	3,270
	40—60	1,536	1,598	1,589	1,619	1,654	1,642	1,643	1,644
	60 and over	489	665	491	662	493	663	460	638
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	5
	Mean age	*25·0*	*26·2*	*24·4*	*25·7*	*24·4*	*25·7*	*24·4*	*25·5*
South Bihar.	0—5	1,282	1,330	1,259	1,293	1,301	1,363	1,445	1,505
	5—10	1,515	1,411	1,373	1,351	1,525	1,386	1,473	1,330
	10—15	1,187	947	1,218	975	1,262	1,000	1,127	887
	15—20	742	675	835	759	769	688	696	624
	20—40	3,150	3,342	3,157	3,324	2,952	3,160	3,084	3,216
	40—60	1,628	1,629	1,647	1,696	1,673	1,699	1,684	1,704
	60 and over	496	666	511	702	518	704	535	728
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	6	6
	Mean age	*25·3*	*26·3*	*25·0*	*26·5*	*24·7*	*26·1*	*24·9*	*26·3*

SUBSIDIARY TABLE II.—Age distribution of 10,000 of each sex in each Province and Natural Division—*concluded.*

	Age.	1911.		1901.		1891.		1881	
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Orissa.	0—5	1,252	1,214	1,306	1,305	1,246	1,268	1,447	1,462
	5—10	1,438	1,323	1,319	1,247	1,435	1,348	1,551	1,416
	10—15	1,317	1,123	1,273	1,083	1,370	1,164	1,148	978
	15—20	876	854	952	941	1,020	947	806	719
	20—40	3,116	3,198	3,048	3,033	2,963	2,884	3,122	3,065
	40—60	1,551	1,673	1,665	1,747	1,614	1,689	1,481	1,630
	60 and over	456	615	437	644	449	700	437	724
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	8	6
	Mean age	*24·9*	*26·1*	*24·4*	*25·9*	*24·1*	*25·8*	*23·7*	*25·7*
Chota Nagpur Plateau.	0—5	1,470	1,534	1,416	1,524	1,494	1,605	1,568	1,718
	5—10	1,664	1,616	1,660	1,630	1,770	1,686	1,771	1,654
	10—15	1,242	1,063	1,382	1,144	1,373	1,126	1,216	951
	15—20	844	824	894	887	823	814	754	758
	20—40	3,029	3,096	2,892	2,989	2,763	2,941	2,946	3,090
	40—60	1,350	1,361	1,399	1,356	1,395	1,324	1,361	1,322
	60 and over	361	476	357	470	382	504	380	502
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	4	5
	Mean age	*23·1*	*23·6*	*22·6*	*23·1*	*22·4*	*23·1*	*22·6*	*23·0*

Age.	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.		Age.	Bengal.		Bihar and Orissa.	
	1911.		1911.			1911.		1911.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5
0—1	303	326	333	327	30—35	792	719	826	844
1—2	143	162	130	131	35—40	668	516	644	609
2—3	297	341	263	275	40—45	571	512	576	587
3—4	309	359	316	343	45—50	370	302	369	358
4—5	291	315	299	299	50—55	355	363	383	407
5—10	1,535	1,573	1,593	1,498	55—60	167	154	174	185
10—15	1,183	981	1,241	1,009	60 and over	430	480	445	600
15—20	867	1,011	806	751					
20—25	785	948	726	851					
25—30	934	938	876	926	Mean age	*24·4*	*23·7*	*24·4*	*25·4*

SUBSIDIARY TABLE III.—AGE DISTRIBUTION OF 10,000 OF EACH SEX IN EACH MAIN RELIGION.

PART I.

BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.

	AGE.	1911.		1901.		1891.		1881.	
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
HINDU.	0—5	1,260	1,346	1,253	1,340	1,298	1,396	1,367	1,441
	5—10	1,478	1,450	1,433	1,400	1,493	1,419	1,494	1,387
	10—15	1,183	974	1,218	994	1,202	966	1,118	891
	15—20	845	850	871	871	880	809	771	742
	20—40	3,221	3,236	3,145	3,167	3,066	3,150	3,152	3,234
	40—60	1,558	1,548	1,615	1,606	1,633	1,609	1,609	1,630
	60 and over	455	596	465	622	478	651	484	670
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	5	5
	MEAN AGE	*25·0*	*25·4*	*24·6*	*25·5*	*24·6*	*25·6*	*24·6*	*25·8*
MUSALMAN.	0—5	1,467	1,601	1,451	1,573	1,555	1,683	1,537	1,619
	5—10	1,693	1,686	1,661	1,638	1,645	1,554	1,648	1,534
	10—15	1,243	1,009	1,283	1,032	1,230	962	1,171	913
	15—20	829	966	823	942	791	891	729	812
	20—40	2,998	3,074	2,965	3,054	2,908	3,039	2,962	3,100
	40—60	1,357	1,226	1,392	1,284	1,422	1,324	1,474	1,428
	60 and over	413	436	425	477	449	527	475	589
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	4	5
	MEAN AGE	*23·4*	*22·6*	*23·1*	*23·0*	*23·2*	*23·5*	*23·6*	*24·3*
CHRISTIAN.	0—5	1,528	1,636	1,386	1,546	1,508	1,674	1,413	1,608
	5—10	1,497	1,574	1,478	1,585	1,511	1,579	1,360	1,502
	10—15	1,321	1,210	1,362	1,247	1,313	1,223	1,098	1,093
	15—20	814	871	867	912	884	876	806	912
	20—40	3,166	3,019	3,174	3,002	3,078	2,973	3,600	3,115
	40—60	1,327	1,264	1,373	1,283	1,344	1,236	1,370	1,257
	60 and over	347	426	360	425	362	439	339	501
	Unspecified	...	...	...	...	...	...	12	12
	MEAN AGE	*23·0*	*22·7*	*23·1*	*22·7*	*22·8*	*22·5*	*23·6*	*23·3*
ANIMIST.	0—5	1,573	1,644	1,517	1,612	1,628	1,735		
	5—10	1,756	1,696	1,816	1,733	1,898	1,767		
	10—15	1,301	1,134	1,482	1,215	1,415	1,186		
	15—20	840	894	880	914	818	859	Not available.	
	20—40	2,837	2,975	2,692	2,861	2,538	2,757		
	40—60	1,315	1,219	1,294	1,226	1,300	1,224		
	60 and over	378	438	369	439	408	472		
	MEAN AGE	*22·6*	*22·6*	*21·9*	*22·2*	*21·8*	*22·2*		

PART II.

CENSUS OF 1911.

AGE.	HINDU.		MUSALMAN.		CHRISTIAN.		ANIMIST.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
			BENGAL.					
0—5	1,187	1,348	1,476	1,631	1,171	1,391	1,522	1,685
5—10	1,356	1,411	1,690	1,708	1,191	1,347	1,691	1,725
10—15	1,119	933	1,241	1,017	1,061	1,111	1,142	1,028
15—20	903	1,017	839	1,009	815	995	748	932
20—40	3,369	3,205	3,013	3,049	3,902	3,405	2,989	3,118
40—60	1,602	1,516	1,339	1,181	1,484	1,305	1,481	1,093
60 and over	464	570	402	405	376	446	427	416
MEAN AGE	*25·6*	*25·3*	*23·3*	*22·4*	*25·4*	*24·1*	*23·8*	*22·9*
			BIHAR AND ORISSA.					
0—5	1,310	1,345	1,403	1,414	1,714	1,744	1,587	1,633
5—10	1,563	1,474	1,718	1,553	1,658	1,674	1,774	1,688
10—15	1,229	1,090	1,255	960	1,459	1,254	1,345	1,162
15—20	805	746	764	697	814	816	865	884
20—40	3,117	3,257	2,897	3,235	2,779	2,851	2,796	2,998
40—60	1,528	1,567	1,474	1,512	1,245	1,244	1,270	1,250
60 and over	448	611	489	629	231	417	363	445
MEAN AGE	*24·6*	*25·6*	*24·2*	*25·4*	*21·8*	*22·1*	*22·1*	*22·7*

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—AGE DISTRIBUTION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX IN CERTAIN CASTES.

CASTE.	Locality.	NUMBER PER MILLE MALES AGED.					NUMBER PER MILLE FEMALES AGED.				
		0—5	5—12	12—15	15—40	40 and over.	0—5	5—12	12—15	15—40	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
AGARWALA (Hindu)	Bengal	64	89	51	578	218	91	116	57	524	212
	Bihar and Orissa	122	182	70	367	259	104	164	44	433	255
AJLAF (Musalman)	Bengal	131	218	71	291	189	157	205	58	411	169
ANGLO-INDIAN (christian)	Bengal	133	159	81	433	194	143	150	68	426	213
	Bihar and Orissa	121	178	91	447	163	148	155	77	461	159
BABHAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	106	190	66	408	230	110	175	45	396	274
BAGDI (Hindu)	Bengal	128	180	77	412	208	129	164	64	426	217
BAIDYA (Hindu)	Bengal	137	192	76	397	198	144	195	57	387	217
BAISHNAB (Hindu)	Bengal	107	163	69	404	257	96	128	50	418	308
BANIYA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	116	214	59	410	201	126	193	46	409	226
BARAI (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	140	209	71	366	214	131	197	60	365	247
BARUI (Hindu)	Bengal	136	184	75	397	208	149	180	63	413	195
BARHI (Hindu)	Bihar and Orisa	140	222	69	366	203	138	198	57	389	218
BAURI (Hindu)	Bengal	129	212	102	389	168	139	186	69	407	197
	Bihar and Orissa	137	200	82	389	192	147	183	79	411	180
BHOTIA (Buddhist)	Bengal	100	144	93	396	267	104	151	92	408	245
BHUIYA (Hindu)	Bengal	128	171	67	423	211	158	180	64	419	179
	Bihar and Orissa	151	221	74	379	175	158	193	70	401	178
BHUINMALI (Hindu)	Bengal	125	185	66	409	215	138	181	54	424	203
BHUMIJ (Hindu)	Bengal	124	206	69	414	187	136	182	61	406	195
	Bihar and Orissa	115	198	103	407	177	142	182	91	366	219
BHUMIJ (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa	140	249	78	376	157	150	226	50	407	165
BRAHMAN (Hindu)	Bengal	113	162	71	433	221	122	173	63	402	230
	Bihar and Orissa	114	184	73	406	223	119	171	58	396	256
BRAHMO (Brahmo)	Bengal	101	129	65	491	214	94	162	115	475	154
CHAKMA (Hindu)	Bengal	149	224	78	356	193	158	239	76	387	140
CHAMAR (Hindu)	Bengal	82	113	60	521	221	134	158	56	466	187
	Bihar and Orissa	145	224	69	367	195	141	200	54	401	204
CHASA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	127	199	79	395	200	131	193	65	392	219
CHINESE (Confucian)	Bengal	17	19	8	698	258	129	207	...	500	164
CHINESE (Buddhist)	Bengal	28	27	14	755	181	92	88	31	561	228
DHANUK (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	130	220	59	381	210	127	189	48	403	233
DHOBA (Hindu)	Bengal	119	180	75	422	204	135	184	59	425	197
	Bihar and Orissa	135	211	71	388	195	133	190	62	404	211
DHUNIA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	148	242	63	353	194	142	207	49	387	215
DOM (Hindu)	Bengal	110	177	78	425	210	119	168	74	429	210
	Bihar and Orissa	141	211	90	385	173	145	207	75	387	186
DOSADH (Hindu)	Bengal	54	77	48	567	254	93	112	56	463	276
EUROPEANS AND ALLIED RACES (Christian).	Bengal	60	67	26	634	213	105	107	38	519	231
	Bihar and Orissa	92	65	15	594	234	134	108	29	511	224
GANDHABANIK (Hindu)	Bengal	118	156	69	430	227	142	163	64	420	211
GARO (Animist)	Bengal	166	229	67	357	181	182	222	64	416	116
GARO (Hindu)	Bengal	170	188	43	360	239	153	202	48	440	157
GAURA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	130	200	83	395	192	122	178	66	403	231
GOALA (Hindu)	Bengal	100	148	68	459	225	125	162	66	414	233
	Bihar and Orissa	126	213	66	393	202	133	196	57	398	216
GOND (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	167	210	79	392	152	175	200	54	399	172
GURUNG (Hindu)	Bengal	127	194	79	420	180	133	187	75	409	196
INDIAN CHRISTIAN	Bengal	137	174	98	406	185	150	192	70	414	174
	Bihar and Orissa	174	210	110	351	155	176	193	103	363	165
HAJJAM and NAPIT (Hindu)	Bengal	120	178	72	422	208	133	178	61	418	210
	Bihar and Orissa	139	215	73	380	193	136	188	59	400	217
HAJJAM (Musalman)	Bengal	113	197	100	403	187	99	169	91	453	188
	Bihar and Orissa	147	211	62	357	223	139	187	49	397	228
HARI (Hindu)	Bengal	123	189	72	411	205	133	175	60	430	197
	Bihar and Orissa	142	219	75	379	185	164	216	57	397	166
JOGI (Hindu)	Bengal	124	191	72	405	208	134	189	56	422	199
JOLAHA (Musalman)	Bengal	123	189	74	424	190	142	187	65	417	189
	Bihar and Orissa	156	235	73	345	191	146	201	58	385	210
KAHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	31	56	61	618	234	88	97	97	477	241
	Bihar and Orissa	139	213	71	379	198	129	171	51	406	243
KAIBARTTA (Unspecified) (Hindu).	Bengal	105	120	100	465	210	91	169	82	433	225
KAIBARTTA JALIYA (Hindu)	Bengal	122	182	74	417	205	139	178	63	427	193
KAIBARTTA OHASI (Hindu)	Bengal	128	178	80	412	202	134	173	65	420	208
KALWAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	130	214	65	387	204	133	184	51	394	238
KAMAR (Hindu)	Bengal	116	169	76	424	215	132	169	66	418	215
	Bihar and Orissa	122	185	78	409	206	119	179	65	415	222
KANDH (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa	180	205	67	417	161	154	194	61	430	161
KANDH (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	145	200	67	412	176	154	188	53	420	185
KANDU (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	135	217	68	382	198	136	184	49	398	233
KAORA (Hindu)	Bengal	78	115	67	518	222	77	91	73	522	237
KAPALI (Hindu)	Bengal	149	198	70	392	191	152	192	58	399	199
KARAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	109	180	77	411	223	105	173	63	393	267
KAYASTH (Hindu)	Bengal	121	174	75	418	212	129	177	57	404	233
	Bihar and Orissa	113	178	68	401	240	116	175	50	393	266
KEWAT (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa	133	196	75	404	192	130	190	63	403	214
KHAMBU AND JIMDAR (Hindu).	Bengal	127	169	72	426	206	149	184	63	417	187
KHANDAIT (Hindu)	Bengal	34	85	59	630	242	91	59	56	497	297
	Bihar and Orissa	125	197	84	400	194	119	178	67	402	234
KHARIA (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa	170	243	99	336	152	165	226	70	363	176
KHAS (Hindu)	Bengal	139	186	68	435	172	154	198	75	408	165
KHATRI (Hindu)	Bengal	53	58	46	609	234	88	104	95	424	289
KOCH (Hindu)	Bengal	124	222	80	384	190	166	202	77	395	160
KOIRI (Hindu)	Bengal	48	44	34	658	216	102	105	53	508	232
	Bihar and Orissa	129	201	66	392	212	136	190	53	400	221
KUKI (Hindu)	Bengal	171	196	67	396	170	166	188	58	429	159
KULU (Musalman)	Bengal	141	234	63	388	174	158	208	57	428	149
KUMHAR (Hindu)	Bengal	121	175	74	418	212	137	171	60	419	213
	Bihar and Orissa	137	209	75	381	198	144	200	73	387	196

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV.—AGE DISTRIBUTION OF 1,000 OF EACH SEX IN CERTAIN CASTES—*concluded.*

CASTE.	Locality.	NUMBER PER MILLE MALES AGED.					NUMBER PER MILLE FEMALES AGED.				
		0—5.	5—12.	12—15.	15—40.	40 and over.	0—5.	5—12.	12—15.	15—40.	40 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
KUNJRA (Musalman) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	154	242	56	349	199	142	206	50	389	213
KURMI (Hindu)	Bengal	120	185	80	421	194	135	199	66	416	184
	Bihar and Orissa ...	120	178	83	402	217	126	183	69	401	221
LEPCHA (Christian)	Bengal	147	214	74	427	138	171	199	90	383	157
LEPCHA (Buddhist)	Bengal	98	166	63	409	264	104	149	55	407	285
LOHAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	146	216	79	373	186	147	190	56	398	209
MAGH (Buddhist)	Bengal	146	217	76	365	196	136	197	66	403	198
MALLAH (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	153	230	69	342	206	133	176	45	404	242
MALO (Hindu)	Bengal	121	172	68	412	227	135	167	61	419	218
MAL PAHARIA (Hindu) ...	Bihar and Orissa ...	162	223	91	354	170	159	215	70	376	180
MAYRA (Hindu)	Bengal	52	79	48	571	250	119	127	74	445	235
MECH (Animist)	Bengal	158	218	63	329	237	260	231	144	285	80
MECH (Hindu)	Bengal	123	163	76	398	240	171	183	42	426	178
MOGHAL (Musalman) ...	Bengal	62	66	78	583	211	105	88	52	506	249
MUCHI (Hindu)	Bengal	121	184	71	425	199	143	185	68	422	182
MUNDA (Animist)	Bengal	158	182	52	425	183	195	183	54	458	110
	Bihar and Orissa ...	166	214	83	373	164	161	211	74	361	193
MUNDA (Hindu)	Bengal	153	184	80	394	189	170	225	58	438	109
	Bihar and Orissa ...	160	186	75	385	194	139	193	71	386	211
MURMI (Buddhist)	Bengal	143	190	84	412	171	137	189	85	388	201
MUSAHAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	136	234	66	365	199	150	221	52	397	180
NAMASUDRA (Hindu) ...	Bengal	136	198	71	399	201	145	186	58	424	187
NUNIYA (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	146	211	74	366	193	143	186	48	400	223
ORAON (Animist)	Bengal	168	188	55	389	200	173	204	59	448	116
	Bihar and Orissa ...	194	204	76	376	150	168	178	58	343	253
ORAON (Hindu)	Bengal	147	184	59	416	194	169	194	69	449	119
	Bihar and Orissa ...	179	221	74	354	172	193	203	67	366	171
PAN (Animist)	Bihar and Orissa ...	144	232	76	414	144	158	219	56	425	142
PAN (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	142	229	79	388	162	148	214	61	404	173
PATHAN (Musalman) ...	Bengal	105	166	77	447	205	139	181	63	424	193
	Bihar and Orissa ...	134	221	69	369	207	131	186	52	392	239
PATNI (Hindu)	Bengal	110	168	58	444	220	120	158	50	452	220
POD (Hindu)	Bengal	148	210	73	379	190	166	199	66	401	168
RAJBANSI (Hindu)	Bengal	133	198	65	397	207	159	199	51	416	175
RAJPUT (Hindu)	Bengal	84	119	64	516	217	115	172	76	421	216
	Bihar and Orissa ...	110	195	69	406	220	114	177	46	392	271
RAJWAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	134	226	72	359	209	135	193	63	406	203
RAUNIAR (Hindu)	Bihar and Orissa ...	138	216	73	381	192	155	204	60	354	227
SADGOP (Hindu)	Bengal	111	162	79	418	230	116	157	67	410	250
SAIYAD (Musalman) ...	Bengal	120	172	74	429	205	133	183	66	415	203
	Bihar and Orissa ...	133	213	71	360	223	131	187	56	389	237
SANTAL (Animist)	Bengal	152	224	78	359	187	165	213	67	394	161
	Bihar and Orissa ...	186	223	90	367	134	185	202	103	371	139
SANTAL (Hindu)	Bengal	148	212	71	375	194	161	205	66	411	157
	Bihar and Orissa ...	151	189	100	361	199	133	195	123	388	164
SONAR (Hindu)	Bengal	94	110	70	448	278	87	119	48	501	245
	Bihar and Orissa ...	134	210	67	385	204	136	189	52	400	223
SUBARNABANIK (Hindu) ...	Bengal	100	110	75	460	255	103	118	85	436	258
SUDRA (Hindu)	Bengal	138	208	82	372	205	129	177	60	411	223
SUNRI (Hindu)	Bengal	114	174	84	385	243	130	180	71	385	234
	Bihar and Orissa ...	145	212	74	370	199	138	189	63	391	219
SUTRADHAR (Hindu) ...	Bengal	118	183	71	415	213	133	180	65	420	202
TANTI AND TATWA (Hindu)	Bengal	116	155	75	439	215	127	163	66	418	226
	Bihar and Orissa ...	138	217	71	369	205	135	188	58	400	229
TELI AND TILI (Hindu) ...	Bengal	113	161	79	431	216	121	158	66	416	239
	Bihar and Orissa ...	137	213	69	388	193	137	193	59	396	215
TIPARA (Animist)	Bengal	150	210	63	383	194	156	215	69	406	154
TIPARA (Hindu)	Bengal	166	243	60	359	172	186	230	66	379	139
TIYAR (Hindu)	Bengal	137	185	89	376	213	169	177	87	396	171
	Bihar and Orissa ...	145	223	56	374	202	161	200	46	401	192

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IV-A.—PROPORTION OF CHILDREN UNDER 12 AND OF PERSONS OVER 40 TO THOSE AGED 15—40; ALSO OF MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40 PER 100 FEMALES.

CASTES.	PROPORTION OF CHILDREN. BOTH SEXES PER 100.		PROPORTION OF PERSONS OVER 40 PER 100 AGED 15—40.		Number of married females aged 15—40 per 100 females of all ages.
	Persons aged 15—40.	Married females aged 15—40.	Male.	Female.	
1	2	3	4	5	6
BENGAL.					
Bagdi	71	185	51	51	32
Baidya	83	209	50	54	32
Baishnab and Bairagi	60	164	64	75	27
Bhumij	82	198	45	48	32
Brahman	69	199	51	57	31
Chamar	46	163	42	40	40
Goala	61	201	49	56	29
Hajjam and Napit (Hindu)	72	185	49	50	34
Jogi and Jugi	77	196	51	47	33
Kaibartta (Chasi or Mahishya)	74	200	49	50	31
Kaibartta (Jalia)	74	196	49	45	32
Kaibartta (unspecified)	74	200	49	49	31
Kayasth	73	201	51	58	31
Namasudra	80	221	50	44	30
Pod	93	236	50	42	31
Rajbansi	85	224	52	42	32
Rajput (Chhatri)	49	195	42	51	30
Sadgop	66	187	55	61	29
Santal (Hindu)	93	216	52	38	34
Santal (Animist)	100	238	52	41	32
Sunri	67	220	64	45	27
Tanti and Tatwa	65	190	49	54	31
Teli and Tili	65	192	50	57	30
BIHAR AND ORISSA.					
Babhan (Bhumihar Brahman)	72	193	56	69	31
Bhuiya	93	212	46	45	33
Brahman	73	194	55	64	30
Chamar	93	190	51	51	35
Chasa	83	191	51	56	33
Dhanuk	85	181	55	58	35
Gaura	79	176	49	57	34
Goala	84	194	51	54	34
Jolaha	100	205	55	54	34
Kahar	82	174	52	60	35
Khandait	77	186	49	58	32
Koiri	88	189	54	55	34
Kurmi	76	189	54	55	32
Munda (Animist)	102	268	44	53	28
Musahar	97	207	55	45	35
Oraon (Animist)	103	242	40	74	29
Rajput	75	217	54	69	28
Santal (Hindu)	89	213	55	42	29
Santal (Animist)	108	266	37	37	30
Tanti and Tatwa	86	183	56	57	34
Teli and Tili	87	195	50	54	34

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V.—PROPORTION OF CHILDREN UNDER 10 AND OF PERSONS OVER 60 TO THOSE AGED 15—40; ALSO OF MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40 PER 100 FEMALES.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	PROPORTION OF CHILDREN BOTH SEXES PER 100.						PROPORTION OF PERSONS OVER 60 PER 100 AGED 15—40.						NUMBER OF MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15 TO 40 PER 100 FEMALES OF ALL AGES.		
	PERSONS AGED 15—40.			MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40.			1911.		1901.		1891.				
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1911.	1901.	1891.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	1911.	1901.	1891.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**75**	**72**	**76**	**177**	**174**	**181**	**11**	**13**	**12**	**14**	**12**	**14**	**33**	**33**	**33**
BENGAL	**76**	**73**	**75**	**181**	**182**	**187**	**11**	**12**	**11**	**13**	**12**	**14**	**34**	**33**	**32**
WEST BENGAL...	**61**	**64**	**64**	**157**	**163**	**167**	**11**	**13**	**11**	**15**	**11**	**15**	**33**	**32**	**31**
Burdwan	58	60	59	147	157	157	11	14	11	16	10	16	33	31	31
Birbhum	66	72	93	157	172	159	12	14	13	16	12	16	34	32	32
Bankura	67	74	50	167	182	180	11	14	12	16	10	14	32	31	31
Midnapore	61	62	65	158	161	168	10	13	10	13	10	13	33	33	32
Hooghly	56	54	60	152	148	164	11	15	11	15	12	16	32	31	29
Howrah	57	61	68	159	166	184	10	14	10	15	12	17	33	32	31
CENTRAL BENGAL	**60**	**64**	**68**	**167**	**174**	**181**	**10**	**13**	**11**	**15**	**12**	**16**	**33**	**32**	**31**
24-Parganas	63	67	71	170	178	189	11	12	13	13	13	14	34	32	32
Calcutta	26	27	27	132	130	129	6	14	7	16	7	14	34	32	32
Nadia	68	74	78	171	183	189	11	15	13	17	14	18	32	31	30
Murshidabad	74	78	74	183	191	188	11	15	12	17	12	18	32	30	30
Jessore	62	64	71	161	163	177	10	11	11	13	13	15	33	33	32
NORTH BENGAL	**78**	**77**	**77**	**195**	**191**	**190**	**10**	**10**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**34**	**(34**	**33**
Rajshahi	75	76	76	181	183	178	9	11	9	11	10	12	35	34	35
Dinajpur	81	78	76	204	191	187	9	8	9	9	10	10	34	36	35
Jalpaiguri	70	70	72	184	186	190	10	8	11	10	11	12	36	34	34
Darjeeling	61	59	56	179	168	166	9	11	8	10	8	10	32	34	35
Rangpur	80	75	72	199	192	187	11	10	11	11	11	12	34	34	33
Bogra	88	84	83	202	192	192	10	9	11	9	11	12	35	36	35
Pabna	77	82	85	184	193	199	10	13	12	15	14	18	34	33	32
Maida	85	78	83	206	195	205	10	13	11	14	11	17	33	31	31
Cooch Behar	72	72	75	205	212	210	11	10	11	10	14	13	31	30	30
EAST BENGAL	**81**	**81**	**84**	**190**	**191**	**197**	**11**	**11**	**12**	**12**	**13**	**14**	**34**	**33**	**33**
Khulna	75	71	75	187	185	194	12	11	12	12	13	14	34	33	32
Dacca	82	82	86	189	190	200	12	12	13	13	14	16	34	33	32
Mymensingh	86	82	83	204	199	205	11	10	10	11	12	14	34	34	33
Faridpur	75	75	82	181	181	193	12	13	13	15	14	16	34	32	32
Backergunge	73	74	78	174	175	185	12	10	12	13	13	15	35	35	34
Tippera	82	84	83	189	197	193	10	8	13	10	12	11	35	34	34
Noakhali	95	93	96	202	201	204	13	9	14	11	15	12	34	34	34
Chittagong	84	90	93	182	195	201	11	11	13	14	13	16	34	32	32
Chittagong Hill Tracts ...	75	75	...	202	203	...	12	10	12	11	...	...	32	33	...
Hill Tippera	77	77	...	190	196	...	10	9	10	9	...	...	35	35	...
BIHAR AND ORISSA ...	**73**	**71**	**78**	**170**	**164**	**173**	**11**	**15**	**12**	**16**	**12**	**16**	**33**	**33**	**33**
NORTH BIHAR	**73**	**72**	**76**	**164**	**162**	**168**	**13**	**17**	**13**	**17**	**13**	**17**	**34**	**34**	**34**
Saran	73	73	79	159	158	162	15	19	15	19	16	20	33	33	33
Champaran	69	67	72	157	157	165	12	16	12	16	13	17	35	34	34
Muzaffarpur	73	70	76	159	154	164	15	20	15	20	15	19	34	34	33
Darbhanga	73	74	75	157	162	160	14	17	13	17	13	16	35	34	35
Bhagalpur	73	73	77	168	166	175	10	15	11	15	11	16	35	35	34
Purnea	76	73	75	190	187	187	9	12	10	12	11	14	33	32	33
SOUTH BIHAR	**70**	**64**	**74**	**160**	**147**	**163**	**13**	**17**	**13**	**17**	**14**	**18**	**34**	**34**	**33**
Patna	64	57	67	153	133	150	15	18	15	19	15	20	34	35	34
Gaya	71	65	74	161	150	166	13	16	13	16	14	17	34	34	33
Shahabad	65	64	73	154	150	162	10	15	10	16	12	19	34	33	33
Monghyr	78	69	80	169	154	171	14	18	13	17	14	18	34	34	33
ORISSA	**65**	**65**	**69**	**152**	**151**	**152**	**11**	**15**	**11**	**16**	**12**	**18**	**33**	**33**	**32**
Cuttack	67	66	71	155	154	163	12	17	11	17	13	20	33	33	32
Balasore	61	64	65	145	148	154	9	13	10	15	10	16	33	34	32
Puri	65	63	53	153	149	126	12	14	11	16	11	17	34	34	33
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	**81**	**83**	**92**	**192**	**197**	**214**	**9**	**12**	**10**	**12**	**11**	**14**	**32**	**31**	**31**
Hazaribagh	83	77	89	190	174	200	10	11	9	11	10	12	33	33	32
Ranchi	93	93	98	219	218	225	11	14	10	13	10	13	30	29	30
Palamau	83	83	...	195	191	...	8	12	7	10	...	...	33	33	...
Manbhum	73	75	87	181	180	202	10	13	10	13	11	15	34	33	32
Singhbum	79	77	89	216	218	243	9	11	8	10	11	12	28	28	26
Santhal Parganas	85	89	94	200	210	218	11	13	12	15	13	15	32	31	31
Angul	76	75	77	188	186	193	8	11	8	11	10	12	32	32	32
Sambalpur	70	...	...	155	...	...	10	15	...	...	...	...	35	...	...
Orissa Feudatory States ...	79	...	...	188	...	...	8	11	...	...	...	...	33	...	...
Chota Nagpur States	78	...	...	201	...	...	10	13	...	...	...	...	30	...	...
SIKKIM	**72**	**62**	...	**186**	**157**	...	**15**	**17**	**16**	**15**	...	...	**31**	**34**	...

NOTE.—In the calculations for each Province and Natural Division those areas for which figures are not available have been left out of account.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE V-A.—PROPORTION OF CHILDREN UNDER 10 AND OF PERSONS OVER 60 TO THOSE AGED 15—40, ALSO OF MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40 PER 100 FEMALES.

RELIGION AND NATURAL DIVISION.	PROPORTION OF CHILDREN, BOTH SEXES PER 100.						PROPORTION OF PERSONS OVER 60 PER 100 AGED 15—40.						NUMBER OF MARRIED FEMALES AGED 15—40 PER 100 FEMALES OF ALL AGES.		
	Persons aged 15—40.			Married females aged 15—40.			1911.		1901.		1891.				
	1911.	1901.	1891.	1911.	1901.	1891.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	1911.	1901.	1891.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
BENGAL—															
All religions	76	73	75	181	182	187	11	12	11	13	12	14	34	33	32
Hindu	62	64	65	171	175	180	11	14	12	15	12	16	32	31	30
Musalma	82	82	83	188	188	192	10	10	11	11	12	13	35	34	34
Animist	85	...	...	201	...	...	11	11	...	...	...	...	34	...	...
WEST BENGAL—															
All religions	61	64	64	157	163	167	11	13	11	15	11	15	33	32	31
Hindu	59	62	62	156	163	167	11	14	11	15	11	15	32	31	31
Musalman	65	68	68	151	157	158	11	13	12	14	11	14	36	34	35
Animist	78	...	...	185	...	...	11	14	...	...	...	...	34	...	...
CENTRAL BENGAL—															
All religions	60	64	68	167	174	181	10	13	11	15	12	16	33	32	31
Hindu	54	58	60	166	174	179	10	15	12	17	12	18	32	30	29
Musalman	67	70	75	168	173	183	10	12	11	13	12	14	35	36	33
Animist	84	...	...	220	...	...	11	10	...	...	...	...	32	...	...
NORTH BENGAL—															
All religions	78	77	77	190	191	190	10	10	10	11	12	13	34	34	33
Hindu	69	67	68	194	190	192	10	12	11	12	12	14	32	31	31
Musalman	85	83	83	194	191	189	10	10	10	10	11	12	35	35	35
Animist	95	...	...	219	...	...	12	8	...	...	...	...	34	...	...
EAST BENGAL—															
All religions	81	81	84	190	191	197	11	11	12	12	13	14	34	33	33
Hindu	68	68	70	178	181	188	12	12	13	15	14	17	32	31	30
Musalman	88	87	91	194	195	201	11	9	11	11	12	12	35	35	34
Animist	84	...	...	198	...	...	12	9	...	...	...	...	35	...	...
BIHAR AND ORISSA—															
All religions	73	71	78	170	164	173	11	15	12	16	12	16	33	33	33
Hindu	72	69	75	165	159	169	11	15	12	16	13	17	34	34	33
Musalman	80	76	81	176	169	177	12	16	14	16	15	18	33	33	32
Animist	89	...	...	220	...	...	10	12	...	...	...	...	29	...	...
NORTH BIHAR—															
All religions	73	72	76	164	162	168	13	17	13	17	13	17	34	34	34
Hindu	72	71	75	161	160	165	13	17	12	17	13	17	34	34	34
Musalman	80	76	80	177	173	178	11	16	14	16	14	17	33	33	33
Animist	104	...	...	254	...	...	12	12	...	...	...	...	29	...	...
SOUTH BIHAR—															
All religions	70	64	74	160	147	163	13	17	13	17	14	18	34	34	33
Hindu	69	63	73	160	147	163	12	16	12	17	14	18	34	34	33
Musalman	79	71	78	162	147	159	18	19	17	20	19	21	33	33	32
Animist	105	...	...	235	...	...	12	10	...	...	...	...	31	...	...
ORISSA—															
All religions	65	65	69	152	151	152	11	15	11	16	12	18	33	33	32
Hindu	64	65	69	151	151	159	11	15	11	16	12	18	33	33	32
Musalman	79	71	75	172	162	172	12	16	11	16	12	19	33	33	32
Animist	90	...	...	208	...	...	9	10	...	...	...	...	32	...	...
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU—															
All religions	81	83	92	192	197	214	9	12	10	12	11	14	32	31	31
Hindu	78	79	86	188	184	193	9	12	9	12	11	14	33	32	32
Musalman	83	84	92	190	189	210	10	12	10	12	11	13	34	34	32
Animist	89	...	...	222	...	...	10	12	...	...	...	...	29	...	...

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VI.—VARIATION IN POPULATION AT CERTAIN AGE PERIODS.

NATURAL DIVISION.	Period.	VARIATION PER CENT. IN POPULATION (INCREASE + DECREASE —).					
		All ages.	0—10	10—15	15—40	40—60	60 and over.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
BENGAL BIHAR AND ORISSA.	**1881 to 1891**	**+ 7·0**	**+ 6·8**	**+ 14·5**	**+ 6·2**	**+ 11·4**	**- 8·7**
	1891 to 1901	**+ 4·7**	**+ 1·9**	**+ 8·2**	**+ 7·1**	**+ 3·4**	**- 0·6**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 8·0**	**+ 10·3**	**+ 5·2**	**+ 9·3**	**+ 4·2**	**+ 3·4**
Bengal	**1881 to 1891**	**+ 7·5**	**+ 9·6**	**+ 11·5**	**+ 7·0**	**+ 15·4**	**- 19·7**
	1891 to 1901	**+ 7·6**	**+ 6·1**	**+ 14·3**	**+ 8·6**	**+ 6·1**	**+ 0·6**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 8·0**	**+ 9·3**	**+ 5·8**	**+ 10·1**	**+ 3·6**	**+ 0·9**
West Bengal ...	1881 to 1891	+ 4·0	+ 7·5	+ 9·6	+ 1·0	+ 71·3	- 53·8
	1891 to 1901	+ 7·2	+ 5·4	+ 13·4	+ 6·3	+ 8·1	+ 7·5
	1901 to 1911	+ 2·8	+ 1·1	+ 2·3	+ 6·2	- 1·9	+ 0·8
Central Bengal ...	1881 to 1891	+ 3·3	+ 2·8	+ 6·3	+ 0·2	+ 14·2	- 3·7
	1891 to 1901	+ 5·2	+ 0·8	+ 11·7	+ 6·7	+ 7·1	- 0·2
	1901 to 1911	+ 4·4	+ 3·1	+ 3·2	+ 9·4	- 2·3	- 4·9
North Bengal ...	1881 to 1891	+ 4·0	+ 5·9	+ 2·0	+ 7·3	— 1·6	- 8·6
	1891 to 1901	+ 5·7	+ 6·3	+ 11·8	+ 6·5	+ 1·4	- 5·4
	1901 to 1911	+ 7·9	+ 10·5	+ 4·9	+ 8·0	+ 5·7	+ 2·1
East Bengal ...	1881 to 1891	+ 14·0	+ 16·3	+ 20·9	+ 14·5	+ 6·6	+ 4·1
	1891 to 1901	+ 10·3	+ 8·4	+ 17·2	+ 12·2	+ 7·2	+ 0·9
	1901 to 1911	+ 12·2	+ 14·3	+ 8·8	+ 13·6	+ 9·2	+ 3·3
Bihar and Orissa.	**1881 to 1891**	**+ 6·4**	**+ 3·4**	**+ 18·0**	**+ 5·2**	**+ 7·0**	**+ 7·9**
	1891 to 1901	**+ 1·1**	**- 3·4**	**+ 1·4**	**+ 5·2**	**+ 0·3**	**- 1·9**
	1901 to 1911	**+ 8·1**	**+ 11·5**	**+ 4·6**	**+ 8·3**	**+ 4·8**	**+ 6·1**
North Bihar... ...	1881 to 1891	+ 6·0	+ 4·6	+ 12·9	+ 4·5	+ 6·2	+ 11·8
	1891 to 1901	+ 0·1	- 3·0	+ 3·5	+ 2·7	- 2·5	- 0·9
	1901 to 1911	+ 2·0	+ 4·0	- 2·2	+ 2·3	+ 0·2	+ 2·9
South Bihar	1881 to 1891	+ 2·4	- 0·7	+ 15·0	+ 2·4	+ 1·9	- 0·8
	1891 to 1901	- 3·6	- 10·5	- 6·5	+ 2·8	- 4·4	- 4·4
	1901 to 1911	+ 0·7	+ 7·7	- 2·0	- 1·4	- 1·9	- 3·7
Orissa	1881 to 1891	+ 8·5	- 2·2	+ 29·3	+ 8·6	+ 15·2	+ 7·5
	1891 to 1901	+ 7·1	+ 4·5	- 0·5	+ 10·7	+ 10·7	+ 0·8
	1901 to 1911	+ 0·9	+ 1·8	+ 4·4	+ 1·8	- 4·6	- 0·5
Chota Nagpur Plateau	1881 to 1891	+ 11·1	+ 8·8	+ 25·3	+ 8·5	+ 12·0	+ 14·0
	1891 to 1901	+ 5·3	- 0·4	+ 7·3	+ 10·3	+ 7·1	- 2·4
	1901 to 1911	+ 25·6	+ 26·7	+ 17·6	+ 27·9	+ 23·6	+ 27·3

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VII.—REPORTED BIRTH-RATE BY SEX AND NATURAL DIVISIONS.

BENGAL.

YEAR.	NUMBER OF BIRTHS PER 1,000 OF EACH SEX (CENSUS OF 1901).									
	PROVINCE.		WEST BENGAL.		CENTRAL BENGAL.		NORTH BENGAL.		EAST BENGAL.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1901	38	37	34	32	33	33	41	41	40	39
1902	39	38	33	31	34	35	41	42	43	42
1903	37	36	34	32	32	32	38	38	40	39
1904	41	40	39	36	36	36	43	44	43	42
1905	38	37	35	33	32	34	39	40	41	40
1906	36	35	32	30	30	31	39	39	38	36
1907	36	35	35	32	32	33	37	39	38	36
1908	38	37	31	30	32	33	41	41	43	41
1909	40	39	35	33	37	38	43	43	41	40
1910	36	37	38	35	36	37	41	41	38	36
Average of decade...	**38**	**37**	**35**	**32**	**33**	**34**	**40**	**41**	**41**	**39**

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VII.—Reported birth-rate by Sex and Natural Divisions—*concluded.*

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

Year.	Number of births per 1,000 of each sex (Census of 1901).									
	Province.		North Bihar.		South Bihar.		Orissa.		Chota Nagpur Plateau.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1901	42	38	43	39	46	41	38	34	38	36
1902	44	40	46	41	45	41	38	35	42	39
1903	44	40	43	38	49	44	44	39	44	41
1904	47	43	46	42	49	45	43	39	50	47
1905	44	40	45	40	46	41	46	42	39	36
1906	42	39	40	36	45	41	44	40	44	41
1907	42	38	37	33	46	42	43	38	47	44
1908	40	36	42	38	41	37	38	33	37	35
1909	41	37	44	40	40	37	34	31	39	36
1910	44	40	41	37	41	37	45	41	49	46
Average of decade	***43***	***39***	***43***	***38***	***45***	***41***	***41***	***37***	***43***	***40***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE VIII.—Reported death-rate by Sex and Natural Divisions.

BENGAL.

Year.	Number of deaths per 1,000 of each sex (Census of 1901).									
	Province.		West Bengal.		Central Bengal.		North Bengal.		East Bengal.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1901	32	28	33	29	32	31	34	31	29	26
1902	36	33	38	35	40	39	38	35	33	29
1903	33	31	34	31	37	36	34	32	31	28
1904	34	32	30	26	37	36	38	36	33	31
1905	37	35	36	32	39	38	40	39	36	34
1906	34	32	36	33	35	34	37	35	31	29
1907	34	32	40	37	39	38	37	35	28	26
1908	33	30	39	35	33	31	36	34	28	26
1909	32	30	27	24	28	26	40	38	32	30
1910	32	30	28	25	29	29	39	38	32	30
Average of decade	***34***	***31***	***34***	***31***	***35***	***34***	***37***	***35***	***31***	***29***

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

Year.	Number of deaths per 1,000 of each sex (Census of 1901).									
	Province.		North Bihar.		South Bihar.		Orissa.		Chota Nagpur Plateau.	
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1901	34	30	33	28	40	40	41	37	24	20
1902	34	29	37	31	33	30	35	30	24	23
1903	37	33	40	34	41	39	38	34	26	22
1904	33	30	36	31	39	39	31	27	24	21
1905	41	37	42	36	56	55	35	31	28	24
1906	39	35	41	35	44	40	36	33	32	28
1907	39	36	37	34	44	42	45	43	25	31
1908	43	38	35	31	43	39	62	59	48	41
1909	34	31	38	34	39	36	26	25	27	23
1910	38	34	40	35	45	41	33	30	30	26
Average of decade	***37***	***33***	***38***	***33***	***42***	***40***	***38***	***35***	***30***	***26***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE IX.—Reported Death-rate by Sex and Age in decade, and in selected years, per mille living at the same age according to the Census of 1901.

	Age.	Avera e of decade.		1903.		1905.		1907.		1909.	
		Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Fema'e.	Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
	All ages	***34***	***31***	***33***	***31***	***37***	***35***	***34***	***32***	***32***	***30***
Bengal.	Under 1 year	270	228	262	221	292	249	248	212	266	223
	1— 5	45	39	43	37	54	48	43	38	42	37
	5—10	19	15	19	15	23	18	20	16	17	14
	10—15	14	12	14	13	16	14	14	12	11	10
	15—20	19	21	19	21	21	24	20	21	17	20
	20—30	20	21	19	21	21	24	21	23	19	21
	30—40	23	23	22	22	24	24	25	25	22	22
	40—50	28	25	28	25	29	27	30	27	27	24
	50—60	42	37	40	36	43	40	46	41	41	35
	60 and over	79	64	78	66	83	68	88	70	77	58
	All ages	***37***	***33***	***37***	***33***	***41***	***37***	***39***	***36***	***34***	***31***
Bihar and Orissa.	Under 1 year	304	262	314	267	329	284	291	257	271	225
	1— 5	59	52	60	53	69	61	60	54	54	48
	5—10	20	17	20	17	24	21	22	20	18	15
	10—15	15	14	15	14	19	17	17	16	13	11
	15—20	16	14	16	14	19	17	18	17	13	11
	20—30	20	18	20	18	23	21	22	21	17	15
	30—40	23	20	22	19	25	23	25	22	21	17
	40—50	30	23	29	22	32	27	32	26	28	22
	50—60	46	42	43	39	49	46	50	46	46	43
	60 and over	93	77	86	71	100	84	101	87	100	85

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Reported deaths from certain diseases per mille of each sex.

BENGAL.

	Year.	Bengal.					Actual number of deaths in—							
		Actual number of deaths.			Ratio per mille of each sex.		West Bengal.		Central Bengal.		North Bengal.		East Bengal.	
		Total.	Male.	Fema'e.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Fema'e.	Male.	Female
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Cholera.	1901 ...	64,324	34,899	29,425	2	1	7,852	6,772	9,034	7,537	2,096	1,751	15,917	13,365
	1902 ...	90,797	49,286	41,511	2	2	12,366	10,877	15,014	11,870	4,544	4,057	17,362	14,707
	1903 ...	93,845	50,490	43,355	2	2	10,293	9,257	15,156	12,671	5,794	5,087	19,245	16,340
	1904 ...	102,460	54,372	48,088	3	2	7,226	6,335	16,057	13,190	7,500	6,847	23,589	21,716
	1905 ...	172,178	89,130	83,048	4	4	12,966	11,693	13,972	11,566	20,616	20,294	41,576	39,495
	1906 ...	135,621	71,792	63,829	3	3	14,808	13,759	13,326	11,054	9,514	8,714	34,144	30,302
	1907 ...	158,190	83,111	75,079	4	4	20,547	19,692	23,740	21,090	12,272	11,460	26,252	22,637
	1908 ...	123,471	66,645	56,822	3	3	25,687	23,591	18,772	14,872	6,218	5,377	15,972	12,982
	1909 ...	88,356	46,527	41,829	2	2	4,123	3,492	8,043	6,261	9,780	10,055	24,581	22,001
	1910 ...	119,686	62,938	56,748	3	3	6,932	5,843	10,137	8,448	17,418	16,371	28,451	26,086
	Total ...	***1,148,928***	***609,194***	***539,734***	***28***	***26***	***123,102***	***111,511***	***143,251***	***118,579***	***95,752***	***90,013***	***247,089***	***219,631***
Fever.	1901 ...	944,528	501,170	443,358	23	22	88,938	80,928	89,273	81,905	147,168	126,300	175,791	154,225
	1902 ...	1,083,553	570,933	512,620	27	25	99,225	93,135	114,626	104,583	161,285	141,477	195,797	173,425
	1903 ...	989,486	517,683	471,803	24	23	91,333	85,707	100,975	93,332	143,383	124,890	181,992	167,874
	1904 ...	1,012,850	527,727	485,123	25	24	79,960	72,430	102,620	93,662	157,224	141,510	189,923	177,521
	1905 ...	1,068,975	556,203	512,772	26	25	96,495	89,999	103,540	100,992	158,222	142,013	192,946	179,768
	1906 ...	979,185	512,476	466,709	24	23	98,596	91,266	94,244	85,497	132,594	135,753	167,042	154,193
	1907 ...	982,773	512,664	470,109	24	23	106,539	100,159	97,052	89,698	151,605	135,831	157,468	144,421
	1908 ...	944,853	496,986	447,867	23	22	97,884	89,948	83,675	74,035	153,505	135,265	161,922	148,619
	1909 ...	928,089	468,357	459,732	22	22	72,167	66,141	68,043	60,615	140,841	138,813	187,306	174,463
	1910 ...	921,813	479,376	442,437	22	21	71,481	66,837	74,318	69,263	152,474	138,137	181 108	168,200
	Total ...	***9,856,105***	***5,143,575***	***4,712,530***	***240***	***230***	***902,618***	***836,550***	***931,366***	***853,582***	***1,518,301***	***1,379,689***	***1,791,290***	***1,642,709***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Reported deaths from certain diseases per mille of each sex—*continued.*

BENGAL.

	Year.	Bengal. Actual number of deaths. Total.	Male.	Female.	Ratio per mille of each sex. Male.	Female.	Actual number of deaths in— West Bengal. Male.	Female.	Central Bengal. Male.	Female.	North Bengal. Male.	Female.	East Bengal. Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Small-pox.	1901	20.187	11,223	8,964	1	·4	5,847	4,687	2,142	1,585	904	789	2,330	1,903
	1902	30.737	16,194	14,543	1	1	10,594	9,588	1,108	953	2,622	2,291	1,870	1,711
	1903	12.987	6,975	6,012	·3	·2	3,148	2,789	404	340	2,257	1,917	1,166	966
	1904	9.497	4,964	4,529	·2	·2	1,316	1,292	341	299	2,094	1,955	1,217	983
	1905	4.513	2,469	2,044	·1	·1	540	464	518	481	321	264	1,090	835
	1906	13 577	7,609	5,938	·3	·2	2,558	1,990	2,748	2,187	552	426	1,751	1,365
	1907	15.315	8,328	6,987	·3	·3	3,145	2,650	2,749	2,208	868	821	1,566	1,311
	1908	11.173	6,155	5,018	·2	·2	2,184	1,714	1,394	1,057	1,838	1,657	739	590
	1909	37.620	20,592	17,028	1	1	5,232	4,049	4,226	3,424	8.748	7,742	2,386	1,813
	1910	11.685	6,325	5,360	·2	·2	1,175	1,047	383	343	2,335	1,951	2,432	2,019
	Total ...	***167,291***	***90,838***	***76,453***	***4·6***	***3·8***	***35,739***	***30,270***	***16,013***	***12,874***	***22,539***	***19,813***	***16,547***	***13,496***
Plague.	1901	8 241	...	...	...	...	251		7,984		3		4	
	1902	7.598	...	...	...	...	276		7,313		1		8	
	1903	8.708	...	...	...	...	337		8,355		2		14	
	1904	4.986	...	...	...	...	259		4,724		...		3	
	1905	9.321	6,317	3,004	·2	·1	1,147	469	5,160	2,585	5	...	5	...
	1906	2 985	2,151	834	·1	·04	127	59	1,997	728	10	14	17	33
	1907	3.743	2,699	1,044	·1	·1	115	10	2,569	1,034	11	...	4	...
	1908	1.845	1,436	409	·1	·01	37	9	1,398	400	1	...	...	...
	1909	2,164	1,545	619	·1	·03	20	...	1,525	619	...	...	...	...
	1910	1.421	1,043	378	·04	·01	62	18	956	339	...	...	25	21
	Total ...	***51,012***	...	...	...	...	***3,196***		***47,636***		***46***		***134***	

The above figures are exclusive of Cooch-Behar, Hill Tippera and the Chittagong Hill Tracts for which vital statistics are not available.
The sex details of deaths from plague for 1901 to 1904 are not available.

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

	Year.	Bihar and Orissa. Actual number of deaths. Total.	Male.	Female.	Ratio per mille of each sex. Male.	Female.	Actual number of deaths in— North Bihar. Male.	Female.	South Bihar. Male.	Female.	Orissa. Male.	Female.	Chota Nagpur Plateau. Male.	Female.
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Cholera.	1901 ...	46.429	23,637	22,792	1	1	4,759	4,512	4,038	3,783	13,874	13,751	946	746
	1902 ...	60.174	31,007	29,167	2	2	16,124	15,008	7,426	7,045	5,404	5,399	2 053	1,715
	1903 ...	109.560	56,831	52,729	4	3	26,302	23,925	15,712	14,948	11,193	10,683	3,624	3,173
	1904 ...	35.241	18,278	16,963	1	1	10,714	9,897	3,030	2,848	2,964	2,937	1,570	1,281
	1905 ...	93.590	48,304	45,286	3	3	19,536	17,050	18,204	17,889	7,894	7,933	2,670	2,414
	1906 ...	131.571	68,553	63,018	4	4	37,947	33,310	14,206	13,383	9.294	9,571	7,106	6,754
	1907 ...	115 801	58,130	57,671	4	3	14,508	13,259	9,244	8,454	24,802	27,230	9,576	8,728
	1908 ...	182.377	94,145	88,232	6	5	19,819	17,625	19,145	17,204	30,061	30,758	25,120	22,645
	1909 ...	32.011	16,780	15,231	1	1	9,081	7,858	4,525	4,184	1,594	1,765	1,580	1,424
	1910 ...	126.382	65,133	61,249	4	4	34,607	32,149	26,070	24,665	2.456	2,581	2,000	1.854
	Total ...	***933,136***	***480,798***	***452,338***	***30***	***27***	***193,397***	***174,593***	***121,620***	***114,403***	***109,536***	***112,608***	***56,245***	***50,734***
Fever.	1901 ...	672 491	346,765	325,726	22	20	158,000	138,212	100,600	105,773	28,912	29,611	59,253	52,130
	1902 ...	638 368	336,344	302,024	21	18	169.212	147,999	76,166	71,372	26,798	26,659	64,168	55,794
	1903 ...	665.455	347,561	317,894	22	19	170.691	149,196	89,334	86,658	27,596	28,562	59.940	53,478
	1904 ...	642.348	328,133	314,215	21	19	164,256	144,941	86,433	85,452	24,707	24,777	52,737	59,045
	1905 ...	784.121	406,879	377,242	26	23	185,259	169,388	119,638	118,108	24,523	24,665	77,459	70,081
	1906 ...	728 434	379,096	349,338	24	21	97,895	93,354	175,420	156,764	24,740	26,046	81,041	73,174
	1907 ...	745.817	381,901	363,916	24	21	170,930	160,336	93,019	91,503	24,863	27,103	88,089	80,974
	1908 ...	809.036	418,415	390,621	26	23	165,582	151,159	100,048	93,954	38,108	42,457	114,677	103,051
	1909 ...	757,206	386,215	370,991	24	22	189,491	180,217	103,635	102,630	21,105	21,610	71,984	66,534
	1910 ...	717,707	373,725	343,982	23	20	173,708	155,636	100,569	92,728	23,891	25,512	75,537	70,108
	Total ...	***7,160,983***	***3,705,034***	***3,455,949***	***233***	***206***	***1,645,024***	***1,485,438***	***1,049,862***	***1,009,140***	***265,243***	***277,002***	***744,905***	***684,369***

SUBSIDIARY TABLE X.—Reported deaths from certain diseases per mille of each sex—*concluded.*

BIHAR AND ORISSA.

	Year.	Bihar and Orissa. Actual number of deaths. Total.	Male.	Female.	Ratio per mille of each sex. Male.	Female.	Actual number of deaths in— North Bihar. Male	Female.	South Bihar. Male.	Female.	Orissa. Male.	Female.	Chota Nagpur Plateau. Male.	Female.
1		2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Small-pox	1901	17,493	8,859	8,634	1	1	1,043	1,059	1,195	1,262	5,081	5,081	1,540	1,282
	1902	26,693	13,868	12,825	1	1	1,426	1,350	4,803	4,807	2,866	2,821	4,773	3,847
	1903	17,472	8,961	8,511	1	1	2,379	2,392	2,992	2,971	896	815	2,694	2,333
	1904	7,833	3,910	3,923	·2	·2	1,859	1,949	1,014	1,063	784	671	303	220
	1905	5,194	2,687	2,507	·1	·1	1,152	968	428	455	1,008	1,001	99	83
	1906	12,607	6,521	6,086	·4	·3	1,621	1,529	1,064	1,041	3,168	2,929	668	587
	1907	18,191	9,330	8,861	1	1	2,907	2,818	3,270	3,188	2,331	2,203	822	657
	1908	29,567	15,294	14,273	1	1	2,543	2,474	8,255	7,704	1,514	1,617	2,982	2,478
	1909	21,480	11,350	10,130	1	1	2,943	2,754	4,649	4,507	767	694	2,991	2,195
	1910	4,448	2,363	2,085	·1	·1	1,331	1,056	495	548	207	180	330	301
	Total ...	***160,978***	***83,143***	***77,835***	***6·8***	***6·7***	***19,204***	***18,324***	***28,165***	***27,566***	***18,572***	***17,962***	***17,202***	***13,983***
Plague	1901	70,388	...	...	...	...	20,955		48,016		23		1,394	
	1902	25,369	...	...	...	...	17,922		6,961		15		471	
	1903	56,972	...	...	...	...	32,696		24,227		38		11	
	1904	70,450	...	...	...	...	23,416		46,795		33		206	
	1905	116,769	48,940	67,829	3	4	19,329	27,267	29,266	40,170	27	...	318	392
	1906	56,708	22,881	33,827	1	2	10,479	15,330	13,226	17,390	8	1	168	206
	1907	79,867	33,086	46,781	2	3	15,004	21,970	17,836	24,452	8	3	238	356
	1908	14,103	5,945	8,158	·3	·4	2,933	4,085	2,986	4,049	2	...	24	24
	1909	9,615	4,186	5,429	·2	·3	2,257	2,751	1,928	2,676	...	...	1	2
	1910	45,209	19,060	26,149	1	2	10,245	13,446	8,813	12,703	1	...	1	...
	Total ...	***545,450***	...	...	...	...	***240,085***		***301,394***		***159***		***3,312***	

The above figures are exclusive of Angul, Orissa Feudatory States and Chota Nagpur States for which vital statistics are not available. Those for 1901—03 are also exclusive of Sambalpur. The sex details of deaths from plague for 1901 to 1904 are not available.

SUBSIDIARY TABLE XI.—INFANTILE MORTALITY.

DISTRICT AND NATURAL DIVISION.	1901—1910.							Total number of deaths.	Percentage of deaths under one year to total deaths (both sexes).
	NUMBER OF BIRTHS.		NUMBER OF DEATHS UNDER ONE YEAR.		PERCENTAGE OF DEATHS UNDER ONE YEAR TO BIRTHS.				
	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Male.	Female.	Total.		
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA.	*14,946·9*	*14,153·9*	*3,037·5*	*2,633·7*	*20*	*19*	*19*	*25,373·3*	*22*
Bengal	*8,139·9*	*7,657·4*	*1,686·4*	*1,439·6*	*21*	*19*	*20*	*13,728·3*	*23*
WEST BENGAL	*1,422·0*	*1,336·7*	*322·7*	*272·9*	*23*	*20*	*22*	*2,665·8*	*22*
Burdwan	255·6	238·6	64·8	53·1	25	22	24	514·6	23
Birbhum	165·2	156·9	40·3	32·6	24	21	23	303·5	24
Bankura	204·8	195·8	44·1	37·4	22	19	20	342·4	24
Midnapore	477·7	453 5	102·1	92·5	21	20	21	876·3	22
Hooghly	171·9	158·4	39·5	32·0	23	20	22	366·1	20
Howrah	146·5	133·4	31·9	25·3	22	19	20	263·0	22
CENTRAL BENGAL	*1,352·0*	*1,263·3*	*279·3*	*248·6*	*21*	*20*	*20*	*2,652·4*	*20*
24-Parganas	348·2	318·5	65·3	53·6	19	17	18	567·1	21
Calcutta	78·7	71·5	25·2	21·7	32	30	31	295·7	16
Nadia	335·5	316·1	68·4	63·5	20	20	20	645·8	20
Murshidabad	295·0	271·7	60·5	54·3	21	20	21	483·7	24
Jessore	304·6	285·5	60·0	56·0	20	20	20	660·2	18
NORTH BENGAL	*1,943·5*	*1,845·9*	*420·8*	*365·0*	*22*	*20*	*21*	*3,396·6*	*23*
Rajshahi	314·0	299·3	60·3	55·4	19	18	19	582·1	20
Dinajpur	349·8	334·6	87·4	76·3	25	23	24	638·8	26
Jalpaiguri	150·1	142·8	42·2	36·1	28	25	27	288·2	27
Darjeeling	44·0	41·4	10·3	8·2	23	20	22	96·0	19
Rangpur	440·7	427·7	102·3	87·2	23	20	22	734·8	26
Bogra	184·3	173·2	35·6	29·2	19	17	18	255·5	25
Pabna	248·7	237·9	45·2	39·2	18	17	18	487·9	17
Malda	211·9	199·9	37·4	33·4	18	17	17	313·4	23
EAST BENGAL	*3,422·5*	*3,211·6*	*663·5*	*553·1*	*19*	*17*	*18*	*5,013·4*	*24*
Khulna	257·4	244·1	59·8	50·9	23	21	22	406·4	27
Dacca	548·4	517·8	103·5	86·9	19	17	18	807·0	24
Mymensingh	759·2	717·8	140·0	116·3	18	16	17	1,006·8	25
Faridpur	401·8	379·0	83·7	70·7	21	19	20	679·2	23
Backergunge	479·8	446·6	111·2	92·2	23	21	22	793·2	26
Tippera	419·1	391·5	73·3	58·8	17	15	16	533·1	25
Noakhali	271·9	255·5	42·4	36·3	16	14	15	361·6	22
Chittagong	285·3	259·4	49·7	41·0	17	16	17	424·2	21
Bihar and Orissa ...	*6,806·9*	*6,496·5*	*1,351·1*	*1,194·1*	*20*	*18*	*19*	*11,498·8*	*22*
NORTH BIHAR	*2,865·8*	*2,727·1*	*511·6*	*446·3*	*18*	*16*	*17*	*4,892·1*	*20*
Saran	497·3	469·3	101·1	78·5	20	17	19	975·5	18
Champaran	392·0	375·2	78·1	68·5	20	18	19	584·8	25
Muzaffarpur	595·3	578·3	105·4	98·7	18	17	17	973·1	21
Darbhanga	593·5	569·3	82·7	76·0	14	13	14	972·8	16
Bhagalpur	414·0	391·5	69·5	61·4	17	16	16	702·9	19
Purnea	373·7	343·6	74·8	63·2	20	18	19	683·0	20
SOUTH BIHAR	*1,685·0*	*1,607·7*	*368·7*	*333·4*	*22*	*21*	*21*	*3,177·5*	*22*
Patna	338·2	321·8	87·2	77·7	26	24	25	771·7	21
Gaya	468·8	457·1	99·7	91·1	21	20	21	856·0	22
Shahabad	417·0	390·3	99·3	86·6	24	23	23	787·6	24
Monghyr	460·9	438·4	82·5	76·0	18	17	18	762·2	21
ORISSA	*832·7*	*791·8*	*208·1*	*191·4*	*25*	*24*	*25*	*1,515·9*	*26*
Cuttack	434·5	411·8	105·6	96·3	24	23	24	749·7	27
Balasore	206·6	198·1	56·6	52·9	27	27	27	404·7	27
Puri	189·5	181·8	45·8	42·3	24	23	24	361·4	24
CHOTA NAGPUR PLATEAU ...	*1,423·5*	*1,369·9*	*262·7*	*223·0*	*18*	*16*	*17*	*1,913·3*	*24*
Hazaribagh	279·6	269·5	52·4	46·7	19	17	18	378·9	26
Ranchi	269·1	260·1	50·2	41·6	19	16	17	332·7	28
Palamau	150·5	146·1	34·6	31·1	23	21	22	228·3	29
Manbhum	262·9	249·1	46·1	38·2	18	15	16	345·1	24
Singhbhum	115·4	111·8	16·2	13·9	14	12	13	139·9	22
Santhal-Parganas	345·7	333·2	63·1	51·5	18	15	17	488·3	23

Those districts for which vital statistics are not available have been left out of account.

CHAPTER VI.

SEX.

INTRODUCTORY.

610. Throughout the census tables separate figures are given for each sex according to the subjects dealt with, but the tables which are most relevant to a consideration of the statistics are Tables I, II, VII and XI, and, for individual castes, Tables IX and XIV. Proportional figures illustrating the more important features of the returns are, as usual, given in Subsidiary Tables at the end of the chapter, viz.—

Subsidiary Table I.—General proportion of the sexes by natural divisions and districts.

Subsidiary Table II.—Number of females per 1,000 males at different age periods by religion at each of the last three censuses.

Subsidiary Table III.—Number of females per 1,000 males at different age periods by religions and natural divisions.

Subsidiary Table IV.—Number of females per 1,000 males for certain selected castes.

Subsidiary Table V.—Number of births and deaths reported for each sex during the decades 1891-1900 and 1901-1910.

Subsidiary Table VA.—Comparative statistics of births and deaths by sex during the same two decades.

Subsidiary Table VI.—Number of deaths of each sex at different ages.

PROPORTION OF THE SEXES.

611. The proportion of the sexes in European countries (excluding those in the south-east of Europe) is very different from what it is in those other parts of the world for which reliable statistics are available. In the former females outnumber males in spite of a general excess of males at birth, as shown in the marginal table, from which it will be seen that this is a phenomenon common to both Latin and Teutonic countries. In India, the south-eastern countries of Europe, North America and other countries, such as Egypt and Japan, the reverse is the case. The deficiency of females in India has been ascribed by European statisticians, such as Von Mayr and Kirchhoff, to a supposed incomplete return of females, which is ascribed largely to "the unwillingness of Muhammadans, and to some extent of Hindus also, to mention to the enumerators the young women living in their zenana." The subject will be discussed later in this chapter, and here it will be sufficient to invite attention to the fact that the relative paucity of women is not confined to India.

COUNTRY.	NUMBER OF FEMALES PER 1,000 MALES.			
	At birth.		In total population.	
	1870.	1900.	1870.	1900.
England ...	963	964	1,054	1,068
Scotland ...	945	955	1,096	1,057
Ireland ...	951	944	1,050	1,027
Germany ...	950	948	1,040	1,032
France ...	953	961	1,008	1,032
Italy ...	937	947	989	1,010
Spain ...	936	905	1,044	1.049

COUNTRY.	Year of census.	Number of females per 1,000 males.
Bulgaria	1905	962
Servia	1900	946
Greece	1907	986
Egypt	1907	992
United States	1910	943
Canada	...	952
Japan	1903	980
India	1901	963
	1911	954
Bengal Bihar and Orissa ...	1901	999
	1911	938

SEX PROPORTION BY LOCALITY.

612. The excess of males in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, which has been shown in the marginal table above, is due to the preponderance of males in Bengal, for there is an excess of females in Bihar and Orissa. In the actual population of Bengal, *i.e.*, the population actually enumerated in each district, including immigrants from outside, there are 945 females to every 1,000 males, whereas there are 1,043 females to every 1.000 males in Bihar and Orissa. Females are in defect

This chapter has been written in collaboration with my Personal Assistant, Babu Naba Gauranga Basak, M.A., Deputy Magistrate and Deputy Collector.